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King Horn,
Floriz and Blauncheflur,
The Assumption of our Lady.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK KING HORN,
FLORIZ AND BLAUNCHEFLUR, THE ASSUMPTION OF OUR LADY

This text includes characters that require UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding:

ȝ ȝ (yogh)
ĥ (h with stroke)
Ɑ (l with slash, see below)
ā ē ī ō ū ÿ æ (vowels with macron or “long” mark)
ē ē and ō ō, each representing open/closed pairs
ēō (eo with shared macron) used as a stand-in for e◻o

If any of these characters do not display properly—in particular, if the diacritic does not appear directly above the letter—or if the apostrophes and quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that the browser’s “character set” or “file encoding” is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser’s default font.

Combinations such as ŷ (y with breve and macron) or ȯ (o with under-dot and macron) may not display as intended in all browsers. These forms are rare.

Except for yogh, h-stroke and paired Ɑ, unusual letters appear only in the editorial material (introduction, notes and glossary). For this e-text, the printed book’s circumflex accents have been shown as macrons—that is, æ instead of â and similar—except for “true” circumflexes in modern French citations and the word “rôle”. The character shown here as ēō was printed as “eo” joined by a single circumflex. In the Trentham MS. of Floriz and Blancheflur, and a few times in the Assumption, some letters were printed with “end flourishes” (see Introduction under “Manuscripts”). They are printed as g⁺, k⁺, n⁺ and similar. In the same passages, the double letter “ll” printed with a joining wavy line is shown as Ɑ.

Footnotes have been numbered continuously through the Introduction, and separately for each of the three original texts. For mechanical reasons, some footnotes in the primary text will seem to be out of order. Line numbering is by multiples of 4.

Typographical errors are shown in the text with mouse-hover popups. Errors are listed again at the end of each file. Within correction popups, italics representing editorial expansions are shown with {braces}.

See the [end of the e-text](#) for details about differences between the e-text and the printed book.

FIRST EDITED IN 1866
BY J. RAWSON LUMBY,
AND NOW RE-EDITED FROM THE MANUSCRIPTS,
WITH INTRODUCTION, NOTES, AND GLOSSARY,
BY
GEORGE H. McKNIGHT.

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PREFACE.

THE triple labour involved in editing three independent works in one volume will, it is hoped, serve as an excuse for some of the shortcomings of the present publication. Under the circumstances it has been impossible to make the work as definitive as might have been the case with a single text. For example, while I have been able to print the three existing manuscript texts of King Horn, of the other two poems, the textual material is not nearly so complete.

The texts, it is hoped, are accurately printed. The credit for this is due, in large measure, to Dr. Furnivall,—who has read with the MSS. the proofs of all the British Museum texts,—and to the proof-readers at Oxford and Cambridge. The notes to King Horn represent a good deal of labour, and may, I trust, prove useful. The glossary, though not so complete as that in Wissmann's excellent critical edition of King Horn, is intended to fit the volume, and to supply explanation of words and uses of words not intelligible to ordinary readers of Early English Texts.

It is my pleasant duty to acknowledge assistance from various quarters. I am indebted to the libraries of the British Museum and Cambridge University, and the Bodleian library at Oxford for the use of manuscripts; also to the Duke of Sutherland for permission to copy the text of Floris and Blauncheflur from the manuscript in his private library; also to the Cornell University library for conveniences placed at my disposal in the preparation of this volume. I must also acknowledge timely words of advice from Prof. J. M. Hart, notes on Layamon from Dr. B. S. Monroe, and assistance in proof-reading by Prof. W. Strunk, jr. But above all I must acknowledge the less apparent work of Dr. Furnivall in preparing the texts for press, a work the amount of which one who has not edited for the E.E.T.S. is not likely to realize.

G. H. M. K.

Ithaca, N.Y., July 8, 1901.

GLOSSARY.

ABBREVIATIONS.

Add. Brit. Mus. Add. MS. of Ass.

Ass. Assumption of our Lady.

C. Cambridge Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2. of King Horn and Assumption.

Cott. Cottonian MS. of Floriz and Bl.

F. & B. Floriz and Blancheflur.

H. Harleian MSS. of King Horn and of Assumption.

KH. King Horn.

L. Laud Misc. MS. 108 of King Horn.

OE. Old English.

OF. Old French.

T. Trentham MS. of Floriz and Bl.

V. Cottonian MS. of Floriz and Bl.

Yogh ȝ and thorn þ are alphabetized as “g” and “t”. I and J are alphabetized together. U/V as a vowel is alphabetized before V as a consonant.

a b c d e f g h i l m
n o p q r s t u v w y

[abegge](#), abeie, *see* beien.

abide, *see* bide.

acupement, *sb.* accusation, F. & B. 664, 670, etc., C. OF. *acouplement*.

Adam, Ass. 429, 461, 465 Add.

Admiral, *sb.* emir, F. & B. 164, 170 C.; amirel, amirayl, F. & B. 175, 179 Cott.; Admirad, amyraud, Admyrold, KH. 95.

adrenche, *see* drenche.

adriže, *see* dreže.

adrinke, *see* drinke.

adun, *adv.* down, KH. 458 C, 485 C; adune, adowne, adoune, KH. 1608 C L H; adun, adoun, KH. 1610.

age, *sb.* be of —, KH. 1420, F. & B. 37 T, of age. Cf. KH. 1420 Note.

agenes, *see* žen.

agesse, *see* gesse.

agrise, *see* grise.

Ailbrus, Aylbrus, *see* Aþelbrus.

Ailmar, Aylmar, Almair, Eylmer, King of Westernesse, KH. 169, 233, 359, 526, 538, 549, 729, 733, 747, 753, 1331, 1514, 1614, etc. OE. *Aepelmær*.

al, *adv.* all, quite, KH. 38 L H.

alle veile, everywhere, KH. 262 L.

Allof, father of Horn, KH. 4, 33, 73 H.

also, *conj.* as, KH. 32, 1102 etc. OE. *eal swā*.

angussus, *adj.* full of anguish, F. & B. 366 C. OF. *angoissous*.

anhitte, *see* hitten.

apližt, *adv.* on one's faith; aplyžt, F. & B. 88 T; aplyst, F. & B. 200 Cott.; apližt, F. & B. 649 C. OE. *on + pliht*.

aquelde, *see* quelle.

aquite, *see* quite.

aražte, *see* areche.

areche, *v.* explain, recount; *infin.*, KH. 1308 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* aražte, F. & B. 812 C. OE. *areccean*.

arecche, *see* recche.

areche ?, *see* reche.

aredde, *infin.* rid, deliver, F. & B. 689 C. OE. *ahreddan*.

Arnoldin, Arnoldyn, KH. 1561, 1613, 1618.

aroum, *adv.* apart; aroom), F. & B. 824 T; aroum, Cott. Cf. Gen. & Ex. 4000, 4021. OE. *on rum*, apart.

arre, *see* er.

arson, *sb.* saddle bow; *n. s.*, F. & B. 369 T. OF. *arçon*.

aslawe, *see* slon.

asoke, *see* sake.

assoine, *infin.* prevent, F. & B. 423 T.

at, *prep.* from. KH. 619 etc. OE. *æt*.

atel, *adj.* dreadful, cruel, F. & B. 113 Cott. OE. *atol*, *eatol*.

Aþelbrus, Aylbrous, Ailbrus, etc., KH. 239, 257, 282, 309, 351, 385, 481, 495, 501, 1621, 1627.

Aþulf, Haþulf, ayol, KH. 27, 29, 300, 309, 311, 316, 537, etc. OE. *Æthelwulf*, *Aþulf*, or *Eadwulf*.
aton, *adj.* (at + one) agreed, KH. 997 C H.
at wite, v. find fault with, twit; *infin.* F. & B. 490 C.; 3 s. *pret.* atwist, F. & B. 490 C. OE. *ætwiþan*.
awreke, v. avenge; *infin.*, F. & B. 731 C.; 3 s. *pret.* awrek, KH. 952 H. OE. *wrecan*.
axede, askede, 3 s. *pret.* asked, KH. 43; askede H, axede C, acsede L. OE. *āscian*, *āxian*.
aye, *see* eie.

Babylon, *dat.* F. & B. 147 T; Babyloyn, 190 T, 191 T; -loigne, 119 C.; babyloyne, 147 T, 191 T;
Babyloyne, 153 T; Babilloine, 172 C.; Babiloyne, 181 Cott.; Babilloigne, 120, 129 C.; Babilloine,
129 C, etc. French version has *Babiloine*, 406, 505, etc.

bale, *sb.* bale, calamity, F. & B. 821 C. OE. *bealu*.

barbecan, *sb.* outer work of a fortress, F. & B. 207 C. OF. *barbecane*.

barm, *sb.* lap, bosom; in bearme, KH. 752. OE. *bearm*.

barnage, *sb.* baronage, F. & B. 639 C. OF. *baronage*.

bede, *sb.* prayer, Ass. 89 C, 95 Add., 332 H, 486 Add. etc. OE. *bēd*.

bede, v. present, offer; *infin.*, KH. 492; 2 *pl. pres.*, KH. 977 C L. OE. *bēodan*.

beien, v. buy; 3 s. *pret.* boʒte, KH. 1442 C. abeie, v. atone for, expiate; *infin.* abeie C; abeye L, KH.
116; abugge C H; abygge L 1155; 3 s. *pret.* aboute L; abohte H, KH. 1493. OE. *bycgan*.

belamy, *sb.* good friend, F. & B. 633 C. OF. *bel ami*.

belde, *see* bolde.

belete, *see* leten.

bemeneþ, *see* bimene.

bene, *sb.* petition, KH. 590 C L. OE. *bēn*.

beode, v. offer; *infin.*, F. & B. 369 C.; 3 s. *pret.* bed, F. & B. 733 C. OE. *bēodan*.

Berild, byrild, beryld, Byryld, KH. 816, 817, 825, 837, 845, 877, 878.

berwe, v. protect; *infin.*, KH. 980 L. OE. *beorgan*.

beyne, *num.* both, KH. 949 H. OE. *bēgen*.

bi, by, *prep.* by, along, in, KH. 5, 20, etc. OE. *be*.

bicolwede, *see* colwen.

bidde, v. pray, beg; *infin.* bidde, bydde, KH. 1263; 1 s. *pres.* bidde, Ass. 135 C, 143 Add.; bid, 170 C;
3 s. *pres.* biddeþ, F. & B. 588 C.; byddeþ, F. & B. 1081 T; 3 s. *pret.* bad, bed, KH. 85, 1272; bad,
badde, Ass. 90 C, 95 Add., 329, C; *pp.* ibede, F. & B. 579 C.; ybede, 859 T. OE. *biddan*.

bide, abide, v. (1) wait, (2) expect, (3) wait for, KH. 910, 1099, 1564. OE. *ābīdan*.

bidene, by dene, *adv.* at once, F. & B. 60 T, Ass. 347 Add.

bihelde, biholde, v. look on, behold, F. & B. 102 Cott., KH 639. OE. *bihealdan*.

biheue, *adj.* profitable, Ass. 676 Add. OE. *behēfe*.

bihoten, v. promise; 3 s. *pret.* bihet, KH. 500. OE. *hātan*.

biknewe, *pp.*, *see* knowe.

bileue, *see* leue.

biliue, bliue, *adv.* quickly, KH. 350 L, 502 C, 771 C, 1042 C; blyue, Ass. 776 Add. OE. *bī lifē*.

bimene, v. bemoan, lament; *infin.*, F. & B. 72 Cott.; 3 s. *pres.* bemeneþ, F. & B. 957 T. OE. *bimēnan*.

binom, 3 s. *pret.* took away from, F. & B. 112 Cott.; *pp.* binomen, benome, Ass. 271 A, 273 C. OE. *biniman*.

birine, *see* reyne.

bisemen, v. befit, beseem; 3 s. *pres.* bisemeþ C, byseme L, bysemeþ H, KH. 518. Icel. *sæma*.

bispac, *see* speke.

biswike, *see* swike.

bite, *infin.* bite, partake of as food, KH. 1211 L, H. OE. *bītan*.

biteche, 1 s. *pres.* entrust, KH. 613 L, H. OE. *tācan*.

bitide, *see* tide.

biþinne, *prep.* within, KH. 1122 C, 1387 C.

bitwexe, *prep.* between, KH. 454 C. OE. *betweox*, *betwux*.

biwente, *see* wende.

biwreien, *see* wreien.

Blancheflour, Blauncheflur, etc., *nom.* 18 T, 46 T, 22 V, 34 V; *dat.* 20 T, 22 T, 36 T, 58 T, 114 T, 122 T, 34, 46, 48, 64, 96, 102, 112 etc., C. Fr. *Blanceflors*, *Blanceflor*.

blenche, *infin.* overturn, KH. 1525 C L; ouerblenche, 1525 H. OE. *blencan*.

blesse, *infin.* bless, KH. 17 L H. OE. *bletsian*.

blessing, *sb.* blessing, KH. 170 C. OE. *bletsung*.

blethelyche, *adv.* blithely. OE. *blīðelīce*.

ble[y]ne, *sb.* whale, KH. 727 L. OF. *baleine*.

bliþe, blyþe, *adj.* blithe, KH. 1, 141, etc.

blynne, *see* linnen.

bode, *dat. sing.* message, Ass. 146 C; *accus.* bodes, Ass. 126 Add. OE. *bod*.

bold, bald, baud, *adj.* bold; *sing.* KH. 96; *pl.* belde, bolde, KH. 640. OE. *beald*.

bone, *sb.* prayer, boon, Ass. 522 H, 27 C, 329 C, 441 C. ON. *bōn*.

boneyres, *adj.* devoted, good looking, debonair, KH. 968 L. OF. *bonaire*.

bord, *sb.* (ship) board; *dat. sing.* borde, KH. 119, 123.

bord, *sb.* table, F. & B. 103 C, KH. 269, 1605.

bote, *sb.* remedy, redress, F. & B. 821 C. OE. *bōt*.

bote, KH. 1364 L; v. baddest, or scribal error.

bote, *see* bute.

braide, breide, 3 s. *pret.* draw, brandish, F. & B. 289 T, 1014 T. OE. *brægd*.

breche, *dat. sing.* breeches, F. & B. 258 C. OE. *brēc*.

breme, *adj.* valiant, spirited, famous, F. & B. 792 C, 1071 T. OE. *brēme*.

brenie, brunie, *sb.* coat of mail, KH. 627, 765, 897, 1310. OE. *byrne*.

bruken, v. use, enjoy; *imper.* 3 *sing.* bruc C, brouke L, brouc H, KH. 220. OE. *brūcan*.

brun, *sb.* beer (?); of a brun C, of þe broune L, H, KH. 1202.

brymme, *sb.* edge, shore, KH. 204 C.

buzge, v. bow, writhe, twist, let fall (Mätzner); *infin.* buze C, unbowe H, KH. 458. OE. *būgan*.

bulmeþ, 3 *sing. pres.* boils, F. & B. 305 C. Probable error for welmeþ. Cf. *zelle*.

bur, *sb.* bower, women's quarters, KH. 285. OE. *būr*.
burdon, *sb.* staff, KH. 1141. OF. *burdoun*.
burgeis, *sb.* burgess, citizen, F. & B. 115 C, 155 T, etc. Bugays, F. & B. 207 T. OF. *burgeis*.
bur3, bure3, boruh, *sb.* castle, F. & B. 176, 181, 182 C.; boruh, F. & B. 190 Cott. OE. *burg*, *burh*.
burles, *sb.* tomb, sepulchre, F. & B. 63 Cott. OE. *byrgels*.
bute, bote, but, *conj.* but, unless, KH. 26 L, 69, 207 C, 37 L, H, etc. OE. *būtan*, except, unless.
buxom, *adj.* flexible, obedient, Ass. 410 H. OE. *būhsum*.
by3ete, *sb.* acquisition, F. & B. 202 T, and Cott. OE. *begietan*.
bygone, *pp.* surrounded, F. & B. 371 T. OE. *bigān*.
byne, (?), F. & B. 1010 T.

[cacche](#), *v.* catch; *infin.* KH. 1307, 1465 H; 3 *pl. pret.* kaute, KH. 944 L.; *infin.* bikeche, KH. 328 L.
OF. *cachier*.

can, *v.* can, know; 3 *s. subj. pres.* cunne; conne, KH. 602 C, H; *infin.* konne, KH. 598 L; 3 *pl. pret.*
couþ, couth, F. & B. 33 T, 157 T. OE. *cann*.

care, *sb.* care, sorrow, KH. 279. OE. *cearu*.

catel, *sb.* property, capital, F. & B. 150 T, 988 T. OF. *catel*.

kele, *infin.* cool, F. & B. 995 T. OE. *cēlan*.

kelwe, *see* colmie.

ken, kenne, kunne, *sb.* race, people, KH. 156, 190, 1358. OE. *cynn*.

kende, cunde, *sb.* birth, kind, Nature, KH. 451, 1479 C, L; F. & B. 677 C, 960 T. OE. *cynd*.

kene, *adj.* keen, brave, KH. 42, 97, 178, 539, 1208, etc. OE. *cēn*.

kepe, *v.* (1) keep, (2) guard, protect, KH. 800, 1288 C H, Ass. 49 Add., 52 Add., 271 Add. OE. *cēpan*.

kep, *sb.* heed, care, Ass. 72 C, 78 Add.

kerue, *v.* carve, KH. 249. OE. *ceorfan*.

Cesar, F. & B. 181 T. French version has *Cesar*, *v.* 494.

chaere, *sb.* throne (?), KH. 1353. OF. *chaere*.

ycharged, *pp.* loaded, F. & B. 343 T. OF. *charger*.

chelde, kolde, kelde, *infin.* become cold, KH. 1230. OE. *cealdian*.

chepinge, *sb.* market, fair, F. & B. 186, 188 Cott. OE. *cēapung*.

chere, *sb.* mien, facial expression, KH. 1143, 1165 L. OF. *chere*.

child, *sb.* (1) child, (2) youth, KH. 10, 13, 27, 99, etc. OE. *cild*.

Claris, Clarice, Clari3, Clarys, F. & B. 895 T, 901 T, 905 T, 915 T, 931 T, etc.; C. 479, 485, 529, etc.

French has Claris, 2125, 2131, 2115, 2339, etc.

cleche, *infin.* reach (with nails), KH. 1027 H ; *pp.* ycli3t, Ass. 719 Add.

clef, scribal blunder (?), *c* + *lef*, KH. 161 L.

clenchen, *infin.* make to clink, KH. 1596.

clene, *adj.* pure, F. & B. 297 C. OE. *clāne*.

clepe, clepen, clepede, clupede, cleped, icluped, etc., *v.* call, KH. 239, 840 L; F. & B. 137 T, 287 T,
137 T, 837 T; 607 C, 140 C, etc.; Ass. 707 H, 847 Add., 73 C, 180 C, etc. OE. *cleopian*.

clergie, *sb.* learned knowledge, F. & B. Cf. Hausknecht's note.

cleppe, clippe, cluppe, klippt, klepte, iclupt, etc., *v.* embrace, KH. 1297 H, 1450; F. & B. 549 C, 594 C, 614 C, 806 T, 512 C, etc. OE. *clyppan*.

yclizt, *see* cleche.

knaue, *sb.* boy, servant, KH. 1012 C, 1095 C; F. & B. 166 T. OE. *cnafa*.

knowe, *v.* (1) know, (2) recognize, KH. 1294; (3) beon biknowe of = acknowledge (cf. Mätzner, KH. 983 Note; Lay. II. 355, III. 51; Alisaunder 724, etc.); *pp.* was iknowe C, was by cnowe L, was biknowe H, KH. 1059 = confessed. OE. *cnāwan*, *becnāwan*.

knyhty, *v.* knight, KH. 488 H, 547, 682.

colmie, kelwe, *adj.* sooty, KH. 1162, *see* colwen.

colwen, bicolwede, *v.* smear, blacken, KH. 1144, 1162.

con, *v.* *auxil.* = did, KH. 817 H, 825 H, 938 H, 1470 H, 1549 H, 1632 H; 3 *s.* *pluperf.* coupe, 1634 H, *see* gan.

icore, *pp.* chosen, F. & B. 268 C. OE. *gecoren*.

creyde, 3 *s.* *pret.* cried, KH. 1362 L. OF. *crier*.

crois, *sb.* cross, KH. 1405 C H; croy3, KH. 1398 H. OF. *crois*.

crowch, *sb.* cross, KH. 1398 L, 1405 L. Lat. *crucem*.

crude, *infin.* press, crowd, KH 1385. OE. *crūdan*.

crune, *sb.* skull, head, KH. 1607. ON. *kruna*.

culuart, *adj.* false, faithless, F. & B. 210, 329 C. OF. *culvert*.

cupe, *sb.* basket, F. & B. 435, 438, 452, 471 C, etc. OE. *cȳpe*, Lat. *cūpa*.

cuppe, cupe, coupe, *sb.* cup, KH. 250, 479; coupe, F. & B. 163 T, 181 T, 208 T, etc. OE. *cuppa*.

Cutberd, Cuberd, Cubert, KH. 876, 833, 851 C, 882, 895, 912, 938, 948, 965 L, 981. OE. *Cūþbeorht*.

cupe, 1 *s.* *pret.* knew, Ass. 39 C; 3 *pl.* *pret.* couthe, Ass. 290 C.

cupe, cowpe, coupe, 3 *s.* *pret. subj.* could, KH. 371.

[dales](#), *pl.* valleys, dales, KH. 168. OE. *dæl*.

dar, *v.* dare, 3 *s.* *pres.* durþ, KH. 408 H; 3 *s.* *pret.* dorte, dorste, F. & B. 167 C, 204 T; 3 *s.* *pret. subj.* þorte, F. & B. 216 C, KH. 408 C. OE. *dearr*, *dorste*.

Daris, Dares, Dayre, daye, Darys, doyres, Darie, F. & B. 561, 570, 599, 737, 816. French has *Daires*, *nom.* 1470, 1531, 1853, etc. *Dairon*, *accus.* 1931.

dawes, *pl.* days, KH. 999 L; *nom. sing.* day. OE. *pl. dagas*.

ded, deed, *sb.* death, KH. 345 L.; *dat. sing.* deede, F. & B. 46 T.

deie, deye, deze, *infin.*, KH. 115. ON. *deyja*.

del, *sb.* part, portion, deal, Ass. 212 C, 218 A, 261 A; dell, 225 C. OE. *dæl*.

ideld, *p. pl.* separated, F. & B. 598 C. OE. *dælan*.

demure, demere, *sb.* delay, F. & B. 591 C. and Cott. OF. *demeurer*.

denie, *v.* din, rattle, KH. 628. OE. *dynian*.

dent, dunt, *sb.* stroke, blow, KH. 164 C, 607, 647, 913, 920, 933, 946. OE. *dynt*.

deol, dole, *sb.* grief, KH. 1128, 1129. OF. *doel*, *duel*.

dere, *adj.* dear, beloved, KH. 161 L, etc. OE. *dēore*.

derie, dere, *infin.* injure, harm, KH. 840, F. & B. 378 T, Ass. 162 C. OE. *derian*.
 derne, *adj.* secret, hidden, Ass. 856 Add. OE. *dierne*.
 deuisse, 2 s. *pres. subj.* devise, KH. 253 L, H. OF. *deviser*.
 direwurpe, *adj.* precious, F. & B. 289 C. OE. *dēorwyrðe*.
 don, dede, dude, v. (1) cause to, KH. 148, 284, 1069, Ass. 462 Add., 474 Add., etc. (2) put, KH. 360, 745, 1332 C; F. & B. 46 T, 200 T, 69 C.; Ass. 61 Add., etc. (3) *intens.* do, did, KH. 1003 (?), F. & B. 16 C, Ass. 17 Add., 80 C, etc. (cf. dede let wed, F. & B. 1065 T). OE. *dōn*, *dyde*.
 dreden, 3 *pl. pret.* fear, dread, KH. 130; dradde C, adred L; *pp.* adred H; 1 *sing. pres.* of drede. C L; adrede H, KH. 307. OE. *drædan*.
 dreze, adrize, *infin.* suffer, endure, KH. 1115. OE. *drēogan*.
 dreme, *sb.* sound, F. & B. 37 C, 397 T. OE. *drēam*.
 drenche, v. drown; *infin.* adrenche, KH. 111 C H, 1526; to drenche, KH. 1045 L; *pp.* adrent, KH. 1053 C; drenched, KH. 1054 L. OE. *drencan*.
 dright, drihte, *sb.* lord, Ass. 275 C, KH. 1406 C. OE. *drihten*.
 idriht, *pp.* troubled, Ass. 190 C. OE. *gedreccan*.
 drinke, v. drink; *infin.* adrinke, adrynke, drown, KH. 111 L, 1045 C H. OE. *drincan*.
 druerie, drury, *sb.* love, F. & B. 382 C, 820 T. OF. *druerie*.
 dun, doun, down, *sb.* dune, hill, KH. 168. OE. *dūn*.
 dunt, *see* dent.
 dureþ, 3 *sing. pres.* extendeth, F. & B. 173 C. OF. *durer*.
 durþ, *see* dar.
 dute, v. fear, be afraid; *infin.* duti, F. & B. 4 C, 192 Cott.; 1 *sing. pres.* dute, doute, KH. 362; 2 *pl. imper.* douzt, dute, F. & B. 817 T, 531 C. OF. *douter*.
 dy3cte, *infin.* arrange, KH. 904 L; *pp.* idiht, F. & B. 23, 260 C. OE. *dihtan*.

[ede](#), *see* zede.

Edmound, seynt, Ass. 893 Add.

eidel, *sb.* anything, F. & B. 813 C. OE. *ænig dæl*.

eie, aye, *sb.* fear, F. & B. 791 T. OE. *ege*.

eke, *adv.* also, KH. 17, 99, 1474, etc. OE. *ēac*.

enchesone, *sb.* occasion, F. & B. 78 T. OF. *enchaisoun*.

engynne, *sb.* device, scheme, artifice, F. & B. 313 T; engin, Ass. 755, 759 C. OF. *engin*.

Enneas, F. & B. 177 T. French version *Eneas*, 489.

entermeten, *infin.* meddle with, F. & B. 167 C. OF. *entremetre*.

er, arre, her, or, *conj.* before, ere, KH. 136 H, 567 C; arre, 567 L.

Ermenild, *see* Reynild, KH. 979 H. Cf. Eormenhild, daughter of Eorcenbriht, king of Kent, Leechdoms iii, index.

erndinge, *sb.* result of undertaking. OE. *ærendung*.

erne, v. run; *infin.* vrne, erne, KH. 936; 3 s. *pret.* arnde C, rende L, ernde H, KH. 1314; *pp.* iorne C, hy 3ouren L, yorne H, KH. 1228. OE. *yrnan*.

escheker, *sb.* chess board, F. & B. 344 C, etc. OF. *eschekier*.

Estnesse, KH. 1018 L H, 1295 L.

eþe, yþe, *adv.* easily, KH. 61, 891. OE. *ēaðe*.

epelikeste, *superl.* most precious, F. & B. 274 C. OE. *æðel*.

Eue, Ass. 461 Add.

euene, eueneliche, *adv.* equally, symmetrically, KH. 100.

euerich, *adj.* every, KH. 230. OE. *ǣfrǣlc*.

eure ȝut, ever yet, KH. 842.

[fable](#), *sb.* story, KH. 762 L.

fader, *sb.* father; *gen. sing.* fader, C H; faderes L, KH. 116; fader, 1622 H.

fairhede, fayrhede, feyrhade, *sb.* fairness, KH. 89.

falle, *v.* fall; bifalle, bualle, happen, occur, become; *infin.*, KH. 105, 186; *pp.* 450 C, L.

fawe, fain, F. & B. 986 T. OE. *fægn*.

fay, *sb.* faith, Ass. 576 C. OF. *fei*.

fayne, *adj.* glad, F. & B. 97 T. OE. *fægn*.

fayne, *adv.* gladly, F. & B. 286 T.

fecche, fette, *infin.* fetch, Ass. 129 C, 137 Add.; 3 *pl. pret.* fett, Ass. 456 C. OE. *fetian*.

feere, *see* fere.

feire, *sb.* market, fair, F. & B. 179 C. OF. *feire*.

felaurende, *sb.* company, KH. 180 H. ON. *fēlagi*.

yfelde, 3 *pl. pret.* feel, KH. 58. OE. *gefēlan*.

fele, vele, *adj.* many, KH. 60, 1425 C, 1464 H. OE. *fela*.

felle, *v.* fell, slay; *infin.*, KH. 66; 3 *pl. pret.* felde, KH. 58.

felle, *sb.* skin, KH. 1015 L. OE. *fell*.

felle, *adj. pl.* fierce, cruel, fell, KH. 1581 L, Ass. 574 C, 684 Add. OE. *fel*.

felun, *adj.* savage, cruel, F. & B. 210, 329 C. OF. *felon*, *felun*.

fende, feond, *sb.* fiend, devil; *dat. sing.* KH. 1480 L, Ass. 164 C. OE. *fēond*.

feo, *dat. sing.* money, expense, F. & B. 25 C. OE. *feo(h)*.

fer, *adj.* unharmed, sound, KH. 161 C, H; Ass. 67 C, 72 A. OE. *fēre*, Icel. *færr*.

veracle, *sb.* company, KH. 180 C. OE. *ferræden*.

ferde, *sb.* host, army; *dat. sing.*, Ass. 116 Add. OE. *ferd*, *fyrð*.

ferde, 3 *s. pret.* went, KH. 663, 805, 1010. uerden, 3 *pl. pret.* behaved, F. & B. 24 C. OE. *fēran*.

fere, ifere, *sb.* companion, comrade; *sing. accus.* fere, Ass. 78 C, 84 Add., 78 Add.; ifere 46 C; *dat. sing.* ifere C, fere L, yfere H, KH. 1209; *plur.* feren, KH. 21, 53 H, 88, 108, 235 L, etc.; ifere C, yfere L, KH. 235; ferene, Ass. 406 C. OE. *fēra*, *gefēra*.

fere, feere, *sb.* companionship, F. & B. 5, 81, 280 T, etc. OE. *gefēr*.

ferli, ferlich, *sb.* miracle, wonder, F. & B. 456 C, Ass. 732 Add. OE. *fǣrlīc*.

ferli, ferly, *adj.* (1) fearful, (2) unexpected, sudden, (3) rare, wonderful, Ass. 327, Add. 347 C.

fett, *see* fecche.

Fikenhild, fykenyld, fykenild, fokenild, Fykenhild, Fekenyld, etc., KH. 28, 30, 731, 1336, 1493, 1509, 1513, 1516, 1543, 1554, 1567, 1589, 1613; *gen.* 1554, 1607.
 fine, *infin.* end, KH. 274. OF. *finer*.
 fipeleres, fypelers, *sb.* fiddler; *nom. pl.* KH. 1592. OE. *fiðelere*.
 fle, *infin.* flay, KH. 1468 C. OE. *flēan*.
 fleme, *sb.* fugitive, exile, KH. 1363 C, L. OE. *flēma*.
 fleoten, flete, *v.* flow, float, swim; *infin.* flete, L; fleoten H, KH. 165; flette 811 L; 3 s. *pret.* flet, KH. 203 H; 3 *pl. pret.* fletten, 811 H; *pp.* bi flette, KH. 1504 C. OE. *flēotan*.
 flitte, flecte, flette, 2 s. *subj. pres.* leave, depart, KH. 757. ON. *flytta*.
 Floris, Florys, Floreys, Florens, Floyres, Floriȝ, Florice, Floures, Florisse, etc., F. & B. 40 T, 44 T, 49 T, 56 T, 65 T, etc. French version has *Floires*, *Floire*.
 flotterede, 3 *sing. pret.* was tossed in the waves, KH. 135 H.
 flur, flour, *sb.* flower, KH. 15, F. & B. 780 T, 482 C, etc.
 flyten, *infin.* combat, KH. 903 H. OE. *flītan*.
 fode, foode, *sb.* food, child, KH. 1436, F. & B. 149 T.
 foȝel, foul, *sb.* bird, KH. 139, 1506; F. & B. 277 Cambr., etc. OE. *fugol*.
 fole, *sb.* foal, horse, KH. 623. OE. *fōla*.
 follyche, KH. 98 L. (?). OE. *fūllīce*.
 fond, *pret. sing.* found, KH. 39. OE. *findan*.
 fonde, *v.* try, experience, prove; *infin.*, KH. 163 C H, 782, 1634 H; F. & B. 2 T, 55 T, 158, 399 C, etc.; 3 *sing. pret.* fonde, fondede, KH. 1634 C. OE. *fandian*.
 fonge, underfonge, *v.* receive, take; *infin.* fonge, KH. 345 C L, 163 L, 769; F. & B. 300, 395 C. etc.; vnderfonge, KH. 607 H, 255, 976 C, etc. OE. *fōn*.
 forbere, *infin.* do without, dispense with, Ass. 60 C, 66 Add. OE. *forberan*.
 forbod, forbode, *acc. sing.* forbiddal, prohibition, KH. 82.
 fordo, *pp.* destroyed, F. & B. 308 C. OE. *fordōn*.
 foreward, forewart, *sb.* agreement, pledge, KH. 482, 586 H; F. & B. 426 C. OE. *foreweard*.
 forȝolde, *pp.* paid for, F. & B. 388 T. OE. *forġieldan*.
 forgone, *pp.* distressed, Ass. 829 Add.
 forhele, 2 *sing. imper.* conceal, Ass. 192 Add. OE. *forhelan*.
 forleie, forlauȝt, *pp.* commit adultery, F. & B. 301 Cambr., 618 T. OE. *forlicgan*.
 forlesen, *see* lesen.
 forliued, *pp.* mislived, F. & B. 99 Cott.
 forloren, *see* lesen.
 fort (for + to), until, F. & B. 66, 122 C.; fort he = for to þe.
 forþinkeȝ, 3 *sing. pres., reflex.*, repent, Ass. 538 Add., 813 Add. ON. *fyrirþykkja*.
 forto, forte, *conj.* in order to, KH. 25.
 forto, *prep.* to, for to, KH. 166 L.
 fremde, fremede, *sb.* foreigner, stranger, KH. 68. OE. *fremede*.
 fremde, *adj.* strange, foreign, Ass. 181 C. OE. *fremede*, *fremde*.

frume, atte, first, F. & B. 135, 179, 345 C. OE. *fruma*.
 ful, foul, foule, *adj.* foul, dirty, KH. 1143. OE. *fūl*.
 fulde, 3 *sing. pret.* filled, KH. 1202. OE. *fyllan*.
 funde, fonde, founde, v. go, KH. 109, 143, 780, 888, 942, 1372. OE. *fundian*.
 fundlyng, fundyng, etc., *sb.* foundling, KH. 234 C H, 242 C, 450.
 furst, *sb.* space of time, respite, F. & B. 638 C. OE. *fyrst*.
 furthestmost, foremost, F. & B. 1059 T.
 fus, *adj.* ready, F. & B. 368 C. OE. *fūs*.
 fyʒen, fissen, *infin.* fish, KH. 1216. OE. *fiscian*.

[gabbe](#), joking, F. & B. 785 T.

gabbest, 2 *sing. pres.* (1) ridicule, (2) deceive, (3) chatter, F. & B. 235 T. ON. *gabba*.
 gabbing, *nom. sing.*, (1) deceit, (2) babble, F. & B. 236, T and Cott.
 galeie, *sb.* galley, KH. 199, 1084 C, 1086 H. OF. *galee*.
 game, *sb.* joy, pleasure, KH. 211. OE. *gamen, gomen*.
 gan, v. *auxil.* did; gan, gon, KH. 257, 268, 312 C, 318 C, etc.; *plur.* gunne, gonne, gunnen, gonnen, KH. 55, 65, 193, 675, 1090, etc.; *imper.* gyn, KH. 329 H, 396 H; bigyn, KH. 329 L; bigan, began, did, KH. 127, 146 L, 203 C, 1271 H; con, did, KH. 372 H, 817 H, 825 H, 938 H, 1049 H, 1470 H, 1632 H, etc.; *pluperf.* couþe, KH. 1634 H.
 ʒare, *adv.* quickly, KH. 497 C, 960 C, 1453 L. OE. *gearu*.
 garysone, garisone, *sb.* treasure, F. & B. 206, T and Cott. OE. *gersum, gersuma*. OF. *garison*. Cf. *gersume*.
 ʒede, yede, eode, v. *pret.* went; 3 *sing.* ʒede C, eode H, KH. 621, 622; yede Ass. 636 H; 3 *pl.* yede L, ede H, KH. 117; ʒede C, yede L, eoden H, KH. 167, 621; yede Ass. 634 H, ʒede Ass. 843 Add., ʒeden Ass. 849 Add., F. & B. 444 C.
 gegges, *sb.* frivolous women (?), F. & B. 439 C.
 ʒelde, yelde, v. (1) yield, (2) pay for; *infin.*, KH. 514 C H, Ass. 249 C, 255 Add.; *pp.* ʒolde C, yolde L, ʒolde H, KH. 681; ʒolde C, hyʒolde L, yʒolde H, KH. 490; F. & B. 161 T, 809 C; 2 *sing. subj.* or *imper.* ʒeld, pay for, KH. 1066. OE. *gieldan*.
 ʒelle = welle (?), F. & B. 621 T.
 ʒem, 2 *sing. imper.* protect, care for. OE. *gīeman*.
 ʒeme, *sb.* care, F. & B. 38 C.
 ʒen, against; aʒeyn KH. 60, aʒenes C, ayenes L, aʒeyn H, KH. 82. OE. *gegn, gēn*.
 ʒend, gonde, *prep.* throughout, KH. 1078; *adv.* yonder, far away; ʒent, KH. 1261 H; gonde, beyond, F. & B. 210 C. OE. *geond*.
 geng, *dat. sing.* company, Ass. 220 C. OE. *genge*.
 gent, *adj.* noble, F. & B. 47 Cott. OF. *gent*.
 ʒere, yere, *sb.* year; *pl.* ʒere C, yere L, KH. 102. OE. *gēār*.
 ʒerne, v. desire, ask for; 1 *sing. pres.* ʒerne C H, herne L, KH. 985; *infin.* KH. 1495 L, 1517 C. OE. *geornian*.
 ʒerne, *adj.* willing, desirous, eager, KH. 1165 C, 1472 H, etc. OE. *georn*.

3erne, *adv.* eagerly, F. & B. 127, 375, 588 C. OE. *georne*.
 (pure3) gersume, reward, F. & B. 405, 419, 773 C. Cf. *garisone*.
 gesninge, gestinge, iustinge, *sb.* entertainment, F. & B. 82, 125, 164 C., 175 Cott.
 gesse, *infin.* guess (?), agesse C, agesce L, gesse H, KH. 1267.
 3euen, v. give, KH. 170, 172, etc. OE. *giefan*, *gifan*.
 gigours, *nom. plur.* violin players, KH. 1592 C. OF. *gigueour*.
 ginne, gynne, *sb.*? (1) contrivance, scheme. (2) tool, penis, KH. 1574 C H; F. & B. 131, 195, 206, 258 C., etc.; F. & B. 1032, 1048 T. ON. *ginna*, Lat. *ingenium*.
 ginnur, *sb.* engineer, workman, F. & B. 324 C.
 gle, glewe, *sb.* song, joy, KH. 1352 C H; Ass. 483 Add. OE. *glēow*, *glīw*.
 glede, *sb.* coal, KH. 532 L H. OE. *glēd*.
 gleowinge, glewinge, gleynge, *sb.* play, KH. 1588.
 glide, *infin.* (1) glide, (2) slip away, KH. 146 L, 1127. OE. *glīdan*.
 gloue, glouen, *acc. plur.* gloves, KH. 848. OE. *glōfa*.
 Godhild, Godild, Godyld, Godylt, KH. 7, 72, 75, 158, 159, 1458.
 Godmod, Horn's assumed name, KH. 821, 833, 879, 883, 895, 911, 925, 949, 952, 965, 987.
 3onge, 3ynge, *adj.* young, KH. 137, etc. OE. *geong*.
 3ore, *adv.* long ago, F. & B. 174 C. OE. *gēara*.
 grace, *sb.* virtue, power, KH. 605. OF. *grace*.
 grame, *sb.* anger, wrath, F. & B. 712 C.; Ass. 515 H, Ass. 738 Add. OE. *grama*.
 igraue, hygraue, ygraued, *pp.* scratched, engraved, KH. 599. OF. *grafan*.
 grede, v. cry out; *infin.* F. & B. 454 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* gredde, KH. 1282 H. OE. *grædan*.
 greding, *sb.* clamour, lamentation, Ass. 213 Add.
 greithe, greþi, *infin.* prepare, make ready, Ass. 120 C, 128 Add. ON. *greiða*.
 grete, *infin.* weep, KH. 957 C L. OE. *grētan*.
 gripe, *infin.* grip, seize, KH. 55. OE. *grīpan*.
 grisen, v. feel horror; *infin.* agrise C L; agryse H, KH. 925; 3 *sing. pret.* gros C, agros L, H, KH. 1410. OE. *āgrīsan*.
 grom, *sb.* boy; *nom. sing.* grom, KH. 1035 L H; *nom. pl.* grome, KH. 175, F. & B. 111 T. ON. *gromr*.
 grunde, grounde, *sb.*; *dat. sing.* ground, bottom, KH. 110, 144, 352, 1242.
 gume, *sb.* man; *nom. sing.* gume, F. & B. 261 C.; *nom. plur.* gomes, KH. 24, gumes C, gomen H; grome L, KH. 175. OE. *guma*.

[halke](#), *dat. sing.* corner, KH. 1167 C L. OE. *healoc*.

Harild, Alrid, Ayld, Aþyld, KH. 815, 877, 878.

harwed, 1 *sing. pret.* harrowed, Ass. 463 Add. OE. *hergian*.

hatere, *sb.* garments, Ass. 149 C. OE. *hæteru*.

hatte, 3 *sing. pret.* became hot, KH. 646 C. OE. *hætan*.

heelee, 1 *sing. pres.* conceal, F. & B. 820 T, 533 C. OE. *helan*.

heete, 3 *sing. pret.* was named, F. & B. 1004 T. Cf. *hoten*.

helde, v., *see* holde.

helde, *sb.* faith, allegiance, F. & B. 397 C. OE. *hyldo*.

heleþ, 3 *sing. imper.* conceal, Ass. 188 C, *see* heele.

hende, *adj.* (1) prompt, gracious, alert, KH. 391, 1197, 1345, etc., F. & B. 156 T, etc.; (2) near, ready, KH. 1217 H. OE. *(3e)hende*.

henne, hanne, hennes, *adv.* hence, KH. 50, 337, 341 C.

hente, v. grasp, receive, get; *infin.* KH. 1032 H; 1 *pl. pret.* KH. 919 L; *pp.* hent, Ass. 453 C.

hepe, *dat. sing.* throng, crowd, F. & B. 466 C. OE. *hēap*.

her, *see* er.

here, *poss. pron.* their; *nom. sing.*, KH. 9, etc.

heren, v. hire; 3 *sing. pret.* hurede C, *herde L, herde L H*, KH. 806. OE. *hȳrian*.

heste, *dat. sing.* command, hest, F. & B. 610 C. Cf. Skeat.

het, 3 *sing. pret.* bade, F. & B. 608, 619 C. OE. *hātan*.

heynde, *sb.* hind (?), KH. 686 L. OE. *hind*.

hiȝe, v. hasten, hie; 3 *sing. pret.* KH. 1042 C. OE. *higian*.

hiȝhede, *sb.* height, F. & B. 327 C.

hitten, v. hit, strike; 1 *sing. pres.* anhitte C; *infin.* hette L, KH. 758. ON. *hitta*.

hol, *adj.* safe, KH. 161 C H etc. OE. *hāl*.

holde, helde, v. hold, KH. 323, 482. OE. *healdan*.

holde, *adj.*, *accus. pl.* faithful, KH. 1339 L H. OE. *hold*.

holt, *adj.* lame, halt, Ass. 516 H. OE. *healt, halt*.

hondhabbing, having in the hand, in the act, *en flagrant delit*, F. & B. 668 C. OE. *hondhæbbende*.

Horn, 9, 74, 121, 128, 135, 184, etc.; horn child 121 L, 128 C, 173, etc.; Horns 123 L; horn þe ȝynge 137 H; Hor 185 L, 397 L, 459 L, 558 L.

hoten, v. be called; 1 *sing. pres.* hote, KH. 821; 3 *sing. pret.* het C, hihte H, KH. 9, 27 C; *pp.* ihote C, hote L, yhote H, KH. 215, 1125 C. OE. *hātan*.

houe, 2 *sing. pret.* raised, KH. 1359 C H; ȝoue L. OE. *hebban*.

hurne, *dat. sing.* corner, KH. 1471 H. OE. *hyrne*.

hynde, *adj.* kind (?), F. & B. 355 T.

I—, I lome, etc., *see* lome, etc.

Ierusalem, Ass. 475 C, 594 Add.

Iewes, Iewis, Iewys, *nom. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 620 Add., 564 H, Iew 674 Add.; *dat. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 530 H, Iew, Ass. 620 Add.; *gen. sing.* Iewis, Ass. 553 H, etc.

Almost everything in this entry is wrong. As printed:

Iewes, Iewis, Iewys, *nom. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 620 Add., 674 H [564 H corresponds to 674 Add.], Iew 674 Add.; *dat. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 530 C, Iew, Ass. 620 Add. [this is wrong, but the correct form has not been identified]; *gen. sing.* Iewis, Ass. 553 C, etc.

Ihesu, Ass. 51 Add., 324 C, 388 Add., Ihesus 481 C, Iesus 486 C; *gen.* Ihesus 624 Add., Crist 76 C, Ihesu crist 248 T, etc.

ilk, ylk, *adj.* same; *dat. sing.* ilke, KH. 948 C, ylke F. & B. 78 T, vlke C, hulke L, KH. 1285, etc. OE. *ilca*.

ynde, India, Ass. 611 C, 775 Add., 807 Add.

Iogelours L, iogelers H; *nom. pl.* jugglers, KH. 1592. OF. *jongleur*.

Iohan, Ion, Ass. 14 C, 15 Add., 49 C, 52 Add., 55 Add., 77 C, 224 C, 228 Add., etc.; *nom. sing.* seynt Ione, 820 Add.

Iosaphath, Iosephas, Iosephat, Ass. 472 C, 581 C, 754 Add.

Irisse, yrisse, yrisshe, Hyrische, KH. 1080, 1302 L, 1382, 1464.

Irlond, hirelonde, yrlonde, KH. 810 L, 1078 C, 1633 C H.

[lacchen](#), v. catch, take; *infin.* lacchen, KH. 686 L, lache KH. 702 L; 3 *sing. pret.* lazte C, laucte L, lahte H, KH. 259; 3 *pl. pret.* laucte, KH. 943 L, by laucte 705 L; 3 *pl. pret.* of laucte, 943 L. OE. *(3e)læccan*.

laze, lawe, *sb.* (1) law, (2) religion, (3) custom, KH. 69 C H, 1190. OE. *lagu*.

largeliche, *adv.* liberally, F. & B. 71 C. OF. *large*.

laste, leste, v. last, endure, KH. 6, 433 L, etc. OE. *læstan*.

lay, ley, *sb.* law, religion, KH. 69 L, 1642 H, Ass. 686 Add. OF. *lei*.

lef, leue, leof, luef, *adj.* dear, KH. 126 L, 342, 695, 754, 1013, 1457, etc.; F. & B. 151 C., 321 C., etc.; Ass. 40 C, 167 C, 42 Add., 173 Add., etc. OE. *lēof*.

lef, leue, leof, lyfe, *sb.* dear one, darling, F. & B. 108 T, 89, 103 Cott., 312 T, 831 T, 542 C. OE. *lēof*.
leue, v. believe, F. & B. 325 T. OE. *lēfan*, *lȳfan*.

bileue, v. remain; *infin.* KH. 381, F. & B. 103 Cott., 51 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* bilefte, Ass. 57 T, bileft 63 Add., 151 Add.; 3 *pl. pret.* bileft, Ass. 759 Add., etc. OE. *belāfan*.

leiȝe, leyhe, v. laugh; *infin.* leyhe L (lyȝe H?), KH. 372; 3 *sing. pret.* lowe L, loh KH. 373, louȝe C, lowe L H, KH. 1600; 3 *plur. pret.* lowȝ, F. & B. 1053 T, 776 C. OE. *hlehhan*.

leme, *sb.* light, brightness, F. & B. 198 C, Ass. 607 H. OE. *lēoma*.

lemman, leman, *sb.* dear one, leman, KH. 463, 589, 721. OE. *lēōfmon*.

lene, v. lend, KH. 491. OE. *lānan*.

leng, *compar.* longer, KH. 1183 etc. OE. *leng*.

lep, lepe, *sb.* basket, F. & B. 465 C., 738, 740, 741 T, 753 T, 758 T. OE. *lēap*.

lere, *sb.* cheek, F. & B. 501 C. OE. *hlēor*.

lere, v. teach, KH. 257, F. & B. 148 C, Ass. 896 Add. OE. *lāran*.

lese, leose, forlese, v. lose; *infin.* leose C. forlese L, forleose H, KH. 707; *pp.* forloren, KH. 511 C. OE. *forlēōsan*.

leste, luste, v. listen, KH. 355, 505, 1355 C. OE. *hlystan*.

leste, luste, v. desire, [hanker](#), lust, KH. 426, 433, 918, 1298. OE. *lystan*.

lesing, lesyng, *sb.* falsehood, F. & B. 84 T, 233 T, 585 C. OE. *lēāsung*.

lete, late, v. let, permit, leave, lose, KH. 1124 C, 1330 L; belete, leave behind, F. & B. 201 T, 1593; forlete, desert, KH. 232, F. & B. 201 Cott. OE. *lātan*.

let, lette, v. hinder, retard, impede, KH. 100, F. & B. 333 T, 25 C. OE. *lettan*.
 yliche, iliche, *sb.* like, equal, KH. 20, 305, 331, etc. OE. *gelīca*.
 licte, lyhte, v. alight, KH. 51 etc; 3 *sing. pret.* alizte, KH. 51 C. OE. *lihtan*.
 linne, lynne, blynne, v. cease, KH. 329, 372, 1068. OE. *linnan*.
 list, *sb.* art, KH. 251, 1577. OE. *list*.
 lite, lyte, *adj., adv.* little, KH. 1004, 678 L, 1211 C. ON. *litt*.
 liþe, lyþe, v. listen, KH. 2, 354, 372 H, 436 L. ON. *hlýða*.
 lodlike, *adj.* loathsome, hateful, KH. 1415 L.
 lofte, *sb.* loft, upstairs, women's apartments, KH. 974 C. OE. *loft*. ON. *lopt*. The peculiar turn of meaning is Scandinavian.
 loke, loky, v. watch, guard, KH. 800, 1180, 1181 L H, 1419 L H, Ass. 47 C. OE. *lōcian*.
 looking, lokyng, *sb.* care, watch, KH. 360.
 ilome, *adv.* frequently, F. & B. 96 Cott. OE. *gelōme*.
 londiss, *adj.* native, KH. 671. Cf. *vnlondisse*, KH. 672 H. OE. *lendisc*.
 longest, 3 *sing. pres.* belongest, KH. 1406 C. OE. *longian*.
 lore, *sb.* teaching, bidding, KH. 472. OE. *lār*.
 loþe, *adj.* hateful, KH. 1140, 1283. OE. *lāð*.
 Lombardy, F. & B. 179 T. French version has (En)Lombardie 49.
 lure, v. (1) lour, look sullen (?), (2) lie in wait, set trap (?), KH. 286, 1312.
 luste, *impers.* be pleasing, F. & B. 378 C.
 lut, *sb.* little, KH. 658 H. OE. *lȳt*.
 luþere, *adj.* evil, bad; *nom. plur.*, KH. 530 C. OE. *lȳðer*. Cf. *of þan luþer folke* (= accursed), Lay. 29576 B.
 lyst, *sb.* desire, pleasure, Ass. 2 Add. OE. *lyst*.

maine, meyne, meigne, *sb.* household, Ass. 110 C, 417, 475, 569, 573 Add.; F. & B. 782 C, 1059 T. OF. *maisnee*.
 maister, *sb.* leader, KH. 659; maister-king, KH. 659 L, 680. OF. *maistre*.
 make, *sb.* wife, spouse, KH. 1523, F. & B. 78 Cott., 303 T. OE. *gemaca*.
 make, v. pretend to be, F. & B. 76 T.
 male, *sb.* bag, pouch, F. & B. 689 T. OF. *male*.
 manrede, *sb.* homage, F. & B. 395 C. OE. *manræden*.
 Marie, Marye, *gen.* Maries, Ass. 29 C, 31 Add., 239 C, 241 Add., 253 C, 498 H, 500 H, 546 C, etc.; *seynt Marye*, F. & B. 248 T; *seynte-marie*, F. & B. 49 V.
 may, *sb.* may, maid, KH. 329, 979 H, 1019 H, 1516 H; F. & B. 201 T, 393 T, 46, 102 C., etc.; Ass. 4 C, etc. OE. *māg*.
 me, *indef. pron.* one, KH. 1008 C H, 1126 C; F. & B. 671, 672, 699 C., etc. OE. *man(n)*.
 mede, *sb.* mead, meadow, F. & B. 434 C. OE. *mæd*.
 mede, *sb.* reward, KH. 288 L, 500, 1498 L, Ass. 638 Add. OE. *mēd*.
 meene, v. mourn, lament, 1 *sing. pres.* F. & B. 273 T. OE. *(bi)mænan*.
 meigne, meyne, *see* maine.

meniuer, *sb.* a kind of fur, F. & B. 110 C. Cf. Hausknecht's Note. Lat. *minutus varius*.
 menske, *sb.* honour, F. & B. 56 T. OE. *menniscu*, humanity; Icel. *menska*, honour.
 mesauenture, *sb.* ill luck, KH. 344 C L. OF. *aventure*.
 mest, *superl. adj.* most, KH. 26.
 mester, mystere, *sb.* (1) office, trade, (2) need, necessity, KH. 243, 581. OF. *mestier*.
 mete, *v.* meet, encounter, 3 *plur. pret.* metten. KH. 169. OE. *mētan*.
 ymete, *adj.* fit, reasonable, KH. 1401 L. OE. *gemāte*.
 mete, *v.* dream, KH. 1522. OE. *mātan*.
 meting, metyng, *sb.* dream, KH. 699. OE. *mātan*.
 mid, *prep.* with, KH. 22 L, 25 L, etc. OE. *mid*.
 middelerd, *sb.* earth, world, F. & B. 272 C. OE. *middangeard*.
 misliken, *v.* misplease, KH. 455. OE. *mislician*.
 mod, *sb.* mood, mind, KH. 297, 1579 C H. OE. *mōd*.
 modi, mody, *adj.* full of passion, angry, KH. 748. OE. *mōdiȝ*.
 Modi, Mody, KH. 1023, 1094, 1121 L, 1331 L, 1626.
 molde, *sb.* earth, KH. 335, F. & B. 343 T. OE. *molde*.
 mone, ymone, *sb.* companion, KH. 560, 840 C L. OE. *gemāna*.
 mone, *sb.* companionship, communion, participation, KH. 890 L, 1149 C.
 mote, moste, *v.* may, might, was to; mote, KH. 197, 218 C, 829; moste, KH. 67 C, 186; munthe (?), KH. 1508 L.
 Mountargis, F. & B. 66 T. French version, Montoire, 174, 316, etc.
 murne, *adj.* troubled, KH. 748. OE. *(un)murne*.
 Murry, Murri, morye, moye, moy, Mory, mury, KH. 4, 33, 73, 921, 1431. Cf. Maurius (Maurus), son of Aruiragus, Lay. 9895 ff. He defeats the invading Picts, and sets up a stone with runes to commemorate the victory.

[nabod](#) (ne + abod).

neb, nebbe, *sb.* face, F. & B. 615 C, 890 T. OE. *nebb*.
 nime, *v.* take; *infin.* nyme, Ass. 121 C; 2 *sing. subjunct.* or *imper.* nym, KH. 1205 L; 1 *sing. pres.* nime, KH. 713 L; 3 *sing. pret.* nam, nom, KH. 619, 1269, Ass. 33 C, 35, 59 Add., etc.; 3 *pl. pret.* neme C, nomen L H, KH. 64; *pp.* ynome, Ass. 6 C; vndernome, F. & B. 128 T, 189 T, 219 T, 227 T, 920 T, etc.; nam = went, Ass. 53 C. Cf. vndernom. OE. *niman*.
 nīping, *sb.* wretch, villain, evil man, KH. 210. OE. *nīðing*.
 noȝ, enough, KH. 196; inoȝe C, hy nowe L, ynowe H. OE. *genōh*.
 nonskyns, *adj.* of no kind, F. & B. 226 T. OE. *nānes cynnes*.
 noȝing, *adv.* not at all, KH. 290 C.
 Nubil, F. & B. 665 C. French, (de) Nubie, 2492.

[O](#), *prep.* until, KH. 134 H. OE. *oð*.

of drede, *see* dreden.

of reche, *see* reche.

on, *prep.* on, in; on mi lokyng, KH. 360 C; on kneuling, KH. 503 L.
onde, *sb.* envy, Ass. 424 C. OE. *anda*, *onda*.
one, *sb.* alone, solitary; hou one KH. 364 L, is one 559 L, go one 559 C, al one C, alon L, ys one H 650. Cf. Bradley-Stratmann.
oppe, *prep.* upon, KH. 466, 480 L.
or, *see* er, or oþer.
ord, *sb.* point, beginning; *dat. sing.* orde C H, horde L, KH. 662; *dat. sing.* ord H, hord L, KH. 1475; *accus. sing.*, F. & B. 48 C. OE. *ord*.
ore, *sb.* favour, grace, KH. 695, 1629 C, F. & B. 173 C. OE. *ār*.
orfreys, *sb.* orfrey, gold fringe, F. & B. 371 T. OE. *orfreis*.
Orgas, F. & B. 101 T. French, *Li dus Joras*, 357.
oþer, *num.* second, KH. 201. OE. *ōðer*.
oþer, *conj.* or, KH. 44. OE. *oððe*.
oþer, *pr.* other, KH. 28. OE. *ōðer*.
otter (buterfliȝe C), *sb.* butterfly (?), F. & B. 772 T.
oueral, *adv.* everywhere, KH. 262 H. Cf. Germ. *überall*.
out londisse, *adj.* foreign, KH. 635 L.
ower, *gen. plur.* your, F. & B. 534 C. OE. *ēower*.

[paene](#), *adj.* pagan, KH. 159 C.

payn, peynim, payen, pain, paynim, paen, etc., *sb.* paien, pagan, heathen, KH. 45, 63, 82, 87, 193, 935, 948, 950, 1412, etc.
paynime, *sb.* heathen land, KH. 859.
page, *sb.* boy, servant, KH. 1012 L H, 1379 H. OF. *page*.
pal, palle, *sb.* costly sort of cloth, F. & B. 822 T, and Cott.; Ass. 631 H, 795 Add. OE. *pæll*, OF. *pal*.
parage, *sb.* high birth, F. & B. 256, 269 C., etc. OF. *parage*.
paramur, *adv.* passionately, F. & B. 486 C., etc.
Paryse, *nom. sing.*, F. & B. 168 T. Fr. *Paris*, 449, etc.
pel, pelle, *sb.* skin, KH. 421, 1582 L. OF. *pel*.
pelte, pulte, pylte, 3 *sing. pret.* pushed, KH. 1529.
pilegrim C, pylegrim L, pelryne H, KH. 1236 pilgrim. OF. *pelegrin*.
Petir, Petyr, Peter, Petre, Ass. 317, 327, 580, 581, 638, 639, 673 Add., 464, 470, 529 C, 499, 563 H, etc.
ipight, *pp.* placed, F. & B. 117, 183 C.
pine, pyne, v. pain; *infin.* KH. 726 C; 1 *sing. pres.*, KH. 1280 L; *pp.* pined C, pyned H, KH. 1280. OE. *pīnian*.
pyne, *sb.* pain, torture, KH. 277 C H, Ass. 426, 458 Add. OE. *pīn*.
plawe, *sb.* sport, fight, KH. 1170 H. Cf. Bradley-Stratmann, *plaze*.
pleie, pleye, v. play, KH. 25, 200, 363. OE. *plegian*.
pleing C, pleyhunge L, pleyzyng H, KH. 34, playing.
plener, plenere, *adj.* full, F. & B. 179 C., 188 Cott. OF. *plenier*.

plizte, v. plight; *infin.* plizte, plyzte, plyhte, KH. 321; 2 *sing. imper.* plist, plyct, plyht, KH. 440; 1 *sing. pres. indic.* plizte C, plicte L, plyhte H, KH. 716; *pp.* iplizt, F. & B. 141 C. OE. *plihtan*.
 pomel, *sb.* pommel, F. & B. 209, 213 Cott. OF. *pomel*.
 porter, *sb.* doorkeeper, F. & B. 329 C. OF. *portier*.
 posse, v. push; *infin.* KH. 1087 C; 3 *sing. pret.* puste, KH. 1153 H; pugde 1156 L. OF. *pousser*.
 poure, pure, *infin.* pore, look, KH. 1172 C L.
 prede, *sb.* pride, KH. 1497 L. OE. *prȳta*.
 prime, *sb.* first quarter of the day, name of one of the offices of the Church, after 'lauds,' KH. 1040; *at prime tide*, KH. 905.
 pris, prys, *sb.* value, worth, KH. 968 C, F. & B. 310, 350, 750 C., 1028 T. OF. *pris*.
 pruesse, *sb.* brave deed, prowess, KH. 588. OF. *proesse*.
 pugde, *see* posse.

[quantityse](#), *sb.* cleverness, F. & B. 543 T.

qued, *sb.* bad, Ass. 174 C, 197, 465 Add. etc. OE. *cwēd*.
 quelle, v. kill; *infin.* KH. 65, 656 C; 2 *sing. imper.* quel, F. & B. 1008 T, aquel 725 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* quelde, F. & B. 904 T, aquelde KH. 929 L H, aquelde H, quelde C, KH. 1064. OE. *cwellan*.
 queme, v. please, KH. 517. OE. *cwēman*.
 queme, *adj.* pleasing, KH. 501 L. OE. *(ge)cwēme*.
 queþe, v. say; 3 *sing. pret.* quaþe, quoþ H, KH. 137, etc. OE. *cweðan*.
 quic, quike, *adj.* alive, KH. 92 C, 1468 C, 1478 H. OE. *cwic*.
 quite, aquite, *pp.* through with, quit of, F. & B. 171, 724 C., 180 Cott. OF. *aquiter*.
 qware, where, KH. 735 L.

[rake](#), *infin.* hasten, KH. 1126 L, 1158 L. OE. *rācian*.

rape, *sb.* haste, KH. 586 C, 1532 C.

rathe, *adv.* soon, quickly, KH. 1407 L, F. & B. 24 T, 193 T, etc. OE. *hræð*.

recche, rekke, v. reckon, care for; 3 *sing. pres.* recche C, reche L, yrecche H, KH. 370; 3 *sing. subj.* arecche, KH. 710 H; 1 *sing. pres.* rekke, F. & B. 96 T. OE. *reccan*.

reche, areche, ofreche, þorhreche, v. reach; *infin.* areche, KH. 1308 C; of reche, gain, KH. 1375 C L; þorhreche, traverse, KH. 1375 H; *pp.* araȝt, F. & B. 687 C, rauȝt F. & B. 974 T. OE. *rācan*.

rede, reed, reede, *sb.* counsel, opinion, F. & B. 45 T, 50 T, 53 T, 314 T, Ass. 294, 298 Add., etc. OE. *rād*.

rede, v. (1) read, (2) counsel, advise; *infin.* KH. 308, 511 L, 881, 966 L, F. & B. 21 T, 148, 151 C.; 1 *sing. pres.* KH. 966 C, F. & B. 75 T; *pp.* rad, Ass. 891 Add., irad F. & B. 578 C., yredde 858 T. OE. *rādan*.

rein, *sb.* rain, KH. 11.

reme, *sb.* coast (?), OE. *rima*; or realm (?), OF. *reaume*, KH. 1625 H (reaume 1623 L).

rende, *see* erne.

rende, v. rend, tear; 3 *sing. pret.* rente C H, to rente L, KH. 775.

rente, *sb.* pay, wages, KH. 984 C L. OF. *rente*.

reue, *sb.* reeve, guard, KH. 1418. OE. *(ge)rēfa*.
 reue, reyue, *infin.* rob, plunder, F. & B. 209 C., Ass. 168 Add. OE. *rēāfian*.
 rewe, *infin.* rue, repent, KH. 398. OE. *hrēowan*.
 rewlich, *adj.* sad, KH. 1129. OE. *hrēowlīc*.
 reyne, ryne, birine, *infin.* rain, KH. 11.
 Reynes C, reny L, Raynis H, KH. 1023.
 Reynild, Hermenyl, hermenylde, ermenyld, KH. 973, 1636. ON. *Ragnhilda*, OE. Eormenhild, daughter of Eorcenbriht, king of Kent.
 riche, *sb.* kingdom, KH. 20. OE. *rīce*.
 rigge, *sb.* back, KH. 1138. OE. *hrycg*.
 rime, ryme, *sb.* rime, speech, KH. 860, 1461.
 rive, *adj.* abundant, F. & B. 73 Cott. OE. *rīf*.
 riuen, ariuen, *v.* arrive, land; *infin.* ariue C, aryue H, KH. 193; *pp.* riued, KH. 162 L, 193 L, ariued, aryued, KH. 40, 162.
 rizte, *adv.* direct, at once, KH. 1428 C.
 roche, *sb.* rock, KH. 79.
 rode, *sb.* cross, rood, KH. 346, Ass. 12, 19 C, 44 C, 46 Add., 270 C, etc. OE. *rōd*.
 roþer, *sb.* rudder, KH. 202. OE. *rōðer*.
 roun, rowne, *sb.* counsel, KH. 1378. OE. *rūn*.
 runde, rounde, 3 *sing. pret.* whispered, F. & B. 716 C., 999 T. OE. *rūnian*.
 Rymenhild, rimenild, rymenyld, reymnyld, rymenild, reymild, reymyld, Rymyld, rimenyld, etc., KH. 264, 293, 393, 472, 600, 652, 691, 738, 741, 1510, etc. Rimhild, OE. *nomen mulieris*.
 ryue, *sb.* shore, KH. 142.

[sake](#), *v.* contend, fight; 3 *pl. pret.* asoke C, forsoken L H, KH. 69, gave up. OE. *sacan*.
 sale, *sb.* hall, KH. 1187 C H. OE. *sal*.
 salyley, scribal error (?), KH. 199 L.
 Sarazin, sarazyn, KH. 42, 636, 645, 671, 1415, 1477 H, 1479.
 scene, schene, *adj.* beautiful, KH. 97 L, 178 L, F. & B. 263 C. OE. *scēne*.
 schautillun, *sb.* model, F. & B. 325 C.
 schenche, *v.* give, serve, dispense; *infin.* schenche, shenche, KH. 1186; 2 *sing. subjunct. or imper.* shenh, KH. 1199 H. OE. *scencan*.
 schende, *v.* (1) scold, (2) injure; *infin.* KH. 747 L, 724; 3 *sing. pret.* schente, schende, shende, KH. 340. OE. *scendan*.
 schete, *v.* shoot, KH. 1011. OE. *scēotan*.
 schillen, *v.* sound; 3 *sing. pres.* shilleþ, KH. 224 L. OE. *scillan*.
 schonde, *sb.* harm, disgrace, KH. 746, 760 C, F. & B. 942 T. OE. *scand*, *sceand*.
 schrede, *v.* clothe; 3 *sing. pret.* schredde L, sredde H, KH. 625, schredde C L, shredde H, KH. 896; 3 *pl. pret.* schrudde C, schurde L, KH. 1582. OE. *scrȳdan*.
 schrewe, *sb.* shrew, evil person, KH. 60. OE. *scrēāwa*, barn mouse.
 schulle, *adv.* shrill, sonorous, KH. 221 C. OE. *scylle*, *scelle*.

sclauyne, *sb.* pilgrim's cloak, KH. 1134, 1137, 1310. OF. *esclavine*.
 scrippe, *sb.* scrip, sack, KH. 1141. ON. *skreppa*.
 scur, *sb.* shower, F. & B. 73 Cott. OE. *scūr*.
 sekerly, *see* sikirli.
 senpere, *sb.* bridge keeper (?), F. & B. 500 T, 513 T.
 sere, *sb.* apparel (?), contrivance (?), Ass. 704 Add. OE. *searo*.
 seriauns, *sb.* sergeant, man at arms, F. & B. 218 C. OF. *sergant*, *serjant*.
 serie, *infin.* dispense, KH. 1489 C. OE. *scerwen*, 'a scattering.'
 seyne, *sb.* snare, fishing net, KH. 726 L. OE. *segne*, OF. *seine*.
 shrelle, *infin.* cry, F. & B. 756 T.
 sib, sibbe, *sb.* kinsman, kindred, KH. 68, Ass. 181 C, 185 Add., 585 H. OE. *sibb*.
 side, syde, *sb.* (1) side, (2) shore, KH. 35, 145. OE. *sīde*.
 sike, syke, syken, *v.* sigh, KH. 456; 3 *sing. pres.* sykes, F. & B. 113 T; 3 *sing. pret.* syȝt, syȝte, F. & B. 256, 270 T, 417, 431 C. OE. *sīcan*.
 sikirli, sekerly, *adv.* certainly, Ass. 390 Add., F. & B. 92 T. OE. *sicor*.
 siȝe, syȝe, *sb.* time, KH. 374 C, 1446, F. & B. 196 T. OE. *sīð*.
 sithen, *conj.* since, Ass. 283, 422 Add. OE. *siððan*.
 siȝpe, sitthe, sithen, *adv.* afterwards, KH. 1185 C, 1238, Ass. 542 Add., 434 C. OE. *siððan*.
 skeete, soon, quickly, F. & B. 1005 T. OE. *scēot*, ON. *skiōtr*.
 skille, skyle, *sb.* right, reason, Ass. 312 H, 352 Add. Icel. *skil*.
 slitte, *sb.* opening in garment, pocket, F. & B. 348 C.
 slon, *v.* slay; *infin.* slen C, slon L, slo H, KH. 91, 47; 3 *pl. pret.* sloȝen C, slowe L, slowen H, KH. 195; *pp.* aslaȝe C, yslawe L H, KH. 94. OE. *slēan*.
 sloo, *sb.* slough, Ass. 507 H. OE. *slōh*.
 smerte, *v.* pain, KH. 1602. OE. *smeortan*.
 snelle, *adj.* quick, KH. 1581 C. OE. *snell*.
 so, *conj.* as, KH. 14, 15, etc.
 soler, *sb.* upper room, summer room, F. & B. 173. OF. *solier*, Lat. *solarium*.
 sond, sonde, *sb.* (1) message, (2) dish at table, Ass. 634 H, 798 Add., F. & B. 1072 T.
 sonde, *sb.* messenger, KH. 281, 287, (ysonde 287 L), 992 H, 1005 C H, etc., F. & B. 796 C., Ass. 106 C, 682 Add. OE. *sand*, *sond*.
 sore, *sb.* pain, KH. 75 L H. OE. *sār*.
 sore, *adv.* much, very, KH. 73, 362. OE. *sāre*.
 soth, soȝ, soȝe, *adj.* true, F. & B. 321 T, etc. OE. *sōð*.
 soune, *sb.* sound, KH. 224 H. Fr. *son*.
 soune, *adv.* clearly, KH. 224 L.
 Spaine, Spayne, Spaygne, Speine, F. & B. 413, 769 C., 1046 T.
 spede, *sb.* speed, good luck, KH. 491. OE. *spēd*.
 spede, *infin.* speed, have good fortune, KH. 852 C H, F. & B. 1026 T. OE. *speke*, *bispac*, *spēdan*.
 spell, selle, *sb.* tale, KH. 1015 H, 1106. OE. *spell*.

spille, spylle, v. perish, kill, KH. 208, 720 L, F. & B. 1007 T; *pp.* ispild, killed, Ass. 19 C. OE. *spillan*.
 squire, *sb.* square, F. & B. 325 C. OF. *esqvarre*.
 stage, *sb.* upper floor of a house, F. & B. 218, 270 C. OF. *estage*.
 stede, *sb.* horse, steed, KH. 51. OE. *stēda*.
 stede, *sb.* place, KH. 273, Ass. 730, 866 Add. OE. *stede*.
 steke, v. pierce; 2 *sing. pres.* stikkeſt, F. & B. 98 Cott.
 stere, *sb.* rudder, ship, KH. 107 C, 1471 C. OE. *stēor*.
 stere, v. lead, command, KH. 464 C, L. OE. *stēōran*.
 sterne, *adj.* stern, insolent, KH. 935 C, 784 H. OE. *sterne*, *styrne*.
 sterte, v. start, leap, F. & B. 457 C. ON. *sterta*.
 sterue, v. die, KH. 829, 980 C, 984 H, 1253 C. OE. *steorfan*.
 steuene, *sb.* voice, KH. 1453 L, F. & B. 54 C., Ass. 73, 239 C, 79, 245 Add., etc. OE. *stefn*.
 stey3, 3 *sing. pret.* climbed, F. & B. 892 C. OE. *stīgan*.
 stonde, *infin.* spring up, rise, KH. 809 L, H. Cf. Lay. 20509.
 stonge, 3 *pl. pret.* pierced, KH. 1475 L H, Ass. 447 Add. OE. *stingan*.
 store, *adj., nom. plur.* great, strong, F. & B. 19 C. OE. *stor*.
 stounde, stunde, *sb.* point of time, period of time, F. & B. 327 T, Ass. 635, 727 Add., KH. 181 C, 351, 791, 1030, 1371. OE. *stund*.
 striken, 3 *pl. pret.* struck, stripped (Stratmann)?, striken L H, strike C, KH. 1089. OE. *strīcan*.
 sture, *infin.* stir, move, KH. 1541 H. OE. *styrīan*.
 Sture, name of a river, KH. 729, 1551.
 Suddene, Sodenne, Sudenne, Suddenne, KH. 155, 189, 542, 929, 1062, 1351, 1370, 1389, 1463, 1637.
 sundry, *adj.* separate, apart, Ass. 148, 364 Add. OE. *syndrig*.
 sune, 2 *sing. subj. pres.* sound, KH. 223 C. OF. *soner*.
 swage, *infin.* assuage, abate, F. & B. 38 T. OF. *asuager*.
 swere, swire, suire, *sb.* neck, KH. 796, 1144, 1291, F. & B. 1016 T. OE. *swira*, *sweora*.
 sweting, *sb.* favourite, KH. 234 L.
 sweuen, *sb.* dream, KH. 710, 723. OE. *swēfen*.
 sweuening, *sb.* dream, KH. 774.
 swike, swyke, *infin.* deceive; biswike C L, bysuyke H, KH. 306; biswike C, swike L, byswyke H, KH. 711. OE. *swīcan*.
 swilc, swihc, such, etc., such. OE. *swylce*.
 swīpe, swype, supe, *adv.* (1) very, KH. 96, 98 L H, 172, 192, etc., Ass. 355 C, F. & B. 87, 280 C.; (2) soon, quickly, rapid, KH. 129 L H, 374 L, 435 L, 289, 845, 1042, etc., F. & B. 148, 308 C., Ass. 612, 671 H, 839 Add., etc. OE. *swīðe*.
 iswo3e, yswowe, *pp.* in a faint, KH. 458, 914.
 swo3ning C, swohinge L, swowenyng H, *sb.* fainting spell, swoon, KH. 474.
 swongen, 3 *pl. pret.* suspended, (?) Ass. 443 Add. OE. *swingan*.
 swymme, swemme, *infin.* move on water, KH. 203. OE. *swimman*.

take, v. take, give, KH. 568, 834, 1134, 1204, F. & B. 207 T, 159 C., Ass. 48, 682 Add., 572 H, etc.; bitak, KH. 839 C, bytoke L, bitoke H, KH. 1179. Cf. teche, biteche. ON. *taka*.

targeþ, v. delay, F. & B. 226 Cott. OF. *targier*.

te, ten, v. draw; *infin.* te, Ass. 282 C, ten KH. 767 T, teon 767 H; 3 *sing. pret.* te3, F. & B. 617 C.; 2 *sing. imper.* te, KH. 327 L. OE. *tēon*.

teche, v. usually 'teach,' sometimes 'give' (cf. take); *infin.* teche, give, Ass. 46 C; 1 *sing. pres.* biteche, KH. 619 L H.

tendeþ, v. set on fire, burn, F. & B. 672 C. OE. (*on*)*tendan*.

tene, teone, *sb.* injustice, harm, KH. 367, 727; anger, F. & B. 902 T. OE. *tēōna*.

terme, *sb.* term, period, F. & B. 432 Cambr. OF. *terme*.

teyse, *sb.* measure of three yards, F. & B. 201, 203 Cott. OF. *toise*.

þar, v. need, KH. 408 L. OE. *þearf*.

þat, (1) *demonstr.* the, that, KH. 27, 28; (2) *rel.* that, KH. 2, 22; (3) *conj.* that, KH. 33 L; (4) *comp. rel.* him, who, KH. 1064 C.

the, *infin.* prosper, thrive, F. & B. 566 T. OE. *ðēon*.

þinke, v. seem; *infin.* KH. 1233; 3 *sing. pres.* þinkþ, KH. 1405 C, etc.; þincheþ, F. & B. 169 C.; of þinke, misplease, repent, *infin.*, KH. 112, 1046 C H, 1136. OE. *þyncean*.

þo, *adv.* then, KH. 52, etc. OE. *ða*.

þole, þolie, v. endure, suffer; *infin.*, F. & B. 422, 677, 678, 737 C., Ass. 22, 215 C, 26, 217, 219 Add.; 3 *sing. pret.*, F. & B. 580 C., etc. OE. *þolian*.

Thomas, F. & B. 611 C, 659, 775, 796, 807, 821 Add.

þorhreche, *see* reche.

þral, þralle, *sb.* slave, thrall, KH. 449. OE. *þræl*.

þroze, *sb.* period of time, KH. 354, 1036. OE. *þrāge*.

þrottene, þrettene, *num.* thirteen. OE. *þrēotȳne*.

þulke (þe + ulke), the same, F. & B. 746 C., etc.

þurston, KH. 875, 1057. Seems to be Norse. A frequent name of Hus Carls. Thurstan (Turstayn) is one of two tax collectors sent by Hardicanute to Worcester.

tide, *sb.* time, KH. 1563. OE. *tīd*.

tide, bitide, v. happen, betide; *infin.*, KH. 212 L H, 218 C; 3 *sing. pres.*, tit, tyt, KH. 1442 L H; bitide, *infin.* KH. 218 L H, 575. OE. *tīdian*.

Printed on two lines with superfluous "OE.":

tide, bitide, v. happen, betide; *infin.*, KH. 212 L H, 218 C; 3 *sing. pres.*, OE.
tit, tyt, KH. 1442 L H; bitide, *infin.* KH. 218 L H, 575. OE. *tīdian*.

timing, tymyng, *sb.* success, KH. 1701 C H. OE. *tīmian*.

tire, tyre, *infin.* tear, F. & B. 736 C., 1017 T. OE. *teran*.

tiþing, tidinge, etc., *sb.* tiding, KH. 138, 1058, 1318.

to, (1) *prep.* to, KH. 2; (2) *adv.* too, KH. 37 L H; (3) *prefix* apart, asunder.

to-brake, 3 *sing. pret.* broke apart, F. & B. 133 T.

to-draȝe, to drawe, *infin.* draw to pieces (cf. draw and quarter), KH. 1612; 3 *pl. pret.* KH. 195. Cf. *alle þa chirchen he to droh*, Lay. 29135 A.

toȝenes, *see* ȝen.

to-shake, *v.* shake to pieces. Ass. 356 C.

trende, 3 *sing. pret.* roll, KH. 460 H. OE. *trendan*.

trewage, truage, *sb.* tribute, homage, KH. 1618. OF. *truage*.

trewþe, *sb.* truth, troth, KH. 321. OE. *trēowð*.

Troye, *dat. sing.*, F. & B. 178 T.

Tune, *sb.* town, city, KH. 168. OE. *tūn*.

twēie, tūeye, tūeyne, *num.* two, twain, KH. 943 H, 955. OE. *twēgen*.

twie, twye, *adv.* twice, KH. 1570 C L. OE. *tuwa*, *twiwa*.

tytte, 3 *sing. pret.* pull tightly (Bradley-Stratmann).

[vȝten](#), *sb.* morning, dawn, KH. 1474. OE. *ūhte*.

uncuþe, vncouþe, *adj.* unknown, KH. 781. OE. *cūð*.

vnderfonge, *see* fonge.

vnderȝete, *v.* perceive, learn; *infin.* F. & B. 49 T; 3 *sing. pret.* vnderȝat, F. & B. 35 C., etc.; *pp.*, F. & B. 292 T, and Cott. 556 C. OE. *undergietan*.

vndern, *sb.* noon, F. & B. 511 T; *ondarne*, Cott. OE. *undern*.

vndernome, *pp.* journeyed, F. & B. 189, 219 T; vndernome, set out, gone, 920 T. Cf. *noome*, gone, F. & B. 227 T.

vndrestode, 3 *sing. pret.* received, Ass. 564 Add.

vnmete, *adv.* violently, Ass. 354 C. OE. *unmete*.

vnmeþ, *sb.* immoderation, F. & B. 675 C. OE. *unmet*.

vnneþes, *adv.* with difficulty, F. & B. 63 T. OE. *unēāðe*.

unorne, *adj.* old, ugly, KH. 348, 1646 C. OE. *unorne*.

vnpliȝt, *sb.* peril, Ass. 194 Add.

unspurne, *infin.* kick open, KH. 1159. OE. *spurnan*.

vnwemmed, *adj.* spotless, Ass. 537 C. OE. *wamm*.

vrne, *see* erne.

utrage, *sb.* error for truage (?), KH. 1618 L.

[verde](#), *see* ferde.

verdoune, *sb.* troop, company (?), Ass. 455, 457 H.

vertu, *sb.* power, strength, F. & B. 370 T. OF. *vertu*.

vie, *sb.* life, Ass. 879, 889, 891 Add. OF. *vie*.

[warysoun](#), *sb.* reward, F. & B. 1051 T, *see* gersume, garisone.

wat, water, KH. 634 L.

waxe, wexe, *v.* grow, wax; *infin.*, KH. 101, 268 C, 312 C; 3 *sing. pret.* wex, KH. 268 L. OE. *weaxan*.

wed-broþer, *sb.* pledged brother, KH. 300 L. Cf. Lay. 14469 and Note 32209. Sax. Chron. 30, brother by baptism. Wace has for Layamon's wed-broðer, in one instance 'cousin,' in another 'nephew.' Cf. also Plummer, Two Saxon Chronicles, p. 25, bottom. ON. *veð brōðar*.

wedde, *v.* wed, marry; *infin.*, KH. 1021; 3 *sing. pret.* wedde (wax mad?); *pp.* wedde, KH. 316 C, L. OE. *weddian*.

wede, *sb.* clothes, KH. 1132. OE. *wæd*.

wel, *adv.*, (1) well, KH. 374 etc., (2) very, KH. 74 L, 97 L, 98 C, 131, F. & B. 147 C. OE. *wēl*.

welde, wolde, *infin.* wield, rule, KH. 324, 452 L, 972 L, F. & B. 207 T. OE. *wealdan*.

wem, *sb.* spot, stain, Ass. 647 Add. OE. *wamm*.

wende, *v.* turn, wend, go; *infin.*, KH. 971 C L, F. & B. 60 C.; 2 *sing. imper.* went C H, wend L; go, KH. 343, 755 C, 759 C H; *pp.* wend H, I wend C, turned, KH. 1170; went, turned, Ass. 346 Add.; biwente C, bywende L, bywente H; 3 *sing. pret.* turned around, KH. 339. OE. *wendan*.

wendling, *sb.* vagrant (?), KH. 754 L.

wene, *v.* think, KH. 131, 313, 1204, 1207, 1213, 1365. OE. *wēnan*.

wene, weene, *sb.* (1) thought, F. & B. 651 C.; (2) doubt, F. & B. 197 T, 181 Cott. OE. *wēn*.

were, 2 *sing. pres. subj.* wear. OE. *werian*.

werie, werye, *infin.* protect, KH. 839. OE. *werian*.

werne, wurne, *v.* prevent, KH.; *infin.*, KH. 938 L H, 1166 C, 1496 L, 1518 C. OE. *wyrnan*.

werþe, *v.* become, shall be; 2 *sing. pres.* wurstu C, worstu L, worþest þou H, KH. 342; 3 *sing. pres.* wurþ C, worþ L H, KH. 490, 728. worþe, KH. 509. OE. *weorðan*.

westernesse, westnesse, westene londe, westnesse londe, westnisse, KH. 172, 182, 228, 808, 993, 1017, 1088 C H, 1268, 1295 C H, 1615 C H.

whannes, wenne, whenne, *inter. adv.* whence, KH. 175. OE. *hwanne*, *hwenne*.

weturly, wytterli, *adv.* surely, F. & B. 819 T, Cott. ON. *vitrliga*.

wif, *sb.* woman, Ass. 18 C. OE. *wīf*.

wiȝt, *sb.* (1) bit, KH. 535; (2) being, person, KH. 715. OE. *wiht*.

wis, ywis, *adv.* certainly, indeed; KH. 131 C, 54 L H, 131 L H, 210 C, etc.

wise, *sb.* guise, KH. 378. OF. *guise*.

wise, wisse, *v.* conduct, direct, KH. 253 C, 443, 807 L, 1575. OE. *wīsian*.

wit, witte, wytte, *sb.* intelligence, understanding, wit, KH. 188, 692 C, 1164. OE. *witt*.

wite, *v.* 1 know; *infin.* KH. 309, 471 L, F. & B. 170, 609, 620 C.; 1 *sing. pres.* wole, Ass. 332 Add.; 2 *pl. pres.* woot, F. & B. 940 T; 2 *pl. subj.* weete, F. & B. 1031 T; 2 *sing. subj.* wite, 755 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* wiste, C L, nust H, KH. 84. Cf. also Ass. 32 C, 240 Add., etc. OE. *witan*.

wite, iwite, *v.* 2 guard, keep; 2 *sing. subj.* white, KH. 1569 H; *infin.* wite, F. & B. 555, 756 C. OE. *wītan*, *gewītan*.

wiþerling C, wiþering L, wytherlyng H, *sb.* enemy, foe, KH. 160.

wiþsegge, *v.* deny, KH. 1368. OE. *secgan*.

wode, *adj.* mad, KH. 950 L. OE. *wōd*.

wowe, wowe, awowen, wowen, *infin.* woo, KH. 578, 847, 1517 C. OE. *wōgian*.

wowe, wowe, *sb.* wall, KH. 1048. OE. *wāg*.

wolde, *see* welde.

won, *sb.* store, quantity, pomp (?); wip̃ ryche won, KH. 962 H, F. & B. 386 C.
wonde, *v.* hesitate, delay, KH. 355, 788. OE. *wandian*.
wone, wonie, wune, *v.* dwell, be accustomed to; *infin.* KH. 783, 1456, F. & B. 218 Cott., Ass. 184 C;
pp. wonede, KH. 80 L H, iwuned, F. & B. 567 C., etc. OE. *wunian*.
wone, wune, *sb.* custom, practice, F. & B. 557 C., 90 Cott., Ass. 20 Add. OE. *(ge)wuna*.
wood, *adj.* mad, F. & B. 936, 994 T. OE. *wōd*.
worship, *sb.* dignity, honour, F. & B. 1030 T. OE. *weorðscipe*.
worstu, thou shalt be, *see* werpe.
wreche, *sb.* vengeance, KH. 1376. OE. *wrēc*.
wreie, wreye, *v.* (1) bewray, (2) accuse, KH. 1338, 1341 L, F. & B. 816 T. biwreie, bewray, accuse,
KH. 380 C. OE. *wrēgan*.
wreke, *infin.* avenge, Ass. 726 Add., F. & B. 919 T; awreke, 640 C. OE. *wrecan*.
wringe, *v.* wring, twist; *infin.* wringe, wrynge, KH. 1142 H; 3 *sing. pret.* wrong, 1142 C; *pr. part.*
wringinde C, wringende L, wryngynde H, KH. 118. OE. *wringan*.
wrope, *adj.* fearful, afraid, KH. 366, 1304. OE. *wrāð*.
wunder, wonder, *sb.* wonder, harm, KH. 1335, 1536. OE. *wundor*. Cf. Mätzner, King Horn, 1247
Note, 1422 Note.
wyzte, *adj.* brave, dexterous, KH. 1080 L, 1302 L.
wynne, *sb.* joy, pleasure, F. & B. 333 T. OE. *wynn*.

[y-](#), *see* i-.

Differences between this e-text and the printed book

Sidenotes giving leaf-and-column information were often abbreviated for space. The forms “lf.” and “bk.” have been silently regularized to “leaf” and “back”. The full word “leaf” has been supplied where missing, except in references to the Trentham MS., where it was consistently omitted in the original.

Notes were variously printed in the side margin or at the bottom of the page, depending on space constraints. They have been treated as footnotes or sidenotes according to their function: information about the text or MS. (footnote), leaf- or column numbering (sidenote), narrative summary (sidenote). Where more than one MS was used, narrative sidenotes are shown at the beginning of each group of lines.

The recurring words “No gap in MS.” are in the original; they are generally followed by one or more blank lines inserted to keep the texts parallel. The words

are retained in *King Horn* to preserve the editor's line numbering; in the other texts they were retained only when needed to prevent ambiguity.

Each page of *King Horn* was divided into three: the Cambridge and Laud versions in adjoining columns, and the Harleian across the bottom, with lines printed in pairs separated by a | divider. For this e-text, the Harleian text has been separated into single lines to match the other two. General sidenotes were originally printed in the Harleian section.

Other Texts

At time of preparation, the three diagrams shown in the Introduction were available online at The Internet Archive:

Wissmann on King Horn:

<http://www.archive.org/details/dasliedvonkingh00wissgoog> (page n16)

Herzog on Floris and Blancheflur in Scandinavia:

<http://www.archive.org/details/diebeidensagenk00herzgoog> (page n100)

Hausknecht on Floris and Blancheflur:

<http://www.archive.org/details/florisandblaunc00hausgoog> (page n131)

In the Introduction to Floris and Blancheflur, the English passages printed alongside the French version are from Hausknecht's edition.

Inconsistencies

Preface:

The forms "H Z", "HZ." and "H. Z." (for "Haupt's Zeitschrift für deutsches Alterthum") each appear once.

The term "X type" (of OE. rime) appears both with and without period, and in both bold and ordinary type.

Some references to Hempl's test have "-wō-, -wō-" instead of the expected "-wō-, -wō-". These are shown as printed.

In a few paragraphs, the abbreviation "O.E." has been silently regularized to "OE."

General:

The abbreviations "V." and "Cott." (see beginning of Glossary) refer to the same MS., Cott. Vitell. D. III.

"MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2." is written both with and without final period (full stop).

When the editor is writing in his own voice, the Introduction uses "æ" while the notes use "ae". Middle English is always "æ" (one letter); Latin is always "ae" (two letters).

The Laud MS. always has "crist..." instead of the more common "crist..."

In the Notes, anomalous quotation marks such as 'R. H.' for R. H. (without quotes) are unchanged.

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Floriz and Blauncheflur,
The Assumption of our Lady.**

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INTRODUCTION.

KING HORN.

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§ 1. SETTING OF THE STORY.

By the beginning of the 13th century, when literature in the English tongue began to show some signs of revival, the earlier English epic tales seem to have been almost entirely obliterated from memory. A solitary survival seems to have been the story of the dragon-killing Wade with his famous boat Guingelot; but even this story is lost to us save for occasional references, [L1](#) and from these we must infer that all definite idea of its origin was lost, since Wade is associated, now with Weyland, now with Horn and Havelok, now with Lancelot. The place of these earlier epic tales was filled in Middle English times by a new set of tales for the most part no longer of purely native, popular origin. Tales were imported from every conceivable

quarter, though usually by way of France, and even in the popular romances of Guy of Warwick and Bevis of Hampton, which are supposed to contain a kernel of genuine English tradition, the original story is almost unrecognizable amid the embellishments added. Similarly in the stories of Waldef and Hereward the historical facts are almost lost amid this mass of added foreign matter, and in the late romance of Richard Cœur de Lion we have to do, not with the historical Richard, but with a conventionalized hero of mediæval romance.

Standing apart from these largely conventionalized tales are the stories of Havelok and King Horn. These are supposed to have been among the first products of the second growth of English story. They seem to preserve, more than the other, later romances, their primitive traits, and are hence usually classed as English, or Germanic, in origin.

§ 2. VERSIONS.

The story of Horn is known in several different versions. Of these the one printed in the present volume is the oldest and in many respects the most archaic. The story, which it will be unnecessary to summarize here, is told in a simple, direct style with a noticeable lack of unnecessary description inserted for embellishment. The explanation of the peculiar features of this version is no doubt to be found in the purpose for which this version was used. It was probably intended to be sung, as one would infer from the opening lines, and perhaps is such a song, or ballad, as the one which, as the French version informs us (R. H. 2776 ff. cf. p. xiv. below), Horn sang about his love Rigmenil. The manner of the narrative is determined by the song character of the poem. There is more detail than in a modern song, at the same time less detail than in a modern story. Events are sometimes simply referred to as though already known instead of being fully described. The bravery of Murry, Horn's father, is alluded to in such a manner as to lead one to expect to hear more about his feats of prowess. No motive is given for the journey to Ireland. We are conducted from place to place with Horn, from Aylmer's court in Westernesse to that of Thurston, or from Horn's wedding feast at Aylmer's court to the annihilation of the Saracen invaders of Suddenne, almost in a breath. In this way sometimes

incidents are thrown absurdly out of perspective. For instance, when Horn wishes to 'prove his knighthood' (v. 588), while the others are at table, he sets out on his 'fole,' and at the seashore finds a shipload of *hebene honde*. He slays about a hundred of them. *At eureche dunte þe heued of wente*. He fixes the leader's head on the point of his sword and thus returns to the hall. All this, which forms the matter for about four hundred twelve-syllabled lines in the more prolix French version, is here related in an off-hand manner, in about forty short lines. The pitched battle of the French version becomes here a mere after-dinner recreation. It would be possible to multiply instances (cf. pp. x-xii) showing the abridged character of the present version.

Very different from the English gleeman's version, is the highly elaborated French version of the story. This version, [1.2](#) which is preserved in three MSS. at Oxford, at Cambridge, and at London, consists of about 5250 lines of twelve syllables, arranged in *laisses*, or strophes, of about twenty lines bound together by a single rime. Here we have a full-fledged romance, with descriptions of rich adornments, of feastings, of battles, of games, and of tournaments quite in the manner of the contemporary romances current in France and in Norman England. The archaic traits of the English King Horn are no longer so obvious. The names of persons and of places, with the exception of those of Horn, Rymenhild : Rigmel (Rigmenil), Fiken(h)ild : Wikele, Modi : Modin, Westernesse : Westir (Yrlande), and Sudden(n)e, are quite different in the two versions.

But with all this difference of detail, the story in its essential elements is the same in the two versions. Wissmann, [1.3](#) in the introduction to his critical edition, says, "der französische roman (R. H.) weist kein einziges notwendiges bindeglied, keinen schönen altertümlichen zug auf, den das englische gedicht, King Horn (K. H.) nicht enthielte; dieses dagegen hat trotz seines geringen umfanges, eine reiche von alten, wahrhaft poetischen motiven jenem voraus." And further, "aus alle dem ergibt sich, dass K. H. keine bearbeitung des französischen romans sein kann." Wissmann's further conclusions, however, are less tenable, when he continues: "das umgekehrte verhältniss dagegen ist nicht nur denkbar, sondern bis zu einem gewissen grade sogar notwendig; eine ältere quelle als das lied von King Horn für R. H. vorauszusetzen sind wir durch nichts berechtigt."

Limited space forbids a thorough-going comparison of the two versions. The essential elements of the story are in each case nearly the same. In the French version (R. H.) again Horn the prince with his companions is set afloat from Suddenne in an open boat, arrives in Bretaigne, is hospitably received by King Hunlaf, is loved by the princess Rigmenil, from whom he receives a magic ring, is betrayed by Wikele, one of his companions, and is exiled from Bretaigne. He takes ship for Westir, the court of King Godreche, and is well received by the king and his two sons. He distinguishes himself in all things, and is loved and wooed by the princess Lemburc. But after delivering the Irish kingdom (Westir) from an African invasion, he is recalled by a messenger to Bretaigne, where, after vanquishing his rival Modun in a tournament, he rescues Rigmenil and himself plays the part of bridegroom at the wedding prepared. He then repairs to Suddenne, and after ridding his father's kingdom of the invaders, is warned in a dream of Wikele's second treachery, and returns again just in time to save his bride from a forced marriage with Wikele. With the death of Wikele and the establishment of Horn's loyal friend Haderof (Athulf) in Ireland and of Horn and Rigmenil in Suddenne, the French story ends.

In addition to this similarity in general outline must be mentioned occasional parallelism between the two versions in minor details or even in phraseology. As instances of the first we may cite: *Of his feire sizte Al þe bur gan lizte* K. H. 385-6; *De la belte de horn tute la chambre resplent.* R. H. 1053. *Drink to horn of horne* K. H. 1145; *Mes com apelent horn li engleis naturer* R. H. 4206. *He lokede on his rynge And þoʒte on Rymenhilde* K. H. 873-4; *Si regarde sa main e lanel kest gemmez. Ke li fud de Rimel al departir donez* R. H. 3166-7. *And whan þu farst to woze tak him þine gloue* K. H. 793-4; *Mes une rien uus di joe dont seiez purgardez, Si alez donneier ke oue uus nel menez Kar il est de beaute issi enluminez ke uus la v il iert petit serrez preisez* R. H. 2323-6. *Biuore me to kerue And of þe cupe serue* K. H. 233-4; *Horn me seruira vi de ma cupe portant* R. H. 463. As instances of phrases from King Horn reflected in R. H., we may cite: *Stiwarde, tak nu here Mi fundlyng for to lere Of þine mestere, Of wude and of riuere* K. H. 227-30; *De bois de riueer refet il altre tal* R. H. 377. *Wiþute sail and roþer* K. H. 188; *Kil naient auirun dunt a (!) seient aidanz Sigle ne guuernad (!) dunt il seint naianz* R. H. 60-61. *Ston he dude lade, ant lym þerto he made* K. H. 1502 H. *Vn castel ad ia fet de pere e de*

furment R. H. 5097. These instances, which might be multiplied, will serve to show how closely related in origin are these two versions, English and French.

The identity of the two versions is, however, by no means complete. The more condensed version (K. H.) presents some traits not to be found in R. H. We may mention: Horn's farewell to his boat, 139 ff.; Rimenhild's assistance in bringing about the dubbing of Horn, 435 ff.; Rimenhild's dream, 651 ff.; Horn's charge to Athulf to care for Rimenhild, 743 ff.; the drowning of the messenger from Rimenhild to Horn, 968 ff.; the palmer's account of Rimenhild's grief, 1035 ff.; Athulf's watching from the tower, 1091 ff.; Horn's fictitious tale to Rimenhild of his own death, 1175 ff.

If K. H. offers these few traits independent of R. H., the latter, longer narrative introduces episode after episode either barely suggested in a single line of K. H., or entirely foreign to the English version. For example, we may mention: the more circumstantial account of Horn's descent, and of the heroic death of Aaluf, 250 ff.; Rimel's amusing method of wheedling Athelfrus into bringing Horn to her, 604 ff.; her confidences to her maid Herselot, 729 ff.; the elaborate account of Horn's victory over Malbroin and Rodmund, 1295 ff.; Wikele's contrived pretext for a quarrel with Horn, 1839 ff.; Horn's loathness to take oath, though he is willing to vindicate his word by meeting in combat any two or even five or six chosen antagonists, 1924 ff.; the love of princess Lemburc for Horn, 2394 ff.; the stone-throwing contest, 2568 ff.; the game of chess, 2696 ff.; Lemburc's apartments, 2709 ff.; the harp-playing, 2776 ff.; the elaborate battle description once more, 3234 ff.; the death of Egfer, 3358 ff.; the meeting of Horn with Wikele and Modin, 4094 ff.; the tournament at Rimil's wedding, 4456 ff.; the victory, with Hardre's aid, over the Saracens in Suddenne, 4604 ff.; the touching description of Horn's meeting with his mother, 4882 ff.; the besiegement of Hunlaf and Rimel by Wikele, 5100 ff.; the intervention of Wikele's brother, Wothere, 5052 ff., etc. [L.4](#)

If the subject matter in the two versions is different, the style is far more so. The simple, condensed, somewhat archaic manner of K. H. stands in marked contrast to the sophisticated style of the French romance. The difference is perhaps that to be expected between two versions, one intended for English-speaking, the other for French-speaking people. [L.5](#) But the difference is perhaps more largely that between ballad and romance. In

K. H. the author gives no evidence of himself directly or indirectly, whereas Thomas, the author of R. H., continually addresses his public in the second person and directly introduces his personal opinion. The incidents which in K. H. are condensed almost to unintelligibility, in R. H. are liberally supplied with motives and explanations. The character of Rimenhild in K. H., almost wild in its naturalness, suggests somewhat one of the female divinities of Germanic mythology. Rimel, of the French romance, is an eminently sophisticated, almost modern young woman who understands the arts of coaxing and of coquetry.

The luxury and refinement described in the French version, contrast [1.6](#) markedly with the primitive manners and surroundings suggested in the English version. Rimenhild shares her single sleeping-room with her six maidens; Rimel has so many maids that these have private rooms, Rimel keeping by her only her one trusted maid. Rimenhild on her wedding day, has four maid attendants; Rimel, thirty. King Murry's retinue consists of two knights, and the sons of the king of Westir appear to have been without retinue; in R. H. the two princes in their *mesnée privée* have *vingt de gens ben escernée*. Even the seneschal of King Hunlaf has twenty knights in his retinue. Stimming further points out the feudalistic relations existing between Horn and his companions in R. H. (as well as in H. C.) of which one can hardly detect a trace in K. H. Further the author of the romance, quite in keeping with the conventions of contemporary romances, has introduced and elaborated descriptions of battles and of sports and tournaments on every possible occasion. In R. H. Horn is a *curteis* knight, whose knightly honour forbids him to take oath.

Stimming further points out the difference in cultivation of manner as reflected in the love-making scenes of the two versions. When Athulf is introduced to Rimenhild's bower, *Anon vpon Apulf child Rymenhild gan wexe wild*, K. H. 295-6, she has him seat himself on her bed, embraces him, and offers herself as his bride. Rimel, on the other hand, who before Apulf's coming has carefully regarded the glass, *pur veer sa belted*, *Pur saver de su vis cum il est culured*, on his appearance, takes him by the hand, leads him to a seat, seats herself beside him, and then expresses the wish, "*Bels amis, dès ore voil estre mise en vostre justise*," politely adding, "*si vostre plaisir est*."

All this, Stimming concludes, is an unmistakable evidence of the later time of R. H.'s composition. Granting the truth of this conclusion, the difference of treatment in the two versions is also no doubt in part due to the difference in the public for which each version was intended, and also still more, perhaps, to the difference in function of the two works. It must be noted that K. H. is a popular ballad-like poem perhaps of the kind referred to in R. H., while the French R. H. is an artificial and conventionalized romance of prowess and love.

That the ballad-like version K. H., simple, even primitive in matter, in manner, and in metrical form, should have been derived from the sophisticated, artificial romance, R. H. deserves little consideration. On the other hand that the artificial romance should have been derived from the simple ballad-like story, incomplete in its record of details, is even more unworthy of consideration, though quite probably Thomas, the French romancer, may have been to some extent influenced by this English version, with which he was probably acquainted, as we may infer from the following passage:

*Mes un lai ai oi dunt ioe sai la meitie
 Si iol sousse tut, par ma crestiente
 En cest nostre pais nad taunt bone cite
 Ki tant me fust a main e á ma uolente
 Ke ainz ne la perdisse ke lousse ublie

 Mut en auez oi parler en cest regne
 E de lamur de horn ke ele od taunt ame

 Coe est ueir dist Guffer, Rigmel est mut loée
 Bele soeur de beaute en meinte cuntrée
 E de horn ai oi meinte feiz renomée
 Quil est pruz e uallanz e corteis sanz pounée.*

R. H. 2783-2801.

The French romance is no doubt constructed from an English story, as we may infer from the proper names, which in general seem to be Germanic in origin, from occasional English words, e.g. *welcume* 800, *wite God*, *wrec* 150, etc., from references to English such as, *Mes com apellent horn li engleis*, R. H. 4206, and especially from the general features of the story which seem to be Germanic. Further, "in the introduction to the French romance of Waldelf we are informed that the romance of Horn was taken

from an English original” (T. Wright, *Essays on Middle Ages*, I, 102. London, 1846). The English gleeman’s version quite likely was composed directly from oral tradition, while the romance rests upon some version of the story, the “*parchemin*” so often referred to. This hypothetical version, judging from the identity of the story in its main outline with that in K. H., must be the version upon which R. H. rests also, or must rest upon the same tradition with K. H.

A third version of the story of Horn is the romance of Horn Childe and Maiden Rimmild, the only copy of which is the incomplete one contained in the famous collection of the Auchinleck MS. of the 14th century. (One leaf lost in the middle and one or two at the end.) Of this romance, which is composed in twelve-lined strophes, *rime couée*, there are preserved 1136 lines, that is to say, 96 strophes, not all complete. The story, very briefly summarized, is as follows:

Hapeolf, king of “*al Ingelond fram Humber norþ*,” has one son named Horn. To Horn Hapeolf gives eight companions and puts all under the instruction of Arlaund. Hapeolf annihilates a host of Danish invaders, but within nine months is again attacked, this time by three kings from Ireland, and after an heroic fight, in which he slays five thousand, is stoned to death, and “*an erle of Northumberland*” seizes the kingdom.

Herlaund conducts the nine boys “*fer souþe in Ingland*,” where they are received by Houlac the king. The king’s only daughter, Rimmild, loves him and asks Herlaund to bring Horn to her bower. As in the other versions, Arlaund first brings Haperof, but the second time brings Horn to Rimmild, and the princess gives Horn rich presents, and promises to be his if he shall be dubbed knight. But Wikard and Wikel, two of Horn’s companions, calumniate Horn and Rimmild to the king, and Horn is banished. After vain attempts at a reconciliation with the king, he takes leave of Rimmild, who gives him a ring with a magic stone:

“*When þe ston wexeþ wan
þan chaungeþ þe þought of þi leman
When þe ston wexeþ rede
þan haue y lorn mi maidenhed.*”

Horn takes the name of Godebunde, has heroic adventure in the forest, wins a great tournament in Wales, then crosses over to Ireland, and delivers king Finlawe (Finlak) from his enemy, Malkan, the one who had slain

Horn's father. Atula, Finlak's daughter, loves Horn, but he remains true to Rinneld, notices that the stone in his ring has turned pale, and with a hundred knights, crosses over into England in time to save Rinneld from marrying King Moion, overthrows Moion in the tournament, slays Wigard and smites out the eye of the false Wizel, Wigard's brother. Horn marries Rinneld, and, after five days of feasting, makes ready a force to go into *North-Humberland* to win back his father's kingdom. The single MS. ends abruptly at this point.

It will be seen that the main outline of the story as told in the other two versions, is here preserved, but with many modifications, with some omissions and some additions. The scene of action has shifted. We hear no more of the to us obscure names Suddenne and Westir; the whole action takes place in the British isles. The names of the persons, too, are greatly transformed, Horn and Rinneld, and possibly Moion being about the only names common to all the versions. The whole introduction of the present version, dealing with the bravery and death of Hafeolf, Horn's father, which forms about a quarter of this romance version as preserved to us, is entirely strange to K. H. and to R. H. Other features peculiar to H. C. are: Hafeolf's instructions to the boy companions of Horn, to bear fealty to Horn, 137 ff.; the fine gifts and rich entertainment by Rinnild of Herlaund and Haderof and, later, of Horn, 330 ff., 377 ff.; the manner of the courtship, where Horn no longer plays the reluctant part, urging his poverty as an excuse, 373 ff.; the episode of the departure of Horn's companions Tebeaud, Winwald, Garins and Apelston for foreign lands, 445 ff. Wikel here does not accuse Horn of designs on the king's life and kingdom, 486 ff. Horn remains at home from the hunting, not to visit Rinnild, but "*for blodeleteing, Al for a maladye.*" 485 ff. There is no Saracen invasion of Houlac's kingdom. Horn tries to appease the king, 541 ff. The ring has a different function, 571 ff. The ring it is that prompts Horn's return to Rinnild. Still other features peculiar to this edition are: the heroic adventure in the forest, 613 ff.; the tournament at the court of Elidan in Wales, 664 ff.; and the whole account of Horn's experiences in Ireland, the occasion of his journey there, the character of the battle (in which Horn is wounded), and the absence of mention of king Finlak's proposal to give his daughter and kingdom to Horn.

All these independent traits in H. C. lead us to conclude that this version must rest, directly or indirectly, on a tradition different from that underlying K. H. and R. H. That, as Stimming thinks probable, the writer “unmittelbar aus der sage selbst geschöpft” seems unlikely considering the highly sophisticated [1.7](#) nature and artificial form of this version, and the frequent remarks of the author, “*in boke as we rede*,” etc. More likely it rests directly on an earlier version of the story, which in its turn rests on a Northern tradition of the story. That such a Northern tradition existed we have evidence in the Scottish ballads of Hind Horn [Child’s (F. J.) English and Scottish Ballads. Boston, 1882-84], which while emphasizing only one element, the separation of the two lovers and their reunion through the agency of the magic ring, agree with the H. C. version rather than with that of K. H. and R. H.

What, then, is the relation of H. C. to K. H. and to R. H.? Wissmann says, apparently with truth: “Das Gedicht von Horn Childe hat von dem Gehalt des K. H. nichts bewahrt, was nicht auch R. H. hätte.” On the other hand H. C. has a number of important traits in common with R. H., for instance, the names: Herland (R. H.); Herlaund, Arlaund, Harlaund, Arlond, etc. (H. C.); Allof (R. H.); Hapeolf (H. C.); Wikel (R. H.); Wizel (H. C.); Haperof (R. H.); Haderof (H. C.) and Hunlaf (R. H.); Houlac (H. C.); further, Haderof’s ignorance of Herland’s intention to palm him off as Horn, the love of the Irish princess for Horn, Horn’s meeting with Moïoun (Moging) and Wikard, and his riddle of the net told here, the tournament and the contest between Horn and Moïoun, Horn’s thanks to king Houlac (Hunlaf). From the considerable French element in the vocabulary of H. C., including frequent rime words, the French form Cornwayle riming with the French phrase *saun faile*, it is reasonable to suppose that the author was acquainted with French, and the general tone of the romance, the feudalism inculcated by King Hapeolf, 133 ff., the tournaments and the general air of luxury in addition to the above-mentioned striking traits in common with R. H., suggest almost inevitably that the author of H. C. must have been acquainted with, and influenced by, the French version.

The Scottish ballads of Hind Horn (cf. Child, as above, I, 187), as said above, emphasize only one element of the original story, namely, the separation of Horn and the princess, and their reunion through the agency of the magic ring. The story in Hind Horn agrees more closely (notably in the

function of the ring, peculiar to the Northern versions) with H. C. than with R. H. or K. H., and seems to rest, along with H. C., on a northern version of the story.

The later French romance *Ponthus et la belle Sidoine* is an adaptation of the French version (R. H.) of the Horn story. It is purely an artificial product based on R. H., and has little bearing on the origin and history of the version in hand. It is interesting in this connection as showing how possible it is to tell the same story with different names, the only name in common between R. H., and the adaptation being that of the steward Herlant. (Cf. English translation, *King Ponthus and the Fair Sidone*, edited by F. J. Mather, Publ. of the Mod. Lang. Assoc. of America, xii, 1-150.) The story of Ponthus also appears in a German *Volksbuch* (cf. Simrock, I. 1 ff.).

§ 3. ELEMENTS OF THE STORY.

The story of Horn, it is generally believed, had its origin in the turbulent times of the Danish invasions, but the kernel of genuine historical tradition is probably small. How the different elements in such a story aggregate, we can plainly see in the case of the *Hereward*: “The writer of the life of Hereward,” according to Wright, “had, among other sources of information, the work of the presbyter, Leofric, Hereward’s archdeacon. This Leofric, he tells us, occupied himself in collecting for the edification of his hearers, all the acts of the giants and warriors from the fables of the ancients, or, in the instance of more modern heroes, from the trustworthy relations of those who had known them, and in writing them in English that they might be preserved in people’s memories.” In this way grew the *Hereward* story, and in a similar manner, we may suppose, that the story of Horn attracted to itself many new and foreign elements, receiving its development and final form probably at the hands of the *jongleurs*, or gleemen, whom we are to think of as wandering widely and gathering romantic material from the most remote regions.

In another place (Publ. of the Mod. Lang. Assoc. of America, xv. 221-232) I have attempted to point out some of the ‘Germanic elements’ in the story. It seems possible to distinguish two essential elements in the story: (1) Horn’s expulsion from his kingdom and his return and avengement of

his father's death; (2) the separation and reunion of the faithful lovers. Of these elements the first seems to be especially Germanic. At least historic incidents which might supply the nucleus for such a tale were particularly common in connection with the continual wars between Denmark, Norway and Sweden, and also with the invasions of England, Danish and Norman. (Cf. the death of Beaduheard. Eng. Chron. (Winch.) a. 787, also the death of Aethelwulf at hands of Danes, avenged by his brother Aethelstan. Gaimar, 2391 ff.) The second element also may have been of Germanic origin, though it has become greatly conventionalized and has come to be the more prominent element in the story. The minor features of the story, though often purely conventional, and, therefore, belonging to no distinct nationality, at times show Germanic traits, as for instance in the *comitatus* relation existing between Horn and his followers, in the manner of wooing and of wedding, in the etiquette of the feasts, in the etiquette of the duel, and in the formal challenge on the part of a champion of an invading host, to a duel upon the result of which shall depend the marriage of a princess or the fate of a kingdom (cf. Mod. Lang. Assoc. Publ., as above, pp. 228-231).

The story as it is preserved in K. H., the earliest of existing versions, is no doubt a greatly expanded form of the original nucleus. The timely rescue of the princess from a forced marriage, which in the Scottish ballad has been preserved at the expense of the complete loss of the other element, the recovery of the kingdom and the avengement of the father's death, even in the earlier K. H. version has come quite to overshadow the recovery and revenge element. It seems very probable also that there has been a duplication of the rescue scene, due either to the desire of the *jongleur*, or minstrel, to repeat a successful climax, or to a blending of two versions of the same story, a not at all uncommon feature in such romances, [1.8](#) and that the second rescue scene, with its more archaic and more particularly Germanic features, represents the sole turning-point in an earlier and simpler version, the first and more conventional rescue scene being an expansion contributed by a later composer. All this, which rests largely on conjecture, would assume for the nucleus of the story a relatively simple incident in which there are involved only two places, the kingdom from which the prince is expelled and which he regains, and the kingdom where he finds refuge.

§ 4. TOPOGRAPHY.

The topography of the Horn story offers some difficult but interesting problems. In the northern version (H. C.) all is made relatively clear. The author of this version assigns the events to very definite places. Horn's father is king of "*al Ingelond fram Humber norþ.*" He repels a Danish invasion on the east coast, and is slain by invaders from Ireland. Horn and his companions take refuge "*fer souþe in Ingland.*" Thence Horn goes in exile to Wales and later into Ireland. The Norman *trouvère*, also, clarifies matters somewhat by assigning definite names to two of the three kingdoms involved, Bretaine and Westir (*Ki ore est Hirlande lors westir fu apelee*, 2184, H). But both the Norman and the older English versions have consistently the perplexing name Suddenne (Sodenne); and the earlier English version has also the vague name Westernesse (Westnesse), leaving as a certain starting-point in our study of the topography only Yrlonde, also referred to as *westene lond* (754 H).

From internal evidence in King Horn we learn little that is definite about the situation of Suddenne. In drifting from Suddenne to Westernesse, Horn and his companions spend "*Al þe day and al þe niȝt, Til hit sprang dai lizt,*" K. H. 122-3; and again we are told of the same voyage "*Dai hit is igon and oþer, Wiþute sail and roþer,*" 187-8. On the return voyage to Suddenne, *Bipinne daies fiue, þat schup gan ariue*, 1295-6. On hearing of Fikenhild's second treachery Horn exclaims, "*Crist for his wundes fiue, To niȝt me þuder driue,*" 1423-4, and then, *Er þan horn hit wiste, To fore þe sunne vpriste, His schup stod vndur ture At Rymenhilde bure*, 1435-39. From all which we can only conclude that ideas of direction and distance are very vague in the mind of the English composer.

In regard to the kingdom of Suddenne, some have thought that the name must be connected with *Suðdene* mentioned in Beowulf, which would make Suddenne refer to some place in northern Europe, possibly in Denmark. (Parallelism with the *Havelok* would also support this opinion.) But neither the proper names of the story, nor the phonology of the word Suddenne itself, support this view. Ward [19](#) suggests that the name is a mere vague poetical designation, and brings together historical facts and internal evidence in the attempt to determine the definite place. He cites the name

Hornesbeorh on the Isle of Purbeck, Dorsetshire, calls attention to the phrase in King Horn, “*y come into þis yle*,” referring to the Sarazin incursion in which Horn’s father was killed, and from the fact that “it was upon Dorsetshire that a descent of the Northmen took place, which was the first recorded appearance in Wessex, and which evidently made a great impression upon the people,” concludes that “Dorsetshire has a very fair claim to be considered the birthplace of the Horn legend.”

One is loath, however, to let go the only thread that seems to lead to an explanation of the name Suddenne itself. Francisque Michel was the first to point out that in the Brit. Mus. text of Gaimar’s *L’estorie des Engleis*, one reads that “*Edelbrit fu feit reis de Kent E de Sudeine ensement*,” vv. 955-6. In spite of the fact that the other three versions have; one, Surrie, the other two Suthreie, one is tempted to cling to this clew, and the fact that in the same manuscript later, Gaimar, in referring to the same political division says, [L.10](#) “*Puis regnat son fi3, E Adelstán, un rei gentils, Li uns out Westsexe, e laltre Kent, Suthdreie, e Suthsexe ensement*,” vv. 2388-91, gives ground for the supposition that Sudeine [L.11](#) may refer collectively to Surrey and Sussex. In that case the coast of Sussex was probably the scene of the first act in the Horn drama.

Whichever of these views is the true one, we may be reasonably certain that the Suddenne in the mind of the composer of K. H. lay on the south coast of England. Knowing this, we may perhaps determine, at least approximately, the situation of Westernesse. In the Harleian and Laud MSS., the messenger sent to seek Horn, says, *Ich seche from Westnesse horn knight of estnesse*,” which indicates that the composer conceives Westernesse to be west of Suddenne. Further it is very certain, as Ward (as above, p. 449) points out, that an early version of the Horn story has supplied several of the incidents of the *Hereward*. The influence of the story of Horn on the *Hereward* is particularly obvious in chapters 4-6, where Hereward gets into trouble at the court of a king of Cornwall named Alef, by killing a champion who had claimed the princess in marriage; Hereward is imprisoned, but is released by the princess, who sends him to her chosen lover, the son of a king of Ireland; a letter subsequently reaches him, saying that she is about to be forced into marriage with another Irish prince. Hereward reaches Cornwall again, visits the bridal feast in disguise, and is presented with the cup by the princess. “This,” as Ward remarks, “is

certainly some evidence that the Westnesse or Westernesse of our poem may be taken to signify Cornwall. The name, Aylmar (*i.e.* Athelmar), also does not oppose this view. The name was a very common one in South England, and was borne by two of the Aldermen of Devonshire, who seem to have had some authority over Cornwall also, one about 930, another in the early part of the 11th century, and both bearing the epithet ‘Ailmer the Great.’”

Another possible explanation of Westernesse may be suggested. The duplication of names and incidents in Westernesse and Ireland has been referred to above. The *-er* suffix of Westernesse certainly suggests the *-r* termination in Westir (the name in R. H.), which is probably a Norse name for Ireland (cf. the other Norse names in Ireland: Thurston, Regnild, = Norse Ragnhilda, and Harild. Cf. also R. H. 2184 H, quoted above, p. xviii), and it is not at all impossible to conceive that in the original, simpler form of the story, there were but two scenes to this drama, and that Westernesse of the English version, and Westir of the Norman version, alike refer to Ireland, only that on account of the amplification of the story, one came to think of Aylmar’s kingdom as in England, and added a *-nesse* to the Norse form Westir (Vestr) so as to make the term fit a promontory on the western end of the south coast of England, in Devonshire or in Cornwall.

§ 5. STYLE.

As we have seen, the story of Horn belongs to a second growth of English story. The manner of expression, and the general movement of the story are quite different from those peculiar to Anglo-Saxon poetry, lacking almost entirely the parallelism,—the appositional construction and the heaped-up epithets, or *kennings* of the earlier stories. With the large French element in the vocabulary, there seems to have been introduced a manner of expression more like the French than like the earlier English. The movement is direct, and the imagery very simple and popular. Cf. *He was briȝt so þe glas. He was whit so þe flur, Rose red was his colur*, 14-16, *Also blak so eny cole*, 624. *Also he sprunge of stone*, 1102, etc. In this respect King Horn is less closely linked with the past than is Layamon’s Brut, which was composed in the West Midlands, where the OE. traditions in

poetry persisted the longest. The Brut, while presenting many of the modern features of manner and of phrase, still preserves much of the manner of the past. There are in King Horn a number of the conventionalized phrases, to be found also in Layamon (cf. Notes to vv. 11, 67, 69, etc.), but the number of such instances is much smaller than one would have expected, and if Layamon's West Midland work represents an earlier stage than King Horn in the development from the Anglo-Saxon manner of writing, the composer of Horn has certainly been subjected to many new and modernizing influences.

The very element in common between Layamon and King Horn is, perhaps, the new, the modern phraseology more often than the old phraseology rooted in the past. While, then, there are but few traces of the older English poetic phraseology, there is much in common between King Horn and the romances of the 13th and 14th centuries. The language in King Horn seems to be already again crystallizing into new conventional forms. In spite of the different demands of the metre of Horn from those of the later, more regular, forms of versification, there are a very great number of stereotyped phrases common to King Horn and to the contemporary and succeeding romances composed in the other metre. I have brought together in the Notes a number of instances of this agreement in phraseology. The minor elements, also, are often rather mediæval than Anglo-Saxon, and the customs described, the princess's manner of receiving visitors, the manner of salutation in meeting and in parting, etc., if truly representing the manners of the time of the composition of King Horn, soon became conventionalized and common to the whole body of Middle English romance. (Cf. Notes to vv. 315, 319, 321, 403, 537, 739, etc.) In these respects the composer of K. H. no doubt at times follows the conventional mode of composition of his time, but he is probably also at times an innovator, for several scenes in Horn seem to have been prototypes directly imitated in later romances in the *Ipomydon* and in the *Richard Coeur de Lion*. (Cf. Notes to 239 ff., 264.)

On the whole, then, we see that the language of King Horn is much less influenced, than one would expect, by older English models. The language of the second growth of story seems to have fallen into new conventional moulds quite independent of the older tradition.

§ 6. VERSIFICATION.

As we have seen, the phraseology of King Horn shows relatively little trace of influence by the older English traditional stereotyped forms of expression. In this respect if Layamon is the link connecting native English poetry with the past, King Horn is the link joining to the newer traditions of poetry, which were forming. For, as we have seen, if King Horn has some phrases in common with Layamon, these are the modern forms of expression more often than the phrases rooted in the older English tradition. And, as we have seen, while King Horn has relatively little of phraseology inherited from the past, it has a multitude of stereotyped phrases in common with the poetry of contemporary and later composition (cf. Notes). In the same way in versification, if Layamon is the link connecting with the Anglo-Saxon mode of versification, King Horn is the link connecting with the newer mode, of Romance or mediæval Latin origin.

The exact theory of the versification of King Horn remains yet to be established. Luick in his article in Paul's Grundriss offers the very ingenious hypothesis that in the 'beginnings of English as well as of German rimed verse, we have before us the coming to light again of the primitive Teutonic measured song verse.' This hypothesis, though ingenious and plausible, does not admit of verification, and it is perhaps safer to adhere to the view of Schipper (*Grundriss der englischen Metrik*), who sees in Layamon's verse the direct traditional descendants of the OE. types, and in King Horn a further development of the versification of Layamon.

We see then, probably, in the versification of King Horn a transitional stage in the development of native English metre, connecting, as we have seen, more closely with the future than with the past. It was probably the occurrence in each verse of two syllables marked from the other syllables by a stronger stress, that gave rise to a feeling of uniformity in rhythm. This tendency toward uniformity in rhythm was fostered by the regular introduction of rime, for since the riming syllable naturally bore one of the two verse accents, and since the riming syllables in two riming verses would occupy the same relative position, hence in a riming verse the second of the two verse accents must balance with that in the other verse of the pair, and the balance established between the second pair of accents would

naturally lead to a complete balance between the two verses. In other words the two verses would be levelled to the same rhythm.

The regular introduction of rime was, no doubt, attended by the gradual loss of alliteration, which would cease to be significant as marking the verse accent, since it could hardly be made to fall regularly on the same syllable with the rime, and would hence be merely an unorganic adornment of the verse. As the position of the two verse accents came to be a fixed one, there seems to have been a tendency by raising some of the syllables bearing merely a logical stress, to rhythmic importance, thus to bring about a verse with regular measure.

The most natural products of this development are the two types: (1) with three accents and feminine rime, the natural product of the OE. A, D, and C metrical types, (2) with four accents and masculine rime, the natural product of the OE. B and E types. These forms of verse were very similar, as Schipper has pointed out (as above, § 39), to two popular Romance forms of verse—namely: the first form, three accents with feminine ending, to the half verses of the Alexandrine; and the second form, four accents with masculine ending, to the verses of the short riming couplets and to the first member of the septenar. The development toward regular measure, which had its origin as explained above, was furthered by the influence of the Romance and Mediæval Latin forms of verse. In certain ME. poems, notably the *Bestiary*, there are to be found verses constructed regularly after Romance or Mediæval Latin models along with native forms in all the stages of development:

1. His muð is yet wel unkuð
Wið *pater noster* and crede;
Faren he norð, er fare he suð
Leren he sal his nede. vv. 112-15.
2. Ðe mire muneð us
Mete to tilen,
Longe liuenoðe,
ðis little wile. vv. 273-6.
Ðe leun stant on hille
And he man hunten here. vv. 1-2.

The native forms must have been influenced by this close association with foreign forms.

To these conditions and to this course of development we must probably attribute the origin of the versification in King Horn. The rime has become a regular and essential element, the alliteration, a rare and unessential element in the verse. The forms mark a transitional stage in development, but are more closely related to the new than to the old. There has been a half-hearted attempt to introduce regularity of measure, but the rhythm of the OE. types has still influenced the ear of the composer. The most frequent verse form is the one with three accents and feminine rime, about 1300 verses (Schipper). This is developed from the OE. through a stronger accent on one of the original theses; e.g., *king he was biweste so longe so hit laste*, vv. 5, 6 C, where the measure has been developed from the OE. **A.** type through stronger stress on *was* and *so* respectively. Sometimes the original OE. **A.** type is preserved; e.g., *Hi slózen and fúzten þe nýzt and þe úzten*, 1473-4 C. But that this was not considered normal is shown by the fact that the other two texts, **L** and **H**, have made these two verses quoted, fit into the new normal form, by adding a new syllable in each verse, so that we have in MS. L, *He smýten ánd he foúten þe nýzt and éke þe oúzten*, vv. 1473-4 L. Cf. also H. The next most frequent type is the one with four accents and masculine rime; e.g., *Here sone hauede to name horn; Feyrer child ne micte ben born*, 9, 10 L. Less frequent types are; that with three accents and masculine ending, e.g., *þu art gret and strong, Fair and euene long*, 99-100 C; and that with four accents and feminine rime, e.g., *To deþe he hem alle brozte, His fader deþ wel dere hi bozte*, 951-2 C (but cf. **L** and **H**, which have more normal forms).

While nearly all the verses may be made to fit into one of the types mentioned above, there are some which do not fit naturally into any one of the new types, but which seems rather to be a stereotyped form handed down from OE. tradition; e.g., *Bi þe se side* (OE. **C** type) 35, *of alle wymmanne* (OE. **C** type) 71, *Wringinde here honde* (OE. **E** type) 118, *Bi þe se brinke* 151, *In to a galeie* 199, *He was þe faireste* 187 C. (OE. **C** types). (Cf. L which tries to make this verse fit better into the new versification, *For þat he was fayrest*), *We ben of sodenne* 189 L, *Of Cristene blode* (OE. type **E**) 191 C. *And þi fairnesse* 227 C. *þoru out westnesse* 228 L (MS. C adapts the verse by changing the *westnesse* of L. H. to *Westernesse*).

Compound proper names seem to have been a source of confusion. Should both [1.12](#) elements of the name receive stress, primary and secondary,

as in OE., or should only one? Notice the struggles of the scribes with verse 169: *Hy metten wiþ almair king C, Metten he with aylmer king L, metten hue Eylmer, þe kyng H.* Also 257. *Ailbrus gan lere C, And aylbrous gan leren L, Aþelbrus gon leren H.* On the whole the scribes have been fairly successful in making the native material fit into the new forms, but not unfrequently may be detected traces of the rhythm of the native OE. types, especially of the C type.

§ 7. DIALECT.

In what dialect King Horn was originally composed, it is not easy to determine. This is a particularly difficult matter because the real pronunciation is disguised behind a great diversity of written forms. Under the circumstances the only safe guide is to be found in the rimes. Even these are very unsatisfactory since they are too few to permit any safe generalizations. For instance, it is impossible to apply satisfactorily Prof. Hempl's -wō-, -wō- test (cf. *Journ. of Germ. Phil.* I, pp. 14-30). In a similar way it is impossible to apply Pogatscher's ingenious test by means of the shortened product of WG. *ā*, WS. *ǣ* (cf. *Anglia*, xxiii, pp. 301 ff.) because of want of rime material. Another difficulty in using the rime-test is the double pronunciation indicated, notably in the case of WS. -eald-, *éa*- as the result of contraction (e.g. WS. *sléan*), and of words with initial palatal *3*- (e.g., WS. *geong*). Cf. examples below.

From a consideration of the phonology of the poem Wissmann concludes (King Horn, Untersuchungen, Strassburg, 1876, p. 33) that, "Im Allgemeinen ist der Charakter des Vocalismus ein südöstlicher, der jedoch von dem kentischen in vielen Punkten sich unterscheidet. Die grösste Wahrscheinlichkeit hat Essex als Gegend der Entstehung für sich." A further investigation reveals to me no reason for dissenting from this view. Some of the more prominent features of the phonology are as follows:

In all of the three MSS. the sign *æ* has been disused. In its place occurs, now *a*, now *e*, so that the indication of pronunciation is often ambiguous. That the letter *a* sometimes denotes the *æ* sound seems certain (cf. Wissmann, Untersuchungen, as above, p. 10). The original pure *ǣ*, as in some districts of America, had nearly disappeared, or been lengthened, or

become *o* or part of a diphthong. The letter *a* was thus left free to denote the *æ* sound, though sometimes assisted in this function by the letter *e*.

OE. *ǣ* and OE. *ǣ* (*ē*) shortened.

In the North and the Midland, OE. *ǣ* and *ǣ* (umlaut of WG. *ai*) shortened, appear as *a*, OE. (WS.) *ǣ* (= WG. *ā*) shortened usually as *e*. In the West-Southern and Middle-Southern, (1) early writings have *e* (*æ*, *ea*), (2) later writings have *a*. In Kentish and East-Southern the prevailing vowel is *e*. (Cf. Morsbach, §§ 96-105.)

In K. H. OE. *ǣ* appears (1) in C usually as *a* (one exception *bed* 536), (2) in H as *e*, e.g., *sumwet* : *net* 725-6, (3) in L as *a* or *e*. OE. *ǣ* (i-umlaut) shortened seems to have been written the same. Cf. 5-6, 653-4, 1249-50, with some variations from the rule in 21-2, 553-4, 1305-6, 701-2 C H. The pronunciation of this shortened OE. *ǣ* (i-umlaut) seems to have been *e*. Cf. *geste* : *feste* 553-4, 1305-6, *biweste* : *laste* 5-6. Apparent evidence to the contrary are *haste* : *laste* 653-4 C L (but *beste* : *leste* H), and *icaste* : *ilaste* 701-2 C H (but *keste* L), *hadde* : *ladde* 21-2, *hadde* : *dradde* 1249-50 C L, but *hedde* : *dredde* 1249-50 H.

Note 1. OE. (WS.) *ǣ* must have had a close pronunciation (*ē*) if we may judge from the rimes; *here* : *lere* 241-2, *lede* : *ȝede* 309-10 C, *ete* : *suete* 1349-50, *lere* : *yfere* 257-8, *swete* : *forlete* 231-2, *seche* : *speche* 183-4, 483-4, etc. Or perhaps we must conclude that *ē* close and *ē* open were not carefully distinguished in rime, for cf. *stede* : *drede* 273-4 C, and Note 2.

Note 2. OE. *a* when lengthened in open syllables seems to have had an open *ē* sound. Cf. *makede* : *verade* 179-80, *pere* : *fare* 497-8 L H, *speke* : *take* 567-8, *pere* : *aylmere* 537-8 L, C H, 1613-14, *ȝate* : *late* 1123-4 C, 1593-4 C, *brake* : *gate* 1157-8 C, *lede* : *made* 1501-2 L H, *slape* : *rape* 1531-2 C. Cf. also the *ai* : *ei* rimes. L and H write *ai*, *ay*, *ei*, and *ey* without distinction. Cf. 1087-8 L, 1361-2 C, 1399-1400, etc.

Note 3. Pogatscher's ingenious test (*Anglia*, xxiii, 301 ff.) can not be applied here, because, so far as I can see, there are no instances of rimes with shortened OE. *ǣ* (WG. *ā*). This *ǣ* with original length occurs in rime, now with *a* lengthened in open syllable (cf. Note 2, above), now with *ē*. Cf. *seche* : *speche* 183-4, *swete* : *forlete* 231-2, etc.

On the whole, then, we may conclude that it is possible to assume for K. H. the East-Southern product *e*, but that if we do so we must also assume either inaccuracy in the rimes or a mixed dialect.

WS. *ea* before *l* + consonant is written, sometimes *eld*, sometimes *old*. It seems also to have had a double pronunciation. Both pronunciations are supported by rimes. Such rimes as *welde* : *zelde* 513-14 C H, *felde* : *welde* 451-2 H, *bihelde* : *felde* 901-2, support one pronunciation based on the OE. (WS.) breaking *ea* before *l* + cons., while *Admirad* : *bald* C, *amyraud* : *baud* L, *Admyrold* : *bold* H 95-6, seem to testify to the unbroken sound in OE. lengthened before *-ld* to *ā* and then opened to *ō*. For other instances with varying spelling cf. 17-18, 323-4, 397-8, 639-40, 1499-1500. In v. 497 the L reading *taledede* seems to represent the OE. broken form as opposed to the unbroken form *tolde* in **C** and **H**.

OE. *ě*. There are many instances of *e* : *i* rimes. But it is seemingly impossible to determine thereby much concerning the dialect. (Cf. Morsb. §§ 109, 114, N. 1.) For examples of this rime, cf. *wille* : *telle* 383-4, 1015-16 C; *stille* : *duelle* 393-4 C; *pikke* : *nekke* 1327-8; *snelle* : *wille* 1581-2 C, etc.

The form *sigge* seems to belong especially to the South-East. (Morsb. 114, N. 1, 109, N. 4, also Wissman, *King Horn*, p. xiv.) Cf. K. H. vv. 1367-8, *ligge* : *wipsegge* C, *ligge* : *sigge* L; *lygge* : *wipsugge* H.

OE. *ȳ*, umlaut of *ū* offers many difficulties. It is represented in writing by *y*, *i*, *u*, *e*. The rimes show the prevailing sound to have been *e*; e.g., *Suddenne* : *kenne* 155-6, 923-4, *pelle* : *fulle* 421-2, *leste* : *beste* 505-6, also 617-18, 671-2, 647-8, 703-4, 917-18, 919-20 L, 805-6, 795-6, 1479-80, 1637-8, 1341-2, 1367-8, etc. But cf. *y* : *i* in *kesse* : *ywisse* 461-2 C H, *lizte* : *drihte* 1405-6 C. That *y* : *i* rimes should occur, might be expected in view of the vague distinction between *e* and *i* as shown by the *e* : *i* rimes, but the number of *y* : *e* rimes attests to a pronunciation *e*. This is the strongest available evidence that K. H. was composed in the south-eastern district.

That the dialect of *King Horn* is a mixed dialect is supported by the treatment of *æ* above, by the double pronunciation of WS. *-eald*, and by further double pronunciations. OE. (WS.) *slēan*, *flēan* seem to have had double pronunciations. The *ō* pronunciation is attested to by the rime, *slon* : *vpon* C, *slon* : *on* L H, 47-8. The OE. *ēā* is rendered probable by the written forms, *sle* : *fle* 1467-8 C, etc. Other double pronunciations are *zonge* : *ispronge* 579-80, and more frequently the *i* rime *zonge* : *bringe* 295-6, *ringe* : *zonge* 599-600.

Prof. Hempl's -wō-, -wō- test does not yield very definite results in this text, but seems to indicate a southern dialect. Cf. *two* : *þo* 53-4 C, 37-8 L H, *go* : *also* 103-4, 107-8 L H, *wo* : *þo* 121-2, 279-80. But cf. *wo* : *do* 291-2. This might perhaps be cited as another evidence of mixed dialect.

For consonants we have no definite rime tests, and consequently can learn concerning them little more than the scribal preferences. In all three texts, however, the southern forms are the favoured ones; e.g. *zeue*, *zate*. Here again, however, we have double forms; e.g. *wurche* : *chirche* 1481-2, but *werke* : *derke* 1547-8 C H; *yliche* : *riche* 19, 20, 357-8; *ilike* : *biswike* 305-6, though, perhaps, we are to seek the explanation of these double forms in difference of vowel-ending rather than in difference of dialect.

From the inflections as from the consonants we can gain no very exact information, and for the same reason. The evidence, however, such as it is, points in the same direction, toward the south. The regular endings of the present indicative seem to be -e, -est, -ep for the singular and -ep for the plural. The forms are not numerous on account of the infrequent use of the present tense. There are some departures from these normal endings. *ben* occurs occasionally in the plural of the verb 'be'; e.g. 882 L, 1643 C L, 177 H. Other traces of the Midland ending -en are to be seen, *wilen* 2 L, 7 H, etc. Such forms as *þou seydes* 588 L, *þou biginnes* 608 L, *wepes þou* 696 L, are probably to be explained as mistakes of the scribe of this MS., who frequently leaves off a final consonant.

The conservative forms of the past participle, preserving the old prefix as *i-* or *y-*, also indicate a southern dialect for the scribes at least.

The personal pronouns preserve the conservative southern forms, rare exceptions being *sche* 380 L, in place of the normal *he*, and *þei* 1557 C, *þe* 55 L, for the normal *hi*.

From what has been said above, it seems fairly certain that the original dialect was a southern one, and probably a south-eastern one. There are, however, some features which distinguish the dialect of Horn from the Kentish. (Cf. Morsbach, § 9, b.) For instance, I may cite the history of the breaking *ea* before *r* + cons. In K. H. this is usually written *a*. (Cf. 481-2, 751-2, 1147-8.) But in case of lengthening before -*rn*, we see that the OE. broken *ea* pronunciation must have been the basis; e.g., *werne* : *berne* C L, *werne* : *berne* H, 753-4, 985-6, 749-50 L, 1513-14 H, *erne* : *werne* 937-8 H.

The combinations *ēō*, *īō*, *ēa* are very regularly monophthonged, not preserving any of the Kentish diversity of form.

The time of composition must have been fairly late, as we must infer from the number of French words even in the rimes. That K. H. was composed later than the beginning of the 13th century, we may conclude from the fact that OE. *ā* has been regularly converted into *-ō-*. Cf. *drof : of* 129-30, *forsoke : loke* 799-800, etc. That it was composed in the second half of the century seems certain from the regularity of the conversion of *ā* to *ō-*, and further from the lengthening of short vowels in open syllables. Of this latter phenomenon we have very few certain instances. Such rimes, however, as *pere : fare* 497-8 L H and *stede : drede* 273-4 C, seem to be certain enough. (Cf. also 179-80, 537-8, 567-8, 1123-4 C, 1157-8 C, 1501-2 L H, 1531-2 C, 1613-14.)

§ 8. MANUSCRIPTS.

The English story of King Horn is preserved in three MSS.

1. The Cambridge University MS. Gg. 4. 27, 2, which forms the nucleus of the present volume, is merely a fragment of fourteen folios. It contains on its first folios the latter part of the story of Floris and Blancheflur, which is printed in the present volume. This is followed by King Horn entire, which is followed by the fragment, printed in this volume, of the Assumption.

The Cambridge MS. is written in a very plain book-hand, apparently of the latter half of the 13th century. The folios are written in double columns, and occasionally, since the lines are short, two lines are joined in one. The initial letters are written a little apart from the rest, and are marked with strokes of red.

This text of King Horn is the one printed by Lumby in the first edition of the present volume.

2. Laud Misc. MS. 108 is well known because containing one of the earliest collections of legends. It contains sixty-one legends (the Southern Cycle) followed by three religious poems, these in turn followed by the romances of Havelok and Horn, and these followed by three further legends, in a later hand of the 15th century.

The MS. is written in double columns on parchment, and probably dates back to 1325. The texts of Horn and Havelok are written in a fine book-hand. The lives that are appended are written in a later, much less formal hand.

[For full description of the MS. and its contents, see C. Horstmann, *Altenglische Legenden*, pp. x-xii, Paderborn, 1875.]

This text of King Horn is printed by C. Horstmann in *Herrig's Archiv*, 1872, pp. 39-58.

3. Harleian MS. 2253 is well known to all connoisseurs of early lyric poetry. It seems to be the collection of a genuine lover of poetry. In the words of the Brit. Mus. Catalogue it is, "A parchment book in small folio, written by several hands, upon several subjects; partly in old French, partly in Latin, and partly in old English; partly in prose, partly in verse." The lyrical poems have been reprinted by T. Wright (*Specimens of Lyric Poetry*, Percy Society, London, 1842), who believes that the collection had its origin in the Abbey of Leominster in Herefordshire. The English poems have also been published by Dr. K. Bøddeker (*Altenglische Dichtungen des MS. Harl. 2253*. Berlin, 1878).

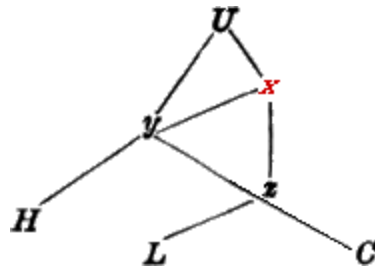
The MS. is written in an informal, but legible hand, probably of the early 14th century. The writer of the text of King Horn seems to have been acquainted with the French version of the story, as we must infer from his substitution of *Allof* (R. H. aaluf) for Murry. The word *geste* in the heading, and the French orthography throughout, together with occasional forms as *enimis* 1024 H, nom. sing. of enemy (cf. Note), 659 H, *maister* gen. sing., 123 L, *Horns*, nom. sing. go along with the evidence of the French associations of the MS., to make us believe that the scribe was an Anglo-Norman.

This text of King Horn has been printed by J. Ritson (*Anc. Engl. Metr. Rom.*, London, 1882, II, pp. 91-155).

We thus see that for the preservation of King Horn we are indebted to (1) a fragment of a collection of stories, (2) a southern collection of legends, to which have been appended Havelok and Horn, (3) a genuine literary collection probably made in Herefordshire by an Anglo-Norman.

Of these MSS. no one is derived from either of the others. To indicate their interrelations, I will borrow the diagram of Wissmann expressing the

result of his studies in this matter. (Cf. Wissmann, *King Horn*, p. v, Strassburg, 1881.)



Missing “x” supplied from Wissman.

Footnotes to Introduction

[L1](#) Cf. Skeat’s *Chaucer*. Note to *Marchaundes Tale* 1424, and Tr. and C. iii, 614.

[L2](#) Brede (R.) und Stengel (E.). *Das agn. Lied vom wackern Ritter Horn*. Aug. u. Abh. VIII. Marburg, 1883. Also Fr. Michel. For the Bannatyne Club, 1845.

[L3](#) Wissmann (Th.), *Quell. u. Forsch.* XVI. Strassburg, 1876.

[L4](#) For complete list of traits peculiar to R. H. cf. J. Caro, in *Eng. Stud.* xii, 331-2.

[L5](#) Cf. the relation of the English version of Fl. and Bl. to the French original.

[L6](#) Cf. Stimming. Review of Wissmann’s ed. of K. H. *Engl. Stud.* i, 357 ff.

[L7](#) The author of H. C. endeavours to be realistic. There are no more vague terms, like *Sarazins*, etc. Further, there is a parallelism with the story of Harold, suggesting that this version has been influenced by historical events.

[L.8](#) Cf. the seeming duplication of names, Rymenhild, Reymyld etc.; Reynild, Ermenyld, etc., all of which may have come from an original Eormenhild (cf. OE. Leechdoms), the variants being due to metathesis as in OE. *yrnan* : *rinnan*. Cf. also the explanation of Westernesse below, p. xx.

[L.9](#) Ward (H. L. W.), Catalogue of Romances in the British Museum, I, 450.

[L.10](#) Aethelwulf was King of Kent, Surrey and Sussex (Gaimar, 2391. Cf. also 2476, 2480-82). Aethelstan had Wessex, for see 2480-82. Aethelwulf was defeated by the Danes (2440-46), and was avenged by his brother Aethelstan, who defeated the Danes (2480-83).

[L.11](#) All three MSS. of K. H. say of Horn's father, "*king he wes by weste*," perhaps referring to this western division of the eastern kingdom. Asser visits Alfred at the latter's royal 'vill' which is called Denne. East Dene (or Dean) and West Dene are two villages near Chichester. There are also two villages of the same name near Eastbourne.

[L.12](#) The rimes throughout indicate that the second syllables in compound words and the more important suffixes still bore an accent. Cf. 169-70, 199-200, 209-10, 219-20, 1353-4, etc.

KING HORN.

ambr. Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2.

Laud Misc. MS. 108, fol. 219 b.

Harl. MS. 2253.

Her bygynneþ þe geste of kyng Horn. [leaf 83]

beon he bliþe
to my song lype,
ng ihc schal 3ou singe
Murry þe kinge. 4

Alle ben he bliþe
A þat to me wilen liþe,
A song ich wille you singe
Of morye þe kinge. 4

Alle heo ben blyþe
at to my song ylyþe,
song ychulle ou singe
f Allof þe gode kynges. 4

*The | corresponds to a sign used in the MS.
to mark the divisions between the lines.*

See [endnote](#) in main file.

rry and his queen, Godhild, have a son named Horn.

g he was biweste
 onge so hit laste.
 hild het his quen;
 e ne miȝte non ben. 8
 iadde a sone þat het horn;
 er ne miste non beo born,
 io rein vpon birine,
 sunne vpon bischine. 12

ing he was bi westen
 /el þat hise dayes lesten,
 nd godild hise gode quene;
 eyrer non micte bene. 8
 ere sone hauede to name horn;
 eyrer child ne micte ben born.
 e reyn ne micte upon reyne,
 e no sonne by schine. 12

yng he wes by weste
 e whiles hit yleste,
 it godylt his gode quene;
 o feyroe myhte bene. 8
 it huere sone hihte horn;
 yroe child ne myhte be born.
 r reyn ne myhte by ryne
 e sonne myhte shyne. 12

rvellously fair and fifteen years old.

er nis non þane he was;
was briȝt so þe glas.
was whit so þe flur,
e red was his colur. 16

gap in MS.
[.]
one kinge riche
non his iliche. 20

ayrer child þanne he was,
rict so euere any glas,
hit so any lili flour,
o rose red was hys colur. 16
e was fayr and eke bold
nd of fiftene winter hold.
was noman him yliche
i none kinges riche. 20

yrore child þen he was,
yht so euer eny glas,
o whit so eny lyllye flour,
o rose red wes his colour. 16
e wes feyr *ant* eke bold
it of fyftene wynter old.
is non his yliche [leaf 83, back]
i none kinges ryche. 20

acens invade the land.

twelve companions.

If feren he hadde
alle wiþ him ladde,
riche mannes sones,
alle hi were faire gomes, 24
him for to pleie.
mest he luuede tweie;

j feren he hadde
at he mid him ladde,
nd alle rich kinges sones,
nd alle swiþe fayre gomes, 24
lid hym forto pleye.
ut mest he louede tueye;

eye feren he hadde
t he wiþ him ladde,
le richemenne sones,
t alle suyþe feyre gomes, 24
yþ him forte pleye.
est he louede tueye;

e best, and Fikenhild the worst.

at on him het haþulf child,
And þat oþer ffikenild. 28
Apulf was þe beste
fikenylde þe werste.

at on was hoten ayol child,
nd þat oþer fokenild. 28
yol was þe beste
nd fokenild þe werste.

t on wes hoten Athulf chyld,
t þat oþer Fykenyld. 28
thulf wes þe beste
t fykenyld þe werste.

rry while riding, finds fifteen ships arrived on the strand.

was vpon a someres day,
 o ihc 3ou telle may, 32
 ri þe gode king
 on his pleing
 e se side,
 he was woned ride. 36

It was sone someres day,
 Also ich nou tellen may, 32
 þat moye þe gode kinge
 od on his pleyhinge
 i þe se syde,
 er he was woned to ryde. 36

yt was vpon a someres day,
 so ich ou telle may, 32
 llof þe gode kyng
 d vpon ys pley3yng
 i þe see side,
 er he was woned to ryde. 36

gap in MS.
.]

fond bi þe stronde,
 ed on his londe, 40
 pes fiftene,
 sarazins kene.
 ixede what iso3te
 r to londe bro3te. 44

with him riden bote tvo;
 l to fewe ware þo.
 e fond bi þe stronde,
 riued on his londe, 40
 chipes xv,
 f sarazines kene.
 e acsede wat he sowte
 þer to londe broucte. 44

iþ him ne ryde bote tuo;
 to fewe hue were þo.
 e fond by þe stronde,
 yued on is londe, 40
 ipes fyftene,
 f sarazynes kene.
 e askede whet hue sohten
 per on is lond brohten. 44

Payn hit of herde
 And hym wel sone answarede,
 “Þi lond folk we schulle slon
 alle þat Crist luueþ vpon, 48
 þe selue riȝt anon;
 schaltu todai henne gon.”

peynym it yherde
 nd sone answerede,
 þi lond folc we wilen slon
 nd al þat god leuet on; 48
 nd þe we solen sone anon;
 ald þou neuere henne gon.”

payen hit yherde
 nt sone him onsuerede,
 y lond folk we wolleþ slon
 nt euer crist leueþ on; 48
 nt þe we wolleþ ryht anon;
 ialt þou neuer henne gon.”

acens kill Horn's father.

rave defence, the king and his two companions are slain,

yng alizte of his stede, þo he hauede nede, his gode kniztes two; o fewe he hadde þo. rd hi gunne gripe to gadere smite. smyten vnder schelde sume hit yfelde. ing hadde al to fewe mes so vele schrewe.	52 56 60
e king licte adoun of his stede, or þo he hauede nede, nd hise gode knictes ij, ut ywis hem was ful wo. werdes þe gonne gripe nd to gydere smyte. e fouten an onder selde ome of hem he felde. e weren al to fewe yen so fele srewe.	52 56 60
e kyng lyhte of his stede, r þo he heuede nede, t his gode feren tuo; id ywis huem wes ful wo. verd hy gonne gripe t to gedere smyte. y smyten under shelde, t hy somme yfelde. þe kyng hade to fewe eyn so monie schrewe.	52 56 60

aracens begin to waste the land.

ele miȝten yȝe
ge hem þre to diȝe.
pains come to londe
neme hit in here honde. 64
folc hi gunne quelle
churche for to felle.

one micten atteþ [KH1](#)
ringen þre deȝe.
e paynmes comen to londe
nd nomen hyt al to honde. 64
herches he gonnen felle,
nd folc he gonne quelle.

[KH.1](#) after þ a letter erased

o fele myhten eȝe
ringe þre to deȝe.
e payns come to londe
nt nomen hit an honde. 64
e folk hy gonne quelle
nt sarazyns to felle.

ne moste libbe
remde ne þe sibbe, 68
e hi here laȝe asoke
to here toke.
lle wymmanne
st was godhild þanne. 72

er ne michte libbe
e fremde ne þe sibbe, 68
ote he here ley forsoken
nd to here token.
f alle wimmenne
erst was godyld onne. 72

er ne myhte libbe
e fremede ne þe sibbe,
ote he is lawe forsoke
nt to huere toke.

68

f alle wymmanne
erst wes godyld þanne.

72

grieves much,

Murri heo weop sore
for horn 3ute more.
gap in MS.
]

or moy he wep sore
nd for horn wel more.
odild hauede so michel sore
licte no wimman habbe more.

76

r Allof hy wepeþ sore
nt for horn 3et more.
odild hade so muche sore
nt habbe myhte hue na more.

76

lhild takes refuge in a cave.

s alone to a cave, where she continues to observe the Christian religion.

venten vt of halle,
n hire Maiden es alle,
er a roche of stone.
heo liuede alone. 80
heo seruede gode,
nes þe paynes forbode.

e vente hout of halle,
ram hire mayden es alle,
i to a roche of stone.
ar he wonede allone. 80
er he seruede god,
yenes þe houndes forbod.

æ wente out of halle,
om hire maidnes alle,
nder a roche of stone.
er hue wonede al one. 80
er hue seruede gode,
eyn þe paynes forbode.

he seruede *criste*,
no payn hit ne wiste. 84
re heo bad for horn child,
lesu *crist* him beo myld.
n was in paynes honde
his feren of þe londe. 88
hel was his fairhede,
ihesu *crist* him makede.

er he seruede *criste*,
at paynimes ne wiste, 84
nd euere bed for horn child,
at ihesu *crist* him were mild.
orn was *in* peynims honde,
lid his feren of þe londe. 88
liche was his fayrhede,
o ihesu him hauede made.

er hue seruede <i>crist</i> ,	
at þe payenes hit nust.	84
it euer hue bad for horn child,	
at <i>crist</i> him wrþe myld.	
Horn wes in payenes hond,	
id is feren of þe lond.	88
uche wes þe feyrhade	
at ihesu <i>crist</i> him made.	

acens deliberate over Horn.

ns save Horn and his companions on account of Horn's fairness,

as him wolde slen	
r al quic flen.	92
his fairnesse nere,	
hildren alle aslaȝe were.	

o hundes wolde slon,	
nd some him wolde flon.	92
if hornes fayrede nere,	
e child yslawe ware.	

ayenes him wolde slo	
at summe him wolde flo.	92
of hornes feyrnesse nere,	
slawe þis children were.	

he spak on Admirad,
 wordes he was bald, 96
 rn, þu art wel kene,
 þat is wel isene;
 rt gret *and* strong,
and euene long. 100
 chalt waxe more
 alle seue 3ere.

J an bi spek him amyraud,
 Of wordes he was swiþe baud, 96
 “Horn, þou art swiþe scene,
 nd follyche swiþe kene;
 ou art fayr and eke strong,
 ou art eueneliche long. 100
 ou scald more wexe
 i þis fif yere þe nexte.

o spec on Admyrold,
 f wordes he wes swyþe bold, 96
 orn, þou art swyþe kene,
 yht of hewe *ant* shene;
 ou art fayr *ant* eke strong
 rt eke eueneliche long. 100
No gap in MS. . . .
]

ne time with forebodings that if Horn lives, he will take revenge.

þu mote to liue go,
þine feren also, 104
hit so bi falle,
cholde slen vs alle.

iore þu most to stere,
nd þine ifere. 108
chupe schulle 3e funde
sinke to þe grunde.

if þu to liue mictest go,
n þine feren also, 104
at micte so bifalle
ou suldes slen us alle.

e for þou scald to stron go
nd þine feren also. 108
o schip ye schulen stounde
sinken to þe grunde.

if þou to lyue mote go,
it þyne feren also, 104
at ymay byfalle
it 3e shule slen vs alle.

are fore þou shalt to streme go, [leaf 84]
ou ant þy feren also. 108
o shipe 3e shule founde
it sinke to þe grounde.

e 3ou schal adrenche;	
schal hit us noȝt of þinche.	112
if þu were aliue,	
swerd oþer wiþ kniue	
scholden alle deie,	
þi fader deþ abeie.”	116
e se þe sal adrinke;	
e sal hit us of þinke.	112
or yf þou come to liue,	
wiþ suerdes or with cniue	
we sholde alle deye,	
i faderes det abeye.”	116
e see þe shal adrenche;	
e shal hit vs of þenche.	112
or ȝef þou were alyue,	
iþ suerd oþer wiþ knyue	
e shulden alle deȝe,	
ȝ fader deþ to beye.”	116

n is put to sea in a boat.

sorely, the children are put aboard the boat,

e children hi broȝte to stronde,
Wringinde here honde,
Into schupes borde
e furste worde.

120

þe hadde horn beo wo,
þeure wurs þan him was þo.
gap in MS.

.]

e childre yede to stronde,
Wringende here honde.

No gap in MS.

.]

þe fte hauede horn child be wo,
þeute neuere werse þan þo.
þe orns yede in to þe shipes bord
þe one at þe firste word,
þe and alle hise feren,
þe at ware him lef and dere.

124

þe children ede to þe stronde,
Wringynde huere honde,
þe it in to shipes borde
þe þe furste worde.

120

þe fte hade horn be wo,
þe neuer wors þen him wes þo.
No gap in MS.

.]

e bigan to flowe
hornchild to rowe. 128

e þat schup so faste drof,
hildren dradde þer of.
wenden to wisse
here lif to misse, 132

e se bigan to flowen
nd horn faste to rowen. 128
nd here schip swiþe drof;
e children adred þer of.
ei wenden alle wel ywis
f here lif haued ymis, 132

þe see bygon to flowen
it horn faste to rowen 128
it þat ship wel suyþe drof,
it horn wes adred þer of,
ie wenden mid ywisse
f huere lyue to misse. 132

ollowing morning see land.

e day *and* al þe niȝt,
it sprang dai liȝt.
l horn saȝ on þe stronde
i gon *in* þe londe. 136
en,” *quaþ* he, “ȝonge,
telle ȝou tiþinge.

l þe day and al þe nict,
il him sprong þe day lyt.
il horn bi þe stronde
eth men gon alonde. 136
eren,” he seyde, “singe,
telle ȝou a tidinge.

þe day *ant* al þe nyht,
 þat sprong þe day lyht,
 lotterede horn by þe stronde,
 he seye eny londe. 136
 ðeren,” quop horn þe 3ynge,
 7 telle ou tydyng.

ounces land to his companions.

here fozeles singe
 þat gras him springe. 140
 e beo we on lyue,
 schup is on ryue.”
 chup hi gunne funde
 setten fout to grunde. 144

ch here foules singe
 nd so þe gras him springe. 140
 liþe be we o liue,
 oure schip hys come ryue.”
 f schip þe gon fonde
 n sette fot on grunde. 144

h here foules singe,
 t se þe grases springe. 140
 yþe be 3e alyue,
 ship is come to ryue.”
 f shipe hy gone founde
 t sette fot to grunde. 144

h's farewell to the boat.

hark, and Horn bids the boat a touching farewell, wishing it ‘*dayes gode*,’

e se side
 eten þat schup ride.
 æ spak him child horn,
 addene he was iborn, 148
 up, bi þe se flode,
 æs haue þu gode;
 e se brinke
 water þe na drinke. 152
gap in MS.
]

i þe se side
 ere schip bigan to glide.
 anne spek þe chid horn,
 i sodenne he was yborn, 148
 Go nou, schip, by flode,
 nd haue dawes gode.
No gap in MS.
]

ofte mote þou stirie,
 o water þe derie.

y þe see syde
 are ship bigon to ryde.
 ænne spec him child horn,
 i sudenne he was yborn, 148
 ou, ship, by þe flode,
 aue dayes gode,
 y þe see brynke
 o water þe adrynke. 152
 ofte mote þou sterye,
 at water þe ne derye.

ging it with messages to his mother and friends.

þu cume to Suddenne,	
þu wel of myne kenne;	156
þu wel my moder,	
hild, quen þe gode.	
seie þe paene kyng,	
cristes wiþering,	160
ihc am hol <i>and</i> fer	
þis lond ariued her.	
seie þat hei schal fonde	
ent of myne honde.”	164
anne þou comes to sodenne,	
ret wel al mi kinne,	156
nd grete wel þe gode	
uen godild, my moder.	
nd sey þat heþene king,	
iesu cristes wiþerling,	160
at ichc lef and dere,	
n londe am riued here.	
nd sei þat he shal fonge	
e deth of mine honde.”	164
þf þou comest to sudenne,	
ret hem þat me kenne.	156
ret wel þe gode	
ene godild, mi moder.	
it sey þene heþene kyng,	
iesu cristes wytherlyng,	160
at ich hol <i>ant</i> fere,	
londe aryuede here.	
it say þat he shal fonde	
en deþ of myne honde.”	164

g Aylmer welcomes the children.

lren set out from the shore and meet King Aylmer,

gap in MS.
]

hildren ȝede to Tune
ales *and* bi dune. 168

e schip bigan to flete
nd horn child forto wepe.
e children yede to towne
i dales and bi downe. 168

þe ship bigon to fleoten
it horn child to weopen.
ȝ dales *ant* by dounes
e children eoden to tounes. 168

netten wiþ almair king,
t ȝeuen him his blessing,
ȝ of Westernesse,
t ȝiue him Muchel blisse. 172

Metten he with aylmer king,
God him yeue god timing,
King of westnesse,
od him yeue blisse. 172

letten hue Eylmer, þe kyng,
rist him ȝeue god tymyng,
yng of westnesse,
ri]st him myhte blesse. 172

ts them kindly and asks their history.

him spac to horn child
 des þat were Mild,
 iannes beo 3e, faire gumes,
 her to londe beoþ icume, 176
 þrottene
 bodie swiþe kene?
 oð þat me makede,
 vihc fair verade 180
 sau3 ihc in none stunde
 uestene londe.
 me wat 3e seche.”

or he spek to horn child
 ʒordes wel swiþe mild,
 Wenne be ye, fayre grome,
 at here to londe ben ycome, 176
 lle xiiij
 f bodi swiþe schene?
 i ihesu þat me made,
 o fayre on ereþ clade, 180
 e say neuere stonde
 i al westnesse londe.
 ey me wat ye seche.”

e spec to horn child
 ordes suyþe myld,
 whenne be 3e gomen,
 at bueþ her a londe ycomen, 176
 le þrettene
 f bodye suyþe kene?
 y god þat me made,
 o feyr a felaurade 180
 e seh y neuer stonde
 i westnesse Londe.
 y me whet 3e seche.”

n spak here speche,	184
spak for hem alle,	
so hit moste biualle.	
was þe faireste	
of wit þe beste.	188
orn spak here speche,	184
or spak for hem alle,	
o hit moste by falle,	
or þat he was fayrest	
nd of witte wisest.	188
orn spec huere speche.	184
Horn spac for huem alle,	
or so hit moste byfalle;	
e wes þe wyseste	
it of wytte þe beste.	188

rn tells his history.

s the king about their adventures,

Ve beoþ of Suddenne,	
ne of gode kenne,	
ristene blode	
kynges suþe gode.	192
as þer gunne ariue	
duden hem of lyue.	
lozen <i>and</i> to droȝe	
tenemen inoȝe.	196
We ben of sodenne,	
comen of godemenne,	
f cristene blode	
nd of swiþe gode.	192
aynims þer were riued	
nd broucten men of liue.	
e slowe and to drowe	
ristene men hy nowe.	196

we bueþ of sudenne,
come of gode kenne,
f cristene blode,
f cunne swyþe gode. 192

ayenes þer connen aryue
nt cristine brohten of lyue,
owen *ant* to drowe
ristinemen ynowe. 196

rist me mote rede,
ie dude lede
o a galeie,
þe se to pleie. 200
hit is igon *and* oþer
ute sail *and* roþer.

o god me mote rede.
s he deden lede
i to salyley,
/it þe se to pleye. 200
ay igo and oþer
/it uten seyl and roþer.

o crist me mote rede,
as hy duden lede
i to a galeye, [leaf 84, back]
ip þe see to pleye. 200
ay is gon *ant* oper
ip oute seyl *ant* roþer.

him do his will with them.

schip bigan to swymme
his londes brymme. 204

þu miȝt vs slen, *and* binde
honde bihynde.
e ȝef hit beo þi wille,
þe þat we ne spille.” 208
nne spak þe gode kyng,
s he nas no Niþing,

nd hure schip swemme gan,
nd he to londe it wan. 204

ou men us binde
ure honden us bi hinden,
nd yf it be þi wille,
elp us þat we ne spille.” 208
o bispac aylmer king,
as he neuere nyþing,

re ship flet forþ ylome,
at her to londe hit ys ycome. 204

ou þou myht vs slen, *ant* bynde
ure honde vs bihynde.
e ȝef hit is þi wille,
elp vs þat we ne spille.” 208
þo spak þe gode kyng,
e nes neuer nyþing,

He tells his name.

sks Horn's name,

e me, child, what is þi name?
schaltu haue bute game.” 212

hild him answerde,
e so he hit herde,
rn ihc am ihote,
nen vt of þe bote, 216
n þe se side,
g, wel mote þe tide.”

sey me, child, wat is þi name,
e schal þe tide bote game.” 212

at child him answerede,
one so hit herde,
For hich am hote,
come out of þe bote, 216
ram þe se syde,
ing, wel þe bityde.”

sey, child, whet is þy name,
ial þe tide bote game.” 212

e child him onsuerede,
sone he hit yherde,
Horn ycham yhote,
come out of þis bote, 216
om þe see side,
yng, wel þe bitide.”

ing it, puns upon it,

ne hym spak þe gode king,
l bruc þu þin euening. 220
n, þu go wel schulle
ales *and* bi hulle.

Hon child,” qwad þe king,
“Wel brouke þou þi naming. 220

Horn him goth snille
i dales an bi hulle;

horn child," quoth þe kyng,
 wel brouc þou þy nome ȝyng. 220
 horn him goþ so stille
 i dales *ant* by hulles.

g that Horn's fame shall spread like the sound of a horn.

n, þu lude sune
 ales *and* bi dune. 224
 chal þi name springe
 n kynge to kynge,
 þi fairnesse
 te Westernesse, 228
 trengþe of þine honde
 Eurech londe.

nd þoruuth eche toune
 orn him shilleþ soune. 224
 o shal þi name springe
 ram kinge to kinge,
 nd þi fayrnesse
 oru out westnesse, 228
 nd stregþe of þine honde
 oruouth euerich londe.

orn hap loude soune
 arh out vch a toune. 224
 o shal þi nome springe
 om kynge to kynge,
 it þi feirnesse
 oute westnesse. 228
No gap in MS. . . .

.]

eads Horn home.

n, þu art so swete
nay iħc þe forlete.” 232

1 rod Aylmar þe kyng,
horn mid him his fundyng
alle his ifere,
were him so dere. 236

orn þu art so swete
o schal yþe for lete.” 232

om rod him aylmer king,
nd wit horn þe sweting
nd alle hyse feren,
at weren lef and dere. 236

orn þou art so suete,
e shal y þe forlete.” 232

om rod Aylmer þe kyng,
1t horn wiþ him, his fundlyng,
1t alle his yfere,
at him were so duere. 236

angements for education of the children.

entrusts Horn to Athelbrus, the steward, charging the latter to give Horn full instruction in hunting, fishing,

kyng com in to halle
 mong his knyghtes alle;
 þe clupede apfelbrus,
 was stiward of his hus. 240
 warde, tak nu here
 fundlyng for to lere
 þine mestere,
 wode *and* of riuere, 244
gap in MS.
]

þe kyng com in to halle
 mong hise kinctes alle.
 þe bad clepen aybrous,
 þe heye stiward of his hous. 240
 Stiward, haue þou here
 for to lere
 þine mestere,
No gap in MS.]
 of wode and of felde 244
 þou riden wel wit shelde.

þe kyng com in to halle
 mong his knyhtes alle.
 forþ he clepeþ Apfelbrus,
 his stiward, *ant* him seide þus, 240
 stiward, tak þou here
 for fundlyng, for to lere
 þine mestere,
 of wode *ant* of riuere, 244
No gap in MS.
]

he harp, and in serving with the cup.

tech him to harpe
his nayles scharpe, 248
ore me to kerue
of þe cupe serue.

ech him of alle þe liste
þu eue of wiste. 252
is feiren þou wise
oþere seruise.

ech him of þe harpe,
/it his nayles sharpe 248
iforn me for to harpen,
nd of þe cuppe seruen,
nd of alle þe listes
at þou on erþe vistes. 252
is feren deuise
f oþer seruise.

nd toggen o þe harpe
iþ is nayles sharpe; 248
nd tech him alle þe listes
at þou euer wystest,
yfore me to keruen
at of my coupe to seruen. 252
at his feren deuyse
iþ ous oþer seruise.

n þu vnderuonge
tech him of harpe *and* songe.” 256
lbrus gan lere
n *and* his yfere.

Torn child þou vnderfonge;
Tech him of harpe *and* songe.” 256
And aylbrous gan leren
orn and hise feren.

orn child þou vnderstond,
ch him of harpe *ant* of song.” 256
Apelbrus gon leren,
orn *ant* hyse feren.

ienhild loves Horn.

ns readily and becomes a general favourite.

n in herte laȝte
at he him taȝte. 260
e curt *and* vte,
elles al abute,
ede men horn child;
mest him louede Rymenhild, 264
ynges oȝene dofter.
was mest in þoȝte.

orn in herte laucte
l þat men him taucte. 260
/it hine þe curt and wit oute,
nd alle veie aboute,
len loueden alle horn child,
nd mest him louede rimenild, 264
e kinge owne douter.
e was euere in þoute.

orn mid herte lahte
þat mon him tahte. 260
iþ inne court *ant* wiþ oute
it oueral aboute,
ouede men horn child;
it most him louede rymenyld, 264
e kynges oune dohter,
or he wes in hire þohte.

ld falls passionately in love with him,

louede so horn child,	
neȝ heo gan wexe wild;	268
heo ne miȝte at borde	
him speke no worde,	
noȝt in þe halle	
ong þe kniȝtes alle,	272
nowhar in non oþere stede,	
olk heo hadde drede,	
aie ne bi niȝte,	
him speke ne miȝte.	276
soȝe ne hire pine	
niȝte neure fine.	
eorte heo hadde wo,	
þus hire biþoȝte þo.	280
o hye louede horn child,	
at hye wex al wild.	268
ye ne micte on borde	
⁊it horn speken no worde,	
oþer in þe halle	
mong þe kinctes alle,	272
e nowre in no stede,	
or for folc þer was so meche.	
ire sorwe and hire pyne	
olde he neuere fine.	276
i day ne bi nicte	
⁊it him speke ne micte.	
i herte hye haue kare and wo;	
us he hire bi þoucte þo.	280

æ louede him in hire mod,
 or he wes feir *ant* eke god. 268
 ƿt þah hue ne dorste at bord
 ƿid him speke ner a word,
 æ in þe halle
 nong þe knyhtes alle, 272
 ƿre sorewe ant hire ƿyne
 olde neuer fyne
 i daye ne by nyhte,
 or hue speke ne myhte 276
 iþ horn þat wes so feir *ant* fre,
 o hue ne myhte wiþ him be.
 i herte hue hade care *ant* wo,
 ƿt þus hue biþohte hire þo. 280

ƿ to Athelbrus.

sende hire sonde
 lbrus to honde,
 he come hire to,
 also scholde horn do 284
 n to bure,
 heo gan to lure.
 þe sonde seide
 sik lai þat maide, 288
 bad him come swiþe
 heo nas noþing bliþe.

e sende hire sonde
 ylbrous to honde.
 nd be, he schold hire comen to,
 nd also scholde horn do 284
 i to hire boure,
 or hƿe gan to loure.
 nd ysonde seyde
 ƿel riche was þe mede, 288
 nd bed him comen swiþe,
 or hƿe nas naut bliþ.

ue sende hyre sonde	
thelbrus to honde,	
at he come hue to,	[leaf 85]
⁊t also shulde horn do	284
to hire boure,	
or hue bigon to loure.	
⁊t þe sonde sayde	
⁊t seek wes þe mayde,	288
⁊t bed him come suyþe,	
or hue nis nout blyþe.	

ld bids Athelbrus bring Horn to her bower,

tuard was in herte wo,	
he nuste what to do.	292
Rymenhild hure þoʒte,	
⁊ wunder him þuʒte.	
te horn þe ʒonge	
ure for to bringe,	296

e stiward was in herte wo,	
e ne wiste wat he michte do.	292
⁊at reymnyld wroute,	
likel wonder him þoute.	
bote horn þe ʒenge	
o boure for to bringe,	296

þe stiward wes in huerte wo,	
or he nuste whet he shulde do.	292
⁊at rymenild bysohte,	
⁊et wonder him þohte,	
oute horn þe ʒinge	
o boure forte bringe.	296

elbrus brings Athulf to bower.

aring some evil consequence, takes Athulf instead.

þohte upon his mode
nas for none gode.
ok him anoþer,
ulf, hornes broþer. 300

e þoucte on his mode
it nas for none gode.
e tok wit him anoþer,
at was hornes wed broþer. 300

e þohte on is mode
it nes for none gode.
e tok wiþ him an oþer,
ulf, hornes broþer. 300

þulf,” he sede, “riht anon
chalt wiþ me to bure gon,
peke wiþ Rymenhild stille
witen hure wille. 304

ornes ilike
chalt hure biswike.
e ihc me ofdrede
wolde horn misrede.” 308

Ayol,” he seyde, “ryt anon
ou shalt wit me to boure gon,
o speke wit reymyld stille
nd witen al hire wille. 304

i hornes ylyche
ou schalt hire bi swike.
el sore y me of drede
at hye wile horn mis rede.” 308

Athulf,” quoth he, “ryht anon
 þu shalt wiþ me to boure gon,
 I speke wiþ rymenild stille,
 I wyte hyre wille. 304
 þu art hornes yliche,
 þu shalt hire by suyke;
 I re me adrede
 I t hue wole horn mys rede.” 308

ception of Athulf.

s and Athulf go to Rymenhild’s bower, and Rymenhild, mistaking Athulf for Horn, embraces him

I lbrus gan Apulf lede
 in to bure wiþ him 3ede.
 I n vpon Apulf child
 I enhild gan wexe wild. 312
 I wende þat horn hit were
 heo hauede þere.

I sette him on bedde,
 Apulf child he wedde. 316
 I hire armes tweie
 I f heo gan leie.

I ylbrous, and ayol him myde,
 I oþe he to boure 3ede.
 I pon ayol childe
 I eymyld was naut wilde. 312
 I ye wende horn hit were
 I at hye hadde þere.

I ye sette him on bedde,
 I ith ayol he gan wedde. 316
 I hire armes tweye
 I yol he gan leye.

thelbrus *ant* Athulf bo
 hire boure beþ ygo.
 on Athulf childe
 menild con waxe wilde. 312
 he wende horn it were
 it hue hade þere.
 he seten adoun stille
 it seyden hure wille. 316
 hire armes tueye
 thulf he con leye.

ires her love.

rn,” quap heo, “wel longe
 habbe þe luued stronge. 320
 chalt þi trewþe plizte
 nyn hond her rizte,
 to spuse holde,
 ihc þe lord to wolde.” 324
 ulf sede on hire ire,
 tille so hit were,

Horn,” hye seyde, “so longe
 h habbe yloued þe stronge. 320
 ou schalt me treuþe plyzte
 i mine honde wel ryhcte,
 le to spouse welde,
 nd ich þe louerd to helde.” 324
 nd seyde in hire here,
 o stille so it were,

rorn,” quop he, “wel longe
 haue loued þe stronge; 320
 ou shalt þy treuþe plyhte
 i myn hond wiþ ryhte,
 ie to spouse welde,
 it ich þe louerd to helde.” 324
 o stille so hit were
 hulf seyde in hire eere,

scloses his identity, and bids her desist.

gap in MS.
]

tale nu þu lynne,
horn nis noȝt her inne.

Ne te þou more speche,
um man þe wile bi keche. 328
i tale bi gyn to lynne,
or horn nis nouth herinne.

re tel þou no more speche,
ay, y þe by seche. 328
i tale gyn þou lynne,
or horn nis nout her ynne.

declares himself in every way inferior to Horn, and his unwillingness to deceive.

þeo we noȝt iliche,
n is fairer *and* riche, 332
er bi one ribbe
e eni Man þat libbe.

horn were vnder Molde,
r elles wher he wolde, 336
r henne a þusend Mile,
nolde him ne þe bigile.”

menhild hire biwente,
Apelbrus fule heo schente. 340

orn his fayr and riche,
e we naut yliche, 332
ayror honder ribbe
an onyman þat libbe.

ei horn were honder molde
þer elles qwere e wolde, 336
anne ouer a þousond mile,
e schulde ich him bigile.”

eymyld hire bi wende,
e stiward sone he schende. 340

e be we nout yliche,	
or horn is fayr <i>ant</i> ryche,	332
gyrore by one ribbe	
en ani mon þat libbe.	
ah horn were vnder molde,	
it oþer elle wher he sholde,	336
ennes a þousent milen,	
nulle him bigilen.”	
rymenild hire by wente,	
it Athelbrus þus heo shende,	340

ienhild rages at Athelbrus.

ld storms at Athelbrus, and drives him from the bower.

nnes þu go, þu fule þeof,	
wurstu me neure more leof	
it vt of my bur,	
muchel mesauenteur.	344
ame mote þu fonge	
on hiȝe rode anhonge.	
þpek iħc noȝt wiþ horn,	
he noȝt so vnorn.	348
[n] is fairer þane beo he,	
muchel schame mote þu deie.”	

Aylbrous, þu foule þef,	
e worstu me neuere lef.	
end out of mi boure,	
yt muchel mesauenture.	344
euele ded mote þou fonge	
nd on heuele rode on honge.	
pak ich nou with horn,	
is he nowt me biforn.	348
e his fayror of liue;	
end out henne bilyue.”	

Aþelbrus, þou foule þef,
 æ worþest þou me neuer lef.
 ent out of my boure,
 name þe mote by shoure, 344
 it euel hap to vnderfonge
 it euele rode on to honge.
 e speke y nout wiþ horne,
 is he nout so vnorne. 348
No gap in MS. . . .
]

elbrus promises to bring Horn.

ælbrus in a stunde
 anon to grunde. 352
 fdi, Min oʒe,
 æ me a litel þroʒe.

o aylbrous a stounde
 n kneus fel to grunde. 352
 A, leuedy, min howe,
 yþe a litel þrowe.

Þo Athelbrus astounde
 l aknen to grounde. 352
 na, leuedy, myn owe,
 e lyþe a lutel þrowe,

s explains his fears,

whi ihc wonde
ge þe horn to honde. 356
horn is fair *and* riche,
no whar his iliche.
nar, þe gode kyng,
e him on mi lokyng. 360

No gap in MS. . . .]
o bringe þe horn to honde. 356
orn hys fayr and riche,
is no man hys liche,
nd aylmer, þe gode king,
ede him in Mi loking. 360

at list were fore ych wonde
o bringen horn to honde. 356
r horn is fayr *ant* riche,
is non his ylyche.
ylmer þe gode kyng
ade him me in lokyng. 360

horn were her abute,
e y me dute
him 3e wolden pleie
vex 3ou selue tweie. 364
ne scholde wiþuten oþe
yng maken vs wroþe.

yf horn þe were aboute,
7el sore ich me doute
at ye schulden pleye
itwen hou one tweye. 364
an scholde wit ouden oþe
e king hus maken wroþe.

if horn þe were aboute,
re ich myhte doute
ip him þou woldest pleye
tuene ou seluen tueye. 364
enne shulde wiþ outhen oþe
e kyng vs make wroþe.

Rymenhild's forgiveness, and promises to bring Horn in all events.

menhild, forʒef me þi tene,
li, my quene, 368
horn ihc schal þe fecche,
am so hit recche."

or ʒyf me þi tene,
ly leuedi and my quene, 368
nd horn ich wolle feche,
am so hit euere reche."

h, forʒef me þi teone, [leaf 85, back]
y leuedy Ant my quene. 368
orn y shal þe fecche,
ham so hit yrecche."

ld is glad, and bids him bring Horn as a squire.

menhild, ʒef he cuþe,
lynne wiþ hire Muþe. 372
makede hire wel bliþe
was hire þat siþe.

eymyld, ʒyf hye cowþe,
an leyhe wyt hire mouþe. 372
ye lowe and makede blyþe
el was hire swiþe.

menild, ʒef heo couþe,
on lyþe wiþ hyre mouþe. 372
eo loh *ant* made hire blyþe,
or wel wes hyre olyue.

nu," quap heo, "sone,	
send him after none	376
me þe kyng arise,	
a squieres wise.	
vude for to pleie.	
non þat him biwreie;	380
schal wiþ me bileue	
hit beo nir eue,	
laen of him mi wille.	
or ne reccheche what me telle."	384
Go," hye seyde, "sone,	
and bring him after none,	376
a squieres wise,	
þan þe king aryse.	
e wende forþ to horne;	
e wolde sche him werne.	380
He schal mid me bi leue	
il hyt be ner heue.	
ad ich of hym my wille,	
e reche y wat men telle."	384
go þon," quop heo, "sone,	
it send him after none,	376
skuyeres wyse,	
hen þe king aryse.	
No gap in MS. . . .	
.]	
e shal myd me bileue	
it hit be ner eue.	
ue ich of him mi wille,	
e recchi whet men telle."	384

elbrus invites Horn to Rymenhild.

s finds Horn in hall, serving the king.

lbrus wende hire fro;
n in halle fond he þo,
re þe kyng on benche,
i for to schenche. 388

gap in MS.
]

ylbrous fram boure wende,
orn in halle he fonde,
i forn þe king abenche,
ed win to schenche, 388
nd after mete stale,
oþe win and ale.

Athelbrus goþ wiþ alle;
orn he fond in halle,
fore þe kyng o benche,
yn forte shenche. 388

No gap in MS. . . .
]

him go to Rymenhild's bower, at the same time urging him to be discreet.

rn,” quap he, “so hende,
ure nu þu wende, 392
r mete stille,

Rymenhild to duelle.
des suþe bolde
erte þu hem holde. 396

Horn,” he seyde, “so hende,
o boure þo most wende, 392
fter mete stille, wit
/ith reymild to dwelle.

ordes swiþe bolde
i herte gon þu holde. 396

Horn,” quop he, “þou hende,
 þou boure gyn þou wende, 392
 þou speke wiþ rymenild þe 3ynge,
 þouhter oure kynges,
 ordes suyþe bolde;
 in horte gyn þou holde. 396

in, beo me wel trewe;
 ischal hit þe neure rewe.”
 in in herte leide
 at he him seide. 400

for, be me wel trewe;
 he schal it þe nouth rewe.”
No gap in MS.
]

orn, be þou me trewe,
 ischal þe nout arewe.”
No gap in MS. . . .
]

rymenhild's reception of Horn.

geode in wel rihte
 rymenhild þe brihte.

Horn him wende forþricte
 To reymyld þe bryhte.

he eode forþ to ryhte
 rymenild þe bryhte.

ƿnes he him sette,
. sweteliche hure grette. 404

is feire siȝte
e bur gan liȝte.
ƿpac faire speche;
lorte him noman teche. 408

on kneus he him sette
nd rimyld fayre grette. 404

f þat fayre wihcte
l þe halle gan licte.
e spak fayre speche;
e þar him no ma teche. 408

knewes he him sette
nt suetliche hire grette. 404

f is fayre syhte
þat bour gan lyhte.
e spac faire is speche;
e durþ non him teche. 408

ets Rymenhild with fair words.

I þu sitte *and* softe,
 Rymenhild þe brizte,
 þine Maiden es sixe
 þe sitteþ nixte. 412

þes stuard vre
 le me in to bure.
 þe speke ihc scholde;
 me what þu woldest. 416
 , *and* ich schal here,
 at þi wille were.”

Wel þou sitte and softe,
 eymyld, kinges douter,
 /ith þine maydnes syxe
 at sittet þe nexte. 412

e kinges stiward and houre
 ente me to boure.
 /ith þe hy speke schulde;
 ey me wat þou wolde. 416
 ey, and ich schal here,
 /at þi wille were.”

wel þou sitte *ant* softe,
 Rymenild, kinges dohter,
 at þy maydnes here
 at sitteþ þyne yfere. 412

ynges styward oure
 nde me to boure,
No gap in MS. . . .
]
 rte y here, leuedy myn,
 het be wille þyn.”

Conversation between Horn and Rymenhild.

; Horn by the hand and embraces him.

ʀmenhild vp gan stonde
 tok him bi þe honde. 420
 sette him on pelle,
 vʀn to drinke his fulle.
 makede him faire chere
 tok him abute þe swere. 424
 heo him custe,
 wel so hire luste.

eymild up gan stonde
 nd tok him bi þe honde. 420
 ette he him on palle;
 ʀyn hye dide fulle,
 lakede fayre chere,
 nd tok him bi þe swere. 424
 ften hye him kiste,
 o wel hire luste.

ʀmenild vp gon stonde
 ʀt tok him by þe honde.
No gap in MS. . . .
]
 eo made feyre chere
 ʀt tok him bi þe suere. 424
 fte heo him custe,
 o wel hyre luste.

ld tells Horn of her love for him, and bids him plight her his troth.

gap in MS.]

Wel come, horn," hye seyde,
So fayr so god þe made. 428

n heue and amorwe
or þe ich habbe sorwe.
aue ich none reste;
lepe me ne liste. 432

este me þis sorwe,
yue hy nawt to morwe.
orn, þou schalt wel swiþe
ly longe sorwe liþe; 436

Wel come, horn," þus sayde
menild, þat mayde, 428
in euen *ant* a morewe
or þe ich habbe sorewe,
at y haue no reste,
e slepe me ne lyste. 432

No gap in MS. . . .

.]
orn, þou shalt wel swyþe
li longe serewe lyþe; 436

rn," heo sede, "wiþute strif
chalt haue me to þi wif.
n, haue of me rewþe,
plis me þi trewþe." 440
orn þo him biþohte
at he speke mihte.

ou schalt, wit uten striue,
abben me to wiue.
orn, haue on me rewþe,
nd plyct þou me þi trewþe." 440
orn child him bi þoute
at he speke myhte.

þu shalt wyþ-oute striue
 abbe me to wyue.
 ʒorn, haue of me reuþe,
 ʒt plyht me þi treuþe.” 440
 horn þo him byþohte
 het he speken ohte.

es his low birth and foundling state in objection.

st,” quað he, “þe wisse,
 ʒiue þe heuene blisse 444
 þine husebonde,
 ʒr he beo in londe;
 ʒam ibore to lowe
 ʒa wimman to knowe. 448

God,” qwad horn, “þe wisse,
 ʒnd ʒyue þe ioƿe and blisse 444
 f þine hosebonde,
 ʒhare he be in londe.
 ʒh am hy born to lowe
 ʒuch a wyf to owe. 448

ʒrist,” quop horn, “þe wisse,
 ʒt ʒeue þe heuene blisse 444
 f þine hosebonde,
 ʒho he be a londe.
 ʒo gap in MS. . . .
]

am icome of þralle,
 fundling bifalle.
 heolde hit þe of cunde
 puse beo me bunde. 452
 nere no fair wedding
 weaxe a þral *and* a king.”
 þo gan Rymenhild mis lyke,
 sore gan to sike. 456

þu am born þralle,
 and fundlynge am bi falle.
 þu am nawt of kende
 e to spouse welde. 452
 it were no fayr wedding
 ittuene a þral and þe king.”
 eymyld gan to mys lyke,
 and sore forto syke. 456

þu am ybore þral,
 þu fader fundlyng wiþ-al.
 þu kunde me ne felde
 e to spouse welde. 452
 it nere no fair weddyng
 ittuene a þral *ant* þe kyng.”
 þo gon rymenild mis lyken,
 and sore [KH2](#) bigon to syken. 456

[KH.2](#) *to syken* crossed out after *sore*.

she asks Rymenhild's assistance.

she swoons when she hears Horn's reply.

ies heo gan buȝe;
n he feol iswoȝe.
orn in herte was ful wo,
tok hire on his armes two. 460
ȝan hire for to kesse,
ofte mid ywisse.

rmes hye nam boȝe,
nd doune he fel yswowe.
or hire ofte wende,
nd in hys armes trende. 460
No gap in MS.
.]

mes bigon vnbowe,
it down heo fel y swowe.
orn hire vp hente
it in is armes trente. 460
e gon hire to cusse,
it feyre forte wisse.

esses her, and promises that if she will help him to become dubbed knight, he will do her will.

nman,” he sede, “dere,
herte nu þu stere. 464
o me to kniȝte,
l þine miȝte
ny lord þe king,
he me ȝiue dubbing. 468

emman,” qwat he, “dere,
in herte gyn þou to stere, 464
nd hep þou me to knicte,
ppe þine myȝte
o my louerd þe kinge,
at he me ȝyue dobbinge. 468

rymenild,” quoth he, “duere,
elp me þat ych were 464
dobbed to be knyhte, [leaf 86]
ete, bi al þi myhte
mi louerd þe kyng,
æt he me ȝeue doobbyng. 468

ne is mi þralhod
æt in to kniȝthod,
i schal wexe more,
do, lemman, þi lore.” 472
rymenhild, þat swete þing,
æde of hire swoȝning.

nd þanne hys my þralhede
erned in knyht hede,
nd þenne hy schal wite more,
nd don after þi lore.” 472
o reymyl þe ȝenge
om of hire swohinge,

enne is my þralhede
wend in to knyht hede.
shal waxe more
æt do, rymenild, þi lore.” 472
o rymenild þe ȝynge
ros of hire swowenyng.

rymenhild instructs Horn what to do.

ld promises Horn that he shall be made knight within a fortnight,

rn,” *quaþ* heo, “vel sone
schal beon idone. 476

chalt beo dubbed kniȝt
come seue niȝt.
e her þis cuppe,
þis Ring þer vppe, 480
ylbrus *and* stuard,
se he holde foreward.

nd seyde, “horn, wel ricte,
ou art so fayr and briycte, 476
ou schalt worþe to knyte,
yt comeȝ sone nyȝte.
ym þou here þis coppe,
nd þis ryng þer oppe, 480
nd beryt houre styward,
nd bid helde foreward.

Nou, horn, to soþe,
leue þe by þyn oþe, 476
ou shalt be maked knyht
þen þis fourteniht.
er þou her þes coppe,
it þes ringes þer vppe, 480
Athelbrus þe styward,
it say him he holde foreward.

him to bid Athelbrus fall on his knees before the king, in his behalf.

ich him biseche,
 loueliche speche, 484
 he adun falle
 re þe king in halle,
 bidde þe king ariȝte
 be þe to kniȝte. 488
 seluer *and* wiþ golde
 wurþ him wel iȝolde.

No gap in MS.
]

id hym for þe falle
 o kinges fot in halle,
 at he dubbe þe to knicte
 /yt hys swerde so bricte. 488
 /yt siluer and wit golde
 yt worþ him wel hyȝolde.

ey ich him biseche,
 iþ loueliche speche, 484
 at he for þe falle
 o þe kynges fet in halle,
 at he wiþ is worde
 e knyhty wiþ sworde. 488
 iþ seluer *ant* wiþ golde
 it worþ him wel yȝolde.

ks out Athelbrus and tells his errand.

t him lene spede
 erende to bede.” 492

Iorn, god lene þe wel spede
 Þi herdne forto bede.” 492

ou crist him lene spede
 in erndyng do bede.” 492

ȝorn tok his leue,
 hit was neȝ eue.
 lbrus he soȝte
 ȝaf him þat he broȝte, 496
 tolde him ful ȝare
 he hadde ifare,
 seide him his nede,
 bihet him his mede. 500

ȝorn tok hys leue,
 or it was ney eue.
 ylbrus he sowte
 and tok him þat he browte. 496
 he taledde to him þere
 þu he hauede hy fare.
 he telde him of his nede,
 and bi het him his mede. 500

Horn tok is leue,
 or hit wes neh eue.
 thelbrus he sohte
 ȝat tok him þat he brohte, 496
 ȝat tolde him þare
 þu he hede yfare.
 he seide him is nede,
 ȝat him bihet is mede. 500

· *King promises to knight Horn.*

s goes before the king in hall,

welbrus also swiþe
 ȝete to halle bliue.
gap in MS.
]
 ng,” he seide, “þu leste
 le mid þe beste.
 chalt bere crune
 ioreȝe in þis tune. 508

ylþrouȝ wel bliþe
 o halle he ȝede wel swiþe,
 nd sette him on kneuling,
 nd grette wel þe king. 504
 ȝyre,” he seyde, “wiltu luste
 ne tale wit þe beste?
 ou schalt bere corune
 i þis hulke toune. 508

thelbrus so blyþe
 ȝede in to halle swyþe,
No gap in MS. . . .
]
 it seide, “kyng, nou leste
 tale mid þe beste.
 ou shalt bere coroune
 i marewe in þis toune. 508

ȝe him to knight Horn at the feast the following day.

foreȝe is þi feste;
bihoueþ geste.
nere noȝt for loren
to kniȝti child horn 512
in armes for to welde;
þi kniȝt he schal ȝelde.”

ȝo morwe worþe þi festes;
le by houed gestes.
th þe wolde rede ate lest
at þou horn knict makedest. 512
in armes to him welde;
ȝod knict he schal ben helde.”

ȝo marewe is þi feste;
e bihoueþ geste.
th þe rede mid al my myht
at þou make horn knyht. 512
in armes do him welde;
ȝod knyht he schal þe ȝelde.”

accedes to the request, and promises that Horn and his twelve companions shall be knighted.

king sede sone,
is wel idone. 516
n me wel iquemeþ;
þi kniȝt him bisemeþ.
schal haue mi dubbing
afterward mi derling. 520

e king seyde sone,
þat hys wel to done. 516
orn me wole ben queme,
ȝo be knict him by seme.
e schal habbe my dubbing
nd be my nowne derling. 520

e kyng seide wel sone,
it is wel to done. 516
orn me wel quemep;
yht him wel bysemep.
e shal haue mi doobbyng
it be myn oper derlyng. 520

alle his feren twelf
shal knizten him self.
he schal hem knizte
re me þis nizte.” 524

nd his feren xij
h schal dobbe My selue.
lle ich hem schal knicte
i for me to fyte.” 524

it hise feren tuelue
e shal dobbe him selue.
le y shal hem knyhte
yfore me to fyhte.” 524

orrow, Horn with his twelve companions presents himself before king Aylmer,

þe lizt of day sprang
nar him þuzte lang.
ay bigan to springe,
n com biuore þe kinge, 528
his twelf yfere;
ie hi were lufere.

morwe her þe dey spronge
Aylmer king þoute wel longe.
þe day by gan to springe,
Horn cam bi forn þe kinge. 528
it swerde horn he girde
it honder hys herte.

þat þe lyhte day sprong
wlmere þohte long.
e day bigon to springe;
orn com byfore þe kynge, 528
iþ his tuelf fere;
le þer ywere.

He is dubbed Knight.

King sets him on a red steed and dubs him knight.

He he dubbede to kniȝte
swerd *and* spures briȝte. 532
sette him on a stede whit;
was no kniȝt hym ilik.
smot him alitel wiȝt
bed him beon a god kniȝt. 536

He sette him on stede
ed so any glede, 532
nd sette on his fotes
oþe spores and botes,
nd smot alitel with,
nd bed him ben god knicht. 536

orn knyht made he
iþ ful gret solempnite, 532
ette him on a stede
d so eny glede,
mot him a lute wiht,
t bed him buen a god knyht. 536

He falls on his knees, and asks that Horn may dub him and the other companions.

Wulf fel a kneȝ þar
þe þe king Aylmar.
ȝig,” he sede, “so kene,
wente me a bene. 540
ȝis kniȝ[t] sire horn
in suddenne was iboren.

Wol fel on kneȝ þere
ȝe forþ þe king aylmere,
and seyde, “king so kene,
wraunte me my bene. 540
ȝou hast kniȝted sire horn
at in sodenne was hy born.

Wulfevel a kneȝ þer
ȝat þonkede kyng Aylmer.
No gap in MS.
.]
“Nou is knyht sire horn
ȝat in Sudenne wes yborn.

ȝe he is of londe,
ȝe us þat bi him stonde. 544
ȝe armes he haȝ *and* scheld,
ȝe ȝite wiȝ vpon þe feld.
ȝe him vs alle kniȝte,
ȝe þat is vre riȝte.” 548

ȝe ouerd he hys in londe,
ȝe vs þat bi him stonde, 544
ȝe lid spere and wit scelde
ȝe fyten in þe felde.
ȝe et him os alle kniȝte,
ȝe o hyt hys hise ricte.” 548

ord he is of londe
æt of vs þat by him stonde. 544
in armes he haueþ *ant* þy sheld,
orte fyhte in þe feld.
et him vs alle knyhte,
o hit is his ryhte.” 548
ylmer seide ful ywis,
iou do þat þi wille ys.”

ghts his twelve companions.

lmar sede sone ywis,
nu þat þi wille is.”
n adun lihte
makede hem alle knihte. 552
ie was þe feste,
f faire gestes.

o seyde þe king wel sone wis,
Do horn as hys wil hys.”
orn adown gan lycte
nd makede hem to knicte. 552
omen were þe gestes,
morwe was þe feste.

orn adoun con lyhte
æt made hem alle to knyhte, 552
r muchel wes þe geste [leaf 86, back]
æt more wes þe feste.

ienhild reminds Horn of his promise.

ld becomes impatient and sends for Horn.

Rymenhild nas noȝt þer,
þat hire þuȝte seue ȝer. 556
ʔr horn heo sente,
he to bure wente.

eymyld was nowt þere,
ire þoute seue yere. 556
fter horn hƿe sende;
or to boure wende.

æt rymenild nes nout þere
re þohte seue ȝere. 556
ter horn hƿe sende;
orn in to boure wende.

Athulf as companion.

de he noȝt go one;
If was his mone. 560
menhild on flore stod,
nes come hire þuȝte god,

No gap in MS.
.]
e nam his felawe in hys honde,
nd fonde Reymyld in boure stonde.

e nolde gon is one;
thulf wes hys ymone. 560
No gap in MS. . . .
.]

ld bids Horn fulfil his share of the compact by marrying her.

. sede, "Welcome, sire horn,
 . Apulf, kniȝt þe biforn. 564
 ȝt, nu is þi time
 to sitte bi me.
 nu þat þu er of spake,
 i wif þume take. 568
 u art trewe of dedes,
 nu ase þu sedes.
 ȝu hast wille þine,
 ind me of my pine." 572

Welcome art þou, sire horn,
 nd ayol chil þe bi forn. 564
 nict, nou it his tyme
 at þo sitte by me.
 f þou be trewe of dedes,
 o þat þou arre seydes. 568
 o nou þat we speke,
 ȝ wif þou schalt me take."
No gap in MS.
]

rymenild welcomeþ sire horn,
 it apulf knyht him biforn. 564
 knyht, nou is tyme
 rto sitte byme.
 ȝ nou þat we spake;
 ȝ þi wyf þou me take. 568
No gap in MS. . . .
]

ou þou hast wille þyne,
 ȝbynd me of þis pyne." 572

n proposes first to prove his Knighthood.

lies that it is the custom for a knight to fight for his leman with some other knight,

ymenhild,” quap he, “beo stille;
wulle don al þi wille.

Þ hit mot bitide,
spere ischal furst ride, 576
mi kniȝthod proue,
hc þe ginne to woȝe.

Reymyld,” qwat horn, “be stille;
y schal don al þi wille.
at first hyt mote by tyde
lid spere þat ich ride, 576
li knicthede for to proue,
erst, here ich þe wowe.

ymenild, nou be stille,
hulle don al þy wille.
i her hit so bitide,
id spere ichulle ryde 576
it my knyhtod proue,
i þen ich þe wowe.

beþ kniȝtes ȝonge,
i dai al isprunge, 580
of vre mestere
s þe manere,
sume oþere kniȝte
for his lemman fiȝte, 584
ie eni wif take;
þi me stondeþ þe more rape.

7e beþ kinctes yonge,
lto day hy spronge; 580
f þe mestere
yt hys þe manere,
7yt som oþer knicte
or hys leman to fycte, 584
er ich eny wif take.
er fore ne haue ich þe forsake.

e bueþ nou knyhtes 3onge,
 le to day yspronge, 580
 it of þe mestere
 it is þe manere,
 iþ sum oþer knyhte
 or his lemmon to fyþte, 584
 ne he eny wyf take
 oþer wyþ wymmon forewart make.

ises that after he has accomplished an act of prowess, he will make her his wife.

ay, so crist me blesse,
 wulle do pruesse 588
 þi luue in þe felde,
 spere *and* mid schelde.
 c come te lyue,
 schal þe take to wyue.” 592
 ðniȝt,” quap heo, “trewe,
 wene ihc mai þe leue.

o day, so god me blisse,
 h sal do pruesce, 588
 or þe lef wyt schelde,
 i mideward þe felde.
 nd hy come to liue
 h take þe wiue.” 592
 Knict,” qwat reymyl, þe trewe,
 Yich wene ich may þe leue.

o day, so crist me blesse,
 shal do pruesse, 588
 or þi loue mid shelde
 niddewart þe felde.
 f ich come to lyue
 chul þe take to wyue.” 592
 knyht, y may yleue þe,
 hy aut þou trewe be.

ænehild gives Horn a Ring.

ld gives Horn a ring, which she bids him wear for her love,

nu her þis gold ring,
him is þe dubbing. 596

gap in MS.
[.]

is vpon þe ringe
ue, ‘Rymenhild þe 3onge.’ 600

nis non betere anonder sunne,
eni man of telle cunne.
my luue þu hit were,
on þi finger þu him bere. 604

aue nou here þis gold ring,
e his god to þi dobbing. 596

e hys none swilk vnder sonne,
at man may offe konne.

y graue hys on þe Ringe,
ÿmyld þi lef þe yenge’; 600

No gap in MS.
[.]

Haue her þis goldring;
it is ful god to þi dobbyng. 596

No gap in MS. . . .
[.]

graued is on þe rynge,
ymenild þy luef þe 3ynge.’ 600

is non betere vnder sonne
æt enymon of conne.

or mi loue þou hit were,
æt on þy fynger þou hit bere. 604

h will protect him if he will look on it and think of her.

tones beoþ of suche *grace*,
 þu ne schalt in none place
 none duntles beon ofdrad,
 on bataille beon amad, 608
 u loke þeran
 þenke vpon þi lemman.
 And sire Apulf, þi broþer,
 schal haue anoþer. 612

And ston him hys of swiche *grace*,
 at þou ne schal in none place
 of none donte fayle,
 er þou biginnes batayle. 608
No gap in MS.
.]
 And sire ayol, þi broþer,
 he sal haue anoþer. 612

And ston haueþ suche *grace*,
 he shalt þou in none place
 neþ vnderfonge,
 he buen yslaye wiþ wronge, 608
 if þou lokest þeran
 neþ þenchest o þi lemman.
 And sire apulf, þi broþer,
 he shal han en oþer. 612

mournfully prays for Christ's blessing on Horn's undertaking.

n, ihc þe biseche
loueliche speche,
t 3eue god erndinge,
3en to bringe.” 616
kniȝt hire gan kesse,
heo him to blesse.

orn, god hy þe bi teche,
/it morninde speche.
od þe 3yeue god endyng,
n hol þe aȝen bringe.” 616
e kniȝt hyre gan to kusse,
nd reymyld him blisse.

orn, crist y þe byteche,
id mourninde speche.
rist þe 3eue god endyng,
it sound aȝeyn þe bryng.” 616
e knyht hire gan to cusse,
it rymenild him to blesse.

as leave, arms himself, mounts his black steed, and sets out in search of adventure.

e at hire he nam
 in to halle cam. 620
 niztes 3eden to table,
 horne 3ede to stable.
 he tok his gode fole,
 o blak so eny cole. 624
gap in MS.
]

eue at hire he nom,
 nd in to halle com. 620
 e knictes 3yede to table,
 nd horn in to stable.
 e tok forþ his gode fole,
 o blac so eny cole. 624
 i armes he him schredde,
 nd hys fole he fedde.

ue at hyre he nom,
 it in to halle he com. 620
 ryhtes eode to table,
 it horn eode to stable,
 er he toc his gode fole,
 lac so euer eny cole. 624
 ip armes he him sredde,
 it is fole he fedde.

ole schok þe brunie,
al þe curt gan denie. 628
ole bigan to springe,
horn murie to singe.
n rod in a while
e þan a myle. 632

ys fole schok hys brenye,
at al þe court gan denye. 628
ys fole gan forþ springe,
nd horn merie to synge.
e rod one wile
el more þan a mile. 632

No gap in MS. . . .
.]

e fole bigon to springe
it horn murie to synge.
orn rod one whyle
el more þen a myle. 632

n meets some Saracen invaders.

at the seashore a ship filled with Saracens, and asks their purpose.

lond o schup stonde
heþene honde.
gap in MS.
[.]

ixede what hi soʒte,
r to londe broʒte.
i hund him gan bihelde
spac wordes belde, 640
lond we wulleʒ wynne,
sle þat þer is inne.”

e sey a schip rowe,
lid wat alby flowe,
f out londisse manne,
f sarazine kenne. 636

em askede qwat he hadde,
þer to londe ladde.
geant him gan by holde,
nd spek wordes bolde. 640

þis lond we wile winne,
nd slen al þat þer ben hinne.”

e seh a shyp at grounde,
iþ heþene hounde.
Vo gap in MS.
[.]

e askede wet hue hadden, 636
þer to londe ladden.

i hound him gan biholde,
it spek wordes bolde. 640
þis land we wollep wynne,
it sle þat þer bueþ inne.”

/s the Saracen leader, and then, after

n gan his swerd gripe
on his arme wype. 644

arazins he smatte,
his blod hatte.
ureche dunte
eued of wente. 648
unne þe hundes gone,
te horn al one.

orn gan hys swerd gripe,
nd on his arm hyt wipe. 644
e sarazin so he smot,
at al hys blod was hot.

t þe furste dunte
ys heued of gan wente. 648
o gonnen þo hundes gon
genes horn alon.

orn gan is swerd gripe,
it on is arm hit wype. 644
e sarazyn he hitte so,
it is hed fel to ys to.
No gap in MS. . . .

.]
o gonne þe houndes gone
eynes horn ys one.

rn bears the leader's head before the king.

n his ring, slays a hundred more.

okede on þe ringe,
þoʒte on rimenilde. 652

iloz þer on haste
undred bi þe laste.
niʒte noman telle
folc þat he gan quelle. 656
lle þat were aliue
niʒte þer non þriue.

e lokede on his gode ringe,
nd þoute on reymild þe yenge. 652

e slow þer on haste
n hundred at þe leste.
No gap in MS.
.]

f þat þe were aryue,
ewe he leued on liue.

e Lokede on is rynge, [leaf 87]
it þohte o rymenyld þe ʒynge. 652

e sloh þer of þe beste
n hundred at þe leste.
e mihte no mon telle
le þat he gon quelle. 656
f þat þer were o ryue
e lafte lut o lyue.

as the leader's head on the point of his sword, and bears it before the king.

n tok þe maisteres heued,
he hadde him bireued, 660
sette hit on his swerde,
uen at þan orde.

erde hom in to halle,
ong þe kniztes alle. 664

e meyster kinges heued
e haddit him by reued. 660
e settit on hys swerde,
noven on þe horde,
il he com to halle,
mong þe knictes alle. 664

Horn tok þe maister heued,
at he him hade byreued, 660
it sette on is suerde,
ouen o þen orde.
e ferde hom to halle,
nong þe knyhtes alle, 664

n relates his adventure.

ites his adventure.

ng,” he sede, “wel þu sitte,
alle þine kniȝtes mitte.
lay, after mi dubbing,
rod on mi pleing, 668
nd o schup Rowe,
it gan to flowe,
viþ sarazines kyn,
none londisse Men. 672
lai, for to pine
nd alle þine.

e seyde, “king, wel mote þou sitte,
n þine knictes mitte.
er y rod on my pleying,
one hafter my dobbing, 668
say a schip rowe
lid watere al by flowe,
f none londische menne,
ote sarazines kenne, 672
o deye, for to pyne
e and alle þine.

Kyng,” quop he, “wel þou sitte,
it þine knyhtes mitte.
o day ich rod o my pleyyng,
ter my doobbyng, 668
fond a ship rowen,
i þe sound byflowen,
lid vnlondisse menne,
f sarazynes kenne, 672
o deþe forte pyne
e ant alle þyne.

676
 680

e gonne me asaylen.
 Iy swerd me ne wolde fayle; 676
 Ich broute hem alto grunde
 In one lite stounde.
 Ich heued ich þe bringe
 Of þe meyster kinge. 680
 Thou ich haue þe yolde,
 That þu me knichten wolde.”

y gonne me asayly.
 verd me nolde fayly; 676
 smot hem alle to grounde
 i a lutel stounde.
 e heued ich þe bringe
 f þe maister kyng. 680
 ou haue ich þe zolde
 at þou me knyhten woldest.”

mar goes hunting.

Moreȝe þo þe day gan springe,
 Þe king him rod an huntinge. 684
 [No gap in MS.
]

5 e day bi gan to springe,
 6 be king rod on huntingge. 684
 7 To wode he gan wende,
 8 or to lacchen be heynde.

e day bigon to springe,
e kyng rod on hontynge 684
þe wode wyde,
at Fykenyld bi is syde,

om lefte ffikenhild,
was þe wurste moder child. 688
ferde in to bure,
en auenture.

/yt hym rod fokenild,
at alþe werste moder child. 688
nd horn wente in to boure,
o sen auenture.

at fals wes ant vntrewe,
hose him wel yknewe. 688
Horn ne þohte nout him on,
it to boure wes ygon.

ceeds to Rymenhild's bower, and finds her weeping.

saȝ Rymenild sitte
þe were of witte. 692
sat on þe sunne,
tieres al birunne.

n sede, "lef þinore,
wepestu so sore?" 696

e fond Reymild sittende,
ore wepende, 692
/hit so eny sonne,
/it teres albi ronne.

e seyde, "lemman, þin ore,
/y wepes þou so sore?" 696

e fond rymenild sittynde	
at wel sore wepynde,	692
o whyt so þe sonne,	
id terres al byronne.	
orn seide, “luef, þyn ore,	
hy wepest þou so sore?”	696

rienhild tells Horn her Dream.

him her dream, how a great fish broke her net.

seide, “noȝt ine wepe;
 e ase ilay aslepe,
gap in MS.
]
 e se my net icaste,
 hit nolde noȝt ilaste.

ye seyde, “ich nawt ne wepe,	
ote ich schal her ich slepe.	
le þoute in my metyng,	
at ich rod on fischinge.	700
o se my net ich keste;	
e Mict ich nowt lache.	

ue seide, “ich nout ne wepe,	
1 y shal er y slepe.	
le þohte o my metyng,	
at ich rod ofysshying.	700
o see my net ycaste,	
at wel fer hit laste.	

et fiss at þe furste,
et he gan to berste. 704

gap in MS.
.]

wene þat iħc schal leose
iss þat iħc wolde cheose.” 708

gret fys ate furste
li net he madeke berste. 704

e fys me so by laucte,
at ich nawt ne kauhte.
h wene ich schal forlese
e fys þat ich wolde chese.” 708

gret fyssh at þe ferste
y net made berste. 704

æt fyssh me so bycahte,
æt y nout ne lahte.
wene y shal forleose
e fyssh þat y wolde cheose.” 708

nforts her.

rist,” quap horn, “and seint steuene,
ie þine sweuene.
ichal iþe biswike,
lo þat þe mislike. 712

God and seynte steuene,”
wad horn, “terne þi sweuene.
e shal ich neuere swike,
e do þat þe mis like. 712

“Crist ant seinte steuene,”
ioþ horn, “areche þy sweuene.
o shal y þe byswyke,
e do þat þe mis lyke. 712

ghits his troth to Rymenhild, but both weep and forebode evil from the dream.

ial me make þinowe,
olden *and* to knowe,
eurech oþere wiȝte;
þarto mi treuþe iþe plizte.” 716

þhel was þe ruþe
was at þare truþe,
Rymenhild weop ille,
horn let þe tires stille. 720

þh nime þe to my nowe,
o habben and to howe,
or euerich wyȝte;
arto my treuwþe ich plicte.” 716

liche was þat rewþe
at was at here trewþe.
eymyld wel stille,
nd horn let teres spille. 720

h take þe myn owe,
o holde *ant* eke to knowe,
or eueruch oþer wyhte;
arto my trouþe y plyhte.” 716

el muche was þe reuþe
at wes at þilke treuþe.
rmenild wep wel ylle,
at horn let terres stille. 720

nman,” quap he, “dere, chalt more ihere. weuen schal wende, r sum Man schal vs schende.	724
iss þat brak þe lyne, s he doþ us pine. schal don vs tene wurþ wel sone isene.”	728
e seyde, “lemman dere, ou schalt more here. y sweuene ich schal schende.	724
<i>No gap in MS.]</i>	
e fis þat brac þi seyne, y wis hyt was som ble[y]ne at schal us do som tene; y wis hyt worþ hy sene.”	728
Lemmon,” quop he, “dere, ou shalt more yhere. y sweuen shal wende; immon vs wole shende.	724
at fyssh þat brac þy net, wis it is sumwet it wol vs do sum teone; wys hit worþ ysene.”	728

enhild calumniates Horn.

d tells the king that Horn is plotting to kill him and to marry Rymenhild.

lmar rod bi sture,
horn lai in bure.
enhild hadde enuye
sede þes folye:— 732

lmar, ihc þe warne,
n þe wule berne.
herde whar he sede,
his swerd forþ leide, 736
ringe þe of lyue,
take Rymenhild to wyue.

e king rod bi his toure,
nd horn was in þe boure.
ykenyld hadde envie,
n seyde hise folye:— 732

Aylmere, king, ich wole warne,
orn chil þe wile berne.
h herde qware he seyde,
nd his swerd leyde, 736
o bringe þe of liue,
nd take rimenyld to wiue.

Aylmer rod by stoure,
t horn wes yne boure.
ykenild hade enuye
t seyde þeose folye:— 732

Aylmer, ich þe werne,
orn þe wole forberne.
h herde wher he seyde,
t his suerd he leyde, 736
o brynge þe of lyue
t take rymenyld to wyue.

iþ in bure,
er couerture, 740

Rymenhild, þi doȝter;
so he doþ wel ofte.
þider þu go al riȝt;
þu him finde miȝt. 744

ou he hys in boure,
l honder couerture, 740
y reymyld, þi douter;
nd so he hys wel ofter.
h rede þat þu wende;
er þu myct him schende. 744

e Lyht nou in Boure, [leaf 87, back]
nder couertoure, 740
y rymenyld, þy dohter;
t so he doþ wel ofte.
No gap in MS. . . .
.]

lo him vt of londe,
r he doþ þe schonde.”
lmar aȝen gan turne,
Modi *and* wel Murne. 748
gap in MS.
.]

o him out of þi londe,
er do more schonde.”
ylmer king him gan torne,
el mody and wel Mourn. 748
o boure he gan ȝerne,
urst hym noman werne.

3 him out of londe,
 4 he do more shonde.”
 Aylmer gan hom turne,
 el mody *ant* wel sturne. 748
No gap in MS. . . .
]

g Aylmar banishes Horn.

inds Horn in Rymenhild’s embrace, and bids him leave the land at once.

1 ond horn in arme,
 Rymenhilde barme. 752
 2 ei vt,” he sede, “fule þeof,
 3 wurstu me neuremore leof.
 4 id vt of my bure,
 5 muchel messaventure. 756

6 e fond horn wit arme,
 7 rimenyldes barme. 752
 8 Henne out,” qwad aylmer king,
 9 Henne, þou foule wending,
 10 ut of boure flore,
 11 ram Reymyld, þi hore. 756

12 e fond horn vnder arme,
 13 rymenyldes barme. 752
 14 go out,” quoþ aylmer, þe kyng,
 15 Horn, þou foule fundlyng.
 16 orþ out of boures flore,
 17 or rymenild, þin hore. 756

sone bute þu flitte,
 swerde ihc þe anhitte.
 id ut of my londe,
 r þu schalt haue schonde.” 760
gap in MS.
]

one bote þe flecte,
 /it swerd hy wole þe hette.
 out of londe sone,
 ere hauest þou nowt to done.” 760
 orn cam in to stable,
 /el modi for þe fable.

end out of londe sone; 759
 er nast þou nout to done. 760
 el sone bote þou flette, 757
 yd suert y shal þe sette.” 758
 orn eode to stable,
 el modi for þat fable.

Here and in next section, lines rearranged by editor.

dles his horse, arms himself, and then visits Rymenhild.

orn sadelede his stede,	
his armes he gan sprede.	764
brunie he gan lace,	
ie scholde, in to place.	
<i>gap in MS.</i>	
.]	
swerd he gan fonge;	
od he noȝt to longe.	
e sette sadel on stede,	
with armes he hym gan schrede.	764
ys brenye he gan lace,	
o he scholde, in to place.	
o hyt þer to gan ten,	
e durst him noman sen.	768
werd he gan fonge;	
e stod he nowt to longe,	
e sette sadel on stede,	
ip armes he gon him shrede.	
is brunie he con lace,	
o he schulde, in to place.	766
is suerd he gon fonge;	769
e stod he nout to longe.	770
is suerd he gon teon;	767
e durste non wel him seon.	768

en takes leave of Rymenhild.

er that her dream has come true,

ȝede forþ bliue
 ȝymenhild his wyue. 772
 ȝede, “lemman, derling,
 hauestu þi sweuening.
 ȝiss þat þi net rente,
 n þe he me sente. 776
gap in MS.
]

and ȝyede forþ ricte
 o reymyld þe bricte. 772
 e seyde, “leman, derling,
 ow hauestu þi meting.
 e fys þi net to rente,
 ram þe he me sente. 776
 e king gynneþ wiht me striue;
 wey he wole me driue.
No gap in MS. . . .
]

e seide, “lemmon, derlyng,
 ou þou hauest þy sweuenyng.
 e fyssh þat þyn net rende,
 om þe me he sende. 776
 e kyng wiþ me gynneþ striue;
 wey he wole me dryue.

going to an unknown country for seven years.

ienhild, haue wel godne day,
eng abiden ine may. 780

o vncuþe londe,
more for to fonde.
ial wune þere
e seue 3ere. 784

eymyld, haue god day,
or nov ich founde away, 780
i to onekup londe,
7el more forto fonde.
h schal wony þere
ulle seve 3ere. 784

are fore haue nou godneday;
ou y mot fonnde *ant* fare away 780
i to vncouþe londe,
el more forte fonde.
shal wonie þere
ille seue 3ere. 784

ier not to await him longer than seven years.

eue 3eres ende,
ine come ne sende,
þe husebonde,
me þu ne wonde. 788
rmes þu me fonge,
kes me wel longe.”

te vij 3eres hende,
ot 3yf hy come oþer sende,
ac þou hosebonde,
or me þat þou wonde. 788
armes þou me fonge,
n kusse swiþe longe.”

þe seueþeres ende,
wif y ne come ne sende,
c þou hosebonde,
or me þat þou no wonde. 788
I armes þou me fonge,
it cus me swyþe longe.”

He fainted.

Truste him wel a stunde,
Rymenhild feol to grunde. 792
He tok his leue;
nizte he no leng bileue.
ok Apulf, his fere,
bute þe swere, 796

He kusten one stunde,
and reymyld fel to grunde. 792
He tok his leue,
for hyt was ney heue.
He nam ayol, trewe fere,
I aboute þe swete, 796

He custen hem a stounde,
and rymenyld fel to grounde. 792
Horn toc his leue;
he myhte nout byleue.
He toc Apulf, is fere,
aboute þe swere, 796

He trusts his ‘new love’ to Athulf.

sede, “kniȝt so trewe,
wel mi luue newe.
leue me ne forsoke,
menhild þu kep and loke.” 800

nd seyt, “knict so trewe,
ep Mi leue wiue.
o þou me neuere forsoke,
eymyl kep and loke.” 800

it seide, “knyht so trewe,
ep wel loue newe.
ou neuer ne forsoke
menild to kepe ant loke.” 800

stede he gan bistride,
forþ he gan ride.
gap in MS.
]

Torn gan stede by stride,
And forþ he gan ride.
Ayol wep wit heye,
nd alle þat hym seye. 804

is stede he bigan stryde,
it forþ he con hym ryde.
þulf wep wiþ eyȝen,
it alle þat hit yseyȝen. 804

en sets sail from West[er]nesse.

ail.

he hauene he ferde,
a god schup he hurede,
him scholde londe
restene londe. 808

wulf weop wiþ iþe,
al þat him isiþe.

orn chil forþ hym ferde;
god schip he him herde,
at hym scholde wisse
ut of westnisse. 808

he whyȝt him gan stonde,
and drof tyl hirelonde.

orn forþ him ferde;
god ship he him herde,
at him shulde passe
ut of westnesse. 808

he wynd bigon to stonde,
it drof hem vp o londe.

ches land.

and he him sette,
fot on stirop sette. 812

o londe he gan flette,
and out of schip him sette. 812

o londe þat hy fletten;
it out of ship hy setten. 812

en is received by Harild and Berild.

two princes, Harild and Berild.

fond bi þe weie,
ges sones tweie;
on him het harild,
þat oþer berild. 816

ld gan him preie
he scholde him seie
at his name were,
what he wolde þere. 820

e mette by þe weye,
ingges sones tweye;
at on was hoten ayld,
nd þat oþer byrild. 816
yrild him gan preye
at he scholde seye
/at hys name were,
nd qwat he wolde þere. 820

e fond bi þe weye,
ynges sones tueye;
at on wes hoten Aþyld,
at þat oþer beryld. 816
eryld hym con preye
at he shulde seye
hat he wolde þere,
at what ys nome were. 820

his name as Cutberd (Godmod),

tberd," he sede, "ihc hote,
nen vt of þe bote,
feor fram biweste,
eche mine beste." 824

ld gan him nier ride,
tok him bi þe bridel.
l beo þu, kniȝt, ifounde;
me þu lef a stunde. 828

ƿuberd," he seyde, "ich hote,
omen fram þe bote,
er fram bi weste,
o chesen mine beste." 824

yryld him gan ryde,
nd tok hym by þe bridel.
Wel be þou, knict, here founde;
lhyt me bileuest a stunde. 828

"Godmod," he seid, "ich hote,
comen out of þis bote,
el fer from by weste,
o seche myne beste." 824

eryld con ner him ryde,
it toc him bi þe bridel.
wel be þou, knyht, yfounde;
ip me þou lef a stunde. 828

nducted by the princes before the king.

þu mote i sterue,
þu schalt serue.
þaz i neure my lyue
þu kni3t aryue.” 832
þerð heo ladde in to halle,
he a kne gan falle.

þu ich ne mote sterue,
þu kyng þu schal serue.
þe sey ich neuere on lyue
þu fayr knyht aryue.” 832
þubert he ledde to halle,
þu adoun gan falle.

so ich mote sterue,
þu kyng þu shalt serue.
þe seh y neuer a lyue
þu feir knyht her aryue.” 832
þuðmod he ladde to halle,
þu he adoun gan falle,

greete the king.

þe sette him a knewelyng,
þu grette wel þe gode kyng. 836

þe sette hym on knewlyng,
þu grette wel þe gode king. 836

þu sette him a knelyng, [leaf 88]
þu grette þene gode kyng. 836

þu ks that he be taken into the king’s service.

ne sede Berild sone,
e king, of him þu hast to done.
k him þi lond to werie;
schat hit noman derie,
he is þe faireste man
eure3ut on þi londe cam.”

840

o seyde byrild wel sone,
Whit hym hauen to done.
ak hym þi lond to werye;
e schal hym noman derye.
e hys þe fayreste man
at euere in þis londe cam.”

840

o saide beryld wel sone,
cyng, wiþ him þou ast done.
lond tac him to werie;
e shal þe nomon derye,
or he is þe feyreste man
at euer in þis londe cam.”

840

en enters the service of the king.

welcomes Cutberd.

ne sede þe king so dere,
lcome beo þu here. 844

u, Berild, swiþe,
make him ful bliþe.
whan þu farst to woze,
him þine gloue. 848

nt þu hauest to wyue,
i he schal þe dryue;
Cutberdes fairhede
chal þe neure wel spede.” 852

o seyde þe king so dere,
Wel come be he here. 844

o nov, byryld, swyþe,
n mak him glad and blyþe.
an þou farest awowen,
ak hym þine glouen. 848

er þou hauest Mynt to wyue,
wey he schal þe dryue.”

No gap in MS.
.]

þo seide þe kyng wel dere,
welcome þe þou here. 844

o, beryld, wel swyþe,
nt make hym wel blyþe,
it when þou farest to wowen,
c him þine glouen. 848

er þou hast munt to wyue,
wey he shal þe dryue;
r godmodes feyrhede
ialt þou no wer spede.” 852

ristmas feast a giant appears.

It was at Cristesmasse,
Neiþer more ne lasse,
[*No gap in MS.*
.]

yt was at Cristesmesse,
aþer more ne lesse.
e king hym makede a feste,
/yt hyse knyctes beste. 856

it wes at *cristesmasse*,
ouþer more ne lasse.
e kyng made feste,
f his knyhtes beste. 856

giant's challenge.

: proclaims a challenge.

cam in at none,
eaunt suþe sone,
ied fram paynyme,
seide þes ryme:— 860
e stille, sire kyng,
herkne þis tyþyng.
buþ paens ariued,
mo þane fyue. 864
beoþ on þe sonde,
g, vpon þi londe.

er com ate none,
geaunt swiþe sone,
rmed of paynime,
nd seyde in hys rime, 860
þyhte, knythes, by þe kyng,
nd lusteþ to my tydyng.
ere beþ paynynms aryued,
el mo þanne fyue. 864
y þe se stronde,
yng, on þine londe.

er com in at none,
geaunt suyþe sone,
armed of paynyme,
it seide þise ryme:— 860
þite, kyng, bi kynges,
it herkne my tidynges
er bueþ paynes aryue,
el more þen fyue. 864
er beþ vpon honde,
yng, in þine londe.

in will fight any three in the land,

of hem wile fizte
n þre kniȝtes. 868

ne þer of wille ich fyȝte
ȝen þi þre knyctes. 868

n þer of wol fyhte
ȝeynes þre knyhtes. 868

at to determine who shall possess the land.

oþer þre slen vre,
is lond beo ȝoure;
vre on ouercomeþ ȝour þreo,
is lond schal vre beo. 872
ioreȝe be þe fiztinge,
in þe liȝt of daye springe.”

yf þat houre felle þyne þre,
l þis lond schal vre be;
yf þyne þre fellen houre,
l þys lond þanne be ȝyure. 872
o morwe schal be þe fyȝtyng,
t þe sonne op rysyng.”

if oure þre sleh oure on,
e shulen of ore londe gon;
if vre on sleh oure þre,
þis lond schal vre be. 872
o morewe schal be þe fyhtyng,
þe sonne vpspringe.”

n, Berild and Alrid accept it.

irston names Cutberd (Godmod), Harild and Berild as the three defenders.

nne sede þe kyng þurston,
 tberd schal beo þat on; 876
 ld schal beo þat oþer;
 ridde, Alrid, his broþer.
 hi beoþ þe strengeste,
 of armes þe beste. 880
 e what schal vs to rede?
 wene we beþ alle dede.”

o seyde þe king þurston,
 Cubert he schal be þat on, 876
 yld chyld þat oþer,
 e þrydde, byryld, hyse broþer.
 ye þre beþ þe strengeste,
 nd in armes þe beste. 880
 t wat schal do to rede?
 h wene we ben alle dede.”

þo seyde þe kyng þurston,
 godmod shal be þat on; 876
 eryld shal be þat oþer;
 e þridde, Aþyld, is broþer.
 or hue bueþ strongeste,
 it in armes þe beste. 880
 1, wat shal vs to rede?
 wene we bueþ dede.”

itberd sat at borde,
 . sede þes wordes:— 884

ubert set on borde,
 nd seyde þis worde:— 884

odmod set at borde,
 it seide þeose wordes:— 884

says that it were shame for three Christians to fight against one pagan, and offers to fight alone.

e king, hit nis no riȝte,
wiȝ þre to fiȝte;
n one hunde,
cristen men to fonde. 888

, ischal al one,
ute more ymone,
mi swerd wel eȝe
ge hem þre to deȝe.” 892

ȝyre kyȝeking, hyt no ryȝcte,
n wiȝ þre to fyȝcte.
No gap in MS.
.]

t wille ich alone,
wiȝ outen mannes mone,
lid my swerd wel heȝe
ringen hem alle to deȝe.” 892

sire kyng, nis no ryhte,
n wiȝ þre fyhte,
ȝeynes one hounde,
re cristene to founde. 888

n kyng, y shal alone,
iȝ-oute more ymone,
ip my suerd ful eȝe
ringen hem alle to deȝe.” 892

parations for the combat.

himself,

kyng aros amoreȝe,
hadde muchel sorȝe;
Cutberd ros of bedde,
armes he him schredde. 896
n his brunie gan on caste,
lacede hit wel faste,

e kyng ros a morwe,
nd hadde meche sorwe.
ubert ros of bedde;
/yt armes he hym schredde. 896
ys brenye on he caste,
acede hyt wel faste.

e kyng aros amorewe;
e hade muche sorewe.
odmod ros of bedde;
ip armes he him shredde. 896
is brunye he on caste,
it knutte hit wel faste,

king,

cam to þe kinge,
is vp risinge. 900
ig,” he sede, “cum to fel[de],
to bihelde
we fiȝte schulle,
togare go wulle.” 904

e cam biforn þe godeking,
t hyse op rysyng. 900
e seyde, “king, com to felde,
le for to by helde,
ou we scholen fyȝte
nd to gydere hus dyȝcte.” 904

it com him to þe kynge,
his vp rysynge. 900
kyng,” quoth he, “com to felde,
le forte byhelde,
ou we shule flyten
it to gedere smiten.” 904

him rides to the combat.

at *prime* tide,
unnen ut ride,
funden on a *grene*,
aunt swyþe kene, 908
feren him biside,
e deþ to abide.

yt at *prime* tyde,
e gonne hem out ryde.
e founden in a *grene*,
geant swyþe kene, 908
rmed with swerd by side,
e day for to abyde.

riht at *prime* tide,
y gonnen out to ryde.
y fonnden in a *grene*,
geaunt swyþe kene, 908
s feren him biside,
at day forto abyde.

fight begins.

strikes so hard, that the giant asks for a breathing spell,

ilke bataille	
werd gan assaille.	912
þaf dentes inoʒe;	
niztes felle iswoʒe.	
dent he gan wiþdraʒe,	
hi were neʒ aslaʒe.	916
ubert him gan asayle;	
ʒolde he nawt fayle.	912
e keyte dundes ynowe;	
e geant fel hy swowe.	
ys feren <i>gonnen</i> hem wyt drawe,	
o here mayster wa slawe.	916
odmod hem gon asaylen;	
olde he nout faylen.	912
e ʒef dundes ynowe;	[leaf 88, back]
e payen fel y swowe.	
s feren <i>gonnen</i> hem wiþ drawe,	
or huere maister wes neh slawe.	916

he has never before experienced such blows, save at the hand of King Murry.

sede, “kniȝtes, nu ȝe reste
 while, ef ȝou leste.”
 ede, “hi neure nadde
 niȝte dentes so harde. 920
gap in MS.
]
 was of hornes kunne,
 n in suddenne.” 924

e seyden, “knyct þo reste
 wile ȝyf þe luste.
 ðe neuere ne hente
 f man [KH3](#) so harde dunte, 920
 ute of þe king Mory,
 at was so swyþe stordy.
 e was of hornes kinne;
 ðe slowe hym in sodenne.” 924

[KH.3](#) MS. adds ‘nes honde’ underdotted as a
 mistake.

ȝe seide, “knyht, þou reste
 whyle, ȝef þe leste.
 ne heuede ner of monnes hond
 ȝo harde dundes in non lond, 920
 ȝote of þe kyng Murry,
 ȝat wes swiþe sturdy.
 ȝe wes of hornes kenne;
 sloh him in sudenne.” 924

nraged,
 ȝorn him gan to agrise,
 his blod arise.
 ȝuberd gan agrise,
 nd hys blod aryse.

Godmod him gon agryse,
at his blod aryse.

vs the fight.

þ him sa3 he stonde
driuen him of londe, 928
þat his fader slo3.
him his swerd he dro3.

y for hym he sey stonde
at drof hym out of londe, 928
nd hys fader aquelde.
e smot hym honder schelde.

yforen him he seh stonde
at drof him out of londe, 928
at fader his a-quelde;
e smot him vnder shelde.

ooks on his ring, then smites the giant through the heart.

okede on his rynge,
þo3te on Rymenhilde. 932
smot him þure3 þe herte,
sore him gan to smerte.
aens þat er were so sturne,
unne awei vrne. 936

e lokede on hys gode ringe,
nd þoute on reymyld þe 3onge. 932
lyd gode dunt ate furste,
e smot hym to þe herte.
e hondes gonnen at erne
i to þe schypes sterne. 936

e lokede on is rynge,
 at þohte o rymenild þe 3ynge. 932
 id god suerd at þe furste,
 e smot him þourh þe huerte.
 e payns bigonne to fleon,
 at to huere shype teon. 936

n kills the Giant.

ns flee to their ship.

n *and* his compaynye
 ne after hem wel swiþe hi3e,
gap in MS.

.

]

o schip he wolden 3erne,
 nd cubert hem gan werne,
 nd seyde, “kyng, so þou haue reste,
 lep nou forþ ofi þi beste, 940
 nd sle we þyse hounden,
 ere we henne founden.”

o ship hue wolden erne;
 oðmod hem con werne.

No gap in MS. . . .

.

]

's sons are slain, but Cutberd annihilates the pagan host,

gap in MS.
.
.
.
.]

e houndes hye of laucte,
n strokes hye þere kaute. 944
aste aȝen hye stode,
ȝen duntēs gode.
elp nawht here wonder;
ubert hem broute al honder. 948

e kynges sones tweyne
e paiens slowe beyne. 944
o wes Godmod swyþe wo,
at þe payens he smot so,
at in a lutel stounde
e paiens hy felle to grounde. 948

sloȝen alle þe hundes,
i here schipes funde.
e schedde of here blode,
nd makede hem al wode.
odmod ant is men
owe þe payenes eueruchen.

g Thurston's two sons are slain.

iging his father's death.

leþe he hem alle broȝte;
fader deþ wel dere hi boȝte. 952

lle þe kynges kniȝtes,
scapede þer no wiȝte.
e his sones tweie
re him he saȝ deie. 956

o deþe he hem browte,
ys fader deþ he bowten. 952

f al þe kinges rowe,
er nas bute fewe slawe.
ote hys sones tweye
y fore he sey deye. 956

is fader deþ *ant* ys lond
wrek godmod wiþ his hond. 952
No gap in MS. . . .

.
.
.]

mourns.

ing bigan to grete,
teres for to lete.
leiden hem in bare,
burden hem ful ȝare. 960
gap in MS.

.]

e king bi gan to grete,
nd teres for to lete.
len leyden hem on bere,
nd ledde hem wel þere 960
to holy kyrke,
o man scholde werke.

e kyng wiþ reuþful chere
 tte leggen is sonen on bere,
 it bringen hom to halle;
 uche sorewe hue maden alle. 960
 i a chirche of lym *ant* ston
 ie buriede hem wiþ ryche won.

g Thurston offers Horn his kingdom.

The following section—through line 986—has been rearranged by the transcriber. Line numbers show the original alignment of the three texts.

king com in to halle,
 ong his kniȝtes alle. 964

e king cam hom to halle,
 Among þe kniȝtes alle. 964

Þe kyng lette forþ calle
 se knyhtes alle, 964

to make Horn (Cutberd) his heir, and to give him his daughter Reynild. Cutberd declines, but offers to continue service.

rn,” he sede, “i seie þe,
as i schal rede þe.
þen beþ mine heirs,
þu art kniȝt of muchel pris, 968
of grete strengþe,
fair o bodie lengþe.
lengne þu schalt welde,
to spuse helde 972
nild, mi doȝter,
sitteþ on þe lofte.”

Do, cubert,” he seyde,
As ich þe wolle rede.
ede beþ myn heyres,
nd þou þe boneyres, 968
nd of grete strengþe,
wete and fayr of lengþe.
li reaume þou schalt helde,
nd to spuse welde 972
ermenyl, my douter,
at syt in boure softe.”

it seide, “godmod, 3ef þou nere,	
le ded we were,	[966]
<i>No gap in MS. . . .]</i>	
ou art boþe god <i>ant</i> feyr;	[973]
er y make þe myn heyr;	
or my sones bueþ yflawe,	
it ybroht of lyfdawe.	976
ohter ich habbe one;	
ys non so feyr of blod ant bone.	
H5 (Ermenild, þat feyre may,	
ryht so eny someres day,)	980
re wolle ich 3eue þe,	
it her kyng shalt þou be.”	

[KH.5](#) This line was at first left out by the scribe, and then written in the margin of the MS.

) sire king, wiþ wronge
 olte ihc hit vnderfonge. 976
 oʒter þat ʒe me bede,
 er rengne for to lede.
 more ihc schal þe serue,
 kyng, or þu sterue. 980
 orwe schal wende
 eue ʒeres ende.
 me hit is wente,
 king, ʒef me mi rente. 984
 inne i þi doʒter ʒerne,
 schaltu me hire werne.”

e seyde, “king, wit wronge
 cholde ich hire honder fonge, 976
 ing þat þou me bede,
 nd þy reaume lede.
 t more ich wile þe serue,
 nd fro sorwe þe berwe. 980
 y sorwe hyt schal wende
 er þis seue ʒeres hende.
 nd wanne he beþ wente,
 yng, ʒyf þou me my rente. 984
 an ich þi douter herne,
 e schalt þou hire me werne.”

e seyde, “more ichul þe serue,
 yng, er þen þou sterue. 984
 hen y þy dohter ʒerne,
 eo ne shal me noþyng werne.”

even years he does not communicate with Rymenhild.

þerð wonede þere
e seue 3ere, 988
gap in MS.

.]
to Rymenild he ne sente,
him self ne wente. 992
menild was in Westernesse,
wel muchel sorinesse.

Iorn child wonede þere
fulle sixe yere. 988

þe seuenþe, þat cam þe nexte
fter þe sexte, [KH4](#)
ð reymyld he ne wende,
e to hyre sende. 992
eymyld was in westnesse,
lyd michel sorwenesse.

[H.4](#) MS. adds ‘yeres hende’ underdotted as a
mistake.

godmod wonede þere
ille six 3ere; 988
No gap in MS.
.]

at þe seueþe 3er bygon;
ð rymynyld, sonde ne sende he non. 992
rmenyld wes in westnesse,
iþ muchel sorewenesse.

ing sues for Rymenhild.

ies for Rymenhild.

king þer gan ariue
wolde hire haue to wyue. 996

1 he was wiþ þe king,
þat ilke wedding.
laies were schorte,
Riminhild ne dorste 1000
in none wise.
rit he dude deuisse;

kyng þer was aryuede
at wolde hyre habbe to wyue. 996

t sone ware þe kynges
f hyre weddinges.
e dawes weren schorte,
nd reymyld ne dorste 1000
ette in none wise.
writ he dede deuisse;

kyng þer wes aryue,
it wolde hyre han to wyue. 996

one were þe kynges,
f þat weddyng.
e dayes were so sherte,
it rymenild ne derste 1000
tten on none wyse.
wryt hue dude deuyse;

rites a letter to Horn.

If hit dude write, horn ne luuede noȝt lite. sende hire sonde uereche londe, eche horn, þe kniȝt, me him finde miȝte.	1004 1008
yol hyt dide write, at horn ne louede nawt lite. nd to eueryche londe, or horn hym was so longe, fter horn þe knycte, or þat he ne Myȝte.	1004 1008
þulf hit dude wryte, at horn ne louede nout lyte. ae sende hire sonde to eueruche londe, sechen horn knyhte, he so er me myhte.	1004 1008

en meets Rymenhild's messenger.

ile hunting, meets a page, who says that he is seeking Horn,

n noȝt þer of ne herde,
o dai þat he ferde
vude for to schete,
raue he gan imete. 1012

n seden, “Leue fere,
sechestu here?”
iȝt, if beo þi wille,
i þe sone telle. 1016
the fram biweste,
n of westernesse,

orn þer of ne þoute,
yl, on a day þat he ferde
o wode for to seche,
page he gan mete. 1012

e seyde, “leue fere,
/at sekest þou here?”
Knytt, feyr of felle,”
wat þe page, “y wole þe telle. 1016
h seke fram westnesse,
orn, knytt of estnesse,

orn þer of nout herde,
l, o day þat he ferde
o wode forte shete,
page he gan mete. 1012

orn seide, “leue fere,
het dest þou nou here?”
Sire, in lutel spelle [leaf 89]
may þe sone telle. 1016

h seche from westnesse,
orn, knyht, of estnesse,

Rymenhild is to marry King Mody of Reynes, on Sunday.

a Maiden Rymenhild for him gan wexe wild.	1020
ng hire wile wedde, bringe to his bedde, g Modi of Reynes, of hornes enemis.	1024
habbe walke wide e se side,	
or þe mayde reymyld, at for hym ney waxeþ wild.	1020
kyng hire schal wedde, soneday to bedde, yng mody of reny, at was hornes enemy.	1024
h haue walked wide y þe se syde.	
or rymenild, þat feyre may, reweþ for him nyht <i>ant</i> day.	1020
kyng hire shal wedde, sonneday to bedde, yng Mody of reynis, it is hornes enimis.	1024
h habbe walked wyde y þe see side.	

enger laments that he cannot find Horn.

gap in MS.
]

he no war ifunde,
awai þe stunde.
laway þe while,
wurþ Rymenild bigiled.” 1032
n iherde wiþ his ires,
spak wiþ bidere tires,

h neuere myȝt of reche
hit no londisse speche. 1028
is he nower founde,
weylawey þe stounde.
eymyld worþ by gile,
weylawey þe wile.” 1032
orn hyt herde with eren,
nd wep with bloody teren.

e mihte ich him neuer cleche,
iþ nones kunnes speche, 1028
e may ich of him here
londe fer no nere.
eylawey þe while,
m may hente gyle.” 1032
Horn hit herde wiþ earen,
it spec wiþ wete tearen,

closes his identity, and sends word to Rymenhild that he will come Sunday before ‘prime.’

aue, wel þe bitide,
 n stondeþ þe biside. 1036
 n to hure þu turne,
 seie þat heo ne murne,
 ischal beo þer bitime,
 neday bi pryme." 1040
 naue was wel bliþe,
 hizede aȝen bliue.
 e bigan to þroȝe
 er hire woȝe. 1044

So wel þe, grom, by tide,
 orn stant by þy syde. 1036
 ȝen to reymyld turne,
 nd sey þat he ne morne.
 h schal ben þer by tyime,
 soneday by prime." 1040
 e page was blyþe,
 nd schepede wel swyþe.
No gap in MS.
]

So wel, grom, þe bitide,
 orn stond by þi syde, 1036
 ȝeyn to rymenild turne,
 it sey þat he ne murne.
 shal be þer bi time,
 sonneday er prime." 1040
 e page wes wel blyþe
 it shipede wel suyþe.
No gap in MS. . . .
]

messenger on his return journey is drowned.

messenger is drowned, and Rymenhild looks for him in vain.

naue þer gan adrinke;
 ænchild hit miȝte of þinke.
 ænchild vndude þe dure pin
 e hus þer heo was in, 1048
gap in MS.
]

e se hym gan to drenche;
 eymyld hyt Myȝt of þinche.
 e se hym gan op þrowe,
 onder hire boures wowe. 1048
 eymyld gan dore vn pynne,
 f boure þat he was ynne,

e see him gon adrynke;
 æt rymenil may of þinke.
 e [see] him con ded þrowe
 nder hire chambre wowe. 1048
 æmenild lokede wide
 y þe see syde,

ld grieves when she finds the drowned messenger.

oke wiþ hire iȝe,
 æo oȝt of horn isiȝe. 1052
 ond heo þe knaue adrent
 he hadde for horn isent,
 þat scholde horn bringe;
 æ fingres he gan wringe. 1056

nd lokede forþ riȝcte
 fter horn þe knyte. 1052
 o fond hye hire sonde
 renched by þe stronde,
 at scholde horn bringe;
 yre fingres hye gan wringe. 1056

if heo seȝe horn come,	
þer tidynges of eny gome.	1052
þo fond hue hire sonde	
þronque by þe stronde,	
at shulde horn brynge;	
re hondes gon hue wrynge.	1056

He asks King Thurston's aid.

He closes his identity to King Thurston

þorn cam to þurston þe kyng,	
tolde him þis tīping.	
He was iknowe	
Rimenh[ild] was hise oȝe,	1060
his gode kenne,	
ing of suddenne,	
hu he sloȝ in felde	
his fader quelde,	1064

þorn cam to þurston þe kinge,	
and telde hym hys tydinge.	
þo he was by cnowe	
at reymyld was his owe.	1060
<i>No gap in MS.</i>	
<i>.]</i>	

Horn com to þurston þe kyng,	
it tolde him þes tidynges.	
it þo he was biknowe,	
at rymenild wes ys owe,	1060
it of his gode kenne,	
e kyng of sudenne,	
it hou he sloh afelde	
in þat is fader aquelde,	1064

his pay and also aid to win Rymenhild.

seide, “king þe wise,
l me mi seruise.
menhild help me winne;
þu noȝt ne linne,

1068

e seyde, “kyng so wise,
eld me my seruyse.
eymyld me help to winne;
at þou ich nowt ne lynne,

1068

it seide, “kyng so wyse,
ld me my seruice.
menild, help me to wyne,
vyþe þat þou ne blynne,

1068

ises that Athulf shall marry Thurston’s daughter.

ischal do to spuse
oȝter wel to huse.
schal to spuse haue
lf, mi gode felawe,
knigt mid þe beste,
þe treweste.”

1072

nd hy schal to house
y douter do wel spuse.
e schal to spuse haue
yol, My trewe felawe,
e hys knyht wyt þe beste,
nd on of þe treweste.”

1072

it y shal do to house
y dohter wel to spouse,
r hue shal to spouse haue
þulf, my gode felawe.
e is knyht mid þe beste,
it on of þe treweste.”

1072

consents.

ing sede so stille,
rn, haue nu þi wille.” 1076

o seyde þe kyng so stille,
Horn, do þine wille.” 1076

e kyng seide so stille,
orn, do al þi wille.” 1076

ies men, and sets sail.

lude writes sende
yrlonde,
r kniztes lizte,
e men to fizte. 1080

orn come inoze,
to schupe droze.
n dude him in þe weie,
a god Galeie. 1084
im gan to blowe
litel þroze.

orn sente hys sonde
In to eueryche londe,
After men to fyzte,
yrische men so wyzte, 1080
o hym were come hy nowe,
at in to schipe drowe.

orn tok hys preye.
nd dude him in hys weye. 1084

No gap in MS.
.]

e sende þo by sonde,	
nd al is londe,	
ter knyhtes to fyhte,	
at were men so lyhte.	1080
o him come ynowe,	
at in to shipe drowe.	
Horn dude him in þe weye,	
a gret galeye.	1084
e wynd bigon to blowe	
a lutel þrowe.	

rn arrives at the latest possible moment.

s after the bells for the wedding have been rung.

e bigan to posse	
in to Westernesse.	1088
trike seil <i>and</i> maste,	
Ankere gunne caste,	
ny day was sprunge	
r belle irunge.	1092
vord bigan to springe	
ymenhilde weddinge.	
n was in þe watere;	
nizte he come no latere.	1096
ere scyp gan forþ seyle,	
e wynd hym nolde fayle.	1088
e striken seyl of maste,	
nd anker he gonne kaste.	
e soneday was hy sp[ronge],	
nd þe messe hy songe,	1092
f reymylde þe zonge,	
nd of mody þe kinge;	
nd horn was in watere;	
lyzt he come no latere.	1096

e see bi-gan wiþ ship to gon, westnesse hem brohte anon. he striken seyl of maste, hit ancre gonnen caste. watynes were yronge hit þe masse ysonge, for rymenild þe ȝynge hit of Mody þe kynges, hit horn wes in watere; e mihte he come no latere.	1088 1092 1096
---	--

his ship, and comes to land.

et his schup stonde, ȝede to londe. folk he dude abide er wude side.	1100
--	-------------

e let scyp stonde, and ȝede hym op to londe. his folc he dide abyde onder þe wode syde.	1100
---	-------------

e let is ship stonde, hit com him vp to londe. his folk he made abyde nder a wode syde.	1100
---	-------------

en meets a Palmer.

forth alone, and meets a palmer,

[n] him ȝede alone,
 he sprunge of stone.
 ȝalmere he þar mette,
 faire hine grette. 1104
 mere, þu schalt me telle
 of þine spelle.”
gap in MS.
]

e wende forþ alone,
 o he were spronge of stone.
 ȝalmere he mette;
 ȝyt worde he hym grette, 1104
 ȝalmere, þou schalt me telle,”
 e seyde, “on þine spelle,
 o brouke þou þi croune,
 ȝi comest þou fram toune?” 1108

Horn eode forþ al one, [leaf 89, back]

o he sprong of þe stone.
 ȝalmere he y-mette,
 ȝyt wiþ wordes hyne grette, 1104
 ȝalmere, þou shalt me telle,”
 e seyde, “of þine spelle,
 o brouke þou þi croune,
 hy comest þou from toune?” 1108

him of the wedding

seðe vpon his tale,
 þome fram o brudale,
 was at o wedding
 . Maide Rymenhild. 1112
gap in MS.
]

e palmere seyde on hys tale,
 Hy com fram on bridale.
 h com fram brode hylde
 f Mayden reymylde. 1112
 ram honder chyrche wowe,
 e gan louerd owe,

at he seide on is tale,
 / come from a brudale,
 om brudale wylde
 f maide remenylde. 1112
No gap in MS. . . .
]

rmenhild's grief.

nizte heo adri3e
 heo ne weop wiþ i3e. 1116
 sede þat 'heo nolde
 ispused wiþ golde;
 hadde on husebonde,
 he were vt of londe.' 1120

e miy3te hye hyt dreye
 at hye wep wyt eye. 1116
 e seyde þat 'hye nolde
 e spoused Myd golde;
 ye hadde hosebonde,
 ey be nere nawt in londe.' 1120

e mihte hue nout dreȝe
æt hue ne wep wiþ eȝe. 1116
ȝe seide, ‘þat hue nolde
e spoused wiþ golde;
ȝe hade hosebonde
ah he were out of londe.’ 1120

in strong halle,
inne castel walle,
iwas atte ȝate;
de hi me in late. 1124
li ihote hadde
oure þat me hire ladde.
ii igan glide;
deol inolde abide. 1128
ride wepeþ sore,
þat is muche deole!”

Iody Myd strenȝe hyre hadde,
nd in to toure ladde,
ito a stronge halle,
/hit inne kastel walle. 1124
er ich was attegate;
Ioste ich nawt in rake.
wey ich gan glyde;
e deþ ich nolde abyde. 1128
er worþ a rewlich dole,
er þe bryd wepeþ sore.”

h wes in þe halle,
iþ-inne þe castel walle.

No gap in MS. . . .

.
.
.]

wey y gon glide;
e dole y nolde abyde. 1128
er worþ a dole reuly;
e brude wepeþ bitterly.”

ʀn exchanges clothes with the Palmer.

nges clothes with the palmer,

iaþ horn, “So *crist* me rede,
schulle chaungi wede. 1132

e her cloþes myne,
tak me þi sclauyne.
ay i schal þer drinke,
some hit schulle ofþinke.” 1136

sclauyn he dude dun legge,
tok hit on his rigge.
ok horn his cloþes,
nere him noȝt loþe. 1140

ʔalmere,” qwad horn, “so god me rede
h and þou willen chaungen wede. 1132

ac þou me þi sclauyne,
nd haue þou cloþes myne.
o day ich schal þere drynke;
om man hyt schal of þinke.” 1136

e sclavyn he gan doun legge,
nd horn hyt dide on rigge.
e palmere tok hys cloþes,
at ne weren hym nowt loþe. 1140

Iop horn, “so crist me rede,
 e wollep chaunge wede. 1132
 c þou robe myne,
 it 3e sclauelyn þyne.
 day y shal þer drynke,
 at summe hit shal of-þynke.” 1136
 clauelyn he gon doun legge,
 it horn hit dude on rugge,
 it toc hornes cloþes,
 at nout him were loþe. 1140

rens his face and neck with coal.

n tok burdon *and* scrippe,
 wrong his lippe.
 nakede him a ful chere,
 al bicolmede his swere. 1144
 nakede him vn bicomelich;
 he nas neuremore ilich.

Iorn toc burdoun and scrippe,
 And gan wringe hys lippe.
 He made a foul chere,
 nd kewede hys swere. 1144
No gap in MS.
]

Horn toc bordoun *ant* scrippe,
 it gan to wrynge is lippe.
 e made foule chere,
 it bicolledede is swere. 1144
No gap in MS. . . .
]

keeper forbids Horn entrance.

þe com to þe gateward,
him answerede hard. 1148

þe bad undo softe,
þi tyme *and* ofte.
þiȝte he awynne
he come þerinne. 1152

þe cam to þe gateward,
at hym answered hard. 1148
þe bed on do wel softe,
þe syþe and ofte.
þiȝte he nowt wynne
or to come þerinne. 1152

þe com to þe gateward,
at him answered froward. 1148
þe bed vn-do wel softe,
þiȝt tyme ant ofte.
þe myhte he ywynne
or to come þer-yne. 1152

þe enters the hall, and sits with the beggars.

þe goes through the wicket, after having thrown the gate-keeper over the bridge.

n gan to þe 3ate turne,
 þat wiket vnspurne.
 oye hit scholde abugge;
 n þreu him ouer þe brigge, 1156
 his ribbes him to brake;
 suppe com in atte gate.
 sette him wel lo3e,
 eggeres rowe. 1160
 okede him abute,
 his colmie snute.

orn gan to þe yate turne,
 nd þe wyket op spurne.
 e porter hyt scholde abygge;
 e pugde hym ofer þe brigge, 1156
 at hys ribbes gonnen krake;
 nd horn into halle rake.
 e sette hym wel lowe,
 i beggeres rowe. 1160
 e loked al aboute,
 lid hys kelwe snowte.

orn þe wyket puste,
 at hit open fluste.
 e porter shulde abugge;
 e þrew him a-doun þe brugge, 1156
 at þre ribbes crakede.
 orn to halle rakede,
 at sette him doun wel lowe,
 i þe beggeres rowe. 1160
 e lokede aboute,
 yd is collede snoute.

3ymenhild weeping, but looks in vain for Athulf.

þeȝ Rymenthild sitte
heo were of witte, 1164
þe wepinge *and* ȝerne;
nizte hure noman wurne.

lokedede in eche halke;
þeȝ he nowhar walke 1168
If his felawe,
he cuþe knowe.

þe sey Reymyld sytte
l so hy were of witte, 1164
lȝyt droupnynde chere,
at was hys *lemman* dere.

þe lokede in eche halke;
þeȝ he nowere stalke 1168
ȝol hys trewe felawe,
at trewe was and ful of lawe.

þer seh he rymenild sitte
þe hue were out of wytte, 1164
þe pinde sore;
þeȝ he seh nowere þore
No gap in MS. . . .

.]
þulful is gode felawe,
at trewe wes in vch plawe.

ulf despairs of Horn's coming.

þom the tower watches in vain for Horn.

If was in þe ture,
te for to pure 1172
r his comynge,
schup him wolde bringe.

æ3 þe se flowe,
horn nowar rowe. 1176

yol was op in toure,
boute for to poure 1172
fter hornes cominge,
yf water hym wolde bringe.

e se he sey flowe,
nd horn nower rowe. 1176

Apulf wes o tour ful heh,
loke fer *ant* eke neh 1172
ter hornes comynge,
f water him wolde brynge.

e see he seh flowe,
n horn nower rowe. 1176

iloquy he says that Horn will be too late.

sedde vpon his songe,
Horn, nu þu ert wel longe.
Hornhild þu me toke,
ich scholde loke. 1180
Ich hadde kept hure eure;
ich nu oþer neure.
Ich may no leng hure kepe;
soreþe nu y wepe.” 1184

He seyde in hys songe,
Horn, þou art to longe.
Ich eymyld þou me by toke,
at ich hyre scholde loke. 1180
Ich haue hire yloked euere,
and þou ne comest neuere.”
Vo gap in MS.
.]

He seyde on is songe,
Horn, þou art to longe.
Hornmenild þou me bitoke,
at ich hire shulde loke. 1180
Ich haue yloked euere,
at þou ne comest neuere.”
Vo gap in MS.
.]

He had bears wine and beer to the guests.

menhild Ros of benche,
for to schenche,
for mete in sale,
the wyn *and* ale. 1188
horn he bar anhonde,
age was in londe.

eymyld ros of benche,
the knyghtes for to schenche.
No gap in MS.
.]
horn hye ber on honde,
his hyt was lawe of londe.

ymenild ros of benche,
the beer al forte shenche,
for mete in sale,
the wyn *ant* ale. 1188
horn hue ber an honde,
for þat wes lawe of londe.

ghtes *and* squier
dronken of þe ber; 1192
the horn al one
de þerof no mone.

he sat vpon þe grunde;
he þuhte he was ibunde. 1196

he drank of þe bere,
the knyht and to squiere. 1192
No gap in MS.
.]

nd horn set on þe grunde;
ym þoute he was bounde. 1196

þe dronc of þe beere,
þo knyht *ant* skyere. 1192

No gap in MS.]

þorn set at groundē;
þam þohte he wes y-bounde. 1196

þe addresses Rymenhild.

þe Rymenhild to serve the beggars.

þe seide, “quen so hende,
þu mēward þu wende.
þef vs wiþ þe furste;
þe beggeres beþ of þurste.” 1200

þe seyde, “quen so hende,
þu mēward gyn þou wende.
þenken hus Myd þe furste;
þe beggeres beþ of þurste.” 1200

þe seide, “quene so hende,
þu me hydeward þou wende.
þu shenhs vs wiþ þe vurstē; [leaf 90]
þe beggares bueþ afurste.” 1200

þe fills a gallon bowl with brown beer, and offers it to Horn.

ire horn heo leide adun,
fulde him of a brun,
bolle of a galun,
heo wende he were a glotoun. 1204

seide, “haue þis cuppe,
þis þing þer vppe.
iaȝ ihc neure, so ihc wene,
gere þat were so kene.” 1208

e horn hye leyde adoune,
nd fulde hem of þe broune,
bolle of one galun;
ye wende he were a glotoun. 1204

Nym þou þe coppe,
nd drinkyt al oppe.
ey ich neuere, ich wene,
eggere so bold and kene.” 1208

yre horn hue leyde a doune,
it fulde him of þe broune,
bolle of a galoun;
ie wende he were a glotoun. 1204

ie seide, “tac þe coppe,
it drync þis ber al vppe.
e seh y neuer, y wene,
eggare so kene.” 1208

as it, saying that he will have nothing ‘bote of coppe white,’

n tok hit his ifere,
sede, “quen so dere,
i nelle ihc, Muche ne lite,
e of cuppe white. 1212

orn tok þe coppe hys fere,
nd seyde, “quen so dere,
o drynk nel ich bite,
ote of one coppe wite. 1212

þu toc hit hise yfere,
æt seide, “quene so dere,
þu beer nullich i bite,
þe of coppe white. 1212

He is no beggar, but a fisher.

þu wenest i beo a beggere,
i þu am a fissere,
þu feor icome bi este,
fissen at þi feste. 1216
æt līf her bi honde,
wel fair stronde.

þu wenest ich be a beggere;
for gode ich am a fyssere,
þu come fram by weste,
þu fyren an þi feste. 1216
Ic net hys ney honde,
i a wel fayr ponde.

þu wenest ich be a beggere;
wis icham a fysshere,
elc fer come by weste,
þu seche mine bestee. 1216
Ic net lyht her wel hende,
iþ-inne a wel feyr pende.

He alludes to her dream of the fish net, and bids her ‘drynke to horn of horne.’

hap ileie þere
e seue 3ere. 1220

am icome to loke
ni fiss hit toke.

gap in MS.
.]

am icome to fisse;
ik to me of disse.
ik to horn of horne,
: ihc am i orne.” 1228

yt hat hy be here
l þis seue3ere. 1220

yc am hy come to loke
if any he toke.
yf any fy3s hys þerynne,
er of þou winne. 1224

h am hy come to fy3sse,
rink to me of þy disse;
rynk to horn of horn,
or ich habbe hy 3ouren.” 1228

h haue leye þere,
ou is þis þe seueþe 3ere. 1220

ham icome to loke
f eny fyssh hit toke.
f eny fyssh is þer-inne,
er-of þou shalt wyne. 1224

or icham come to fyssh,
rynke nully of dyssh.
rynke to horn of horne;
el fer ich haue y-orne.” 1228

ld looks at him and trembles, not fully comprehending his meaning.

Rymenild him gan bihelde;
 Heorte bigan to chelde.
 Heo neo noȝt his fyssing,
 1232
 Horn hym selue noȝing;
 Under hire gan þynke,
 He bad to horn drinke.

Rymyld hym gan by holde,
 And hyre herte to kolde.
 Heo neowt hys fyssing,
 1232
 He hym selue no þyng.
 Under hyre gan þynke,
 He he hyre bed drynke.

Rymenild him gan bihelde;
 He herte fel to kelde.
 Heo kneo heo noht is fysshing,
 1232
 He him selue noȝing.
 Under hyre gan þynke,
 He for horn he bed drynke.

He puts the ring in the horn.

He fills the horn with wine and bids him drink his fill, and then tell her if he knows aught of Horn.

He fulde hire horn wiþ wyn,
 He dronk to þe pilegrym.
 He seðe, “drink þi fulle,
 1236
 Suppe þu me telle
 He eore isige
 He vnder wode lize.”
 1240

He fulde horn þe wyn,
 He dronk to þe pylegrim.
 He seðe, þou drinke þy fulle,
 1236
 He syðe þou schalt telle,
 He þou horn awt seye
 He onder wode leye.”
 1240

He fulde þe horn of wyne,
 He dronk to þat pelryne. 1236
 He seide, “drync þi felle,
 He seþþen þou me telle
 If þou horn euer seze
 Under wode leze.” 1240

He then throws the ring in the horn.

He dronk of horn a stunde,
 He þreu þe ring to grunde.
gap in MS.
]

He dronk of horn a stounde,
 And þrew hys ryng to þe grounde.
 He seyde, “quen, nou seche
 Wat hys in þy drenche.” 1244

Horn dronk of horn a stounde,
 He þreu is ryng to grounde,
 He seide, “quene, þou þench
 Hat y þreu in þe drench.” 1244

He goes to her bower, and finds the ring.

uen ȝede to bure,
hire maidenen foure.
ond heo what heo wolde,
ng igræuen of golde, 1248
horn of hure hadde.
e hure dradde
horn isteue were,
þe Ring was þere. 1252

eymild ȝede to boure,
/yt hyre maydenes foure.
e fond þat he wolde,
ryng hy grauen of golde, 1248
at horn of hyre hadde.
/el sore hyre of dradde
at horn child ded were,
or þe ryng was þere. 1252

e quene eode to boure,
id hire maidnes foure.
æ fond þat he wolde,
e ryng ygraed of golde, 1248
at horn of hyre hedde.
l sore hyre adredde
at horn ded were,
or his ryng was þere. 1252

ænehild summons Horn to her bower.

s for the palmer, and inquires where he got the ring.

ente heo a damesele
r þe palmere.
mere,” quap heo, “trewē,
ing þat þu þrewe, 1256
eie whar þu hit nome,
whi þu hider come.”

o sende hye a damysele
doun after þe palmere.
þalmere,” hye seyde, “so trewe,
e ryng þou here þrewe, 1256
ey war þou ith nome,
nd hyder wi þou come.”

o sende hue a damoisele
ter þilke palmere.
þalmere,” quop hue, “so trewe,
e ryng þat þou yn þrewe, 1256
ou sey wer þou hit nome,
it hyder hou þou come.”

s that in his wanderings he has met Horn by the strand.

sede, “bi seint gile,
habbe go mani Mile, 1260
feor bi 3onde weste,
eche my beste.

gap in MS.
[.]
nd horn child stonde,
chupeward in londe.

e seyde, “bi seynt gyle,
h aue hy go mani amyle, 1260
el fer her by weste,
o seche my beste,
ly mete for to bidde,
o hyt me by tidde. 1264
at fond ich horn child stonde,
o scyppeward on stronde.

e seyde, “by seint gyle,
h eode mony a myle, 1260
el fer 3ent by weste,
o seche myne beste,
li mete forte bydde,
or so me þo bitidde. 1264
h fond horn knyht stonde,
o shipeward at stronde.

ues to relate how Horn, on ship board, fell ill and died, and how Horn charged him to bear the ring to Rymen

þeðe he wolde agesse
þæt he in westnesse.

1268

þæt he nam to þe flode,
me *and* horn þe gode.

þæt he was sik *and* deide,
þæt he me preide,
wiþ þe ringe,

1272

Rymenhild þe 3onge.’

þæt he hit custe,
þæt he 3eue his saule reste.”

1276

þæt he seyde he wolde agesce

þæt he ryuen in westnesse.

1268

þæt he scyp hym 3ede to flode,

þæt he me and horn þe gode.

þæt he horn was sech and ded,

þæt he for his loue me bed,

1272

þæt he to schipe with me þe ring

þæt he Reymyld quene þe 3eng.’

þæt he me kuste,

þæt he 3yue hys soule reste.”

1276

þæt he seide he wolde gesse

þæt he aryue at westnesse.

1268

þæt he ship nom in to flode,

þæt he me *ant* horn þe gode.

þæt he horn by-gan be sek *ant* de3e,

þæt he for his loue me pre3e

1272

þæt he gon wiþ þe rynge,

þæt he rymenild þe 3ynge.

þæt he el ofte he hyne keste,

þæt he 3ist 3eue is soule reste.”

1276

þæt he prevents Rymenhild from stabbing herself.

þæt he raves with grief, and attempts to slay herself with a knife, but is prevented by Horn,

menhild sede at þe furste,
rte, nu þu berste,
horn nastu namore,
þe haþ pined þe so sore.” 1280

eymyld seyde ate ferste,
Herte, nou to berste;
orn ne worþ me na more,
or wam hy pyne sore.” 1280

Rymenild seide at þe firste,
Herte, nou to berste.
orn worþ þe no more,
at haueþ þe pyned sore.” 1280

feol on hire bedde
heo knif hudde,
le wiþ king loþe,
hure selue boþe, 1284
at vlke niȝte,
orn come ne miȝte.
Herte knif he sette;
orn anon hire kepte. 1288

ye fel adoun on þe bed
er hye hauede knyues leyð,
o slen hire louerd loþe,
nd hyre selue boþe, 1284
i þat hulke [nyȝte],
ote horn come myȝte.
nyf to hyre herte hye sette,
nd horn hire gan lette. 1288

ue fel adoun a bedde, [leaf 90, back]
 nt after knyues gredde,
 slein mide hire kyng loþe,
 nt hire selue boþe. 1284
 ip-inne þilke nyhte,
 me 3ef horn ne myhte.
 herte knyf hue sette,
 rn in is armes hire kepte. 1288

wipes away the black from his face.

gap in MS.
]

ys schirt lappe he gan take,
 nd wipede away þat blake
 is shurte lappe he gan take,
 nt wypede a wey þe foule blake

rn makes himself known.

s who he is, and bids Rymenhild kiss him.

wipede þat blake of his swere,
 sede, “Quen so swete *and* dere, 1292
 am horn þino3e;
 canstu me no3t knowe?
 am horn of westernesse;
 rmes þu me cusse.” 1296

at was on hys swere,
 nd seyde, “quene so dere, 1292
 anst þou me nawt knowe?
 e am ich al þyn owe?
 h am horn of estnesse;
 i þyn armes þou me kusse.” 1296

at wes opon his suere,
 it seide, “luef so dere, 1292
 e const þou me yknowe?
 e am ich horn þyn owe?
 h, horn of westnesse;
 armes þou me kesse.” 1296

d embraces, he tells her that he has armed men by the ‘wodes ende,’ who will prevent the wedding.

uste hem mid ywisse,
 .makeden Muche blisse.
 ymenhild,” he sede, “ywende
 n to þe wudes ende. 1300
 beþ myne knyȝtes,
 i to fiȝte,
 ied vnder cloþe.

ye clepten and hye kuste
 e wile þat hem luste.
 Reymyld,” qwad horn, “ich moste wende
 o þe wodes hende, 1300
 fter mine knyȝtes,
 yrische men so wyȝte,
 rmed honder cloþe.

clupten *ant* kyste
 o longe so hem lyste.
 Rymenild,” quop he, “ich wende
 un to þe wodes ende, 1300
 r þer bueþ myne knyhte,
 orþi men *ant* lyhte,
 med vnder cloþe;

chulle make wroþe 1304
ing *and* his geste
come to þe feste.
ay i schal hem teche,
sore hem areche.” 1308

e scholen maken wroþe 1304
e king and hyse gestes
at sytten atte feste.
o day we schole hem keche,
yzt nou ich wolle hem teche.” 1308

æ shule make wroþe 1304
e kyng *ant* hise gestes
æt bueþ at þise festes.
o day ychulle huem cacche,
ou ichulle huem vacche.” 1308

is the bower, and Rymenhild sets out in search of Athulf.

orn sprong ut of halle,
let his sclauin falle.
uen zede to bure,
fond Apulf in ture. 1312

Horn sprong out of halle;
þe sclavyn he let falle.
And Reymyld wente to toure,
nd fond ayol lure. 1312

Horn sprong out of halle;
s brunie he let falle.
rmenild eode of boure;
ulf hue fond loure. 1312

ulf,” heo sede, “be bliþe,
to horn þu go wel swiþe.
Ayol, be wel blyþe,
nd go to horn swyþe.

þulf, be wel blyþe,
æt to horn go swyþe.

oes to find Horn, and embraces him.

s vnder wude boʒe,
wiþ him kniʒtes Inoʒe.” 1316
uulf bigan to springe
þe tiþinge.

r horn he arnde anon,
þat hors miʒte gon. 1320
him ouertok ywis;
nakede suiþe Muchel blis.

e hys honder wode bowe,
nd Myd hym felawe ynowe.” 1316
yol forþ gan springe,
ʒel glad for þat tydyngge.

aste after horn he rende;
ym þoute hys herte brende. 1320
f tok he horn hy wys,
nd kuste hym wit blys.

e is vnder wode bowe,
iþ felawes ynowe.” 1316
þulf gon froth springe,
r þat ilke tydyngge.

ter horn he ernde;
m þohte is herte bernde. 1320
e oftok him ywisse,
æt custe him wiþ blysse.

æn breaks up the wedding feast.

th his armed men, breaks into the hall and slays many of the guests,

n tok his preie,
dude him in þe weie. 1324

om in wel sone,
ates were vndone,
ied ful þikke
n fote to þe nekke. 1328

No gap in MS.
.]

e com aȝen wel sone,
e gates weren ondone.

No gap in MS.
.]

orn tok is preye
it dude him in þe weye. 1324

ie comen in wel sone,
e gates weren vndone;
armed suiþe þicke
om fote to þe nycke. 1328

þat were þerin,
ite his twelf ferin
þe king Aylmare,
lude hem alle to kare 1332
at þe feste were.
e lif hi lete þere.

ye þat ate feste heten,
ere lyue he gonne þer leten.
nd þe kyng mody
ym he made bloody. 1332
nd þe king aylmere
o hauede myche fere.

le þat þer euere weren,
iþ-oute is trewe feren
at þe kyng aylmare,
wis he hade muche care. 1332
lonie þat þer sete,
are lyf hy gonne lete.

es not understand Fikenhild's treachery, for all deny the treason.

n ne dude no wonder
fikenhildes false tunge. 1336
woren opes holde,
neure ne scholde

Horn no wonder ne makede
Of fykenildes falsede. 1336
He sworn alle and seyde
at here non hym by wreyde.

orn vnderstondyng ne hede
Fykeles falssede. 1336
ue suoren alle, ant seyde,
at hure non him wreyede

that they have not betrayed Horn.

n neure bitraie,
he at diþe laie. 1340
lunge þe belle,
wedlak for to felle.
gap in MS.
.]

nd ofte he sworn hopes holde,
at þere non ne scholde 1340
o ware horn by wreyen,
ou he to deþe leyen.
e rongen þe bellen,
e wedding for to fullen, 1344
f hor þat was so hende,
nd of reymyld þe zonge.

it suore oþes holde
at huere non ne sholde 1340
orn neuer bytreye,
ah he on deþe leye.
er hy ronge þe belle,
at wedlake to fulfulle. 1344
No gap in MS. . . .
.]

⁊n weds Rymenhild.

ling is celebrated in the king's palace.

n him ȝede with his,
e kynges palais. 1348

was brid *and* ale suete,
riche men þer ete.
e ne miȝte tunge
gle þat þer was sunge. 1352

orn ledde hyre hom wit heyse,
o hyre fader paleyse. 1348

er was brydale swete;
iche men þer hete.
ellen ne Myȝte no tonge
e joye þat þer was songe. 1352

ae wenden hom wiþ eyse,
o þe kynges paleyse. 1348

er wes þe brudale suete,
or richemen þer ete.
lle ne mihte no tonge
e gle þat þer was songe. 1352

resses the king, and begins to recount his history.

orn sat on chaere,
bad hem alle ihere.
ig,” he sede, “þu luste
le mid þe beste. 1356

Horn set on hys cheyere,
And bed he scholden alle here.
He seyde, “kyng so longe,
ly tale þou honderstonde. 1356

Horn set in chayere,
it bed hem alle yhere.
e seyde, “kyng of londe,
i tale þou vnderstonde. 1356

seie hit for no blame,
n is mi name.
ne to kni3t houē,
kni3thod haue proued. 1360
e king men seide
iþe bitraide;

y was born in sodenne;
yng was My fader of kunne.
o me to kny3te þou 3oue;
ly kny3thede ich haue proued. 1360
o þe of me men seyde
ar for þi herte creyde.

h wes ybore in sudenne;
yng wes mi fader of kenne.
ou me to knyhte houē;
f knythod habbe y proue. 1360
No gap in MS. . . .
.]

lains to the king his innocence,

nakedest me fleme,
þi lond to reme. 1364
vendest þat iwro3te
y neure ne þo3te,
ymenhild for to ligge,
þat i wiþsegge. 1368

ou makedest me to rewe,
o þou bote me fleme. 1364
ou wendes þat ich wroute
at hy neuere ne þoute,
yt Reymyld for ligge.
wys ich hyt wyt sigge. 1368

þu dryue me out of þi lond,
æt seydest ich wes traytour strong. 1364
þu wendest þat ich wrohte
at y ner ne þohte,
y rymenild forte lygge;
wys ich hit wiþsugge. 1368

that he will not take Rymenhild to wife until he has regained his kingdom of Sudenne.

Ichal ihc hit biginne,
suddene winne.
Kep hure a stunde,
while þat i funde 1372
þu min heritage
to mi baronage.

þu ne schal neuere a gynne,
for ich sodenne wynne.
Kep hire me a stounde,
þe wille ich hennes founde 1372
to myn heritage,
lid myn hirysce page.

þe shal ich hit ner agynne, [leaf 91]
for ich sudenne wynne.
þu kep hyre me a stounde,
þe while þat ich founde 1372
to myn heritage,
iþ þis yrisshe page.

lond i schal ofreche,
do mi fader wreche. 1376
al beo king of tune,
bere kinges crune.
æ schal Rymenhilde
ge bi þe kinge.” 1380

at lond ich schal of reche,
nd do my fader wreche. 1376
h schal be kyng of tune,
nd wite of kynges r[?]owne.
enne schal Reymyld þe 3onge
yggen by horn þe kyng.” 1380

at lond ichulle þorhreche,
it do mi fader wreche. 1376
chul be kyng of toune,
it lerne kynges roune.
enne shal rymenild þe 3ynge
gge by horn þe kyng.” 1380

æn sets sail for Sudenne.

sail with Athulf and his Irish companions, and has a favouring wind.

orn gan to schupe draze,
his yrisse felazes.
lf wiþ him his broþer;
le he non oþer. 1384
schup bigan to crude,
vind him bleu lude.

or gan to schipe ryde,
nd hys knyȝtes bi side.
No gap in MS.
.]
ere schip gan to croude,
e wynd hym bleu wel loude.

Horn gan to shipe drawe,
 iþ hyse yrisshe felawe.
 þulf wiþ him, his broþer,
 æ nolde habbe non oþer. 1384
 æ ship by-gan to croude;
 æ wynd bleu wel loude.

th Sudenne within five days.

nne daies fiue
 schup gan ariue, 1388
gap in MS.
]
 te middelnizte.
 n him zede wel rizte. 1392

onder sodenne syde
 ere schip bi gan to glide, 1388
Vo gap in MS.
]
 bowte myd nizte.
 orn hym yede wel ryzte, 1392

yþ-inne dawes fyue
 æ ship began aryue. 1388
 nder sudennes side
 ære ship by-gon to ryde,
 oute þe midnyhte.
 orn eode wel rihte; 1392

finds a knight sleeping by the wayside.

Athulf land, and find a goodly knight sleeping by the wayside.

ok apulf bi honde,
 . vp he 3ede to londe.
 ounde vnder schelde,
 nizt hende in felde. 1396

gap in MS.
]

nizt him aslepe lay
 iside þe way. 1400
 n him gan to take,
 sede, “kni3t, awake.

am ayol on hys honde,
 nd yeden op hon londe.
 ye found honder schelde,
 . knyt liggen in felde. 1396

p þe scheld was drawe
 . crowch of ihesu cristes lawe.
 e knyt hy lay on slepe,
[H6](#)In armes wel ymete. 1400

orn hym gan take,
 nd seyde, “knyt, awake.

[KHL6](#) Between vv. 1399 and 1400 stands in
 the MS. Laud the incomplete line *Horn hym*
gan m, underdotted to indicate that it is due
 to a mistake of the scribe.

e nom apulf by honde,
 nt ede vp to londe.
 ie fonden vnder shelde,
 knyht liggynde on felde. 1396

þe shelde wes ydrawe
 croyz of ihesu cristes lawe.
 e knyht him lay on slape,
 i armes wel yshape. 1400

Horn him gan ytake,
 nt seide, “knyht, awake.

s him tell his business, under pain of death.

what þu kepest,
whi þu her slepest. 1404
þinkþ, biþine crois liȝte,
þu longest to vre driȝte.
e þu wule me schewe,
ial þe to hewe.” 1408
ode kniȝt vp aros;
e wordes him gros.

No gap in MS.
.]
le þynkeþ, by þe crowches lyste,
at þou leuest on criste.
ote þou hit raþe schewe,
/yt Mi swerd ich schal þe hewe.” 1408
e gode knyht op aros;
f hornes wordes hym agros.

ou sei me whet þou kepest,
at here whi þou slepest! 1404
e þuncheþ, by crois liste,
at þou leuest on criste;
ote þou hit wolfe shewe,
y suerd shal þe to-hewe.” 1408
e gode knyht vp aros;
f hornes wordes him agros.

knight tells his story.

ht says that he serves the Saracens against his will,

seide, “ihc haue, aȝenes my wille,
as ful ylle. 1412

was *cristene* a while,
com to þis ille
arazyns blake,
dude me forsake. 1416

e seyde, “hy serue ylle
aynys, aȝen My wille. 1412
th was *cristene* som wyle,
nd þo were come into þis yle
arazyns lodlike and blake,
nd dide me god forsake. 1416

e seide, “ich seruy ille
aynes, toȝeynes mi wille. 1412
th was *cristene* sum while;
come in to þis yle.
arazyns loþe *ant* blake
e made ihesu forsake, 1416

how the Saracens invaded the land and slew King Murry.

Crist ihc wolde bileue;

 nim hi makede me reue,
 tepe þis passage
 n horn þat is of age, 1420
 wunieþ bieste,
 3t wiþ þe beste.
 lo3e wiþ here honde,
 ing of þis londe, 1424

i god on wam yleue,
o he makeden me reue,
o loke þis passage
or horn þat hys of age. 1420
e woneþ alby weste,
od knyht myd þe beste.
e slow Mid hys honde
e kyng of þise londe, 1424

Vo gap in MS. . . .
]
 I loke þis passage
 or horn þat is of age, 1420
 at woneþ her by weste,
 oð knyht mid þe beste.
 He slowe mid huere honde,
 þe kyng of þisse londe, 1424

ers that Horn does not return to avenge his father's death.

wiþ him fele hundred.	
þerof is wunder	
he ne comeþ to fiȝte;	
. sende him þe riȝte,	1428
wind him hider driue,	
ringe hem of liue.	
loȝen kyng Murry,	
nes fader, king hendy.	1432
n hi vt of londe sente;	
lf felazes wiþ him wente,	
nd wyt hym men an hundred.	
er fore me þinkeþ wonder	
at he comeþ fiȝþcte.	
od yeue hym þe miȝte,	1428
at wynde hym driue	
o bringen hem of liue.	
e slowen þe kyng mory,	
ornes fader so stordy.	1432
orn to water he sente,	
j children myd hym wente.	
at wiþ him mony honder.	
er fore me þuncheþ wonder	
at he ne comeþ to fyhte;	
od ȝeue him þe myhte,	1428
at wynd him hider dryue,	
o don hem alle of lyue.	
at slowen kyng mury	
ornes cunesmon hardy.	1432
orn, of londe hue senten;	
elf children wiþ him wenten.	

the knight proves to be Athulf's father.

lines to tell how his son, Athulf, is Horn's faithful companion.

ȝng hem apulf þe gode,
 ȝene child, my leue fode. 1436
 ȝorn child is hol and sund,
 Apulf biþute wund,
 uueþ him so dere,
 is him so stere, 1440
gap in MS.
]
 te iseon hem tueie,
 ioie i scholde deie.” 1444

er mong was ayol þe gode,
 lyn owe child, myn owe fode. 1436
No gap in MS.
]
 e louede horn wel derne,
 nd horn hym also ȝerne. 1440
 yf horn hys hol and sounde,
 yol ne tyt no wounde.
 ote ich nou se hem tweye,
 wys ich wolle deye.” 1444

ip hem wes apulf þe gode,
 i child, myn ȝone fode. 1436
 f horn is hol ant sounde,
 ulf tit no wounde.
No gap in MS. . . .
]
 e louede horn wiþ mihte,
 t he him wiþ ryhte.
 f y myhte se hem tueye,
 enne ne rohti forte deye.” 1444

make themselves known, and a joyful scene of recognition follows.

knȳt, beo þanne bliþe,
t of alle siþe.
n *and* Apulf his fere,
e hi ben here.” 1448
horn he gan gon,
grette him anon.

Knȳt, be swiþe blyþe,
lest of alle syþe.
yol and horn yfere
oþe he ben here.” 1448
e knȳt to hem gan steppe,
nd in armes cleppe.

“knyht, be þenne blyþe,
lest of alle syþe.
þulf, *ant* horn is fere,
oþe-we beþ here.” 1448
e knȳt to horn gan skippe,
nt in his armes clippe.

þe ioie hi makede þere,
while hi togadere were. 1452
ildre,” he sede, “hu habbe ȝe fare?
ihc ȝou seȝ hit is ful ȝare.
le ȝe þis londe winne,
sle þat þeris inne?” 1456

e joie þat he made,
lyȝte no man rede. 1452
e seyde wit steuene ȝare,
Children, hou abbe ȝe fare?
olle ȝe þis lond winne,
nd wonye þer inne?” 1456

fulche ioƿe hue maðen yfere,
þæt hue to gedere y-come were.” 1452
e saide wiþ steuene þare, [leaf 91, back]
þungemen, hou habbe 3e 3ore yfare?
olle 3e þis lond wynne,
wæt wonie þer ynne?” 1456

night informs Horn that his mother, the queen Godhild, still lives.

seide, “leue horn child,
lyueþ þi moder Godhild.
ioie heo miste,
so þe aliue wiste.” 1460

e seyde, “leue horn child,
et liueþ þy moder godild.”
No gap in MS.
.]

e seide, “suete horn child,
æt lyueþ þy moder godyld.
f ioie hue ne miste,
lyue 3ef hue þe wiste.” 1460

orms the old knight that he has with him many Irish companions.

orn sede on his rime,
essed beo þe time
n to suddenne,
mine irisse menne. 1464
schulle þe hundes teche
peken vre speche.
we hem schulle sle,
al quic hem fle.” 1468

orn seyde on hys rime,
Hyblessed be þe tyme
h am ycome to sodenne,
yt Myn hyrysce menne. 1464
is lond we schollen winne
nd fle at þat þere ben inne.
nd so we scholen hem teche
o speken oure speche.” 1468

orn seide on is ryme,
blessed be þe time
ham icome in to sudenne,
ip fele yrisshemenne. 1464
e shule þe houndes kecche,
it to þe de3e vecche.
it so we shulen hem teche
o speken oure speche.” 1468

rn delivers Sudenne from the Saracens.

ws his horn, and his men arrive;

n gan his horn to blowe;
folk hit gan iknowe.
omen vt of stere,
n hornes banere. 1472

orn gan hys horn blowe,
at hys folc it gan knowe.
e comen out of scyp sterne,
o horn ward wel 3erne. 1472

Horn gon is horn blowe;
folc hit con yknowe.
ae comen out of hurne,
o horn swyþe 3urne. 1472

attack and slay the Saracens, old and young.

lo3en *and* fu3ten,
i3t *and* þe v3ten.
gap in MS.
.
.
.]

arazins cunde,
efde þer non in þende. 1480

e smyten and he fouten,
e ny3t and eke þe ou3ten.
lyd speres hord he stonge,
e held and eke þe 3onge. 1476

at lond he þoru sowten;
o deþe he hus brouten
arazines kende,
e leuede on þe fende. 1480

ae smiten *ant* hue fyhten,
e niht *ant* eke þe ohtoun.

No gap in MS. . . .

.]

e sarazyns hue slowe,
it summe quike to drowe.
id speres ord hue stonge
e olde *ant* eke þe 3onge.

1480

in causes chapels and churches to be built.

n let wurche
peles *and* chirche;

orn let sone werchen
hapeles and cherchen;

Horn lette sone wurche
þe chapel *ant* chyrche.

ses the bells to be rung and masses to be celebrated.

et belles ringe,
Masses let singe.

1484

ellen he dide ryngen,
nd *prestes* messe syngen.

1484

e made belle rynge
it *prestes* masse synge.

1484

seeks his mother, and all make merry.

com to his Moder halle,
roche walle.

gap in MS.
]

an he let serie,
made feste merie.
ie lif he wro3te;
enchild hit dere bo3te. 1492

e sowte hys moder oueralle,
it inne eueriche walle. [KH7](#)
e custen and hye cleten,
nd in to halle wenten. 1488
roune he gonnen werie,
nd made festes merye.
lurye he þere wroute;
eymyld hyt aboute. 1492

[KH.7](#) This line repeated in the MS.

e sohte is moder halle,
þe roche walle.
e custe hire ant grette,
it in to þe castel fette. 1488
roune he gan werie,
it make feste merye.
lurie he þer wrohte,
rymenild hit abohte. 1492

enchild builds a strong castle.

antime Fikenchild, by gifts, wins powerful support,

kenhild was prut on herte,
þat him dude smerte.

gap in MS.

.

.

.]

ge he ʒaf *and* elde,
him for to helde.

1500

ʒile þat horn was oute,
ikenyld ferde aboute.

o wiue he gan hire ʒerne;

e kyng ne dorst him werne.

1496

luche was hys prede;

e ryche he ʒaf mede,

onge and eke þe helde,

at Mid hym scholde helde.

1500

Þe whiles horn wes oute,
ikenild ferde aboute.

No gap in MS. . . .

.]

e betere forte spede,

e riche he ʒef mede,

þe ʒonge ant olde,

iþ him forte holde.

1500

is a castle entirely surrounded by the water.

þ he dude lede,
he hopede spede.
þing castel he let sette,
to see him biflette. 1504

þe miȝte liȝte
þe foȝel wiþ flizte;
þe whanne þe see wiþ droȝe,
to come men ynoȝe. 1508

þen he dede lede,
and hym þerto he made.
þe kastel he dude feste
wiþ water alby sette. 1504
liȝt no man hon on legge,
þy pape ne by brigge;
þote wan þe wit drowe,
þer munthe come. 1508

þen he dude lade,
þat lym þerto he made.
þe kastel he made sette,
wiþ water by flette. 1504
þat þer yn come ne myhte
þote foul wiþ flyhte;
þote when þe see wiþ-drowe,
þer mihte come ynowe. 1508

He then plots to wed Rymenhild, and sets the day for the wedding.

anhild gan wende
anhild to schende.
gap in MS.
]

is fykenild ganto wende [KH8](#)
eynyld for to wende.
e day by gan to wexe,
at hem was by twexe. 1512
ekenyld, her þe day gan springe,
erde to aylmer þe kyng,
fter reynyld þe bryzte,
nd spousede hire by nihte. 1516

[KH.8](#) Written wēnde

us fykenild gon by-wende
ymenild forte shende.
No gap in MS. . . .
]
wyue he gan hire 3erne;
e kyng ne durst him werne.
at habbeþ set þe day,
ykenild to wedde þe may. 1516

ld weeps tears of blood.

vo3e he gan hure 3erne;
yng ne dorste him werne.
anhild was ful of mode;
wep teres of blode. 1520

e ledde hyre hom in derke,
o his newe werke.
e festes he by gonne,
ere aryse þe sonne. 1520

o was rymenild of mode;
rres hue wepte of blode.
No gap in MS. . . .
.]

in dreams of danger to Rymenhild.

ams that Rymenhild is shipwrecked, that she tries to swim to land, but that Fikenhild prevents her with his sw

nyȝt horn gan swete,
heuie for to mete
Rymenhild his make,
schupe was itake. 1524
chup bigan to blenche;
lemman scholde adrenche.

at nyȝt gan horn swete,
nd harde forto mete
f Reymyld hys make,
at in to schype was take. 1524
at schip scholde on hire blenche;
ys leman scholde adrenche.

lke nyht horn suete
on wel harde mete
f rymenild his make,
at in to shipe wes take. 1524
e ship gon ouerblenche;
lemmon shulde adrenche.

nenhild wiȝ hire honde
de vp to londe. 1528
nhild aȝen hire pelte
his swerdes hylte.

eymyld wit hire honde
olde suemme to londe. 1528
ykenyld hire ȝen pulte
/it his sword hylte.

Rymenild mid hire honde,
 wymme wolde to londe. 1528
 ykenild aȝeyn hire pylte,
 id his suerdes hylte.

akes, and tells Athulf his dream.

orn him wok of slape,
 . man þat hadde rape. 1532
 ulf,” he sede, “felaȝe,
 chupe we mote draȝe.
 nhild me haþ idon vnder,
 Rymenhild to do wunder. 1536
 t, for his wundes fiue,
 iȝt me þuder driue.”

No gap in MS.
]
 Ayol,” qwat horn, “trewe felawe,
 ito schip gonne we drawe.
 ykenyld haueþ gon onder,
 nd don Reynyld som wonder. 1536
 od, for his wordes fiue,
 o nyȝt us þyder driue.”

orn awek in is bed;
 f his lemmon he wes adred. 1532
 Apulf,” he seide, “felawe,
 o shipe nou we drawe.
 ykenild me haþ gon vnder,
 t do rymenild sum wonder. 1536
 rist, for his wondes fyue,
 o nyht þider vs dryue!”

n sets out to the rescue of Rymenhild.

diately sets sail, with a good wind.

n gan to schupe Ride,
feren him biside. 1540

gap in MS.
.]

enhild, or þe dai gan springe,
iȝt he ferde to þe kinge, 1544

orn gan to Scype Ride,
nd his knyȝtes by side. 1540

Horn gon to shipe ride, [leaf 92]
is knyhtes bi his side. 1540

e ship bigon to sture,
iþ wynd god of cure.
at fykenild her þe day springe,
side to þe kyng, 1544

l espouses Rymenhild by night, and leads her to his castle.

r Rymenhild þe brizte,
vedden hire biniȝte.
adde hure bi þe derke,
his nywe werke. 1548

fter rymenild þe brhyte,
at spousede hyre by nyhte.
e ladde hire by derke,
to is newe werke. 1548

in the feast before sunrise.

este hi bigunne,
at ros þe sunne.
ane horn hit wiste,
ore þe sunne vpriste. 1552

No gap in MS.
.]

ere schip bigan to terne
y þe wateres sterne. 1552

e feste hue bigonne,
 þen aryse þe sonne.
No gap in MS. . . .
]

ip arrives under the castle.

schup stod vnder ture,
 tymenhilde bure.

ys schip stod in store,
 onder fikenildes boure.

ornes ship atstod in stoure,
 nder fykenildes boure.

s not recognize the new castle, but meets Arnoldin, who is awaiting him,

enhild, litel wenep heo
 Horn þanne aliue beo. 1556
 astel þei ne knewe,
 he was so nywe.
gap in MS.
]

n fond sittinde Arnoldin,
 was Apulfes cosin,
 þer was in þat tide,
 n for tabide. 1564

e wiste horn on liue
 /har he was a Ryue. 1556
 e kestel he ne knewe,
 or he was so newe.
 e sond by gan to drye,
 nd hyt hym made weye. 1560

e fond stonde arnoldyn,
 at was ayolles cosyn,
 at was þere in tyde,
 orn for to abyde. 1564

uste horn a-lyue
 her he wes aryue. 1556
 ene castel hue ne knewe,
 or he was so newe.
 e see bigon to wiþ drawe;
 o seh horn his felawe, 1560
 e feyre knyht arnoldyn,
 it wes apulfes cosyn,
 at þer set in þat tyde,
 yng horn to abide. 1564

oldin explains the situation to Horn.

tells him that Fikenhild that day has wedded Rymenhild.

rn kniȝt,” he sede, “kinges sone,
 beo þu to londe icome.
 ay haþ y wedde fikenhild,
 wete lemman, Rymenhild. 1568
 schal i þe lie;
 iap giled þe twie.

e seyde, “horn, kynges sone,
 ʒel be þou here to londe come.
 ou hat wedded fikenyld
 y nowe lemman, Reymyld. 1568
 ele ich þe nowt lye;
 e haueþ þe gyled twye.

e seide, “kyng horn, kyngessone,
 ʒder þou art welcome.
 o day haþ sire Fykenild
 weddeþ þi wif, rymenild. 1568
 hite þe nou þis while;
 e haueþ do þe gyle.

ur he let make
or þine sake. 1572

nai þer come inne
an wiþ none ginne.
n, nu crist þe wisse,
ȝymenhild þat þu ne misse.” 1576

is castel he dude make
or Reymyldes sake. 1572
er may mo man on legge,
y paþe neby brigge.
orn, nou crist þe wisse,
f Reymyld þat þou ne misse.” 1576

s tour he dude make
for rymenildes sake. 1572
e may þer comen ynne
o mon wiþ no gynne.
Horn, nou crist þe wisse,
rmenild þat þou ne misse.” 1576

n enters the castle, disguised as a harper.

l some companions, disguise themselves as harpers, hiding their swords under their garments.

orn cuþe al þe liste
eni man of wiste.
þe he gan schewe,
tok felazes fewe, 1580
niȝtes suiþe snelle,
schrudde hem at wille.

orn her kenede al þe lyste
at any man of wiste.
o herpe he gan drawe,
nd wyȝt hys tweye felawe, 1580
nyȝtes swyþe felle,
nd schurde hem in pelle.

ȝorn coupe alle þe listes
 ȝt eni mon of wiste.
 ȝarpe he gon shewe,
 ȝt toc [KH9](#) him to felawe, 1580
 ȝyhtes of þe beste
 ȝt he euer hede of weste.

[KH.9](#) MS. tot

gap in MS.
]

eden bi þe grauel,
 ȝard þe castel.
 ȝunne murie singe,
 ȝmakede here gleowinge. 1588

ȝyt swerdes he hem gyrte
 nouen here schirte. 1584
 e wenden on þe grauel
 ȝward þe castel.
 e ȝonne murye synge,
 ȝnd makede here glewinge. 1588

ȝen o þe sherte
 ȝe gurden huem wiþ suerde. 1584
 ȝe eoden on þe grauele,
 ȝwart þe castele.
 ȝe ȝonne murie singe,
 ȝt makeden huere gleyngre, 1588

l hears their singing, and bids bring them in.

rymenhild hit gan ihere,
axede what hi were.
ede hi weren harpurs,
sume were gigours. 1592
lude horn in late,
at halle gate.
sette him on þe benche,
harpe for to clenche. 1596

at fykenyld myȝt yhere;
earkedede wat hye were.
len seyde hyt harperes,
ogelours and fipeleres. 1592
e dude hem in lete;
t halle dore he sete.
orn set on þe benche;
ys harpe he gan clenche. 1596

at fykenild mihte y-here;
e axede who hit were.
len seide hit were harpeirs,
ogelers ant fypelers. 1592
em me dude in lete;
halle dore hue sete.
orn sette him a benche;
harpe he gan clenche. 1596

kes a lay to Rymenhild, and she falls in a swoon.

nakede Rymenhilde lay,
heo madeke walaway.
Fienhild feol yswore;
was þer non þat loure. 1600
smot to hornes herte
witere þat hit smerte.

Re madeke Reymyld a lay,
and reynyld madeke weylawey.
Reymyld fel yswore;
so was þer non þat lowe. 1600
yt ȝede to hornes herte;
fore hym gan smerte.

Re made rymenild a lay,
at hue seide weylawey.
Rymenild fel y swore;
so nes þer non þat lowe. 1600
it smot horn to herte;
fore con him smerte.

ks on his ring and thinks of Rymenhild, then with his good sword slays Fienhild and all his men.

okede on þe ringe,
þoʒte on Rymenhilde. 1604

þede vp to borde,
gode suerdes orde.
ʒnhildes crune
ifulde adune, 1608
al his men arowe
lude adun þrowe!

ey lokede on hys gode Ryng,
nd Reymyld þe ʒonge. 1604

ey ʒede op to borde,
lid hys gode swerde.
ykenyldes crowne
e leyde þere adowne; 1608
nd alle hys men arewe
e dide adoun þrewe.

e lokede on is ryng,
nt o rymenild þe ʒynge. 1604

e eode vp to borde,
id his gode suorde.
ykenildes croune
e fel þer adoune; 1608
nt alle is men arowe
e dude adoun þrowe.

No gap in MS. . . .
.]

ʒn slays Fikenhild, and makes Arnoldyn king.

s Arnoldin king there, after Aylmer,

enne hi weren aslaȝe,
nchild hi dude to draȝe. 1612

n makede Arnoldin þare
ȝ, after king Aylmare,
l westnesse,
his meoknesse. 1616
ing and his homage
en Arnoldin trewage.

o he weren alle yslawe,
ykenyld he dide to drawe. 1612

e makede arnoldyn kyng þere,
fter þe kyng aylmere,
Vo gap in MS.

.]
e knytes and þe barnage
ude hym alle utrage.

it made arnoldyn kyng þere,
fter kyng aylmere, [1612]
þe kyng of westnesse,
or his mildenesse.
e kyng ant is baronage
uen him truage. [1616]

g with him Athulf and Rymenhild, sets out for King Modi's kingdom.

orn tok Rymenhild bi þe honde,
ladde hure to þe stronde, 1620
ladde wiþ him Aþelbrus,
ode stuard of his hus.

orn tok rymyld by þe hond,
nd ledde hire by þe se strond. 1620
e tok hym syre aylbrous,
tiward of þe kynges hous.

Horn toc rymentild by honde,
it ladde hire to stronde,
nt toc wiþ him Aþelbrus,
e gode stiward of hire fader hous. [1620]

e bigan to flowe,
horn gan to Rowe. 1624

e riuede in a reaume,
i a wel fayr streume, 1624
e see bigan to flowen, [leaf 92, back]
it hy faste to rowen.
ie aryueden vnder reme,
i a wel feyr streme. 1624

As King Modi, and makes Athelbrus king in his place.

unne for ariue
king modi was sire.
lfrus he madeþ þer king,
his gode teching. 1628
þaf alle þe kniȝtes ore,
horn kniȝtes lore.

er kyng mody was syre,
at horn slow wyt yre.
ybrous he madeþ þer kyng,
or hys gode tydyng; 1628
or syre hornes lore,
e was kyng þore.

ynge Mody wes kyng in þat lond;
it horn sloh wiþ is hond.
þelbrus he made þer kyng,
or his gode teching; 1628
or sire hornes lore
e wes mad kyng þore.

ulf weds Reynild, and Horn marries Rymenhild.

proceeds to Ireland, and causes Athulf to marry the princess Reynild.

n gan for to ride;
vind him bleu wel wide. 1632

riuede in yrlonde,
he wo fondede.
he dude Apulf child
lden maide Reynild. 1636

No gap in MS.
.]

orn ariuede in hyre londe,
er he hadde woned so longe.
er he dude ayol childe
edden mayden hermenylde. 1636

Horn eode to ryue;
e wynd him con wel dryue. 1632
e aryuede in yrlonde,
er horn wo coupe er fonde.
e made þer Apulf chyld
edde mayden ermenyld, 1636

returns to Sudenne, and makes Rymenhild his queen.

n com to suddenne,
ong al his kenne.
ienhild he makede his quene,
it miȝte wel beon. 1640

orn wente to sodenne,
o hys owe kunne.
eymyld he makede quene,
o ich Miyȝte wel bene. 1640

it horn com to sudenne,
o is oune kenne.
ymenild he made þer is quene,
o hit myhte bene. 1640

in true love, and cherish God's law. 'Nu ben hi boþe dede.'

þilk hem miȝte rewe,
loueden hem so trewe;
þen hi boþe dede;
t to heuene hem lede. 1644

endeþ þe tale of horn
fair was *and* noȝt vnorn.
e we vs glade Eure among,
þus him endeþ hornes song. 1648
s þat is of heuene king,
e vs alle his suete blessing.

lle folc hyt knewe
at he hem louede trewe.
ou ben he alle dede;
od hem to heuene lede. 1644
Vo gap in MS.
.]

trewe loue hue lyueden ay,
it wel hue loueden godes lay.
ou hue beoþ boþe dede,
rist to heouene vs lede. AmeN! 1644

X—PLI—CIT. Amen.

Am . . . e . . . n.

NOTES.

KING HORN.

Links generally lead to the next lower multiple of 4, corresponding to visible line numbers.

[4](#), H. *Allof*. An undoubted trace of the influence of the French version on the H text of the English version. The French has *Aaluf*.

[6](#). *laste*. Cf. 'Lay.' 7017: *þe while þe hit ilæste*.

[8](#). *Fairer* ... Cf. 'The Erl of Tolous' (ed. by G. Lüdtke, Berlin, 1881): *were no fayrer undyr hevyn, That any man myght see, Fayre myght none bee*. 354. Cf. also 980-1. Further, 'The King of Tars.' (Engl. Stud. xi. pp. 1 ff.): *Feirer miȝt non ben oliue* 8.

[10](#), C. *miste*. In many southern texts the s- initial has the phonetic value *sh-*. Hence here it is to be assumed that medial *-st-* has the pronunciation *-sht*, a loose way of representing the pronunciation of the *-ht*, *-ȝt* like German *-cht* in *nicht*, etc.

[11](#), [12](#). *rine* : *schine*. Cf. 'Lay.' 31889-90: *þa sunne gon to scine, Þe rein bigon to rine*; 28303, *muchel rein him gon rine*; 31086-7, *nis nan feirure wifmon þa whit sunne seineð on*.

[14](#). *briȝt so þe glas*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' (Weber, Early Engl. Romances, II.). 75. *And a lady þerinne was bryȝt as the sunne thorough glas*.

[15](#). *whit so þe flur*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.': *off that lady whyt so flour*, 128.

[17](#), [18](#). *bold* : *old*. Cf. 'The Erl of Tolous': *He was a feyr chyld and a bolde, Twenty wyntur he was oold*, 712-13; Reinbroun 4, 4. *Faire child he was and bolde, He was boutte seue winter olde*. 'Beues' 3899-3900: *Be þat he was seue winter old, He was a fair child and a bold*.

"Faire child he was ..." is Beues l. 52; "Be þat he was ..." is Reinbroun st. 4 l. 4.

[19](#), [20](#). *iliche*. Cf. 'Guy of Warwick' 1336: *In all þys worlde ys none hym lyke*.

[21](#), H. *tueye feren*. The H text here lacks one of the archaic features of the story, referring to only two companions, viz., Apulf and Fikenhild. The other ten, save for the abrupt introduction of Arnoldin at the conclusion, play no active part in the present version.

[23](#). *riche menne sones*. Cf. 'Lay.' 28932-3: *monies riches monnes sune, monie hæðene gume*.

[25](#). *for to* with infinitive. This is frequent, especially in H, and is probably due to French influence, *por à*. Cf. 166 L, 242 H, 388 C H, 902, 1011, 1186, etc.

[27.](#) *him het*. For frequent use of reflexives cf. 134 L, 140 C L, 147 C, 173 C, 233 L, 293 C, 294, 526 C, 307 C, 364, 398 C, 426, 806 L, 802 L, 1250, 1269, 1297-8, 1386, 1410, 1545.

[27.](#) H. *Athulf*. In the early part of the H text *th* is used in proper names.

[31-35.](#) Cf. 'Erl of Tolous' 181-3: *So hyt befell upon a day, The erl and he went to play, Be a reuer syde*. Cf. also 'Lyb. Disc.' 25, 26 (Ritson): *As hyt befelle upon a day, To wode he wente on hys play*; also 'Lay.' 25661 A, *bi þere sæ side*; 'Lyb. Disc.' 645-6: *Yesterday yn the mornynge y wente on my playnge*.

[42.](#) *sarazins*. The conventional enemy in mediaeval romance. Probably due to French influence and ultimately due to the stories originating in the crusades and in the struggles between Mohammedans and Christians culminating in the Battle of Tours.

[44.](#) *Ofer to londe brohte*. Murry mistakes them for merchants (cf. also 637-8). The whole incident, vv. 39-62, reminds one of the quite parallel historical incident of the first landing of the Northmen in 787, and the death of Beaduheard and his retinue.

[45.](#) *Payn*. Cf. Note on *Sarazins*, 42. *of herde*, an unusual combination. This is the only instance cited in Bradley-Stratmann.

[55.](#) *gunne* = 'did' intensive, as frequently. See *gan* in Glossary, also *con*, *coupe*, *began*.

[57.](#) *vnder schelde* means perhaps 'in arms.' Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 5691-3: *And yiff the sawdon off that land Myghte sloo Richard in that feeld With swerd or spere undyr scheeld*. Cf. also Wissmann's note.

[67-8.](#) *libbe : sibbe*. Cf. 'Lay.' 11605-6: *penne mazen we libben mid sæhten & mid sibben* (Wissmann).

[69.](#) *hi here*. The representatives of the OE. forms of the personal pronouns are usually very strictly adhered to. *þei*, *þe* occurs twice (55 L and 1557 C), *sche* once (380 L), 'their' and 'them,' not at all.

[69, 70.](#) *asoke : toke*. Cf. 'Lay.' 12114-16: *& sūme heo god wiðsoken & to haðenescipe token* (Wissmann). Also 'Lay.' 29187-8: *for crist seolue he for soc, and to þon wursen he tohc*.

[82.](#) L. *hundes*. Cf. also 91 L, 634 C H, 887, 1465, etc. For a possible explanation of the term cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 337-40: *Upon his creste a rede hounde. The taylor henge to the grounde. That was Sygnyfycacioun The hethene folke to brynge down*. Cf. [634 Note](#).

[89, 90.](#) *made*. Cf. 'Lay.' 28067-8: *deoren swið hende, þa ure drihten make* (Wissmann). The contracted form *made* of L H, is that of the original as shown by the rime and rhythm.

[92.](#) *quic flen* perhaps a trace of a primitive custom in this crystallized phrase (cf. also 1468 C).

[98.](#) *iseene*. Cf. Chaucer, 'Knight's Tale' 65: *Now be we caytifs as it is wel seene* (Wissmann).

[100.](#) *strong : long*. Cf. 'Havelok' 2242-3: *Non so fayr, ne non so long, ne non so mikel ne non so strong*.

[107.](#) C. *stere*. Cf. Glossary.

[109.](#) Cf. the parallel historical incident where Aethelstan sets his brother Eadwine adrift, in Thorpe's translation of Lappenberg's *England under the Anglo-Saxon Kings*, II, iii, London, 1845 (Wissmann).

[118.](#) *wringinde*. Cf. 'Havelok' 152: *He wrungen hondes and wepen sore* (Wissmann).

[121-122](#). *wo* : *þo*. A stereotyped couplet in romance. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 8429-30, 20383-4, 8677-8, ‘Sir Isumbras’ 380-1, 759-60, ‘Rich. C. de L.’ 6521-2.

[123](#). *Horns*. Perhaps a scribal error, so common in this MS.; perhaps a trace of the OF. inflection with -s in the nom. sing. Cf. *Horns* [1560 H](#), *enimis* 1023 C, 1024 H; also *page* and *crois* in Glossary.

[127](#). *flowe*. Cf. ‘Proverbs of Alfred,’ v. 197 (M. and S. selections): *Uppe þe see þat floweþ*. Kölbing (Eng. Stud. vi. 154) thinks *flowe* means ‘flood’ as distinguished from ‘ebb.’

[128](#). *rowe*. The ‘ship’ was a ‘galeie,’ cf. 199, 1084, 1086, etc.: cf. also ‘Rich. C. de L.’ 2521-4: *They rowede hard, and sungge ther too With henelow and [rumbelooo](#). The galeye wente also faste As quarrel dos off the arweblast*.

[131-2](#). *ywis* : *ymis*. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 19067-8: *for æuere heo wende ful iwis þat it weoren þe eorl Gorlois*.

[134](#). *sprang*. Cf. ‘Owl and Nighting.’ 734: *Wane þe lizt of daie springe*. Also ‘Ipomydon’ 776: *To-morrow, or the day sprynge*. Hence the modern word ‘dayspring.’ For reflexive phrase, *him sprong*, cf. [27 Note](#).

[150](#). *L. dawes*, the natural phonetic development from OE. nom. accus. plur. *dagas*. The more usual forms *daies*, *dayes*, are formed by analogy with the singular.

[161](#). C H. *hol and fer*. Cf. ‘Ass.’ 62 Cambr.: *so hol ne fer*.

[168](#). *dales and dune*. A common collocation of words. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 27352-3: *isezen alle þa dales, alle þa dunes* (Wissmann).

[170](#). *blessing*. The accent on the second syllables of dissyllabic words as revealed by the rimes in ‘Horn’ is an interesting feature. This accent is no doubt in part to be explained as a French characteristic, in part as the survival of an OE. secondary accent. For further instances cf. 209-10, 219-20, 233-4, 239-40, 243-4, 253-4, 263-4, 359-60, 467-8, 529-30, 609-10, 859-60, 1169-70, 1235-6, etc.

[174](#). *mild*. Cf. ‘Rich. C. de L.’ 6887-8: *Tho sayde to hym with mylde stevene*, also a frequent phrase in the ‘Assumption.’

[176](#). *beoþ [icumene](#)*. For other examples of *beon* as auxiliary cf. *bep ygo* 310 H, *am iorne* 1228 C, etc. Cf. also ‘Lay.’ 13838-9: *whæt cnihten 3e seon & whænnenen 3e icumen beon*.

[175 ff](#). Compare with Aylmer’s greeting the in many ways similar greeting of Vortiger to Hengest and Horsa. ‘Lay.’ 13826 ff.

[180-2](#). *Ne sau3 ihc ...* Cf. [180-2 Note](#).

[202](#). *sail and roþer*. Cf. ‘R. H.’ 60-61: *Kil naient auirum dunt a (!) seient aidan3 sigle ne guuernad (!) dunt il seient naian3*.

[204](#). *brymme*. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 272: *ferde bi þere sæ brimme* (Wissmann).

[206](#). *honde bihynde*. Cf. Wissmann’s parallel citations from Alexander (Weber, as above I.) 2013 ff. and ‘Chron. of Engl.’ (Ritson II.) 873.

[208](#). *spille*. Cf. ‘Havelok’ 242: *Helpe me nu in þis nede and late ye nouth mi bodi spille* (Wissmann).

[210](#). *Niping*. Cf. Wissmann’s note.

[221.](#) *schulle*. Cf. Wissmann's note and citation from 'Oct. Imp.' (Weber III.). 535. *to blowe swyþe schylle*.

[239 ff.](#) Horn's education. Cf. the similar scene in the later romance, 'Ipomydon' 32 ff., which, like 'Rich. C. de L.,' has many traits in common with King Horn, and was no doubt influenced by King Horn. (Weber, as above, II, pp. 281 ff.):

*A feyrer child myght no man see
Tholomew a clerk he toke,
That taught the chyld vppon the boke,
Bothe to synge and to rede;
And after he taught hym other dede;
Aftirward to serve in halle
Bothe to grete and to smalle
Before the kyng mete to kerve,
Hye and lowe feyre to serve:
Bothe of howndis and haukis game
Aftir he taught hym, all and same.
In se, in feld, and eke in ryuere
In wodde to chase the wild dere
And in the feld to ryde a stede
That all men had joy of his dede*

Verses 67-70 of 'Ipomydon' remind more directly of the French version, 'R. H.,' so that perhaps it was by this version of the Horn story that the composer of 'Ipomydon' was influenced.

[244.](#) *Of wude and of riuere*. Cf. the similar phrase in 'R. H.' 377: *De bois e de riuere, refait il autre tal*.

[247 ff.](#) Cf. 'Lay.' 4893 ff.: *Brennes wes swiðe hende^v his hap wes þe betere. Brennes cuðe on hundes, Brennes cuðe on hauekes, he cuðe mid his honden hanlie þa harpe*.

[250.](#) *Cupe serue*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' (as above) 295, where the princess says to Ipomydon, "*Of the cuppe ye shall serve me,*" and 320 where Ipomydon does serve with the cup. Cf. also 'R. H.' 471: *Horn serui le rei bien de la cupe acel ior*.

[264 ff.](#) Cf. the apparently borrowed scene in 'Rich. C. de L.' vv. 879 ff., where the princess falls in love with the captive Richard and bids the jailer, "*And aftir soper, in the evenyng, To my chaumbyr thow hym bryng In the atyr of a squyer*" (909-11).

[266.](#) *He* = 'she' as elsewhere (OE. *hēo*): *mest in þozte*. For similar phrase cf. Wissmann 254 Note.

[268](#) *wexe wild*. A popular word combination. Cf. 'Proverbs of Hendyng' (Böddiker's ed.) 121: *Ne wax þou nout to wilde* (Wissmann).

[275.](#) *Bi daie ne bi nizte*. Cf. 'Erl of Tolous' 42: *Be dayes and be nyght*. 'Launfal' 412: *Be dayes ne be nyzt*. 'Lay.' 13829: *bi dæie no bi nihtes*, etc.

[282.](#) *him þuzte*. Cf. Wissmann's note with incorrect reference to 'Lay.' 312. See present volume, [268 Note](#).

[300.](#) *wed broþer*. Cf. Glossary.

[315.](#) *sette him on bedde*. The usual mode of entertainment. Cf. 'Beues of Hampton' (E.E.T.S.) 1090; 'Guy of W.' (E.E.T.S.) 3043; 'Sir Eglamour' 679: *sche sett hym on hur beddys syde*.

[319 ff.](#) For other instances of the maiden wooing the man see 'Beues of H.' 1093 ff.; 'Amis and Amiloun' 550 ff.; 'Sir Eglamour' 674 ff., etc.

[321.](#) *trewþe plizte*. Cf. 'Sir Eglamour' 674: *Therto ther trowthys they plyght*. 'Erl of Tolous' 210: *Therto my trouth y plyght*, etc., frequently.

[333.](#) *bi one ribbe*. Not clear. Cf. Wissmann's Note, also Kölbing (Engl. Stud. vi. 155), who translates *bi*, 'im bezug auf,' 'with reference to.'

[341.](#) *fule þeof*. Cf. 'Havelok' 1780: *Goth henne swiþe fule þeues* (Wissmann).

[350.](#) *mote þu deie*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 6858: *God geve the wel evyl pyne*; 6862, *God geve you wel evyl endyng*.

[364.](#) *hou one*. Cf. 559 C H, 650 C H, also Glossary. The OE. weak form *āna* seems to have the same experience as *seolfa*, 'self.'

[366.](#) vs *wroþe*. *wroþe* means 'fearful' (Mätzner).

[373.](#) *makeð hire bliþe*. Cf. 'Havelok' 2244, 'Rich. C. de L.' 1606 (Wissmann).

[378.](#) *squieres wise*. Cf. [264 Note](#).

[379.](#) *C. pleie*. Cf. 'Lyb. Disc.' 25-26: *As hyt befelle upon a day To wode he wente on hys play*.

[387-8.](#) *kyng on benche*. Cf. 'Lay.' 14963-4: & *heo gon scenchen, on þas kinges benche*. Also 'Ipomydon' 229: *Of þe cuppe ye shall serve me*. Cf. also 1185.

[403.](#) *On knes he him sette*. The conventional mode of salutation. Cf. 'Lay.' 22147-8: *Comen to þan ki[n]ge, & setten an heore cneowen*. Cf. also 'Lay.' 13821 and 'King of Tars.' 719: & *gret hir feir vpon his kne*, also 90, 221. 'Guy of Warwick' 161-2: *Gye on his kneys sone hym sett, And that mayden feyre he grett*. 'Rich. C. de L.' 891-3, 1591; 'Ypotis' 15: *On his kne he hym sette. Well fayr þe emperour þer he grette*. 'Ipomydon' 267-8: *Ipomydon on knees hym sette And the lady feyre grette*. 187-8: *Vppon his knees he hym sette, And þe kyng full feyr he grette*. Cf. also 902-3, also 'Erl of Tolous' 1066: *To the emperour he knelyd blyve*. Cf. Wissmann's Note.

[405-6.](#) *of his feire sizte ...* Cf. 'R. H.' 1053: *De la belte de horn tute la chambre resplent*. Compare with this the flame which came from Havelok's mouth when he slept.

[420.](#) *honde*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 2164: *Ipomydon toke hyr by the hond*. Cf. also 'Havelok' 408; 'Amis and Am.' 550 ff.; 'Guy of W.' 217 ff.; 'Rich. C. de L.' 891-3: *Fayr he grette that lady bryght, And sayde to her with herte free, What is thy wille, Lady, with me*.

[425.](#) *ofte heo hine custe ...* Cf. 'Lay.' 5012-14: *bitwixen hire ærmes heo hine nom, ofte heo hine clupte, & ofte heo hine custe*.

[436.](#) *liþe*. Cf. 'Life of Alex.' 431: *He wol solace me and lythe and in this care make me blythe*, and 'Will. de Shoreham' (ed. Wright), p. 19: *and lytheth oure pyne*.

[437.](#) *wiþute strif*. Cf. 'Erl of Tolous' 240: *Wythoute any stryfe*. 'Ipomydon' 1607-8: *He sayd, he wold haue hyr to wyffe, If she wold withouten stryff*.

[440.](#) *plis*. Cf. [10 Note](#); *trewþe*. Cf. [321 Note](#), also Wissmann's Note.

[441-2.](#) *biþo3te : mi3te*. Cf. 'Lay.' 28410-11: *Modred þa þohte, what he don mihte* (Wissmann).

[450.](#) *H. þy fader fundlyng*. An instance of the preservation of the OE. 'irregular' genitive form. Cf. also 116 C H, 951 H; *moder* 1485 C.

- [451.](#) ... *cunde*. 'It would not be in keeping with thy rank' (Mätzner).
- [452.](#) *welde*. Cf. 324.
- [454.](#) *wedding*. Cf. Wissmann's ref. to Grimm, Rechtsalt. 439.
- [458.](#) *iswoȝe*. Swoons are frequent in mediaeval romance. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 873-8: *Uppon hyr bedde she gan downe falle On swoone, afore hyr maydens alle*. Cf. also Wissmann's Note.
- [464.](#) *stere*. Cf. 'Ritson' III. 35, 825: *Ther myght no man hure stere* (Wissmann).
- [473.](#) C. *þat swete þing*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 1021: *Than sory was that swete thyng*. 'King of Tars.' 374: *For Maries loue, þat swete þing*; 'Lyb. Disc.' 2127, 'Fl. and Bl.' 272 T, etc.
- [474.](#) *swoȝning*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 875: *And whan she roos of swounyng*.
- [478.](#) C. *seue nigt*, a 'week,' like 'fortnight.'
- [480.](#) *cuppe* : *vppe*. Cf. also 1205-6, where the couplet is a stereotyped one and does not fit.
- [482.](#) *foreward*. Cf. 'Erl of Tolous': *Yschall hold thy forward god*; also 'Lay.' III. 177 (Wissmann).
- [485.](#) *adun falle*. Cf. [403 Note](#).
- [486.](#) *halle*. Cf. 'Havelok' 157: *Bifore þe king into þe halle* (Wissmann).
- [492.](#) *bede*. Cf. Wissmann's Note.
- [506.](#) *mid þe beste*. Cf. 'Lay.' 20449: *cniht mid þam beste*, also 23259.
- [520.](#) *derling*. Cf. 'Lay.' A. 28342: *i-sloȝen is Angell þe king, þe wes min aȝen deorling*.
- [524.](#) *sprang*. Cf. [134 Note](#), also 'Lay.' A. 28314: *ase þe dæi gon lihte*.
- [526.](#) *þuȝte lang*. 'Lay.' A. 28297: *feouwertyne niht him þuhte to lōȝ*.
- [537.](#) *fel a knes*. Cf. [403 Note](#).
- [562.](#) C. *þuȝte god*. Cf. 'Life of Alex.' 1145 (Wissmann); also 'Ipomydon' 599: *And of his comyng she was glad*; and 'Lay.' 13832: *for eouwer cumen ich æm bliðe*.
- [572.](#) *vnbynd me of my pine*. Cf. 'Fl. and Bl.' 308: *of care vnbynde*.
- [573-4.](#) *stille* : *wille*. Cf. 'Seven Sages' (Weber III.) 485 (Wissmann).
- [581.](#) *mestere*. Cf. 'Sir Eglamour' 252, The knight must accomplish "*dedes of armys thre*" before he can marry the princess. Cf. the similar conditions in 'Guy of Warwick.'
- [586.](#) L. *forsake*, 'give up,' 'renounce.' Cf. Wissmann's Note and Ritson II. 70 ff., 159.
- [595.](#) *gold ring*. The ring element is almost invariably present in mediaeval romance. Cf. 'Guy of W.' 7264; 'Sir Eglamour' 617-21; 'Ipomydon' 2060 ff.; 'Rich. C. de L.' 1635 ff.; 'Erl of Tolous' 392, 1029, 1077; 'Fl. and Bl.' etc. Cf. also discussion of the subject in Child's Engl. and Scot. Metr. Ballads I. pp. 194 ff.
- [607.](#) C. *of drad*. Cf. 'Havelok' 278: *Al Engeland was of him adrad* (Wissmann).
- [619.](#) *Leue at hire he nam*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 745-6: *They toke there leue at the quene. And wente forthe all by dene*.
- [624.](#) *blak so eny cole*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 2182: *rede as any blode*. 'Rich. C. de L.' 1515: *Vpon a stede whyt so mylke*. 'Ipomydon' 645: *That one (steed) was white as any mylke*. 'Rich. C. de L.' 824: *ded as ony stone*. 'K. Horn' 532 L H: *red so eny glede*.

[628](#). *gan denie*. Cf. 'Lay.' 27441: *þa eorðen gon to dunien* (Wissmann). 'Beowulf' 226: *syr can hrysedon*.

[631-2](#). *while : myle*. Cf. Wissmann's Note with parallel references to 'Lay.' I. 248; 'Squyr of Lowe Degree' 489; 'Lyb. Disc.' 5, v. 103 (Ritson II.); also Wolfram's *Parz.* 132, 16.

[634](#). *heþene hunde*. Cf. 'Lay.' 28982, 29202, etc.: *heðene hundes alle*; 'King of Tars.' 92 (Ritson II.).

[637-8](#). Cf. [44 Note](#).

[640](#). *wordes bolde*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 2407: *And I say thee wordes bold*.

[641-2](#). *wynne : inne*. Cf. 'Chron. of Engl.' 465-6: *Engelond to bywynne And sle that ther weren ynne* (Wissmann).

[643](#). *swerd gripe*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 4471: *Her weþene he gunne þer to gripe*; also 5070.

[649-50](#). *Abute horn al one*. Cf. 'Beues' 3885, 4403: *Al aboute þai gonne þringe*. Also 'Guy of W.' 1072: *And þey aboute syr Gye can goo*.

[659](#). *H. maister gen. sing.* Another trace of French influence on this text, the French *gen. sing.* without ending. Cf. *enimis* 1024 H, *Horns* 123 L.

[678](#). *L H. lite stounde*. Cf. 'Life of Alex.' 947; 'Chron. of Engl.' 469 (Wissmann).

[681](#). *C. wile izolde*. Cf. 'worth while.' Cf. Wissmann's parallel citations; 'Life of Alex.' 734; 'Chron. of Eng.' 871, etc.

[684](#). *huntinge*. Cf. 'Erl of Tolous' 937: *He rod on huntyng on a day*. 'Guy of W.' 1315: *On huntyng Gye went on a day*. Hunting was a favourite amusement at the time of the Danish invasions, as we know from the life of Alfred.

[692](#). *C. sat on þe sunne*. The sun shone in the bower. Cf. Wissmann's citation from *The Squire of L. D.*: *Anone that lady, fayr and fre, Vndyd a pynne of yvere, And wyd the windowes open set; The sonne schone in at her closet*.

[710](#). *turne þine sweuene*. Cf. 'Lay.' 25573: *Let þu mi sweuen to selþen iturnen* (Wissmann).

[716](#). *treuþe iþe plizte*. Cf. [321 Note](#).

[729](#). *bi sture* refers to one of the rivers Stour. Cf. like opinions of Mätzner and Wissmann.

[731 ff.](#) Cf. 'Guy of W.' 3065 ff.; 'Amis and Amil.' 781 ff.; and 'Rich. C. de L.' 1000, for other instances of betrayal.

[734](#). *berne*. Not clear. Cf. Mätzner, *Ae. Sprachproben*, p. 219.

[740](#). *Vnder couerture*. Cf. 'Life of Alex.' 549: *In he cam to here bur and crape under hire couertour* (Wissmann).

[767-8](#). *L H.* Meaning somewhat obscure. Cf. Wissmann's Note with somewhat parallel citation from 'The Squire of L. D.' 507 ff.: *his drawen swerd in his hande, There was no more with him wolde stande*.

[779](#). *haue wel godneday*. Common form of parting salutation. Cf. 'Lay.' 26002, 32187 (Wissmann); also 'Rich. C. de L.' 106: *Lemman haue thou good day*. 'Ipomydon' 463: *Have good day; noue wille I fare*, etc.

[780.](#) *No leng abiden.* Cf. 'King of Tars.' 283, 314, 760: *The messengers nold no leng abide.* Also 'Yw. and Gaw.' (Ritson I.) 2673-4: *He said, No lenger dwell I ne may Beleves wele, and haves goday.* Cf. also 'Assumption' 142 C, 288 A.

[783-4.](#) *wune þere : seue zere.* Cf. 'Lay.' 29437-8, also 30088-9 (Wissmann). Seven years, like seven days, is a period of time conventional in romance. Cf. 'Squire of L. D.' 117: *I haue thee loved this seven yere.* Also 'Beues' 1274, 3835, 3897, etc. Cf. also Grimm, Rechtsalt. 214.

[798.](#) *Kep wel.* Cf. 'Beues' 2372: *I pray þe kepe wel Iosian.*

[808.](#) *westene londe.* Ireland, without a doubt. Westnesse as distinguished from estnesse; Aylmer's kingdom as distinguished from Murry's.

[809.](#) L H. *stonde*, spring up, rise. Cf. 'Lay.' 20509: *wind stod.*

[827 ff.](#) Cf. the description of the coming of Hengest ('Lay.' 13785 ff.).

[829.](#) *Also mot i sterue.* For other forms of asseveration cf. 179, 197, 365, 437, 709, 1131, 1259, etc.

[831.](#) *Ne saȝ i neure.* Cf. 'Lay.' 13830-1: *bi dæie no bi nihtes ne sæh ich nauere ær swulche cnihtes.* Cf. also 180-2, also ['Beowulf'](#) 246-7: *Næfre ic mǣran geseah eorla ofer eorþan þonne is ēower sum.*

[834.](#) Cf. [403 Note.](#)

[836.](#) Cf. 'Lay' 13816 ff.

[838.](#) L. *hauen to done.* Cf. 'Seven Sages' 452: *With me ne hadde he neuer to done.* 'Life of Alex.' 1429: *There he hadde thought to done, Ac he hit aleyde sone* (Wissmann).

[839.](#) *bitak ... to werie.* Cf. 'Lay.' 3021 (Wissmann).

[841.](#) *faireste man.* 'Lay.' 13797-8: *þis weoren þe færeste men þat auere her comen.*

[848.](#) *Tak him pine glorie.* Cf. Wissmann, Note, also Kölbing (Engl. Stud. vi, 156). The glove had many significations. It might be used as a sign of challenge (cf. 'Erl of Tolous' 1100); or it might signify a handing over of authority from a superior to a subordinate (Grimm, Rechtsalt. 154, 4). It is in this latter way that Kölbing believes the word to be used here in Horn. When a prince for any reason left his land, he must leave some one behind, *to hold the court* ('Sir Tristrem,' v. 1985), and must supply this one with the badge of authority. This opinion of Kölbing's seems very plausible. It is interesting, however, to note two other uses of the glove. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 5696-1: *Thertoo I holde, Thertoo my glove* (= 'make agreement'). And 'R. H.' 909-11 C: *E horn uent cuntre li cumme il iest costumez, E lespée e les gaunz sire dist ca donez, Issil soleit faire ainz quil fust encusez.* The clue to the meaning might be suggested by either one of these phrases. One thing seems certain; in our poem (K. H.) the king's meaning is that Horn should be left at home. This is the meaning in R. H. 2324-6: *Si alez doneer k'od vus ne le menez, K'il est de belté issi inluminez. Ke vus là ù il ert, petit serrez preisez.*

[861.](#) C. *site stille.* Cf. 'Lay.' 28173, 24866: *sitted adun stille cnihtes inne halle* (Wissmann).

[867 ff.](#) Regarding the custom of single combat, cf. 'Publ. of Mod. Lang. Assoc. of America' xv. pp. 228, 230. Cf. also the triple combat in 'Rich. C. de L.' 5691 ff. Cf. also the Arundel MS. version (French) of 'Havelok,' in which Havelok overcomes Hadulf in single combat and thus regains his Danish kingdom.

[876-7.](#) *þat on : þat oþer.* Cf. 'Lay.' 29215-16: *him seoluen he heol þat ane, Isembard þat oðer.*

[881-2](#). *to rede : alle dede*. Cf. 'Havelok' 118: *Louerd what schal me to rede*; Bøddeker, G. L., ix. 16, *sone, what shal me to rede* (Wissmann). Also 'Lay.' 13904-5: *her-of þou most ræden, oðer alle we beoð dæden*.

[886](#). *wip* used in the OE. sense 'against.' Cf. the use of *on* (= 'in') and *at*, [619 Note](#). (= 'from') in Glossary.

[895](#). H. *ros of bedde*. Cf. 'Lay.' 6717: *þe king aros of bedde* (Wissmann).

[904](#). H. *to gedere smiten*. 'Lay.' 25605: *heo smiten heom to-gaderen* (Wissmann).

[909](#). *on a grene*. Inconsistent with 'at Cristesmasse,' v. 853.

[911 ff.](#) Cf. Wissmann's Note.

[921-2](#). *King Mory*. This is one of several references to a fuller, longer tale, in which Murry must have played a more important rôle. Cf. vv. 4 ff. and the abrupt introduction of Arnoldin, 1561.

[925](#). *agrise*. Cf. 'King of Tars.' 1202: *so sore hem gan agrise*.

[931](#). *rynge*. Unlike the ring in the Scotch ballads and in H. C. the ring in this version serves as a protection.

[933-4](#). *smerte*. Cf. 'Havelok' 2646: *þorw þe brest unto þe herte þe dint bigan ful sore to smerte* (Wissmann).

[935](#). *sturne*. Cf. 'Lay.' 25841, 6732 (Wissmann).

[947-8](#). H. *stounde : grounde*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 4537-8: *Soone, withinne a lytyl stounde The moste party yede to grounde*.

[952](#). *fader*. OE. gen. sing. Cf. 116 'C. H.'

[964 ff.](#) Cf. the similar offer made to Brennes by Sequin, 'Lay.' 4919 ff.

[974](#). *lofte*. In the sense 'women's apartments' seems to be of Norse origin. Cf. Skeat, Etymol. Dict., also Wissmann, 928 Note. Cf. also 1050 L. It seems probable that the women's apartments were in the 'tower.' Cf. also Kölbing (Engl. Stud. vi. 155).

[1002-3](#). *dude* seems to be used in the modern, intensive sense, and not as 'cause to' or 'put.'

[1010-11](#). For similar situations cf. 'Guy of W.' 1315-16: *On huntyng Gye went on a day, He mett a palmer by the way*. Also 'Erl of Tolous' 937-8: *He rode on huntyng on a day, A marchand mett he be þe way*. Cf. also 'Beues' 1300 ff.

[1021-2](#). *wedde : bedde*. Cf. 'Lay.' 31126-7 B: *he þat maide weddede, and nam hire to his bedde*.

[1024](#). H. *enimis*. Perhaps trace of OF. nom. sing. ending in -s, due to French scribe. Cf. [123 Note](#).

[1034](#). *bidere*, error for *bitere* (?).

[1056](#). *wringe*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 876: *Hir handes fast gan she wringe*.

[1068](#). *linne*. Hortative (?).

[1073](#). *knizt mid þe beste*. A common phrase. Cf. 'Lay.' 20449, etc.

[1077-8](#). *sonde : londe*. Cf. 'Lay.' 28676-7: *and sende his sonde wide zeond his londe*.

[1089](#). *striken*. Stratmann suggests 'strip.'

[1091-2](#). H. *yronge : ysonge*. Cf. 'Lay.' 29441-2: *no belle irungen. no masse isunge*.

[1093.](#) *word bigan to springe*. Cf. 'Havel.' 959: *of him ful wide þe word sprong*. 'Lay.' 26242: *Wel wide sprong þas eorles word* (Wissmann). Also 'King of Tars.' 1065: *þe word wel wide sprong*. 'Lyb. Disc.' 264 ff.: *Hys name ys spronge wide*.

[1102.](#) *sprunge of stone*. The simile is one of quickness that of a spark from the stone in striking a light, like modern "quick as a flash." Cf. *He sprange als any spark one glede*, 'Sir Isumbras,' 451.

[1103-4.](#) *mette : grette*. A very common rime. Cf. 'Lay.' 31041-2: *þer he hine mette and fæire hine grette*. 'Beues' 2051-2: *þar wiþ a palmer he mette, And swiþe faire he him grette*.

[1117.](#) *nolde*. Cf. 'Lay' 28900: *and seiden þat he nolde*.

[1118](#) L. *ispused wiþ golde*. Reference, probably, to an old custom of buying the bride.

[1121.](#) *Myd strenche*. Cf. 'Squire of L. D.' 443 (Wissmann).

[1132 ff.](#) *chaungi wede*. Compare with this 'Beues' 2051 ff., where Beues meets a palmer, learns from him the news, exchanges garments with him, and in disguise goes to see Iosiane after an absence of seven years. Disguises are an almost universal feature of these mediaeval tales. Cf. Brian's disguise in 'Pierre de Langt.' (Rolls Series), pp. 248-350. Cf. also disguises in 'Guy of W.', 'Layamon' (17637 ff.), 'Ypomydon', 'Rich. C. de L.', 'Isumbras,' etc. They are frequent in Germanic story from the stories of Thor down.

[1134.](#) *sclauyne*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 611-12: *with pyke and with sclavyn, As palmers were in Paynim*.

[1139.](#) *horn his = Hornes*, evidently due to scribe's mistake in hearing.

[1144.](#) *bicolmede*. Cf. 'Lay.' 17700-1, *iblcæched he hæfde his licame: swulc ismitte of cole*.

[1147-8.](#) *gateward*. Cf. 'Ipomydon' 245-6: *They com to the castelle-gate, The porter was redy there at*.

[1155.](#) *abugge*. Cf. 'Lay.' 3841, 8159 (Wissm.).

[1158.](#) L. *rake*. Cf. 'Beues' 2183: *Let me wiþ þe reke*.

[1164.](#) *zerne*. Cf. Ritson, II. 25, 589: *þe mayde cryde yerne* (Wissm.).

[1184 ff.](#) Cf. the story of Brian, 'Lay.' III., pp. 234-8: Brian, disguised as a palmer, enters the banqueting hall. Galarne, his sister, the queen, serves the guests to drink from a bowl. She recognizes Brian, and gives him a ring in token of recognition.

[1185-6.](#) *benche : schenche*. Cf. 'Lay.' 14963-4: *& heo gon scenchen on þas kinges benche*. Cf. also 'Beowulf,' 1226-54.

[1190.](#) *so laze was in londe*. Cf. 'Rich. C. de L.': *Thenne as hit was lawe of land* (Wissm.).

[1191-2.](#) *Hye drank of þe bere To knyht and to squiere*. An old Germanic custom. Cf. Wissmann, 'Untersuchungen' ('Q. u. F.' xvi. Strassb., 1876), p. 110.

[1202.](#) *brune*. Cf. Wissm., 1142 Note, also Kölbing ('Engl. Stud.' vi. 156). Wissmann takes *brun* to be a collective referring to 'beer.' Kölbing, with greater probability, takes *brun* to mean an ordinary brown horn, as distinguished from the *cuppe white*, which she has laid down, 1201.

[1204.](#) *glotoun*. The same phrase in Wolfram's 'Parz.': *si wænde, er wære ein garzūn* (Wissm.).

[1206.](#) *þing*, probably a mistake for *ring*. Cf. 479-80.

[1240.](#) *vnder wude lize*. Cf. ‘Lay’: *Ich eou wille leden forð to mine lauerd i þon wade rime þer he under rise lið* (Wissm.).

[1259.](#) *bi seint gile*. Cf. Wissm. 1197 Note. Cf. also [829 Note](#).

[1275.](#) *custe*. Cf. ‘Erl of Tolous’ 401: *And kyssyde hyt fele sythe*. Cf. also [425 Note](#).

[1281-2.](#) *Heo feol on hire bedde*. Cf. ‘Erl of Tolous’ 871, 875: *He hent a knyfe with all his mayn ... And fell in swoun upon hys bedd*; also ‘Ipomydon’ 871 ff.: *Uppon hyr bedde she gan downe falle*. Cf. also 458, 792.

[1282.](#) *H. gredde*. Cf. ‘Beues’ 2151: *After Bonefas 3he gan grede*.

[1297.](#) *L, H. kuste*. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 15017-18, 5012-14.

[1304.](#) *wrope*. Cf. [366 Note](#).

[1311-12.](#) *bure : ture*. Cf. ‘Havelok’ 2072-3: *I shal lene þe a bowr þat is up in þe heye tour*.

[1321-2.](#) *ywis : blis*. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 7605-7 B: *Mochel was þe blisse þat hii makede mid iwisse*.

[1335.](#) *wunder*. Cf. Mätzner 1247 Note.

[1336.](#) *falsede*. Early instance of a hybrid word.

[1398.](#) *crouch*. Lat. *crucem*, OE. *cru*ce*.

1335. *wunder*. Cf. Mätzner 1247 Note.

1336. *falsede*. Early instance of a hybrid word.

1398. *crouch*. Lat. *crucem*, OE. *cruce**.

1410. *hym agros*. Cf. 924 Note.

[1410.](#) *hym agros*. Cf. [925 Note](#).

[1419.](#) *kepe þis passage*. Cf. ‘Beowulf’ 230 ff.: *se þe holmc lifu healdan scolde*, etc.

[1420.](#) *of age*. This phrase seems to have very nearly its modern meaning, and if so, is probably the earliest recorded instance. Cf. New Oxford Dict.

[1422.](#) *bi este C, by weste L H*. This confusion, here as elsewhere, seems due to changing points of view. *Westernes* is of course west to *Suddenne*, and both are east to *Yrlonde*.

[1428.](#) *þe rizte*, direct. Cf. Wissmann, 1356 Note.

[1462.](#) *I blessed beo þe time*. Cf. ‘Havel.’ 1215; ‘Chron. of Engl.’ 705 (Wissmann).

[1465-6.](#) *teche : speche*. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 26544: *for þus we eou scullen techen ure Bruttisce speche*, and 26834: *Nu is we wulle teche Bruttisce spæche*. For a very similar use cf. ‘Lay.’ 18424-25: *we scullen heom to teon & tiðende tellen*; 20605-6, *and we heom sculleð tellen Bruttisce spelles*; 21698, *sorhfulle spelles*; 24942, *3eomere spelles*. In all these instances, as in the phrase in K. H., the meaning seems to be to inflict dire punishment. Cf. also ‘Lay.’ 23503-4: *& techen heō to riden þene wæi touward Romen*.

[1467-8.](#) *sle : fle*. Cf. ‘Lay.’ 6417-18: *oðer mid fure he lette hom slæn · oðer he heom lette quic flan*. Cf. also ‘Lay.’ 27376-7, 29049-50; ‘Life of Alex.’ 1734 (Wissmann). Cf. also ‘Havelok,’ 612: *He shal hem hangen, or quik flo*. For details of the flaying, cf. ‘Havelok’ 2492 ff.

[1469.](#) *horn to blowe*. In both French versions of 'Havelok,' Havelok proves his identity in Denmark by his ability to blow the horn which Sigar presents to him, and which no one else can blow. Cf. also 'Beues' 3377: *Saber is horn began to blow, þat his ost him scholde knowe*. Cf. also Roland's horn in the Song of Roland and a similar incident in the German romance, 'König Rother.'

[1481-2.](#) *wurche : churche*. Cf. 'Lay.' 10205-6: *chirchen he lettē areren monie & wel iwhare*; also 29531-2.

[1483-4.](#) *ringe : singe*. Cf. 'Havelok' 242: *Belles he deden sone ringen, monkes and prestes masse singen* (Wissmann).

[1487.](#) L. *cleten*. Scribal error for *clepten*.

[1501-2.](#) L H. *ston ... lym ...* The combination of stone and lime is probably a sign of French influence on MSS. L and H. Cf. R. H. 5047: *de pere e de furment*. Cf. also 'Erl of Tolous' 467: *Was made of lyme and stone*; also 'Sir Eglamour,' 252.

[1509-10.](#) *wende : schende*. Cf. 'Lay.' 1793-9: *Ðe kaisere wende Walwaī to scende*.

[1516-17.](#) For mode of marriage cf. 'Rich. C. de L.' 185-8.

[1518.](#) *newe werke*. Cf. 'Rob. of Glouc.' p. 449 (Wissmann).

The following single line was printed at the end of the section, after the note to l. 1574.

[1536.](#) *wunder* = harm, evil. Cf. Mätzner, 1247 Note, 1422 Note.

[1537.](#) *wundes fiue*. Cf. 'King of Tars.' 57: *þat suffred wowndes fiue*.

[1574.](#) *ginne*. Cf. 'Lay.' 30567: *þurh nanes cunnes giñe* (Wissmann).

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**King Horn,
Floris and Blauncheflur,
The Assumption of our Lady.**

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INTRODUCTION.

FLORIS AND BLAUNCHEFLUR.

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§ 1. INTRODUCTORY.

IF in King Horn we have a story Germanic in descent, and betraying everywhere traces of its Germanic origin, in Floris and Blauncheflur we have a romance of extraneous, probably ultimately of oriental origin, and the contrast is in many ways interesting and instructive. The love element, which in King Horn plays so large a part, in Fl. and Bl. is the all in all. This story of all-absorbing passion, which in spite of seemingly insurmountable obstacles and desperate perils, in the end reunites the devoted lovers, was one of the most popular during the Middle Ages, and one of the earliest to be imported from the East. The history of the tale vies in interest with the story itself. The story in a perplexing variety of versions spread over all the countries of Christendom, as we shall see later. It seems to be the basis of the charming *chante-fable*, Aucassin and Nicolette, which Andrew Lang and Walter Pater have made so

well known to the modern world. The English version, which unfortunately is incomplete at the beginning in each one of the four manuscripts in which it has been written down, was probably derived directly from one of the French versions, as we shall see.

§ 2. HISTORY.

(a) Origin.

The story of Floris and Blancheflur is probably an oriental product, and shows many traces of Byzantine influence. It was one of the first of these oriental tales to be retailed in the Occident and had a wide circulation in all the countries of western Christendom, from Spain and Italy to the Scandinavian North. Its route from East to West it is not easy to trace with certainty, though the Crusades were quite probably the means of its importation. Further than this it is not easy to determine. The Provençals, whose active part in the Crusades is well known, may have been the agents, or, as is so often the case with the oriental tales, it may have been imported in a Latin dress.

The history of the story in the West is complicated on account of the puzzling multiplicity of versions among which it is sometimes exceedingly difficult to determine the interrelations. The clue to the difficulty was early hinted at by Sommer (E. Sommer, Einl. zu R. Fleckes Flore und Blaunscheflur, Quedlingburg und Leipzig, 1846), and more recently the matter has been very thoroughly explained by Herzog (H. Herzog, Die beiden Sagenkreise von Flore und Blanscheflur, Wien, 1884) in his investigation of the subject. Herzog points out that there are to be distinguished in the Occident, two distinct general versions of the story. In the first of these, **A**, seems to be preserved the story in its original and genuine form. The second of these versions, **B**, seems to be a remodelling of the original version in the attempt to adapt to common folk a story in its existing form intended for higher circles of society. [1.13](#) For this purpose slight allusions in **A**, are expanded in **B** into striking incidents. To bring out into strong light the injustice of Floris's father and the final triumph of true love, supernatural and horrible elements and episodes are introduced. Since these new elements are of a kind common in other Byzantine tales, it is concluded that the remodelling of the story had already taken place before the importation from the East.

The second of these imported versions, **B**, first circulated in Italy, in Spain and in Greece. It also seems, somewhat indirectly as we shall see, to have served as a basis for the second French version and for one group of the German *Volksbücher*. The versions of **B**, if we leave the second French version out of consideration, all represent the parents of Blauncheflur as Italian, and in part have the same names for the characters. This circumstance, with other corroborating facts, seems to indicate that version **B** first took root in Italy, and from there spread into Spain and into Greece, possibly its original home.

Version **A**, on the other hand, seems first to have been imported into France, the great jobbing nation of the Middle Ages in all sorts of romantic stuffs and materials. From France it was early retailed to Germany, to England, to Scandinavia, and, possibly, to Italy. From Germany in turn it was re-exported into Bohemia. Version **A** was without doubt the first to become known, since we find it not only in the Old French, but in the Germanic versions springing from a French source, in an unperturbed state. All the different versions of **B**, on the other hand, have been very noticeably influenced by **A**, indicating that the arrival of **B** was after **A** had become established and well known.

(b) In France.

We encounter the story of *Floris and Blauncheflur* earliest in France, and the French seem to have been the first to make the story a subject for poetic treatment. The story appears in French, besides in two songs celebrating episodes in this tale of true love, in two distinct versions. The earliest of these versions, which we may designate as I., had its origin, it seems, about 1160. [I.14](#) (Cf. F. Steinmeyer, H Z, xxi, 319.) Certain it is that a French version of **A** must have existed about 1170, to serve as a basis for one of the German (the low Rhenish) versions, *Floyris und Blanscheflur*. This French version, **I**, seems to represent fairly well the **A** general form of the story. As so often in the case of other romances, the *jongleurs* tried to bring this foreign importation into the cycle of French story by connecting in bonds of kinship, its characters with the names celebrated in French epic. Blauncheflur is represented as being the mother of Bertha of the big foot, the wife of Pepin, father of Charlemagne. [I.15](#)

Du Ménil (E. du Ménil, *Floire et Blancheflor*, Paris, 1876) in discussing the interrelations of the two French versions, characterizes one as a version for a select public, “*version aristocratique*,” and the second as a version for the entertainment of the masses, “*version populaire*.” The French II. version, the “*version populaire*,” is, according to Herzog, p. 4, the result of a sort of fusion

of the **A** and **B** general forms of the story, [L16](#) with which have been woven in various episodes which elsewhere are not known to either general form of the story, **A** or **B**. Herzog further on continues (p. 11), “Ich halte dafür dass dieselbe (the OF. II. version) ebenfalls aus Italien nach Frankreich hinübergewandert ist, wo ihr Bearbeiter den Inhalt des zweiten Kreises mit dem ihm geläufigen ersten Kreise so verschmolzen hat, dass dieser einige nur dem zweiten Sagenkreise angehörige Züge ganz verdrängte.”

The general style and manner of handling the story is quite different in the two French versions. The “*version aristocratique*” preserves the traits of an oriental romance, and Floire is represented as a love-sick youth. “*Sans li ne puis jou pas aprendre*” he replies when his father proposes to educate him alone. There is hardly a more sentimental passage in literature than the one in I. (212-266) describing the school-days of the children:

*Ensamble vont, ensamble viennent
Et la joie d’amor maintient
Nus d’aus deus chose ne savoit
Que lués a l’autre ne disoit.
.
On ooient parler d’amors.
Ensamble lisent et aprendent;
A la joie d’amor entendent:
Un vergier a li peres Floire
.
D’amors i chantent li oisel.
Quant il mangoient et bevoient
Li oisel seure aus se séoient;
Des oiseles oent les chans:
Cou est la vie as deus enfans.
.
Et quant a l’escole venoient
Lor tables d’yvoire prenoient,
Adont lor veissiez escrire
Letres et vers d’amors en cire.
Letres et salus font d’amors
Du chant des oisiaus et des flors.*

The writer of I. is evidently a genuine poet, though perhaps somewhat of the ‘spring poet’ order. He exalts the sentiment of love, as we have seen, and feelingly describes the elaborately constructed tomb (vv. 530-652), the finely wrought cup (vv. 431-498), and the birds and flowers and fountains and trees of the gardens of the king and of the ‘Admiral.’ He dwells in sensuous fondness in his enumeration equally of the fine stuffs and precious stones; the *mantiaus*, *vairs osterins* and *bliaus indes porprins* (429-30), or the *saffirs* and *calcidoines*

and *boines jagonses* and *sardoines*, etc. (1755-77), and of flowers and trees; the “*poivre, canele et garingal*,” or the “*encens, girofle et citoval*,” or the *beuns*, the *plantoine*, the *alier*, the *boins figiers*, the *peschiers*, the *periers* and the *noiers* (1761-8).

The “*version populaire*,” on the other hand, seems to be adapted somewhat to the ideal of the native French epic, and Floire is represented as a model of courage and knightly virtue, in a class with the *douze pers* and the other heroes of the Charlemagne cycle of stories. The writer interpolates scenes in which Floire may display his fighting qualities. In the early part of the story, he returns from school just in time to rescue Blauncheflur, who is about to be committed to the flames. He accomplishes her rescue by acting as her champion and fighting the seneschal, who has accused her of attempting to poison the king. The combat is a stirring one quite in the manner of the *Chansons de geste* (vv. 920-1160). On the journey to Babylon, Floire has heroic adventures in a battle with Diogenes, son of Samones, king of the city of Fuis (1854-1984). Later, when the trial of Fl. and Bl. is interrupted by the arrival of an invader, Jonas de Handreas, Fl. offers to vanquish the invaders if his life be spared. At first he is unsuccessful in his attempt, but after being taken prisoner by the invaders, he is aroused by the reproachful words of Bl. and breaking loose, slays Jonas, thus delivering the city and winning Bl. (3120-3410). The writer of II. emphasizes the battle scenes at the expense of the descriptive passages, devoting to the description of the tomb only 32 verses, and to that of the wonderful cup, only 14. He seems also to be of a practical turn of mind, and instead of fondly enumerating the gems received for Bl., describes rather the circumstances of the sale. Babyloine is a rich city with no poor, and has a rent of three thousand ounces of gold each day (vv. 2319, 2342). From all these instances one can see that the sweet and sentimental tale of the I. version is quite modified in II. If we agree with Herzog that this version was the result of the blending of the **B** version imported from Italy, with the **A** version, which was already well known in France, we must conclude also that this “*version populaire*” is influenced by the ideals of contemporary French poetry of native origin, by the manners and conventions of the *chansons de geste*, and the heroic romances springing from or influenced by them.

(c) Provence.

Among the troubadours of Provence the story of Fl. and Bl. was early known and popular, as one must judge from the very frequent allusions. There

is, however, no proof of the existence of a Provençal romance.

(d) *In Germany.*

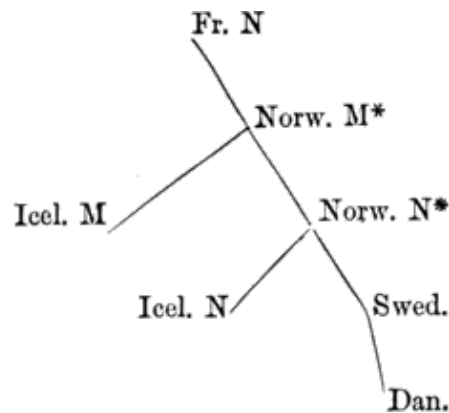
In Germany are to be encountered many versions of the popular story. The earliest one seems to have been the Low Rhenish poem *Floyris* and *Blaunchiflur*, of about 3700 lines, translated by an unknown poet about 1170 (Steinmeyer, H. Z. xxi, 307-331). To the middle of the 13th century belongs the MHG. poem in 8006 lines by Konrad Fleck, composed, quite independently of the Low Rhenish version above mentioned, after an OF. original. (Ed. by E. Sommer, Quedlingburg u. Leipzig, 1846.) Somewhat younger is the Mid. Low Germ. poem, *Floris ende Blancefloer* of 3983 lines (Ed. by H. von Fallensleben, Leipzig, 1836, and by H. E. Moltzer, Groningen, 1879, in the *Bibl. van Middelnerlands Letterkunde*). The poet, Dideric van Assenede, says, himself, that he derived his material from the “Walsche.” [1.17](#) As a matter of fact his original seems to have been French. To the third half of the 14th century belongs the Low Germ. poem *Flosse un Blankflosse* of 1534 lines (Ed. by Stephan Waetzoldt, Bremen, 1880), which also seems to go back to a French original. [1.18](#)

If we look more closely into the question of the French original of the German poems, we must assume a version, χ , earlier than the version preserved in the three existing MSS. of French I. version. These three MSS. may be classed into a group, z , whose chief characteristic is the attempted suicide of Floris in the Lion pit. This scene appears in two of the existing MSS., and the writer of the third MS. seems to have had the scene in his original but to have left it out. (Cf. H. Sundmacher, *Die altfrz. u. mittelhd. Bearbeitung der Sage von Fl. und Bl.*, diss. Göttingen, 1872.) Among the German versions it appears only in the LG. *Flosse un Blankflosse*. The other German versions must rest on an OF. version, χ , which at the hands of Fleck [1.19](#) underwent an artistic reconstruction, but at the hands of Dideric was translated simply, without the addition of any new ideas by the adapter.

In addition to these early German versions must be mentioned two groups of *Volksbücher*: (1) from Boccaccio's *Filocolo*, (2) from Fleck's poem, also a Bohemian adaptation and a German Jewish adaptation, (Cf. Hausknecht, ed. of *Fl. u. Bl.*, pp. 13-20, Berlin, 1885.)

(e) *In Scandinavia.*

Our story had a wide circulation also in the North, as one must infer from the number of Scandinavian versions preserved: (1) the old Norweg. fragment of a saga (ed. by G. Storm, *Nordisk Tidskrift for Filologi og Pædagogik*, Copenhagen, 1874, pp. 24-28), (2) the complete Icelandic saga of *Flóres ok Blankiflúr*, (3) the fragments of a second Icelandic Saga (ed. by Brynjolf Snorrason, *Annaler for nordisk old kyndighed og historie*, 1850); (4) the Old Swed. poem (ed. by E. Klemming, *Samlingar utgifna af svenska formskriftsällskapet*, I., Stockholm, 1844); and (5) the Danish translations from the Swedish (ed. by C. J. Brandt, *Romantisk Digtning fra Middelalderen*, I. and II. København, 1869-77). The distinguishing characteristic of the Northern versions is the conclusion. According to the Norse version, Floris, to refute the charge that he has gained admittance to Bl.'s tower by the use of magic tricks, offers to fight in single combat the bravest of the Admiral's knights. In the ensuing combat he overcomes the Admiral's champion, and receives as his guerdon, Blancheflur. If we accept Herzog's conclusions (pp. 15, 35, 45-6, 66) we must assume as an original for the Scandinavian versions, a French original, N, with the ending peculiar to the Northern versions. The development from this original is shown by the following plan (also borrowed from Herzog, p. 92).



(f) In Italy.

In Italy also the story of Fl. and Bl. enjoyed great popularity. The two chief versions were: (1) the *Cantare*, written by a popular poet in *ottave rime*; and (2) Boccaccio's youthful production, his first prose romance, *Filocolo*. That the I. version of the story, the one most popular in France, was also current in Italy, we see in these two versions, both of which show, in addition to the special traits of II., many traits peculiar to version I. To determine exactly the

interrelations of these two versions is no easy matter. From allusions in the *Filocolo* we know that the *Cantare* was the older. Internal evidence, however, forbids the supposition that the *Filocolo* has sprung from the *Cantare*. Rather the two versions go back to a common source. This Italian, or Franco-Italian, version, which probably had no differences of real moment from the *Cantare* in its present form, must in many points have been more ample and complete, and in individual instances nearer the French tradition, than the *Cantare* is.

In connection with the Italian group must also be mentioned the Greek poem of Florios and Platziaflore, composed in the 14th century and founded upon the *Cantare*.

(g) In Spain.

In Spain we find allusion to our story already in the 13th century, when the *Gran conquista de Vltramár* refers to Fl. and Bl. as the most devoted pair of lovers that one had ever heard of. But there is no proof of the existence of a Spanish version of the story as early as this. In the year 1512, appeared at Alcala the prose romance, *Flores y Blancaflor*, which is current to the present day. The close relationship of this to the Italian versions is very evident. Its source, however, seems hardly to be directly the *Cantare*. The beginning of the Spanish romance, which is entirely peculiar to this version, points rather to a version in the North of Italy, which the Spanish adapter has quite probably translated into Spanish without important alteration.

§ 3. ENGLISH VERSION.

The story of Fl. and Bl. found its way into England in the 13th century, that is to say, when it had been for a hundred years familiar to French hearers and after it had already spread into many lands outside of France. As has been said, the English version goes back to a French original. This original was certainly of the I. form. Of the features peculiar to the French II. version, the English version does not show one, while it agrees with the French I. version to the extent of exact translation of many phrases and verses and even of reproduction of French rime-words. At the same time the French original that lay before the English adapter can not have been the text exactly as it is preserved in any one of the three extant French MSS., but rather an older, or purer text which we have designated by χ , a distinguishing feature of which is the absence of the attempted suicide of Floris in the lion pit. The text that must be assumed as the

original of the English poem must have been very similar to the original from which Fleck and Dideric derived their German versions, but not exactly identical as is evidenced by frequent slight divergences.

The English poet has not expanded and amplified by the addition of further details or by the introduction of personal reflections, as the German Fleck has done. He has presented the essential features of the love story as it impressed him, in a condensed form to be sure, at the same time without bareness or baldness. Unlike the adapter of the Low Rhenish condensed version, he has preserved the original order of incidents, and has usually preserved faithfully the smallest details that have any essential bearing on the plot.

Some idea of the English writer's fidelity to the details and even to the phraseology of his French original, and of his method of translating, may be gained from the following parallel passages:

The English text, including line numbers, is from Hausknecht's edition.

<i>Que bien soient parler latin Et bien escrire en parchemin</i>	vv. 263-4.	<i>Inouȝ þey couþ of latyne And wel wryte on parchemyn</i>	vv. 33-4.
<i>Faites la moi tost demander Ja li ferai le chief couper.</i>	vv. 399-400.	<i>Let do bryng forþ þat mayde, Fro þe body þe heved schal goo.</i>	vv. 140-41.
<i>Et il l'a tant bien acatée Qu'a fin or l'a sept fois pesée.</i>	vv. 507-8.	<i>Þe amyral hur bouȝt anoon And gafe for hur, as she stood upryȝt, Seven sythes of gold her wyȝt.</i>	vv. 194-6.
<i>Ci gist la bele Blanceflor A cui Floires ot grant amor.</i>	vv. 651-2.	<i>Here liþ swete Blauncheflur Þat Floris loved par amur.</i>	vv. 217-18.
<i>Un grafe a trait de son rapier En son cuer bouter le voloit, Quant sa mere cou aperçoit.</i>	vv. 787-890.	<i>His knif he droȝ ut of his schepe And to his herte hit hadde ismite, Nadde his moder hit underȝite.</i>	vv. 308-10.

The *grafe* is elaborately described in vv. 788-98:

<i>Li roi li done un palefroi, Qui d'une part estoit tous blans, De l'autre rouges comme sans.</i>	vv. 964-6.	<i>De king let sadel a palfray De oon half white, so mylke And þat oþer reed, so sylk.</i>	vv. 382-4.
<i>Fius, fait ele, gardez le bien; Tant com l'aurez, mar cremez rien;</i>		<i>Mi sone, he rede, have þis ring; While he is þin, ne dute noþing.</i>	
<i>Car vous ja rien ne requer(r)iez Que tost ou tard vous ne l'aiez</i>	vv. 1003-6.	<i>And be hit erli and be hit late To þi wil þu schalt habbe whate.</i>	vv. 393-8.
<i>La le troevent ou siet, sous l'arbre, Sor un perron qui fu de marbre.</i>	vv. 1355-6.	<i>De briggere he fond ate frome, Sittinde on a marble ston.</i>	vv. 558-9.
<i>Le millor conseil que jou sai</i>	v. 1858.	<i>De beste red þat ihc þe can</i>	v. 742.
<i>Si maudient qui s i foula</i>	v. 2060.	<i>Hi beden God 3ive him wel fin þat so manie flures dide þerin</i>	vv. 855-6.
<i>Des flors sali un paveillon Des eles feri mon menton; Del paveillon tel paor oi, Que m'escrai plus tost que poi</i>	vv. 2093-6.	<i>Der fliste ut a buterflize, Are ihc wiste, on mine ize. So sore ihc uas offerd of þan, þat ihc loude crie bigan</i>	vv. 889-92.
<i>Bele compaigne, Blanceflor, Volez vous veoir bele flor?</i>	vv. 2117-18.	<i>And sede, "Swete Blauncheflur, Wiltu se a wel fair flur?"</i>	vv. 897-8.
<i>Damoisele qui a amor Et joie en soi, doit avoir flor.</i>	vv. 2124-30.	<i>Ho þat loveþ par amur, An hap þerof joie, mai love flur.</i>	vv. 903-4.

In spite of this number of tolerably exact correspondences, in word and phrase, with the French original, the English poem is a condensed adaptation rather than a slavish translation. As in the French II. version, the tender and sentimental element is much condensed; but the English writer, unlike the writer of French II., does not introduce the heroic and warlike element in the form of duels and battles. He does not amplify by adding new details, as Fleck did, nor does he confuse the order of incidents as does the adapter of the Low Rhenish version. He makes rather a faithful condensation quite after the manner of English adapters from the French, which is no doubt to be explained as due not so much to difference between the writers, English and French, as to a

difference between the hearing publics, French and English, for whom the production was intended. [1.20](#)

No doubt with his English public in mind, the English poet, in adapting the story from the French, has modified to some extent the tenderness and sentimentality, even at times the poetic descriptions, of his French original (compare vv. 1117-1194 of the French with the corresponding English vv. 457-72), and has omitted the enumeration of gems and of precious stuffs suggestive of an elegance perhaps unintelligible to an English speaking and hearing public at this time. The wonderful cup, to the description of which 67 verses (431-498) are devoted in the French romance, in the English poem is dismissed with 17 verses (163-184). The garden so elaborately described in the French, vv. 1724-1835, in the English poem occupies only vv. 685-732. The description of the knife (*grafe*), which serves no other purpose than that of external adornment in the French version (vv. 788-799), is entirely neglected in the English translation. The translator's method is well illustrated in the case of the description of Floris's equipage preliminary to setting out on his journey. The description of the saddle and harness occupies 37 verses (964-1000) of the French poem, and is dismissed by the English translator with 5 (vv. 382-389), *I ne can telle 3ou noȝt Hu richeliche þe sadel was wroȝt*, and three verses following.

To sum up, the English version is a free, somewhat condensed, translation from the French I. version. The translator has introduced almost no new traits, and the extent of the condensation may be judged by considering the 1296 verses of the English as compared with the 2974 verses in the French I. version. The manner of the condensation has been indicated. But with all the condensation, especially in the descriptive passages, it is important to note that in the essential features of the story, the translator follows his original faithfully, so that the main outline of the story is preserved as accurately in English as in French.

[§ 4.](#) DIALECT.

In Fl. and Bl. as in King Horn it is difficult to distinguish certain criteria of dialect on account of the variety of orthography in the different manuscripts. Here again the only safe guide is the rimes, and the evidence of these is not entirely uniform for the different texts. There is a great difference in age between MS. C, the oldest, and MS. T, probably the youngest of the four MSS.

Further there is a difference in the dialects represented by the different scribes. The scribes of MSS. C and Cott. were evidently southerners, and seem, here and there, to have twisted the verses around to make them fit the Southern dialect. On the other hand the later scribe of MS. T seems to have changed verses to make them fit his later dialect. Either the phrases are less stereotyped than in Horn or the poem was not so well known; in any event the scribes of the individual texts seem to have allowed themselves greater independence. The result is that the rime test here is not a sure one. The evidence of rimes in MS. C is not necessarily valid for MS. T, and *vice versā*; and which rimes indicate the pronunciation of the original composer, it is often difficult to say. If we bear these points in mind we may perhaps draw some satisfactory conclusions from the following criteria:

1. OE. *ȳ* seems to have been pronounced *ī* e.g.; *cussep* : *blisse*, *custe* : *wiste* 549-52 C, *ywys* : *kysse* 1067 T, *winne* : *kinne* 806 C, *blisse* : *kisse* 786 C, *fylle* : *wylle* 738 T, *lyke* : *lyte* 782 T. Only apparent exceptions are *meene* : *kyne* 274 T (these words do not rime together in the original), and *byggge* : *segge* 989 T. *Ostesse* : *kysse* belongs only to MSS. T and Auch.

2. If we apply Prof. Hempl's -wō̄-, -wō̄- test we find some evidence of a Midland dialect, e.g.; *too* : *soo* 94 T, *vndoo* : *soo* 74 T, *also* : *doo* 224 T, 764 C, *soo* : *doo* 64 T, 336 T, 624 T, *so* : *fordo* 307-8 C. This test applied to Fl. and Bl. is not certain in itself, but supports the other evidence. That the test is uncertain we see from the occurrence of apparently inaccurate rimes such as *hoom* : *doom* 1079 T, 802 C, and from a few rimes which oppose the evidence of those above cited, e.g., *poō* : *twoo* 30 T, *two* : *mo* 218 T (and Cott.), *so* : *go* 438 C, 824 C, *bo* : *atuo* 548 C, 614 C, *po* : *so* 666 C, *also* : *bo* 780 C, *whoom* : *froom* 70 T. It would seem then that the change had affected the *ā* in OE. *swā* but not in *twā* and *hwā*. It must be noted that all the quoted *so* rimes with *ō̄* occur in MS. C, which, as we shall see later, has a strong Southern colouring.

3. The product of OE. *a* before *l* + cons. seems to be *a*, or with lengthening before -ed, *ō*. e.g.; *wal* : *cristal* 273-4 C (also 609-10 T), *wolde* : *golde* 208 T, *tolde* : *holde*, *sholde* : *holde* 435-6 T (also 77-80 C), *wolde* : *beholde* 751 T (also 449-50 C), 769-70 T (also 471-2 C). Exceptions occur in the Southern MSS. e.g.; *elde* : *helde* 102 Cott., *halle* : *welle* 230 C, *welle* : *alle* 224 C, 280 C, but are not paralleled in MS. T. [1.21](#)

4. The inflectional endings of the pres. indic. seem to be -e, -est, -ep for the singular. There are rimes to prove the 3rd sing. in -ep; *seith* : *withe* 106 T, *he sit* : *nabit* 40 C, *gep* : *dep* 200 C (also T and Cott.), 422 C (also T). The plural

ending is less evident. The Cambr. MS. has regularly *-ep*. e.g.; *habbeþ* 20, *serueþ* 1256, *beoþ* 294, 295, *weneþ* 314, *letez* 448, *chaungeþ* 510, *goþ*, *seoþ*, *spekeþ* 708 C, *crieþ* 526; the T. MS. *-en*, e.g.; *seruen* 590 T, *cryen* 815 T, *ben* 909 T, etc. That the *-ep* ending did not belong to the original we may probably infer from the fact that while the *-ep* of the 3rd sing. counts metrically, the *-ep* of the plural usually does not. Cf. 20 C, 256 C, 448 C, 526 C, 708 C, etc. But cf. *springeþ* 296 C, *bisecheþ* 765 C, *falleþ* 786 C. These endings, then, point to an East Midland dialect. Cf. also the rimes; *wepinge* : *bringe* Cott. p. 105, *cusseþ* : *blisse* 549-50 C.

5. OE. *ǣ* (*e*) and shortened OE. *ǣ*, umlaut of WG. *ai*, or WG. *ā*.

The OE. short *æ* appears regularly as *a*. *trespas* : *was* 1043 T, *orgas* : *was* 102 T, *Cesar* : *bar* 182 T, are probably to be explained as due to one of the Southern scribes of MSS. C and Cott. e.g. *vnderzet* : *set* 166 C (but cf. *vnderzat* : *sat* 98 C). The shortening of OE. *ǣ* (umlaut of WG. *ai*) also appears regularly as *a*. e.g.; *glade* : *ladde* 480 T, *ilast* : *cast* 338 C, *glad* : *ilad* 114 C. But cf. *lasse* : *wytnesse* 952 T. In the rime, *rest* : *mest* 120 C, 384 C, it is impossible to determine whether the *ǣ* is shortened to *ě*, as in parts of the South, or the *ě* is lengthened to *ē*. The shortening of OE. *ǣ* (WG. *ā*) does not occur in rime often enough to permit any safe conclusion. The rimes *radde* : *madde* 826 T and *radde* : *hadde* 1025 T, seem to show that the product of shortening was *a*. That the representative of WG. *ā* was the Saxon *ǣ* rather than the Anglian, and Kentish *ē*, seems probable from the rimes *rede* : *seide* 21-2 T, 51-2 T, 215-16 T, 263-4 T (66 Cott.); *reede* : *deede* 45-6 T, 53-4 T.

From these criteria, which seem to be the best available, we may infer that Fl. and Bl. belongs further north than King Horn. Further, the inflections seem to point to the Eastern rather than to the Western Midland, so that we may feel fairly safe in attributing Fl. and Bl. to the East Midland.

§ 5. DATE OF COMPOSITION.

We shall probably be safe in setting the date of composition in the second half of the 13th century. Lengthening in open syllables seems to have taken place, e.g.; *coome* : *soone* 100 T, *grome* : *coome* 112 T, *come* : *hoom* 500 T, *wite* : *vnderzete* 556 C (also Cott.), *wite* : *wite* 756 C, *þerone* : *stone*, 112 T, *vppone* : *stone* 172 T, 212 T, *þare* : *ware* 1036 T, etc. From this we must conclude that the date of composition is not earlier than 1250. On the other hand the earliest MS. (C) dates back to the second half of the 13th century.

Indeed in this MS. there are still traces of the old distinction of grammatical gender, and OE. *ū* is still always represented by *u*; while the second oldest MS. (Cott.) has the newer writing *ou*. (Cf. Hausknecht, ed. of Fl. and Bl. p. 130, Berlin, 1885.)

§ 6. VERSIFICATION.

The poem is composed in short rimed couplets. The normal verse has four stresses. In no one of the MSS., however, are all the verses perfectly regular, due largely, no doubt, in part to the variety of forms available to each composer and to the variety of spellings to choose from, also to the attempts of each scribe to make the verses of the original fit into his own dialect. The rimes may be masculine or feminine. At times they are mere assonances, e.g.; *first* : *lyst* 693-4, *furste* : *luste* 377-8 C, *lyke* : *lyte* 781-2 T, *longe* : *sonde* 795-6 C, *coome* : *soone* 100 T, etc. At times they are inaccurate, e.g.; *grunde* : *honde* 303-4 C, *meene* : *kyne* 273-4 T. Peculiar are the rimes; *perate* : *gate* 153-4 C, etc., *fyne* : *peryne* 369-70 T, 441-2 C, etc., *perone* : *stone* 112 T, 212 T.

§ 7. MANUSCRIPTS.

Floris and Blancheflur appears in four MSS., in each of the four with a greater or smaller part of the beginning lost.

1. T., the Trentham MS., is in the library of the Duke of Sutherland at Trentham Hall in Staffordshire. The MS. is a relatively late one (about 1440), and is written in a very legible, informal running hand, with loops to the *b*'s, *l*'s, etc. It contains a series of metrical romances; besides Floris and Blancheflur, also Kyng Rychard, Bevous of Hampton, The Batell of Troye, Amys and Amylion, and Sir Eglamoure. Our poem stands on folios 98-111. The headings to the pages are; on the even, left-hand pages, *Florence*, on the odd, right-hand pages, & *Blanchefloure*. The MS. contains 1083 lines of our poem. The beginning of the poem is lost in this MS., as in the three others, and the first preserved folio is an odd, right-hand page, with the heading, & *Blanchefloure*. The first verse in this MS. corresponds to verse 193 of the French.

The reading of the MS. is made difficult and uncertain by the end flourishes to certain letters, e.g.; *gold*^l, *stoon*^l, *vppon*^l, which it is hard to interpret. It has

been collated with the three others by Hausknecht, in his admirable critical edition of the poem.

2. **Cott.**, the Brit. Mus. MS. Cott. Vitell. D. III., which probably belongs to the second half of the 13th century, suffered badly from fire in 1731. Of the original 219 folios of this parchment MS., 26 remain, and these are in many parts exceedingly difficult to read, so that the readings here offered, which are based mainly on Lumby's text, are offered with apologies, and may no doubt be bettered here and there by comparison with the other MSS. Our poem, which occupies folios 6a-8b of the existing MS., is preceded by *Versus de historibus sacris veteris et novi Testamenti, veteri lingua Gallicana* (O. French), and in the same handwriting with Fl. and Bl. The following folios (9-26) contain in Latin prose, *Expositiones quaedam sive comentarii in Macrobiani Saturnalia*.

Of our poem only 451 lines are preserved in this MS., and of these only 180 are completely legible. The first verse corresponds to about v. 508, and the last to about v. 2514 of the French. The writing is in a fine, apparently French, book hand.

This MS. has been printed by Lumby in the original to the present edition for the E.E.T.S., and has been used by Hausknecht in collation.

3. **A.**, the celebrated Auchinleck MS. of the Advocates' Library in Edinburgh, is a veritable mine of romance. Perhaps the best description is still that given in Sir Walter Scott's introduction to *Sir Tristrem*, where is to be found an enumeration of the 44 different articles, mostly romances, still contained (besides 13 lost). It is a large quarto on vellum, and according to Ellis, belongs to the very first of the 14th century. Of our poem, which occupies five double-columned folios (100-104), 861 verses are contained, of which the first corresponds to v. 1001 of the French.

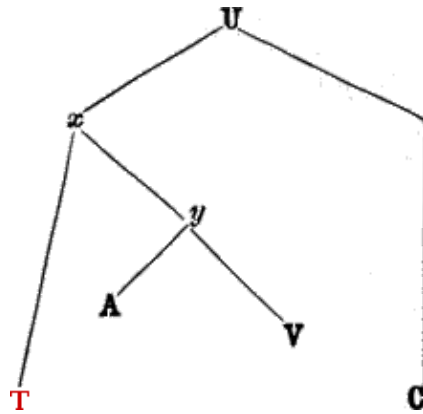
Fl. and Bl. has twice been reprinted from the Auchinleck MS.: (1) C. H. Hartshorne, *Ancient Metrical Tales*, London, 1829, (2) David Laing, *A Penny Worth of Witte*, etc., Abbotsford Club, Edinburgh, 1857.

4. **C.**, the Cambr. Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2, has already been described. (See page xxviii.) Of the fragment of a MS. that now exists, the final 824 verses of Fl. and Bl. occupy folios 1a-5b. The first verse preserved corresponds to verse 1001 of the French poem.

The interrelations of these four MSS. have been carefully studied by Hausknecht (as above, pp. 98-108), whose results may be summarized as follows: MSS. A., Cott., T form a group x. Now C., now group x has gaps, and neither is free from individual changes.

Within the group x , **A** and Cott. form a special sub-group, y going back to a common origin, but at the same time independent of each other.

We may borrow from Hausknecht the following diagram representing the interrelations.



T misprinted as I (both here and in Hausknecht).

As regards the relative value of the different MSS., it must be said that **T** is the least to be depended on for accuracy, but is valuable because it preserves more of the early part of the story than is preserved in any of the other MSS. As regards the relative value of **C** and x it is hard to decide. Still the instances in which **C**, in opposition to **A**, agrees with the French are more numerous than are the instances of the contrary case.

Footnotes to Introduction

[L13](#) G. Paris distinguishes three general versions, two French versions and a third, “Roman” version, in which the parents of Blanche-flur are not French but Roman.

[L14](#) The evidence cited by G. Paris, consists of allusions to—(1) History of Troy, (2) Siege of Troy, (3) Aeneid, etc. The place of origin, according to G. Paris, was probably in the region about Beauvais, lying between Normandy, Picardy and the Île de France.

[L15](#) Perhaps this is a mere coincidence, since in a poem about Berthe, her father happens to be named ‘Florie,’ a Florie with a different

history, *roi de Hongrie*. Later this relationship was commonly assumed. In the *Gran Conquista de Vlramar*, the story of Berthe is intercalated. She is daughter of Blancaflor and Flores.

[L.16](#) G. Paris makes this II. version the sole representative of a third distinct form of the story, the 2^o of his general classification, 1^o, 2^o, 3^o.

[L.17](#) That is to say, French or Italian.

[L.18](#) This version was evidently not translated from a French MS. but written from memory. The details are not always exactly identical with those of the French, though often so, enough so to make the origin of the poem unmistakable though it is much condensed and the order of events somewhat transposed.

[L.19](#) Fleck's work is a paraphrase. The details are identical but are amplified to 8006 verses.

[L.20](#) This same consideration, as we have seen, probably explains *in part* the difference between the English King Horn and the Norman French *Horn et Rigmenil*.

[L.21](#) That the Cambr. scribe was from the South is very apparent from: (1) the pres. indic. plur. endings in *eþ*, e.g. *comeþ* 282, etc., (2) the above rimes of OE. *call* : *ell*, (3) *axede* 576, 602, etc., (4) *rede* : *hadde* 453-4, (5) *hi* for 'they' 284, etc., *heo* for 'she' 303, etc., (6) *ifere* 502 C, in *fere* 827, 280 T, (7) *vaire* 16, *wuder* 114, etc.

FLORIS AND BLAUNCHEFLUR.

*erentham MS., fol. 98 a; vellum, c. 1440:
eginning lost. Headlines 'Florence and
lanchefloure.'*

hurst men FB1 neuer in londe	
r feirer Children fonde.	
risten woman fedde hem þoo,	
wel she louyd hem boþ twoo.	4
onge sche fedde hem in feere	
þey were of elde of seuen ȝere.	
yng behelde his sone dere,	
. seyde to him on this manere,	8
harme it were mucche more	
his sone were sette to lore	
þe book ⁺ letters to know,	
nen done, both hye and lowe.	12
re sone," she seide, "þou shalt lerne,	
at þou do ful ȝerne."	
ys answerd <i>with</i> wepyng,	
ie stood byfore þe kyng ⁺ ;	16
wepyng ⁺ seide he,	

[B.1](#) first 'mey,' then alterd

rs that he cannot learn unless Blauncheflur is with him.

schal not Blancheflour lerne *with* me?
 can y noȝt to scole goone
 h-out Blanchefloure,” he seide þane. 20
 can y in no scole syng⁺ ne rede
 h-out Blancheflour,” he seide.
 ing⁺ seide to his soone,
 e shal lerne for þy loue.” 24

are put to school together, and make good progress.

cole þey were put;
 þey were good of⁺ wytte.
 nder it was of⁺ hur lore,
 of⁺ her loue wel þe more. 28
 hildren louyd to-geder soo,
 myȝt neuer parte a twoo.
 en þey had .v. ȝere to scoole goone
 vel þey had lerned þoo, 32
 vȝ þey couþ of latyne,
 wel wryte on parchemyne.
 yng⁺ vnderstod þe grete Amoure
 vene his sone and Blanchefloure, 36
 þouȝt when þey were of Age
 her loue wolde noȝt swage;
 he myȝt noȝt her loue *with*drawe
 en Florys shuld⁺ wyfe after þe lawe. 40
 ing⁺ to þe Queene seide þoo, [98 b]
 tolde hur of⁺ his woo,
 his þouȝt and of his care,
 v it wolde of⁺ Floreys fare. 44

begins to devise to separate the two, and proposes to put the maiden to death.

me,” he seide, “y tel þe my reede,
 þat Blaunchefloure be do to deede.
 en þat maide is y-slawe,
 brouȝt of her lyf⁺ dawē, 48
 one as Florys may it vnder ȝete,
 he he wylle hur forȝete.
 may he wyfe after reede.”
 Queene answerde þen and seide, 52
 þouȝt *with* hur reede
 e þe mayde fro þe deede.
 ,” she seide, “we auȝt to fonde
 Florens lyf⁺ wit menske in londe, 56
 þat he lese not his honour
 þe mayden Blauncheflour.
 so myȝt þat mayde clene,
 she were brouȝt to deȝ bydene, 60
 were mucche more honour
 slee þat mayde Blanche flour.”
 eþes þe king⁺ g[ra]unt þat it be soo.
 me, rede vs what is to doo.” 64

ris is sent to Mountargis to school.

n suggests that Floris be sent away.

, we shul oure soone Florys le into þe londe of Mountargis. he wyl my suster be is lady of ⁺ þat Contree.	68
. when she woot for whoom ^Þ we have sent him vs from ^Þ , wyl doo al hur myȝt, by day and by nyȝt,	72
nake hur loue so vndoo t had neuer ben soo. , <i>sir</i> ,” she seide, “y rede eke þe maydens moder make hur seek ⁺ .	76
may be þat other resoun ^Þ þat ylk ⁺ enchesoun, she may not fro hur moder goo.” ⁊ ben þese Children swyþ woo,	80
⁊ þey may not goo in fere wryer þinges neuer noone were. ys wept byfore þe kyng ⁺ ,	[99 a]
. seide, “ <i>Sir, with-out lesyng⁺</i> , my harme out ȝe me sende, ⁊ she ne myȝt <i>with</i> me wende. ⁊ we ne mot to-geder goo,	84
ay wele is turned to woo.” ing ⁺ seide to his soone aplyȝt, ne, <i>withynne</i> þis fourtenyȝt, ier moder quykke or deede,” erly,” he him seide,	88
. mayde shal come þe too.”	92

sent to his aunt at Mountargis, with the promise that Blauncheflur shall follow within fourteen days.

sir," he seid, "y pray 3ow it be soo.
 þat 3e me hur sende,
 like neuer wheder y wende." 96
 þe Child⁺ graunted þe kyng⁺ was fayne,
 him betau3t his Chamburlayne.
 h̄ muche honoure þey þeder coome,
 el to a ryche kynges soone. 100
 feire him receyuyd þe Duke Orgas,
 king⁺ of þat Castel was,
 his Aunt wiþ muche honour;
 euer he þou3t on Blanchefloure. 104
 l and blythe þey ben him withe;
 for no ioy þat he seith,
 ny3t him glade game ne gle,
 he my3t not his lyf⁺ see. 108
 Aunt set him to lore
 as other Children wore,
 maydons and grome;
 erne mony þeder coome. 112
 v3 he sykes, but no3t he lernes;
 Blauncheflour euer he mornes.
 enyman to him speke
 e is on his hert steke. 116
 e is at his hert roote
 no þing⁺ is so soote:
 /ngale ne lycorys
 ot so soote as hur loue is, [99 b]
 othing⁺ ne none other. 120
 nuch he þenkeþ on Blancheflour,
 oo day him þynkeþ þre,
 he ne may his loue see. 124

King proposes to put Blauncheflur to death.

as until the fourteen days are past.

he abydeth *with* mucche woo
þe fourtenyȝt were goo.
en he saw she was nouȝt ycoome,
nuche sorow he haþ noome, 128
he loueth mete ne drynke,
nay noone in his body synke.

Chamberlain reports Floris's sorrow to the king.

Chamberleyne sent þe king⁺ to wete,
sones state al y-wrete. 132

He is very angry, and again proposes to put Blauncheflur to death.

ing⁺ ful sone þe waxe to-brake,
to wete what it spake:
þe gynneth to chaunge his moode,
. wel sone he vnderstode, 136
. *with* wreth he cleped þe Queene,
. tolde hur alle his teene,
. *with* wrap spake and sayde,
: do bryng⁺ forþ þat mayde! 140
þe body þe heued shal goo."
He was þe Quene ful woo.
spake þe Quene, þat good lady,

He now proposes, instead, to sell the maiden.

ȝe goddes love, <i>sir</i>, mercy. the next hauen þat here is, ben chapmen ryche y-wys, chaundes of⁺ babyloyne ful ryche, wol hur bye blethelyche. n may ȝe for þat louely foode e mucche Catell and goode. . soo she may fro vs be brouȝt, þat we slee hur nouȝt.” eþes þe king⁺ graunted þis; forsop so it is, ing⁺ let sende after þe burgeise, was hende and Curtayse, . welle selle and bygge couth, . moony langages had in his mouth.	144 148 152 156
--	---

one, and for the maiden they receive among other things a magnificent cup with a romantic history.

sone þat mayde was him betauȝt;
 o þe hauene was she brouȝt. 160
 haue þey for þat maide ȝolde [100 a]
 Mark⁺ of reed golde,
 a Coupe good and ryche,
 l þe world⁺ was none it lyche. 164
 was neuer noone so wel graue;
 ȝat it made was no knave.
 was purtrayd on, y weene,
 ⁊ Paryse ledde away þe Queene; 168
 on þe Couercle a-boue
 rayde was þer both her love;
 in þe Pomel þerone
 d a Charbuncle stoone. 172
 e world⁺ was not so depe soler,
 it nold⁺ lyȝt þe Botelere,
 ylle boþ ale and wyne,
 yluer and golde boþ good and fyne. 176
 eas þe king⁺, þat nobel man,
 ʒroye in batayle he it wan,
 brouȝt it in-to Lumbardy,
 gaf⁺ it his lemman, his Amy. 180
 loupe was stoole fro king⁺ Cesar;
 æf⁺ out of his tresour hous it bar.
 sethe þat ilke same þeef⁺
 Blaunchefloure he it ȝeef⁺. 184
 he wyst to wynne suche þree,
 t he hur bryng⁺ to his contree.
 ⁊ þese Marchaundes saylen ouer þe see,
 h þis mayde, to her contree. 188
 onge þey han vndernome,

uncheflur is sold and carried to Babylon.

flur is taken to Babylon and sold to the Admiral.

to Babyloyne þey ben coome.
 e Amyral of⁺ Babyloyne
 solde þat mayde swythe soone; 192
 and soone þey were at oone.
 amyral hur bouȝt Anoone,
 gafe for hur, as she stood vpryȝt,

MS. Cott. Vitell. D. III., 6 a, col. 1.

The 3 leaves of this MS. are burnt and shrunk, and are hardly legible.

yne sythes of⁺ golde her wyȝt, 196
 he þouȝt without⁺ weene
 faire mayde haue to Queene;
 ong⁺ his maydons in his bour
 ur dide with muche honour. 200

. . . . [FB2](#)so dere
 wiþ þoute wene.
 . þat maide to his quene.
 his maidenep vp in is tur, 4
 hire wiþ muchel honour

[FB.2](#) *MS. note.* See Introduction; also *Floris et Blanch.*, Paris 1856, p. 28, l. 673.

⁊ þese merchaundes þat may belete,
ben glad of⁺ hur byȝete. [100 *b*]

Ɔw let we of Blaunche flour be,
speke of Florys in his contree. 204

⁊ is þe Bu[r]gays to þe king⁺ coome
⁊ þe golde and his garysone,
haþ take þe king⁺ to wolde,
eluer and þe Coupe of golde. 208

. marchans þis maide forlete,
. . bliþe mid here by-ȝete.
. . . we blancheflur be. 8
. floires in his cuntre.

burgeys to þe king icome.
. . gold *and* þisse garisome.
. . þan king i ȝolde. 12
. þo cupe of golde.

and queen cause to be made a supposititious tomb for Blauncheflur.

y lete make in a Chirche
withe feire *graue* wyrche.
lete ley þer-vppone
w feire peynted stone, 212
h letters al aboute wryte
h ful muche worshippe.
-so couth þe letters rede,
þey spoken, and þus þey seide: 216
re lyth swete Blaunchefloure
Florys louyd *Paramoure*.”
Florys haþ vndernome,

. . let at one chiriche.
. . . les wereche,
. . [þ]at anouen . . 16
. pointe stonde
. . . bi write.
. . . . hele worþsipe
. . þe letters rede. 20
.
.
.
. [h]aueþ vnder-nome 24

ris returns and inquires for Blauncheflur. ‘She is dead.’

urns, and asks his father and mother for Blauncheflur in vain.

. to his Fader he is coome. 220
 is Fader halle he is lyzt,
 Fader him grette anoone ryzt,
 . his moder, þe Queene, also,
 vnneþes myzt he þat doo, 224
 he ne asked where his Lemman bee;
 skyns answeƿe chargeþ hee.
 onge he is forth noome,
) Chamber he is coome. 228

. faderlonde he is icome
 . . halle he is alyzt
 . . . he grette anonryzt
 . þe quene he grette also 28
 . . haueþ his gretinge ido,
 . . askeþ war þat maide beo
 . . were nou targeþ heo.
 . . res hit haueþ vnder nome 32
 . boure & a is icome

isks the girl's mother.

naydenys moder he asked ryȝt,
 here is Blaunche flour, my swete wyȝt?"
 ," she seide, "forsothe ywys,
 woot where she is." 232

beþouȝt hur on þat lesyng⁺
 was ordeyned byfoore þe king⁺.
 I gabbest me," he seyde þoo,
 gabbyng⁺ doþ me muche woo. 236
 ne where my leman be."

wepyng⁺ seide þenne shee,
 . . . to hire anonriȝt
 [bl]anche flour mi suete wiȝt
 ful iwis 36
 war heo is

ine gabbinge deþ me wo; [leaf 6, col. 2]
 el me war my lemmon beo.
 I wepinge onsuerede heo, 40

her at length tells Floris that Blaunche flour is dead.

," shee seide, "deede." "deed!" seide he.
 ," sche seide, "for sothe, ȝee." 240
 as, when died þat swete wyȝt?"
 , withynne þis Fourtenyȝt [101 a]
 rth was leide hur aboute,
 . deed she was for thy loue." 244

ȝire," heo seyde, "ded." "ded!" quad he.
 ȝire," heo seyde, "for soþe ȝe,
 las, wenne deide my suete wyȝt?"
 ȝire," heo seyde, "wiþ inne þis seueniȝt 44
 at vrþe hire was leyd aboue,
 nd ded heo is for þine loue.

oons.

es, þat was so feire and gent,
nyd þere verament.
risten woman began to crye
hesu crist and seynt Marye. 248

ing⁺ and þe queene herde þat crye;
þe Chamber þey ronne on hye.
þe Queene herde her byforne
sowne þe Childe þat she had borne. 252

loyres þat was so fayr *and* gent,
e fel iswoue vp on þe pauement. 48
nd þe cristene wimmon gon to crie
o crist *and* to seyntemarie.
e king & þe quene iherdde þat cri;
i to þe bure þo vrne hy. 52
nd þe quene ate frome
y wepeþ hire dere sone.

inges hert was al in care,
sawe his sone for loue so fare.
en he a-wooke and speke moȝt,
e he wept and sore he syȝt, 256
seide to his moder ywys,
de me þere þat mayde is.”

nd þe kinges herte is ful of care
at he sikþ is sone vor loue so fare. 56
non he of swoninge awok *and* speke miste.
ore he wep *and* sore he syȝte,
nd on his moder he by siȝt.
Dame,” he sayde, “led me þar þat mayde 60
lyþ.”

er comes to him, and conducts him to the supposititious tomb.

er þey him brouȝt on hyȝe;
care and sorow he wolde dyȝe. 260
one as he to þe graue com,
e þere behelde he þen,

ider heo hine broute wel suþe,
or care a[n]d sorwe of hire deþe.
non þat he to þe burles com,
/el ȝerne he bi-hul þer-on, 64

ris reads the inscription on the monument, and swoons.

ids the inscription, and then swoons three times.

þe letters began to rede,
þus speke and þus seide: 264
re lyth swete Blauncheflour,
Florys louyd paramoure.”

sithes Florys sownydde nouth;
speke he myȝt not *with* mouth. 268
one as he awoke and speke myȝt,
þe he wept and sore he syȝt⁺.

nd letteres bigon to rede.
us spek *and* þus sede
at þar lay suete blancheflur.
þat] floyres louede par amur. 68
. . . . swouneþ nouþe

nd asone ase he speke myȝte.
ore he wep *and* sore he syȝte,
nd gon blancheflur bi mene 72
/it teres riue ase a *scur* of r[e]ne.

eps and sighs, and laments Blauncheflur’s death.

blancheflour!” he seide, “Blauncheflour!”
wete a þing was neuer in boure. 272

Blauncheflour is þat y meene,
she was come of⁺ good kyne.

Blancheflur,” he seide, “blancheflur,
o sute þing nas ner in bur,
or þou were ibore of gode cumme, [leaf 6, back]
or in worle nes nere non 76
ine imake of no wimmon.
Iou3 þou cupest of clergie
nd of alle curteysie. 80

Al and mucche loueden þe
þy goodnesse and þy beaute. 276
leþ were dalt ary3t,
shuld be deed boþ on oo ny3t.
oo day borne we were;
shul be ded boþ in feere.” 280

Al muchel *and* litel hit louede þe
or þi fayr hede *and* þi bunte.
if þat deþ were ideld ary3t,
we scholden habbe idized boþe in ar ny3t. 84
or in one deye ibore we were;
lid ri3te we scholden deie ifere.”

rophizes death.

eþ,” he seide, “ful of⁺ enuye, [101 b]

of alle trechorye,

e þou hast me my lemman.”

soth,” he seide, “þou art to blame. 284

wolde haue leuyd, and þu noldest,

fayne wolde y dye, and þu woldest.

Deþ,” he seyde, “vol of enuie,

and vol of alle tricherie, 88

lid traisun þou me hast mi lef binome.

bi-traie þat folk hit is þi wone;

eo wolde libbe and þu noldest.

ou nelt me slen and ihc wolde; 92

gap in MS.]

if þere me wolde þat þou were.

ul tu no wiȝt come þere,

and þer me wolde þat þou . . . ne come, 96

er þou wolt come Ilome.

ilke þat buste best to libbe,

em þou stikest under þe ribbe.

and ȝif þer is eni forliued wrecche,

at of is liue nouȝt ne recche, 100

at fawe wolde deie for sorewe & elde,

n hem neltou nouȝt bi helde.

o lengore ich nelle mi lef bileue,

chulle be mid hyre ere eue. 104

r deþ clepe nomore y nylle,

slee my self⁺ now y wille.” 288

ou after deþ clepie ich þe nulle,

c mi sulue aslen ich wille.”

tries to stab himself, but is prevented by his mother.

pts to stab himself with a knife, but is prevented by his mother.

knyf⁺ he braide out of his sheth;
 self he wolde haue doo to deth.
 to hert he had it smetene
 had his moder it vnder zetene. 292
 þe Queene fel him vppone,
 þe knyf⁺ fro him noome.
 reft⁺ him of⁺ his lytel knyf⁺,
 sauyd þere þe Childes lyf⁺. 296
 þe Queene ranne, al wepyng⁺,
 she come to þe kyng⁺.

se a mon þat draȝh him sulue to þe deþe,
 is knif he draȝh out of his scheþe, 108
 and to his herte hit wolde habbe ismite,
 adde his moder hit vnder gete.
 c þe queene his moder . . . fel vpon,
 þis knif heo him binom. 112
 eo bi nom him his atel knif.

[leaf 6, back, col. 2]

at heo com bi

queen discloses to Floris the deception.

n persuades the king to reveal the truth.

seide þe good lady,
ȝ goddes loue, *sir*, mercy! 300

xii. children haue we noone
yue now but þis oone.
better it were she were his make,
he were deed for hur sake.” 304

anne spac þe quene þe . . .
ȝ seyde to þe kinge, “sire, mercy, 116
ire, of þis children nabbe we non,
on aliue bote þis on,
ȝ bote hit were þat hit wer . . .
ane eyþer dezede vor oþer . . . 120

me, þou seist soþ,” seide he;
ȝ it may noone other be,
er me were she were his wyf⁺,
y lost my sonnes lyf⁺.” 308
þis word þe Quene was fayne,
to her soone she ran agayne.

Dame, þou seist soþ,” þo seyde he,
Nu hit nele non oþer bee.
euere me were þat heo were
ane ihc for lore mine sone l[yf].” 124
f þisse wordes þe quene w . . .
ȝ floyres, hire sone, . . .

him the facts, and together open the grave and find it empty.

ryes, soone, glad make the,
ef þou schalt on lyue see. 312
ys, sone, þrouȝ engynne
þy Faders reed and myne,
graue let we make,
e sone, for þy sake. 316
þou þat maide forgete woldest,
r oure reed wyf⁺ þou sholdest.”
Flores, sone, glad make þe .
or ut þou schalt þi lef . . . 128
eue sone
. . . fader rede *and* . . .
. . . wo . . .
eue sone so 132
or [*two lines illegible here*]
. . . vre rede . . .
euery worde she haþ him tolde,
þat þey þat mayden solde. 320
his soth, my moder dere?” [102 a]
his soth,” she seide, “she is not here.”
owȝ stoone adoune þey leyde,
sawe þat was not þe mayde. 324
. . . word *and* ende him .
ou hei habbeþ þat mayde, 136
and is þis soþ, mi moder dere?”
þe, for soþe,” heo nis not .
ane stond hii panne
e isay þat þere nas 140

clares his resolve to find Blauncheflur.

w, moder, y þink þat y leue may.
shal y rest nyȝt ne day,
t ne day ne no stounde,
y haue my lemmon founde. 328

u me þencheþ
. . . ne schal ihc
iȝt ne da
. . . ich 144

*[Some folios lost here. Continued at bottom
of page 84.]*

to seken y wołł wende,
ȝ it were to þe worldes ende.”
e king⁺ he goþ to take his leue,
his Fader bade him byleue. 332

, y wyl let for no wyne;
to bydden it it were grete synne.”
seid þe king⁺, “seth it is soo,
þou wylt noone other doo, 336
at þe nedeþ we shul þe fynde;
u þe of⁺ care vnbynde.”

ris equips a company with which to search for Blauncheflur.

bes to the king the retinue that he would like.

the Fader," he seide, "y telle þe
 at þou shalt fynde me. 340
 mast me fynde, at my deuyse,
 en horses al of⁺ prys,
 .twoo y-charged vppon^Þ þe molde
 with seluer and wyþ golde, 344
 .two ycharged with monay
 to spenden by þe way,
 .þree with clothes ryche,
 est of⁺ al þe kyngryche, 348
 en horses and seuyne^Þ men,
 .þre knaues without hem,
 .þyne owne Chamburlayne,
 is a wel nobel swayne. 352
 can vs wyssh and reede,
 narchaundes we shulþ vs lede."
 Fader was an hynde king⁺,

gives him also the marvellous cup, and an elegantly caparisoned 'palfray.'

Coupe of golde he dide him bryng⁺, 356
 ilke self⁺ Coupe of golde
 was Blaunche flour for 3olde.
 ue þis, soone," seide þe king⁺,
 rewith þou may þat swete þing⁺, 360
 nne so may betyde, [102 b]
 mche flour with þe white syde,
 mche flour, þat faire may."
 ing let sadel a Palfray, 364
 one half so white so mylke,
 .þat other reed so sylk⁺.
 can telle nouȝt
 v rychely þat sadel was wrouȝt. 368
 rson^Þ was of golde fyne,
 ies of vertu stode þeryne,
 one aboute wit orfreys.

n gives him a magic ring.

Queene was kynde and curtays, 372
: hur toward þe kyng⁺
of⁺ hur fynger she brayde a ryng⁺:

Cambridge MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2.

eo tok forþ a wel fair þing,
f hire finger a riche Ryng.

ue now þis ylke ryng⁺:
le is it þyne, douȝt no þyng⁺ 376
fire brennyng⁺ ne water in þe See;
ren^⁹ ne steele shal dere thee.”

Mi sone,” heo sede, “haue þis ring.
Whil he is þin, ne dute noþing, 4
at fur þe brenne ne adrenche se,
e ire ne steil ne mai þe sle.
nd to þi wil þu schalt habbe grace,
ate *and* rathe in eche place.” 8

ris and his company arrive at the haven.

es leave and comes to the haven,

ook⁺ his leue for to goo;
was ful muche woo; 380

↯ loris nimeþ nu his leue;
↯ No longer nolde he bileue.
He custe hem wiþ softe muþe;
l wepinge hi departeþ nuþe. 12

as at the same house where Blauncheflur had been.

made him noon^o other chere
her soon^o were leide in bere.

e made his Moder non o^oer chere,
ute also he were ileid on bere.
or him ne wende hi neuere mo
ft to sen; ne dude hi no.

16

o he went *with* al his mayn^o;
h him went þe Chamberlayn^o.
laue þey her hauyn^o nome
þey ben to þe hauyn^o come

384

Blanchefloure was alnyzt,
rychely þey ben dyzt;

388

orþ he wende wiþ al his mein,
nd wiþ him his fader chaumberlein.
ort to þe hauene hi beoþ icume,
nd þer habbeþ here in inome.
t þe selue huse hi buþ alizt
at blauncheflur was þat o^oer nizt.
iche soper þer was idizt,

20

l there good entertainment. All make good cheer except Floris,

ord of⁺ þe ynne was welle hende;
hild⁺ he sette next þe ende,
l þe feirest seete
þey dronken and al þey 3ete:

392

nd murie hi verden þer anizt.

24

loriz ne let for ne feo
o finden al þat neod beo,
f fless, of fiss, of tendre bred,
f whit win, *and* eke red.

28

lad *and* bliþe hi weren alle
at weren wiþ hem in þe halle,
nd pleide *and* gamenede ehc wiþ o^oer.

ks ever on Blauncheflur.

gap in MS.]

ne drynke myȝt he nouȝt;
blauncheflour was al his þouȝt.

c floriȝ þencheþ al on oþer, 32
or he net ne dronk riȝt noȝt.
n blauncheflur was al his þoȝt.

ris mourns. He hears of Blauncheflur, and is glad.

ess observes his ‘mourning,’ and tells him that she is reminded of the mourning of Blauncheflur.

ady of þat vnderȝat
þe Childe mornynȝ⁺ sat, 396
seide to her lord *with styl dreme*,
, nyme now goode ȝeme
þe Child⁺ mournynȝ syttes:
e and drynke he forȝetes: 400
l he eteþ, and lasse he drynkeþ; [103 a]
s a marchaund, as me þynkeþ.”

e lefdi of þer inne vnderȝat
at he *murninge* sat. 36
o hire louerd heo sede wiþ stille dreme,
ȝire, nimestu no ȝeme
u þis child *murninge* sit?
lete ne drinke he nabit. 40
e net mete ne he ne drinkeþ;
is he no marchaunt, ase me þinkeþ.”

Flores þen seide she,
 ful of⁺ mournyng⁺ y the see. 404
 sate þer þis sender day,
 inche flour, þat swete may.
 er was þat mayde brouȝt
 h Marchaundes þat hur had bouȝt; 408
 er þey brouȝt þat mayde swete;
 wold haue solde hur for byȝete;
 ȝabyloyne þey wylle hur brynge,
 of semblant & of⁺ mornynge.” 412

Floriz,” heo sede, “what mai þe beo,
 us murninge as ich þe seo? 44
 us her inne þis oþer day
 at blaunche flur, þat faire may.”
 rd *and* ende he haþ him told,
 u blaunche flur was þarinne isold. 48
No gap in MS.]

þu art hire ilich of alle þinge,
 oþe of semblaunt *and* of murninge,
 f fairnesse *and* of muchel hede,
 ute þu ert a man *and* heo a maide.” 52

oices at the mention of the name. He gives the hostess a silver cup, etc., and inquires further about Blaunche fl

en Florys herd speke of⁺ his lemman,
 he neuer so glad a man,
 in his hert bygan to lyȝt;
 loupe he let fulle anoon¹ ryȝt: 416
 o floriz iherde his lemman nempne,
 o blisful him þuȝte þilke steuene,
 e let fulle a cupe of win.

me,” he seide, “þe fessel is þyne,
 þe Coupe and þe wyne,
 wyne and þe gold eke,
 þou of my leman speke: 420
 þur y þouȝt, for þur y syȝt;
 wȝst where I þur fynde myȝt;
 ȝde ne weder shal me assoyne,
 y ne shal seche þur in Babyloyne.” 424

Dame,” he seide, “þis hail is þin, 56
 at win *and* þat gold eke,
 or þu of mi leman speke.
 or hire iþoȝte, for hire isiȝte,
 or inot wher hire seche miȝte. 60
 ire to seche iħc wille i wende,
 eȝ heo beo at þe wordles ende.”

⁊ Florys resteþ him al a nyȝt.

loriz geȝ to his rest;
 n blauncheflur he þoȝte mest. 64
 c rest ne miȝte he nabbe none,
 ort þe dide slep him nome.

s sail once more.

orne, when it was day lyȝt,
 lide him in-to þe wylde flood⁺.
 ȝde and weder *with* him stood; 428
 e so Florys come to londe,
 he þanked goddes sonde

moreȝe so sone so hit was day
 e tok his leue *and* wente his way, 68
 nd dude him into þe salte flod;
 e hadde wind *and* weder ful god.
 e Mariner he ȝaf largeliche,
 at broȝte him ouer blupeliche. 72

ris reaches the land where his Leman is.

s in the country where his leman is.

he londe þer his lyf⁺ ynne is:
I þouȝt he was in paradyse. 432

er hi wolden hem self alonde,
or hi funden hem so hende,
o þe lond þer his lemman is;
im þuȝte he was in parais. 76

e to Florys tydyng men tolde
þe Amyral wold⁺ Fest holde;
Erls, Barons, comyn^l sholde,
al þat wold⁺ of him lond holde, 436
to herkyn^l his hest
for to honoure his Feest.

non me him tiþinge tolde
at þe admiral wolde feste h[olde].
rles, baruns þer come sch[olde],
nd þat wolden of him h[olde]. 80

I was Florys of þat tydyng⁺;
I hoped to come to þat gestyng⁺, 440
he myȝt, in þat halle,
lemman see among hem alle.

liþe was floriz of þe tiþinge;
e hopede come to þat gesninge.
el he hopede among hem alle
is lemman sen in þe halle. 84

ƷW to þat Citee Florys is come; [103 b]
e he hath his ynne y-noome 444
palaise; was none it lyche;
ord of þat ynne was fulle ryche;
iadde ben ferre and wyde.

Ʒ a riche Cite hi buþ icume;
aire hi habbeþ here in inome,
t one paleis suþe riche;
e lord of þer inne nas non his liche. 88
im feol gold inoʒ to honde,
oþe in water *and* in londe.

1 there is good cheer, and Floris enters into conversation with the host.

þhilde he set next his syde, 448
l þe feirest seete.
þey dronken and ete,
at þerynne were,
ey made good chere, 452
ete and dronke echoon¹ *with* other;
Florys þouʒt al another,
ne drynke he myʒt noʒt,
Blaunche flour was al his þouʒt. 456

e hadde ilad his lif ful wide;
is child he sette next his side. 92
lad *and* bliþe hi weren alle,
o fele so were in þe halle.
No gap in MS.]

c floriz net ne dronk noʒt;
f blaunche flour was al his þoʒt. 96

spake þe Burgays
 was hende and Curtays:
 7, child⁺, me þynkeþ welle
 muche þou þynkest on my catelle.” 460
 y, sir, on Catel þenke y nouȝt,”
 Blaunche flour was al his þouȝt,
 t y þynke on al wyse
 to fynde my marchaundise; 464
 ȝit it is þe most woo,
 en y it fynd, y shal it forgoo.”
 e lord of þerinne vnderȝat
 at þis child murninge sat.
 Floriz,” he sede, “what mai þe beo,
 us murninge þat ihc þe seo? 100
 spak⁺ þe lord of⁺ þat ynne,
 sender day, þer sate hereyne 468
 faire Maide Blaunche flour,
 in halle and in boure.
 r she made mornyng chere,
 bement Florys, her lyf⁺ fere; 472
 ne blis made she noon),
 for Florys she made her moon).”
 ȝus herinne þis oþer day
 ȝat blaunche flour þat faire may.
 In halle ne in bur ne at bord,
 ȝf hire ne herde we neure a word. 104
 ȝute of floriz was hire mone;
 heo] nadde in herte ioie none.”

ys toke a Coupe of⁺ syluer clere,
 antyl of⁺ Scarlet *with* menyuere: 476
 ue þis, *sir*, to þyn^⁹ honour;
 may þonke it Blaunche flour.
 nyȝt make myn^⁹ hert glade,
 couþ me tel wheder she is ladde.” 480

ʌhanne] herde he nempnen his lemman,
 ȝliþe] he was iwis for þan. 108
 ȝe lat] bringe a cupe of seluer
 And eke] a pane of menuuer.
 ʌanne] he sede, “haue þis to þin honur,
 ȝo þ]u speke of blaunche flour. 112
 þu miȝtest make min heorte ful glad;
 þu tel]le me wuder heo were ilad.”
 ʌanne] sede þe burgeis,
 þat was] wel hende *and* curtais, 116

innkeeper tells Floris how the Admiral bought Blaunche flour.

tells him that Blaunche flour has been sold to the Admiral at Babylon.

ild⁺, to Babyloyne she is brouȝt;
 myral hur haþ bouȝt:
 ȝaf⁺ for hur, as she stood vpryȝt, [104 a]
 en sithes of⁺ gold hur wyȝt; 484
 he þenkeþ *with*-out weene,
 faire may haue to Queene.
 ong⁺ his maydons in his toure
 ur dide, *with* much honoure.” 488
 To Babi]lloigne he was ibroȝt;
 e adm]iral hire haȝ iboȝt.”

⁊ Flores restep him þere al nyȝt,
on þe morrow þe day was lyȝt;
⁊ oos on þe morownyng⁺,
ȝaf⁺ his Ost an hundryd shelyng⁺, 492

c reste ne miȝte he habbe none;
ort þe dide slep him nome.
moreȝe so sone so hit was day,
e nem his liue, *and* wende his way. 124

⁊ es the host a hundred shillings, and asks his assistance.

his ost and to his Ostesse,
toke his leue, and feire dide kysse;
and for his niȝtes gestinge
e ȝaf his oste an hundred schillinge.

⁊ ȝerne his ost he besouȝt,
he him help, ȝif he myȝt ouȝt, 496
he myȝt⁺, *with* any gynne,
feire may to him wyne.

and ȝerne he haȝ his oste bisoȝt
at he him helpe wiȝ al his þoȝt, 128
⁊ Babilloine, oȝer wher a beo,
at he miȝte hire iseo,
u he miȝte mid sume ginne,
is *lemman* blauncheflur awinne. 132
anne sede þe burgeis,
at was hende *and* curtais,

MS. Cott. Vitell. D. III.

. by souht [leaf 7]
. mid al his mauht
. frend in babiloyne hadde
. wisede *and* wel radde
. . he mihte mid eni ginne
. . blancheflour iwinne

innkeeper gives Floris instructions.

ilde,” he seide, “to a brygge þou shalt come,
Senpere fynde at hoome: 500
woneth at þe brygges ende;
ays man he is, and hende;
arn^þ bretheren, and trouthes plyȝt:
an þe wyssh and rede a-ryȝt; 504
t babilloine atte frume,
o one brigge þu schalt cume. 136
thane þu comest to þe ȝate,
e porter þu schalt find þarate.
el hende man *and* fair he is;
e is icluped sire daris. 140
li felaze he is þureȝ truþe ipliȝt,
nd he kan rede þe ariȝt.

. one longe brugge þou schalt come
. . ngere finde þer ate frome.
. . c is ate brugge ende
. . mon he is *and* hende
. . breþeren *and* treweþe ipliht
. . wisi *and* reden wel riht.

eeper sends him with a ring of introduction to the bridge porter at Babylon.

shalt bere him a ryng
my-self⁺ to tokenyng,
he help þe in boure and halle
t were my self⁺ befalle.” 508

awe *and* ber him þis ring,
n mine halue to tokning, 144
at he þe helpe in alle halue,
se he wolde me selue.”

. . . bere him neseno [FB3](#) ring
. to toking
. elpe on eche halue

[FB.3](#) ?

ys takeþ þe ryng⁺, and nemeþ leue,
long⁺ wold⁺ he nouȝt beleue.

loriz herof was wel bliþe,
nd þonkede his oste wel suiþe. 148
eire of him he nimeþ leue;
o lengur nolde he bileue.

. *and* takeþ is leue
. þer by sene

es leave, and by midday reaches the bridge and finds the porter.

þat it was vndern³ hy3e,
 þrygge come he swyð nye. 512
 þenperes name was Darys.

ys gret him wel feire ywys,
 þe him þe ryng⁺ arau3t,
 ful feire it him betau3t. 516

iþat hit was middai hi3,
 loriz was þe brigge ni3. 152

e he com to þe gate
 e porter he fond anon þerate,
 ittinde one a marbelston,
 uþe fair *and* hende mon, 156
 nd so him sede child floriz,
 Rest þe murie, sire daris,”

. ondarne hey3
 [bru]gge suiþe ney3
 þane brugge icome
 bruggere ate frome
 a Marbreston
 mon he was on
 was of Muchel pris
 him sulf iwis
 ys was i hote doyre
 s him grette wel fayre
 him þane ring arauht
 . . [d] ayre hine him bi tauht

ris presents his ring of introduction to Daris.

resents the ring, and is hospitably received.

13 þe token of þat ilk⁺ ryng⁺
ys had ful faire gestnyng⁺
Fyssh and flessch and tender breed⁺,
wyn^l, both white and reed⁺: 520

nd tok him to tokne þis ring;
nd þerfore he hauede wel fair gestning. 160
lade *and* bliþe hi weren alle,
o fele so weren in þe halle,

. . . þe tockne of þe ringe
hadde þer aniht wel gode gistinge
. . . b of fles of tendre bred
. . . t win *and* eke of red

s mourning.

. euer Florys sate ful colde,
. Dares bygan þe Childe beholde:

c floriz net ne dronk noȝt;
n blauncheflur was al his þoȝt 164
ire daris vnderȝet
at floriz murninge set.

. . . re floyres sike *and* colde
. . . gon þat chil by holde

s if he is not pleased with his entertainment.

1e Child, what may þis be, [104 b]
þouȝtful as y the see? 524
. þou nouȝt al in feere,
þou makist þus sory chere,
þou lykkest noȝt þis yn^l?”

Floriz,” he sede, “what mai þe beo,
o þoȝtful ase ihc þe seo? 168
le þincheþ bi þine chire,
u nert noȝt glad of þi sopere,
þer þe ne likeþ noȝt þis in.”

. . . wat may þe be
. . . . þe i see
. uoice al fere
. ele chere.
. þin in.” [leaf 7, col. 2]

Floreys answered him^Þ: 528
, sir, by goddes ore,
good ne had y mony day 3ore:
let me abyde þat daye
y þe quyte wel may: 532

o floriz ansuerede him: 172
Sire,” he sede, “bi godes ore,
o god in nauede ihc wel 3ore,
re louerd me lete ibide þe day
at ihc hit þe zulde may. 176

ot floyres onswerede him,
Nay, sire, bi godes ore,
o god nadde [I] wel 3ore.
od lete me abide þane day
at ich hit þe 3elde May.

Is him, in veiled words, his real trouble.

y þenke on al wyse
it vppon^Þ my marchaundyse;
gap in MS.]

. 3it it is most woo,
en y hit Fynde, y shal it forgoo.” 536

ic þenche, sire, on fele wise
u vpon mi marchaundise,
ast ine finde no3t atte frume
at þing for whi ihc am hider icume. 180
nd þe3 ihc hit finde hit is mi wo
est ihc schulle hit forgo.”

c ich þenche on alle wise
þpon mine Marchaundise
⁊are vore ich am hider icome,
est ich ne feynde hit ate frome,
⁊d þat is 3et mi meste wo,
if ich hit finde *and* hit forgo.

s him speak plainly, and Floris speaks out.

gap in MS.]

ilde, woldest þou telle me my gryf⁺,
iele þe, me were ful lyf⁺.”

o sede daris, þe freo burgeis,
at was wel hende *and* curteis, 184
⁊ain ihc wolde þe rede *and* lere,
at þu muche þe betere were,
ef þu toldest me þi gref,
o rede þe me were lef.” 188

hild, woldest þou telle me of þi gref
o helpe þe me were lef.

ris tells his story to Daris.

ry word he haþ him tolde,
þe mayde was fro him solde, 540
how he was of⁺ Spayn^Þ a kynges sone,
grete loue þider y-come,
onde, *with* quantyse and *with* gyn^Þ,
incheflour for to wyne. 544

o floriz bigan his consail schewe,
nd to daris beon iknewe.
rd *and* ende he haþ him told,
u blauncheflur was isold, 192
nd hu he was a kinges sune,
or hire luue þider icume,
o fonde þureȝ sume cunnes ginne
is lemman blauncheflur biwinne. 196

nd now floyres him haueþ itold
ou þat mayd from him wa sold,
nd hou he was of spayne one kinges sone,
or hire loue þider icome.

is begins to tell of the Admiral and the city.

es him to be a fool, and proceeds to tell the strength of the Admiral and the size of the city.

w,” seith Dares, “þou art a Folt,”—

For a Foole þe Childe he halt,—

w y woot how it gooth,

desirest þyn^o own^o death.

548

Amiral hap to his Iustinges

þer half⁺ hundred of ryche kinges;

þe Alder-rychest king⁺

st not begynne suche a þing⁺.

552

Arise þanne floriz bihalt,

And for more þane fol him halt.

Floriz,” he sede, “iseo hu hit geþ;

And ert abute þinoze deþ.

200

The Admiral haueþ to his gestninge

þer half hundred of riche kinges.

þe þer nis non so riche king

that dorste entermeten of eni such þing,

204

ilke maide to awinne,

þer wiþ strengþe ne wiþ ginne,

þou doyres þat chil[d] by halt,

And for a fol he hine halt.

Child, nou ich wot al hou hit geþ;

þis þou welnest þin owene deþ.

The amirel haueþ to his iustninge

þer half hondert of riche kinge,

þe alre richeste kinge

that dorste bi ginne swch a þing.

Amyral myȝt it vnderstonde,
shulde be drawe in his owne londe,
out Babyloyne, y wene,
longe myle and tene; 556
uery myle is a walle þerate,
en sithes twenty ȝate;
.xx. toures þer ben ynne,
euery day chepyng is ynne; 560

nd þe Admiral hit miȝte iwite,
at he nere of his lif aquite. 208
nd Babilloine, ihc vnderstonde,
ureþ abute furterniȝt gonde.
bute þe walle þer buþ ate,
euesiþe tuenti ȝates. 212
nd ine þe bureȝ amidde riȝt
eoþ twe tures ipiȝt.

nd mihste þe amirayl hit vnder ȝete,
one of his liue he were quite.
boute babiloyne beþ to ȝonge wiþoute wene,
ixti longe Mile *and* tene,
nd ate walle þer beþ ate,
euesiþe tuenti ȝate.
nd tueye toures þer beþ inne,
at þe chepinge is eche day inne.

ry day and nyȝt þrouȝ-out þe ȝere
chepyng⁺ is y-lyche plenere;
þauȝ al þe men þat ben bore, [105 a]
on hur lyf⁺ swore 564
vynne þat maide feire and free,
hul þey die, so moot y the.

che day in al þe ȝere
e feire is þer iliche plenere. 216
eue hundred tures *and* two
eoþ in þe burȝ, biþute mo.

is þer day þoruh out þan 3er,
 at þe chepinge is iliche plener.
 eue hundred tures, wit outhen þan tuo,
 [er] beþ in þan boruh *and* somdel mo.
 e alre febleste tour
 olde nouht duti þe amperur.

Description of the maidens' 'tower.'

s of the 'towers,' the spring, the wonderful carbuncle,

at bour, in mydward py3t,
 ideþ a toure, y the ply3t, 568
 ʀundryd fathum^ʃ it is hye,—
 ʃ-soo beholdeþ hit, fer or nere,
 ʀundred fathum it is y-fere;—
 made *with-out*[en] pere, 572

nd ine þe bur3 amidde ri3t,
 eoþ twe tures ipi3t, 220

or to come þer wiþ inne,
 o þer wid stregþe ne wid ginne.
 [leaf 7, back]

.
 a3en woo
 schal to iwinne þat Mayd al so sone
 þe sonne *and* mone.
 . . þe bor . . . mid rift
 aplyft
 . hondred teyse þe tour is heie
 by halt fur *and* nei.
 ʀd an hundret teyse hit is wid,
 ʀd imaked wiþ muchel pruid.

yme and of Marbulstone;	
l þis world ⁺ is suche noone.	
is þe mortar made so wele,	
nay it breke, iren ne steele.	576
omel þat aboue is leide,	
made <i>with</i> mucche pride;	
f lym <i>and</i> of marbelston;	
i þe world nis swich <i>tur</i> non.	
i þe tur þer is a welle,	
uþe cler hit is wiþ alle.	224
e vrneþ in o pipe of bras,	
hider so hit ned was.	
ram flore in to flore	
e strimes vrneþ store,	228
ram bure in to halle	
e strimes of þis welle.	
i þe tur is o kernel	
f seluer <i>and</i> of crestel.	232
n þe tur anouenon	
a charbugleston	
at ȝiueþ leme day <i>and</i> niȝt,	
e bi hit neure so derk niȝt.	236
f lym <i>and</i> of marbel ston;	
i cristiante nis swich non.	
at mortar is i maked se wel,	
e May hit breke ire ne stel.	
nd þe pomel about þe lede	
i wrouht mit so	

man ne þar in þe Tour berne
 ther torcher [FB4](#) ne lanterne; 580
 æ a pomel was þer bygone,
 shyned a nyȝt so doþ þe soone.

[B.4](#) MS. torthther

ȝ þe bureȝ ne darf me berne
 ampe ne torche ne lanterne,
 at he ne ȝiueþ liȝt *and* leme
 s doþ a day þe sunne beme. 240

e þarf me aniht
 ouþer torche
 a pomel

⁊ the maidens are guarded.

⁊ on guard,

gap in MS.]

e porter is prud wiþalle;
 che day he goþ on þe walle.
 nd ef þer comeþ eniman
 iþinne þilke barbecan, 244
 ute he him ȝeue leue,

e wule him boþe bete *and* reue.
 e porter is culuart *and* felun;
 e wule him sette areisun. 248

orty-four maidens kept in the ‘high tower.’

7 arn^Þ in þat ilk⁺ Tour
 o and fourty nobel^þ boure; 584
 were þat ilke man
 myzt woone in þat oon^Þ!
 lurst him neuer more ywys
 ete after more blysse. 588

Þer buþ in þe hiȝe tur
 orti Maiden^{es} *and* four.
 7el were þat ilke mon
 at miȝte winne wiþ þat on. 252
 e þorte he neure ful iwis
 7ilne more of *paradis*.

. . . . beþ in þan . . .
 oure *and* fourti
 7at wel were þat ilke
 . Mihte wonie

[About twenty lines illegible here.]

7 arn^Þ þer Seriauntes in þat stage
 seruen þe maydons of hyȝe *parage*;
 no serieaunt may serue þerynne
 bereþ in his breche þat gynne 592
 erue hem day and nyȝt,
 he be as a Capoun dyȝt.

e gate is a ȝateward⁺;
 s not a Coward⁺; 596
 s wonder proude *with* alle;
 ry day he goþ in ryche palle.

er buþ seriauns in þe stage
 at serueþ þe maiden^{es} of *parage*. 256
 c ne mot þer *non* ben inne
 at one þe breche bereþ þe ginne,
 oþer bi daie ne biniȝt,
 ute he also capun beo idiȝt. 260

iral takes a new wife each year.

þe Amyral haþ a wonder woon^Þ,
he þat is come of cristendome, 600
ry 3ere to haue a new wyf⁺,
he loueþ his Queene as his lyf⁺.

nd þe Admiral is such a gume,
al þe world nis such a sune.
e bu his wife neure so schene,
ute o 3er ne schal heo beon his quene. 264
e3 heo luue him ase hire lif,
at he nele habbe anoþer wif.
nd, floriz, imai þe telle fore,
eo schal beon his quene icore. 268

euer . . . [leaf 7, back, col. 2]
o chesen hire
ey3 he louede is quene

cription of the wonderful orchard.

lens are brought down into a beautiful orchard in which is a marvellous spring and a wonderful tree.

n shul men brynge down) of þe Toure [105 b]
e Maidens of grete honour, 604
. brynge hem into an Orchard⁺,
eirest of al mydlerd⁺:

rn is mony fowles song⁺;
i myȝt leue þeryn ful long⁺: 608
ut þe Orchard is a walle,—
owlest stone is Cristalle,—

lle þe maidenen of parage
le schal bringe adun of þe stage,
nd leden hem in to on orchard,
e faireste of al þe Middellerd. 272
bute þe orchard is a wal;
e eþelikeste ston is cristal.
o so wonede a moneþ in þat spray,
olde him neure longen away. 276
o merie is þerinne þe fozeles song,
at ioie *and* blisse is eure among.

le schul fecche adoun of þe . . .
lle þe maydenen of parage.
ad bringe hem in on orcharde
e fayreste of þe middel[erd].
er is fowelene song
e mihte wel libbe hem a[mong]
bute þan orchard is a wa[l] .
umme of þe stones be . . .
er me may ise uppon a . . .
write muchel of þe w . . .

a wełł spryngēþ þerynne, is made <i>with</i> mucche gynne;	612
vel is of ⁺ mucche prys, tremes com froo Paradyse; rauel of ⁺ þe ground is <i>precious</i> stoonēs, al of vertu for þe noones.	616
is þe wełł of mucche auȝt;	
i þe orchard is a welle at is suþe cler wiþ alle.	280
ic mai seggen iwīs, e strimes comeþ fram paradis. or in þe strimes þe smale stones, i beoþ þer funden eurech one,	284
oþe saphirs <i>and</i> sardoines, nd suþþe riche cassidoines, nd Iacinctes and topaces, nd onicle of muchel <i>grace</i> ,	288
nd mani on oþer direwerþe ston at ich nu nempne ne can. boue þe walle stant atreo at faireste þat miȝte in erþe beo.	292
it is ihote þe treo of luue, or lef <i>and</i> blosme beoþ þer buue. o sone so þe olde beoþ idon, er springeþ niwe riȝt anon.	296
lle þilke þat clene maidenēs beo, chulle sitte arewe vnder þat treo; nd which falleþ on þat furste flur chal beo <i>quene and</i> fonge þonur.	300

nd a welle þat springeþ
 at is i mad mid muchel
 is welle is . . . Muchel
 at grauel bi þe
 nd of v . . eu
 f safir . . . and of
 f omcie and of
 e welle is al

marvellous spring and marvellous tree.

iden, who is not a virgin, approach the spring, the water boils up as if mad.

a woman com þat is for-lauzt,
 . she be doo to þe streeme
 to wesshe her honndes clene, 620
 vater wylle 3elle as it were wood⁺,
 . bycome red as blood⁺.
 what maide þe water fareþ soo,
 e she shal to deþ be doo. 624
 þat ben maidens clene,
 may wesshe þeryn, y wene;
 vater wol stonde feire and clere;
 iem makeþ it no daungere. 628
 e walles hed stondeþ a tree,
 eirest þat on erthe may be;
 cleped þe tree of loue:
 vers and blossomes spryngen aboue; 632
 ef þer is eni maide forleie,
 e wal is of so muchel eie,
 n heo stepe to þe grunde,
 or to wassche hire honde, 304
 a bulmeþ vp so he were wod,
 nd chaungeþ fram water in to blod.
 n wuche þe welle fareþ so,
 lso suiþe he wurþ fordo. 308

if þer come
 . . . ho
 or
 . w . . wele
 . come al so
 . wlyche w
 /el sone
 lle þat

 . . wole

*[About nine more lines illegible. Several
 folios lost here.]*

len upon whom first falls a blossom from this tree is chosen queen.

þey þat maydons clene bene,
 shul be brouȝt vnder þe trene,
 . which so falleþ þe floure,
 l be queene *with* mucche honour. 636

any mayden þer is
 þe Amyral telleþ of⁺ more pris,
 lour shal be to her sent
 iȝ art of⁺ enchauntement. 640

c ȝef þer eni maiden is,
 at þe Admiral luueþ mest of pris,
 n hire schal beo þat flur i went,
 ureȝ coniureson *and* chauntement. 312

amyrall cheseþ hem by þe flour,
 . euer he herkenep after Blaunche flour.
 e sithes Flores sownyd anoon^Þ [106 a]
 byfore hem euerychoon^Þ: 644
 en he awoke, and speke myȝt⁺,
 e he wept, and sore he syȝt,
 us he cheoseþ his wif þureȝ þe flur;
 lle wenep hit schulle beo blaunche flour.”
 ic wene ne darf me axi noȝt
 floriz were of dreri þoȝt. 316

is suggests to Floris a plan.

plores the aid of Daris.

. seide, “Dares, y worth now deed⁺,
 þat y hope of þe som reed⁺.” 648
 ie soon^Þ, wyl ȝe see
 þy trust is mucche on me;
 is þe best⁺ reed þat y can^Þ—
 er reed ne can y noon^Þ— 652

Daris,” he sede, “ihc wurthe ded
 ute if þu do me summe red.”
 anne se Daris, þe freo burgeis,
 at was wel hende *and* curteis, 320
 Floriz,” he sede, “leue man,
 e beste red þat ihc þe can,

s him go, disguised as a mason, to the tower,

ide to-morn^l to þe toure
 ou were a good gynoure;
 e on þy honde squyer and scantlon^l
 ou were a free mason^l; 656
 old⁺ þe tour vp and down^l,
 orter is cruel and Feloun^l;
 sone he wyl come to the,
 aske what maner man þou be, 660
 bere on þe, Felonye,
 sey þou art come to be a spye.

/end tomoreȝe to þe Tur,
 Iso þu were a gud ginnur. 324
 er wiþ þe squire *and* schauntillun,
 Iso þu were a gud Mascun.
 ihold of þe ture þe hiȝhede,
 nd wiþ þi fot met þe brede. 328
 e porter is culuert *and* felun;
 orþ he wule setten his resun,
 nd bere vpon þe felonie,
 nd segge þat þu art a spie. 332

re the porter to play at draughts.

. þow shalt⁺ answere swetlyche,
 . sey to him myldelyche, 664
 þou art a gynoure,
 eholde þat feire Toure,
 to loke and for to fonde
 nake suche another in þy londe. 668

nsuare him wel hendeliche,
 nd spek wiþ him wel sueteliche,
 nd seie þert icome fram ferren londe,
 or to seche *and* for to fonde, 336

gap in MS.]

sone he wyl com þe nere,	
. wyl byd þe play at þe chekere.	
en þou art at cheker brouȝt,	
hout seluer [be] þou nouȝt;	672
shalt haue redy <i>with</i> the	
Marke beside þy knee;	
<u>þou</u> wyne ouȝt of ⁺ his,	
tel þerof ⁺ lytel prys;	676
. yf ⁺ he wyne ouȝt of ⁺ þyn ^l ,	
þow leue it with hym ^l ;	
ou shalt, al <i>with</i> gynne,	
orters loue forsoth wyne,	680
he þe help on þis day:	
he þe helpe, no man may.	

mi lif so longe ilast,
 o makie atur after þis cast,
 i þine londe ate frume
 /hane þu ert hom icume. 340
 /hane he þe hireþ speke so hendeliche,
 nd ansuerie so sueteliche,
 enne he wule come þe nier,
 nd bidde þe pleie at þe escheke. 344
 /hane þescheker is forþ ibrozt
 iþute panes ne plei þu nozt.
 u most habbe redi mitte
 wenti Marc ine þi slitte. 348
 e3 þu biwinne ozt of his,
 old hit of wel litel pris.
 he biwinneþ ozt of þe,
 if him of þine suche þre. 352
 luche he wule þonki þe
 nd of þe suþe iwundred beo,
 or he is suþe couetus,
 nd at þescheker enuius. 356

ails of the plan.

him so as to secure an invitation for the morrow.

3erne he wyl þe bydde and pray [106 b]
 ie anoper day to playe: 684
 shalt seye þou wylt soo;
 shalt take *with* þe suche twoo;
 erne he wile þe bidde *and* preie
 at þu come amore3e *and* pleie.
 rante him þat þu wilt so,
 nd tak mid amore3e suche two. 360

gap in MS.]

rydde day take an hundred pound⁺,

nd wel þi nedes for to do
at þridde day þu wend him to,
nd ber wiþ þe forti pund,

n your cup, and he will be greedy for it.

þy Coupe hool and sound⁺: 688

e him markes & poundes of þy male;

þy tresour tel þou no tale;

þerne he wyl þe bydde and pray

ay þy Coupe, and to play. 692

shalt answer alþerfirst,

ger to play þe ne lyst.

much he wylle for þe Coupe bede,

he myȝt þe better spede; 696

nd þine cupe hol *and* sund. 364

þanne þu lest lest him þe cupe iseo,

þel angussus he wile beo.

e wile beo wel coveitus,

nd hire to bigge suþe fus. 368

luchel he þe wule beode

him miȝte þe betere spede.

ic wot he wille þilke day

onure þe so muche so he may. 372

give him the cup.

shalt it blethly ȝeue him
t be of⁺ gold fyne;
he wol ful moche loue þe,
to þe bowe also, *parde*, 700

e wule þe lede to his inne
e cupe of þe to biwinne.
erne he wule þe bidde and *preie*
at þu legge þe cupe to pleie. 376
u him ansuere atte furste,
at no leng pleie þe ne luste.
nsuere him wel hendeliche,
in beo þe cupe,' seie blupeliche. 380
or his gode *compaygnie*
wunne he hap þi druerie.

gap in MS.]

ic wot þat he mai alrebest
f þine neode helpe þe mest. 384
u miȝt segge, 'þe ne faileþ non
old ne seluer ne riche won.'
eie þu wilt parte wiþ him of þan,
at he schal eure beo riche man. 388
/hanne he hereþ þe speke so richeliche,
nd ansuerie so hendeliche,
anne he wile beo wel bliþe,
nd biginne to luuie þe suiþe, 392

him unlimited gold and silver if he will aid you. He will then fall at your feet and be your man.

he wyl falle to þy foote,
become þyn^l, 3if⁺ he moote.
homage þou shalt fonge,
þe trouþ of his honde.” 704

nd falle he wile to þi fote,
nd bcome þi man, if he mote.
is manrede þu schalt fonge,
nd his truþe of his honde, 396
at he þe bere al þe helde
at man schal to his louerd 3elde.
nd þus þure3 þe cupe and his ginne
u mi3t þi lemman best awinne. 400
anne þu mi3t beon iknewe,
nd þi cunsail to him schewe.”

this plan Floris wins over the ‘porter.’

he seide, he dide ywys;
as he ordeynd, so it is:
porter ys Florys man bycome,
his gold⁺ and his warysone. 708

nd alþus floris hath iwro3t,
s daris him haþ ita3t. 404
c þureþ (sic) þe cupe and þure3 gersume,
e porter is his man bcome.

eal to him your wishes.

ys seide, “now art þou my moon^l,
ny trust is þe vppon^l;
my consel y wyl þe shewe;
e me ry3t, 3if⁺ þou be trew.” 712

Nu quap floriz, “þu art mi man;
l mi trest is þe vpon. 408
eruore þu most me helpe nede;
ipute þe ne mai me sped.”

s as advised, and discloses his identity.

⁊ euery word he haþ him tolde,
⁊ þe mayde was fro him sholde,
how he was of⁺ Spayn[⁊] a kynges soon[⁊],
grete loue þeder ycoom[⁊] 716
onden, *with* some gynne,
feire mayde for to wynne.

rd *and* ende he haþ him told,
u þat maide was isold, 412
nd hu he was of spaygne a kinges sune,
or hire luue he was þider icume,
o fonde mid sume kunnes ginne,
u he miȝte hire awinne. 416

porter covers Floris in a basket of flowers.

er at first reproaches himself, but presently promises his aid.

porter þat herde, and sore syȝt,	
seide, “y am betrayde aryȝt;	720
ȝ þy Catel, y am dismayde;	
ore y am wel euyl a-payde	
ȝ y woot how it goop;	[107 a]
þe shal y suffre deth;	724
al þe faile neuere moo,	
while y may ryde and goo;	
forwardes shal y holde alle,	
at-so-euer may befalle.	728
ȝde now hoom ^l to þyn ^l ynne	
le y beþenke me of sum gynne;	
weene þis and þe þrydde day.	
de y shal, what y do may.	732
es spake and wept amonge	
þouȝt þe terme al to longe.	
o þe porter iherde þis, he siȝte,	
“he am,” he seide, “bitraid wiþ riȝte,	
at þureȝ þis cupe <i>and</i> þis gersume	
ȝc am nu þi man bicume.	420
u ihc seo hu hit gep;	
or þe ihc drede þolien deþ.	
oȝt for þan while ihc mai go,	
ne schal þe failli neuere mo.	424
ȝhat me bitide oþer bifalle,	
ȝc schal þe foreward holden alle.	
wend nu, floriz, to þin inne,	
ȝhile i biþenche of sume ginne.	428
ȝc wulle fonde what ido may	
ituene þis <i>and</i> þe þridde day.”	
loriz siȝte <i>and</i> weop among	
ulke terme him þuȝte long.	432

porter þouȝt þe best reed,
let geder floures in a meed⁺; 736
vist it was þe maydons wylle.
epes he lete of floures fyllē:

 E porter þoȝte what to rede;
 He let flures gadere on þe mede.
 Cupen he let fulle of flures,
 o strawen in þe maidenēs bures. 436

s Floris in a basket of flowers, which is borne above.

was þe best reed, as him þouȝt þoo,
ires in þat oon^l lep to doo. 740
o maydens þe lepe bore;
ieuȝ charged neuer þey wore,
bade god ȝeue hem euyl fyne;
nony floures he dide þerynne. 744
Blaunchefloures Chamber þey shulde tee;
ȝede to anoþer, and let þat be:
shuld haue gone to Blauncheflour,
ȝede to swete Clarys boure, 748

at was his red to helpe him so;
e let floriz on þat on cupe go.
uei gegges þe cupe bere,
nd for heuie wroþ hi were. 440
i beden God ȝiue him vuel fin,
at so manie flures dude þerin.
o þe chaumbre þer hi scholde go,
e ȝeden hi ariȝt no. 444
o anoþer chaumbre hi beoþ agon,
o blauncheflures chaumbre non.

stakes another maiden for Blauncheflur and leaps forth.

. cursed him so fele brouȝt to honde;
 ȝede hoom¹, and lete hem stonde.
 ys to þe lepe come wolde,
 'lores to hondel and to be-holde; 752
 ys wende it hadde be his swete wyȝt;
 þe lepe he stert vpryȝt;
 e cupe hi sette to þe grunde,
 nd goþ forþ *and* leteȝ hire stonde. 448
 maiden com *and* wolde
 e flures handlen *and* biholde.
 loriz wende hit were his swete wiȝt;
 t of þe cupe he lep ariȝt; 452
 len cries out.
 . þe mayde, al for drede,
 an to shrelle and to grede. 756
 nd þat maide, for þe drede,
 igan to crie *and* to grede.
 vers himself again.
 en he sawȝ it was not shee,
 o þe lepe aȝen¹ stert he,
 . held⁺ him betrayde clene;
 his lyf⁺ tolde he not a beene. 760
 o nuste floriz what to rede,
 or þe ferlich þat he hadde. 456
 ito þe cupe he sterte aȝen,
 nd wiþ þe flures he hudde him.
 is maide þoȝte anon riȝt
 at hit was floriz, þat suete wiȝt, 460
 or here chaumbres niȝ were;
 elde was þat hi togadere nere;
 nd ofte blauncheflur hire hadde itold
 u heo was fram him isold. 464

ris discovers Floris.

come maydons, and to Clarys lepe

en, by twelf⁺, on an heepe

. þey asked what hur were,

[107 *b*]

. why she made suche a bere.

764

ys byþouȝt hur anooneryȝt

hit was Blaunche flour þe white,

u Maiden es comeþ in to hire lepe,

/ei fiftene in on hepe,

nd axede hire what hire were,

nd whi heo made suche bere.

468

/el heo was biþoȝt *and* whare,

o finden hem ansuare.

len conceals the fact by a clever story.

. gaue þe Maydons answere anoon),
 to her Chamber were goon), 768
 to þe lepe come she wolde,
 'lowres to hondel and to beholde;
 d, or y it ere wyst,
 Otter fley3 a-geynst my brest: 772
 s so soore a-drad þan,
 y loude crye can."
 Maydons þerof⁺ hadden glee,
 . turned hem, and lete hur be. 776

No gap in MS.]

To þe cupe," heo sede, "ihc com *and* wolde
 is flures handlen *and* biholde, 472
 er fliste vt a buterfli3e,
 re ihc wiste, on min i3e.
 o sore ihc was offerd of þan,
 at ihc crie bigan." 476
 is opere lo3en *and* hadde gleo,
 nd goþ a3en *and* leteþ beo.

Is Blauncheflur come see a 'well fair flower.'

one as þe maydons were gon),
 Blauncheflour she 3ede anoon),
 . seide boldly to Blauncheflour,
 ow, come and see a feire Flour! 780
 æ a flour þe shal wel lyke,
 e þou it sene a lyte."

ㄣ Larice hatte þat maide hende:
 ㄣ To blauncheflures chaumbre heo gan 480
 wende,
 nd sede, "sute blauncheflur,
 /iltu seo a wel fair flur?
 it ne greu no3t on þis londe,
 at flur þat ihc bringe þe to honde." 484

flur bids Claris depart, and reproaches Floris for his inconstancy.

re, Clarys!” quod Blaunche flour;
scorne me, it is none honoure. 784
gap in MS.]

re, Clarys, without gabbe,
þe Amyral wyl me to wyf⁺ habbe;
þat day shal neuer be,
he shal euer haue me, 788
y shal be of⁺ loue so vntrewe,
chaunge my loue for no newe;
no loue, ne for noon[]] aye,
ake Florys in his Contraye. 792
y shal swete Florys mysse,
shal noon[]] other of me haue blysse.”

Away, Clariz,” quap blancheflur;
Ho þat luueþ *par* amur
nd haþ þer of ioie, mai luue flures;
c ic libbe in soreþe in þis tures, 488
or ihc wene bithute gabbe,
at þe Admiral me wule habbe.
c þilke day ne schal neure be;
e schal me neure at-wite me, 492
at ihc beo of luue vntrewe,
e chaunge luue for no newe,
e lete þe olde for no newe be,
o doþ floriz on his Contre. 496
c þeþ floriz forþe me,
e schal ihc neure forþete þe.”

ris brings Blaunche flour to Floris.

ther urges Blaunche flour, who at length comes.

ys stood and beheld þat rewth,
þe trewnesse of⁺ hur trewth, 796
seide, “lady Blaunchefloure,
we see þat ilk⁺ floure.”

lariz iherde þes ille reuþe,
f trewnesse *and* of trewþe. 500
e terres glide of hire lere;
Blauncheflur,” he sede, “go we ifere,
eue suete blauncheflur,
um *and* se a well fair flur.” 504

ings forth, and they embrace one another.

ie lepe þey went both.
ul man was Florys þoo, 800
he had herde al þis.
þat lepe he stert y-wys:
sone Blauncheflour chaunged hewe; [108 a]
ier of⁺ hem other knewe: 804
houte speche togeder þey lepe,
klippt⁺ and kyst⁺ wonder swete.

o gedere hi goþ nu iwis,
nd floriz haþ iherd al þis.
t of þe cupe he lep anon,
nd to blauncheflur he gan gon. 508
iþer oþer sone ikneu;
oþe nuþe hi chaungeþ heu.
o gadere wiþute word hi lepen,
lepte *and* keste *and* eke weopen 512
ere kessinge ileste a mile;
nd þat hem þuzte litel while.

ful reunion of the lovers.

cs Blauncheflur if she knows this flower.

ys beheld⁺ al this,
countenaunce and her blysse, 808
seide þen to Blaunchefloure,
ow, knowist þou auȝt þis flour?

larice biheold al þis,
ere cuntenaunce *and* here blis. 516
eide Clarice to blauncheflur,
Knowestu oȝt ȝete þis flur?
litel er þu noldest hit se;
u ne miȝte hit lete fram þe. 520

shul konne ful muche of⁺ Art
þou woldest þerof⁺ geue part⁺.” 812

e moste kunne muchel of art
at þu woldest ȝeue þer of part.”
Certes,” quap blauncheflur to Clariz,
þis is min oȝene suete floriz.” 524

[*MS. lf. 8: Fr. p. 32, l. 522.*]

. . . wel muchel of art
. woldest ȝeue þer of eny part.
. . . de blancheflur to clarise
. . min owene leue floyres

Clariz not to betray them.

ȝ Blaunche flour and Florys,
þese swete þinges ywys,
en her mercy, al wepyng⁺,
she ne wrey hem to þe king⁺. 816

u boþe tuo, þes suete þinges,
rieþ hire merci, al wepinge,
o þe Admiral þat hem ne wreie,
or þenne were here soreȝe niwe. 528

. . . þis ilke swete þinges
. . . clarisse merci . . .
nto þe amyrayl noȝt ne wreye
. . . scholden deȝe

omises silence.

gap in MS.]

douȝt no more of⁺ me in alle,
it were myself⁺ byfalle.
e ȝe wel weturly,
le y wyl ȝoure drury.” 820

larice hadde of hem pite;
Noþing,” heo sede, “ne dute ȝe,
e dute ȝe nammore wiþ alle,
at hit were to me bifalle. 532
ele ihc wulle *and* noþing wreie,
wer beire cumpaignie.”

. . . namore mid alle
. . . hit were to me by falle
. . . wel wytterli
. . . beyre drewori

. bedde þey ben brouȝt,
is of palle and of⁺ sylke wrouȝt;
. þere þey sette hem doun^Þ
. drouȝ hem self⁺ al a room^Þ: 824
was no man þat myȝt radde
ȝye þat þey twoo madde.

larice hem haþ to bedde ibroȝt,
at was of pal *and* selc iwroȝt. 536
i bedde heo broȝte hem adun,
n hure self wende hem fram.

. bedde heo hem haueþ ibrouȝt
. selk *and* pal i wrouht
. heo sette hem þer adoun
. wende aroum
. . more bote cluppe *and* cusse
. . blancheflur hit wiste

rejoice together greatly.

ys þen to speke bygan^Þ,
. seide, “lord þat madest man, 828
þonke goddes sone
al my care I haue ouercome;
⁊ my leue I haue y-founde,
al my care y am vnbounde.” 832

o floriz furst speke bigan.
⁊re louerd,” he sede, “þat makedest man, 540
e ihc þonki, godes sune,
at ihc am to mi leof icume.
li leof, nu ihc habbe þe ifunde,
f al mi care ihc am vnbunde.” 544

. . . formest speke bigon
 . . d þat makedest mon
 . . . nou godes sone
 . . . he is ouer [c]ome
 . . . habbe ifounde
 am vnbounde

maidens are at mornings to assist at the ‘Admiral’s’ toilet.

ys hem seruyd al at wylle, dernlyche and styлле. Larys with þe white syde e vp on morne tyde,	836
cleped after Blaunchefloure vende with him in to þe Toure: seide “y am commaund ⁺ ”; her answeere was slepaund ⁺ .	840
u aiþer haþ oþer itold f here soreȝe <i>and</i> care cold, at hi hadde ifunde bo uppe hi were ideld atuo.	548
u hi cluppeþ and cusseþ nd makeþ togadere muchel blisse. þer was aȝt bute custe, wete blauncheflur hit wiste.	552
on oþer heuene hi ne bede, ute eure swich lif to lede. c longe ne miȝte hi hem wite at hi neren vnderȝete.	556

. . . . oþer haueþ told
 kare ful cold
 me wel stronge
 rt so longe
 serueþ al to wille
 . . . [dern]eliche *and* stille
 . . . heo noȝh longe wite
 eren vnder ȝete

ning two maidens went to the Admiral's tower to comb his hair and wash his hands,—

myral had such a woone,
 euery day shulde come
 o maydons of⁺ hur bour [108 *b*]
 o him in to þe Toure, 844
gap in MS.

ʒ water and clooth, and basyn^ʒ,
 to wesshe his hondes ynnē:
 or þe Admiral hadde such a wune,
 hc moretid þer moste cume
 uo maidenēs wiþ muchel honour
 ito þe heȝeste Tur, 560
 at were feire *and* suþe hende,
 at on his heued for to kembe,
 at [oþer] bringe towaille *and* bacin,
 or to wasse his honden in. 564

ially often, Claris and Blauncheflur.

day þey seruyd him feire;
þer day come another peire; 848
most were wonyd into þe Toure,
ys and Blaunche flour.

wiche him serueþ a day so faire;
moreþe moste anoþer peire.
c mest were iwuned in to þe tur
laide Clariz *and* blaunche flour. 568

. . . wel hire mote bi tide
. . . . amorewe tide
. . . . ed blanche flour
. . . hire in to þan tour
. . . ich am cominge
. . . . was slepinge

ris invents an excuse for Blaunche flour's absence.

morning Claris calls Blaunche flour, but she falls asleep again.

ys come þenne aloon^Þ:
myral asked a-noon^Þ, 852
gap in MS.]

ere is Blaunche flour so free?
/ comeþ she not heder *with* þe?"

larice, ioie mote hire bitide,
ros vp in þe morezentide,
nd haþ icluped blaunche flour
o go wiþ hire in to þe tur. 572

uaþ blaunche flour, "ihc am cominge."

c heo hit sede al slepinge.

lariz com in to þe Tur;

e Admiral axede blaunche flour. 576

. ane wine
 come
 . . . of herd

 [leaf 8, col. 2]

e amiral askede blanche[flur]

vents an ingenious excuse for her.

,” she seide anoon^l ryȝt,
 e haȝ wakyd al þis nyȝt, 856
 y-cryde and y-loke
 y-redde on hur booke,
 y-bede to god her orysoun
 he geue þe his benysoun, 860
 þat he holde long⁺ þy lyf⁺;
 now þe mayde slepeȝ swyȝth;
 slepeȝ so fast, þat mayde swete,
 she may not com ȝete.” 864

Sire, Alniȝt heo set at hire boke,
 nd haȝ þeron irad *and* loke,
 nd þeron ibede hire oresun,
 at god, þat þolede passiun, 580
 e holde, sire, longe aliue;
 nd nu heo is asleped suiȝe,
No gap in MS.]
 at heo ne mai come to þe.”

and clarisse seyde anonriht,
Sire, he haueþ i waked al niȝht,
and iwaked *and* iloked,
and irad on hire boke,
and ibede to god hire orison,
at ȝeue þe his beniscun,
and god þe holde longe aliue.
and nou þat mayde slepeþ so suiþe,
eo slepeþ so faste, þat mayde suete,
at heo ne may nouȝt come ȝete.”

gap in MS.]

tes,” seide þe kyng⁺,
w is she a swete þing⁺:
auȝt me ȝerne her to wyf⁺,
so preyeth for my lyf⁺.” 868

is þat soþ?” sede he. 584
eo sede, “ȝe, sire, withute lesing.”
Heo is,” he sede, “a suete þing;
þel aȝte iħc willen hire to wif,
at so ȝerne biddeþ mi lif.” 588

and þo bi spak him þe king
wis heo is a swete þing.
þel auȝhte ich wilny habbe hire to wiue
o ȝerne heo bit for mine liue.

‘Admiral’ doubts Claris’s second story.

wing morning Claris again calls Blauncheflur in vain to go with her.

þer day Clarys erly Aryst;
Blaunche flour wełł wyst,
gap in MS.]

seide, “y come anoon),”
en Clarys her clepe bygan), 872
fel in a slepe newe.
e after it made hem to rewe:

moreȝe, þo Clariz arist,
launche flur heo atwist
at he makede so longe demure.
Aris,” heo sede, “*and* go we ifere.” 592
uaþ blaunche flur, “ich come anon.”
c floriz cleppen hire bigon,
nd he him also vnwise
nd feolle aslepe one þis wise. 596

larisse a noþer day arist,
nd haueþ blancheflur at wist
at heo haueþ so longe de mere,
Aris vp nou *and* g[on]e ifere.”
er heo seyde ich come anon
. . . floyres hire
bode þe children ase don wise.
ell aslepe on þisse wise
n þisse wise hey
one þer

ys to þe Pyler cam);
isyn) of gold⁺ in hond she nam), 876
Cleped after Blaunche floure
vende *with* hur in to þe Toure.

o Clarice to þe piler com,
nd þe bacin of golde nom,
o bere wiþ into þe Tur,
eo lokede after blaunche flur. 600

larise to þe piler wende anon
 . basin of gold þer heo nom,
 ⁊d haueþ ycleped [blanchef]lur
 o wende
 eo ne . . . uerede 3e ne . . .
 o wende clarisse þat heo were ago.

iral again inquires for Blauncheflur, and not content with Claris's story,

myral asked after Blauncheflour,
gap in MS.]

at! is she not come 3et? 880
 ⁊ she me douteþ al to lyte."

o Clarice com into þe tur,
 e axede after blauncheflur.
 Sire, ihc wende hire finde here;
 e was arise are ihc were. 604
 is heo no3t icume 3ete?"
 uap he, "heo duteþ me to lite."

o clarisse com in to þe tur,
 e amiral askede blanchefl[ur],
 ⁊d askede whi heo ne come,
 Iso heo was woned to done.
 Heo was arise are ich were,
 h wende hire habbe ifunde þere.
 hat nis heo . . . icome . . .
 od heo . . . me to . . .

· *‘Admiral’ finds the children in bed together.*

chamberlain, who finds the two children in bed together.

3 he cleped his Chamburlayn),
 4 bade him wende *with* his mayn)
 5 vete why she wyl not come [109 a]
 6 he was wonyd to doon). 884

7 Chamburlayn) is forth noom);
 8 3 Chambre he is coom),
 9 e clupede to him his chaumberlayn,
 10 nd het him go wiþ alle mayn, 608
 11 or to wite whi heo ne come
 12 3 his heste suthe sone.
 13 orþ he wende sone anon
 14 3 hire chaumbre þat he com. 612

. chaumberlen
 his . .

 3 heo was

1 stondeþ byfore hur bedde, 888
 2 fyndeþ þere, nebbe to nebbe,
 3 be to nebbe, and mouþ to mouþ.
 4 e Amyral it was sone couþ;
 5 n to þe Toure he stey3, 892
 6 told his lord al þat he sey3.

7 i hire bedde he fond tuo,
 8 7el faste iclupt, aslepe bo,
 9 eb to neb *and* muþ to muþ;
 10 one were here sore3eren cuþ. 616
 11 7o þe Admiral sone he te3
 12 7nd tolde him what he ise3.

.
.
. . . . a 3e

[leaf 8, back]

. his louerd wat he i a3heþ
1d 3et he þouhte, are he hem quelle,
7at he were hui scholden telle.
1d seþþe he þoute hem to deþe don.

iral then goes with drawn sword and finds the children.

umyral late him his swerd brynge,
wete he wolde of⁺ þat tydynge:
gap in MS.]

vent to hem þere þey lay: 896
vas she a-slepe þere ay.

þe] Admiral het his suerd bringe;
w]ite he wolde of þus þinge. 620
7o]rþ he wende wiþ al his mayn,
7e] *and* his chaumberlayn.
n] þe bed heo fond tueie;
þit] was þe slep in here eie. 624

e amirayl bed his swerd him bringe
/[i]te he wolde of þisse tiþinge.
orþ he wende mid al his mayn,
at he com þer hei boþe leie.
e 3et was þe slep in here e3e.

Amyral lete þe clothes doun^Þ cast
tel by-nethe hur brest,
sone he knew anoon^Þ 900
oon^Þ was woman, & þat oþer groom^Þ.
quaked for tene þere he stood;
1 to sloon^Þ was in his mood⁺;
ie þouzt, or he hem quelde, 904
it þey were, þey shuld him telle,
seth he wyl *with* dome hem done.

He] let Adun þe cloþes caste
3in]eþen here breste.
i here breste he kneu anon
at on was maide *and* þat oþer a mon. 628

e amiral het here cloþes adoun caste
lutel bi neþe here breste.
o iseih he wel anon
on was may *and* þoþer mon.
e amirayl quakede, for angys þe astod,
em to quelle, hit was on his mod.

ike and cry for mercy.

Children wakyd swyth soone,
saw þe swerde ouer hem drawe; 908
ben adrad, and in awʒe.

seide Florys to Blaunche flour,
oure lyf⁺ is no socour.”
þey cryde him mercy swyth, 912
to length her lyue.

e children awoke þo anon
nd seʒe þe Admiral biuore hem gon,
iþ his suerd al adraʒe; 632
ore hi beoþ offerd *and* wel maze.

ʒeie,” quap þe Admiral, “belamy,
o makede þe so hardy,
or to come in to mi Tur
nd to ligge bi blaunche flur?” 636
i crieʒ him “merci,” boþe suiþe,
at he ʒiue hem furst of liue.

e children a woken vnder soon (?)
nd seʒen þat swerd ouer hem a drawe,
ij weren agr . . . *and* eþe hui mawe.

. belami
ho makede þe so hardi
. in my tour
. blancheflur.
.
. . . þe fore.

o seyde floyres to blancheflur,
Of vre liue nis no socur.”
k hei crieþ him merci so suiþe
at he ʒaf hem furst of here liue.

re bade hem sytte booth,
do on boþ her cloþ;
he dide hem bynde fast, 916
in prison¹ lete hem be cast.

No gap in MS.]

þ he bad hem sitte boþe,
 ⁊ don on here beyre cloþe,
 ⁊ þo he bad hem binde faste,
 ⁊ in to one prisun he het hem cast.

· *‘Admiral’ summons his counsellors.*

iral summons his counsellors and tells them the case.

⁊ haþ he after his Barons sent,
 vreke him after Iugement,
 ⁊ han þe Barons vndernome, 920
 to þe Amyral þey ben coome.

fter his barnage he haþ isend,
 ⁊ awreke him wiþ iugement. 640
 ⁊ let hem þe while binde faste,
 ⁊ in to prison ben icaste.

is palais þat was so faire ibuld,
 f Erles *and* barons hit was ifuld. 644

. . he . . after his barenage
 . . he him . . .
 . . barenage . . .
 ⁊ to nan amyrayl abeþ nome .
 ibuld
 was ifuld.

stood vp a-monge hem al,
 h̄ semblant wroþ withalle,
 seide: “Lordynges, *with* much honour, [109 b]
 erde speke of Blaunche flour, 924
 y bouȝt hur dere a plyȝt
 seuen sithes of golde hur wyȝt;
 y wende *with*-out wene 928
 feire mayde to haue had to Quene.

p he stod among hem alle,
 i semblaunt wel wroþ wiþ alle.
 Lordynges,” he sede, “wiþ muchel honur,
 e habbeþ iherd of blaunche flour, 648
 u ihc hire boȝte apliȝt,
 or seuesiþe of gold hire wiȝt.
 o hire was mi meste wene,
 or to habbe to mi quene. 652

e amiral stod up among hem alle
 wroþ mid [alle]

 wiþoute [leaf 8, back, col. 2]
 w[ene]
 o habben hire to mi quene

trial of the children.

3ng⁺ my maydons in my Toure
 r dide, *with* much honoure;
 ore her bedde my self⁺ y coom³; 932
 ide þeryn a naked man.
 were þey to me so looþ,
 u3t to haue sleyn³ hem booþ,
 s so wroþ and so wood⁺. 936

No gap in MS.]

is no3t 3ore þat i ne com
 nd fond hire wiþ hordom,
 le to schame *and* deshonor,
 i hire bedde on mi Tur. 656

. . hire bedde miself ich co[me]
 . . hire ane naked grome
 me wel loþe
 hem boþe.
 1d ich was so wroþ *and* wod

7 *withdrow*3 myn³ hoot blood⁺
 y haue sende after 3ow, by assent,
 wreke me *with* Iugement.
 7 3it 3e woot how it is goon³, 940
 ke me soon³ of⁺ my foon³.”

No gap in MS.]

ic habbe 3ou told hu hit is went;
 . wrekeþ me wiþ Iugement.”
 1d 3et ihc wiþ drou
 at ich hadde after
 3 wreke me þoruh iugem[ent].
 ou 3e habbeþ iherd hou it is.
 wrekeþ me of mine fon.”

gests that the children be heard before being judged.

spake a kyng⁺ of þat londe,
 þat haue herd al þis shame and shonde;
 or we hem to deth deme, 944
 vs hem see, ȝif it þe Queeme,
 at þey wolde speke or sygge,
 þey wyl auȝt ageyn^⁹ vs legge:
 were nouȝt ryȝt iugement, 948
 hout answere make acoupement.

anne spak a freo burgeis,
 at was hende *and* curt[eis], 660
 Sire, are hi beo to diþe awreke,
 7e mote ihere þe children speke.
No gap in MS.]

it nere noȝt elles rist iugement,
 iþuten ansuare to acupement.” 664

Do spak a king of þulk . . .
 ȝe habbeþ iherd þis
 k are we hem to deþe
 7e schullen i heren þe
 7hat huy wolleþ speke
 and ȝif huy wolleþ ou
 it nis no riȝht iugem[ent].”
 7iþ oute onsuere

trial continued.

of Nubia advises that they be instantly burned.

his is herde of⁺ more and lasse,
it myster is, to bere wytnesse?”

the king of Nubie sede þo,
For soþ, ne schal hit noȝt go so.
it is riȝt þureȝ alle þing
elons inome hond habbing,
or to suffre Jugement
iþute ansuere oþer acupement.”

668

þe king of nubie
Sire, so ne schal hit
raitour þat is nome hond . . .
it is riȝt þoru alle þ
o beo for don oþer i sch . . .
iþ outen oni here of
I þis ihe . . . and lag . . .
and bereþ him þer of w

for þe Children haue þey sent,—
forenne hem was his entent;—
forserieauntes hem gan brynge
ward⁺ hur al wepynge.

952

forȝy boop þese children goo;
forer bemenep oþeris woo.

956

forfter þe children nu me sendep;
for em to berne fir me tendep.

672

forfter þes childeren
for em to for berne þer
forwene seriauns hem forþ bringe
for fonge here dom sore wepin[ge]
foreri weren þo chydren . . .
forer eyþer by wepeþ oþer . . .

forroaches himself to Blauncheflur.

seide Florys to Blaunche**flour**,
oure lyf⁺ is no socour:

eide floriz to blaunche**flur**,
Of vre lif nis no sucur;
c min is þe guld *and* þe vnmeþ,
at þu for me schalt þolie deþ. 676

þo seyde floyres to blanche[flur]
f vre liue nis no soc[ur].

kinde of⁺ man it þole myȝt, 960
es y shuld dye *with* ryȝt,
es for my self⁺, anoþer for the,
þy deep þou hast for me.”
inche**flour** seyde þoo, [110 a]
gylt is myn^Þ, of oure woo.” 964

c if cunde hit þolie miȝte,
ic oȝte deie tuye wiþ riȝte.
deþ for þe, on oþer for me;
or þis þu þolest nu for me. 680
or if i nere *in* to þis *tur* icume,
/iþ mireȝþe þu miȝtest her inne wune.”

her the ring, telling her of its properties.

ys drouȝ forþ þat ryng
his moder him gaff at her partyng⁺:
ue þis ryng⁺, lemman myne; 968
shalt not dye while it is þyne.”
inchefloure seide þoo,
gap in MS.
ne shal it neuer goo,
þis ryng⁺ shal help me, 972
þe deed on þe see.”

e droȝ forþ a riche ring,
his moder him ȝaf at his parting. 684
Haue þis ring, lemman min,
u ne miȝt noȝt deie þe while he is þin.”
e ring he haueþ forþ araȝt
nd to blauncheflur bitaȝt. 688
þe ring ne schal neure aredde me;
or deþ ne mai ihc se on þe.”

tempts to force the ring back on him; it falls to the ground and is picked up by an earl.

ys þat ryng⁺ hur rauȝt,
she it him agayn¹ betauȝt,
ther ne wyl other deed seene; 976
let it falle hem bytwene;
ng⁺ com¹ after; a ryng⁺ he fonde,
brouȝt it forth in his honde.

e ring heo wolde aȝe reche,
nd to floriz him biteche. 692
c for al þat heo miȝte do,
e him nolde aȝen ifo.
nd þe ring bi one stunde,
el adun to þe grunde. 696
duc stupede *and* him vp nom,
nd was þer of wel bliþe mon.

þe Children wepyng⁺ com^Þ 980
þe fire and hur doom^Þ.

þore þe folk⁺ þey were brouȝt;
þy was her bothes þouȝt;

þu þes childre forþ me bringeþ
to here dom, al wepinge. 700

‘fairness’ of the children excites compassion.

ness’ of the children excites compassion.

þe was noon^Þ so sterne man 984

þe Children lokede oon^Þ,
þey ne wolde, al wel fawe,
iugement haue *with*drawe,
þe *with* grete Catel hem bygge, 988

þey durst speke or sygge;
Flores was so feire a ȝonglyng⁺,
þe Blaunchefloure so swete a þing⁺,
wyst no man whor hem were woo, 992
no semblaunt þat þey made þoo.

þe c þer nas non so sturne mon,
þat hem lokede vpon,
þat nolde þo suþe saȝe
þat iugement were wiþdraȝe. 704
[No gap in MS.]

þor floriz was so fair ȝongling,
þe blauncheflur so suete þing,
þe f men *and* wimmen þat buþ nuþe,
þat goþ *and* seop *and* spekeþ wiþ muþe, 708
þe buþ so faire in here gladnesse,
þo hi were in here sorinesse.

þe admiral is very wroth.

ʌdmyral was so wood⁺,
 nyȝt he nouȝt kele his hoot blood⁺;
 ʌde þe Children fast be bound⁺, 996
 in to þe fire slong⁺.

c þe admiral was so wroþ *and* wod,
 e quakede for grame þer he stod. 712
 nd het hem binde wel faste
 nd in to þe fire caste.

with the ring steps forward and speaks in behalf of the children.

ilke king⁺ þat þe ryng⁺ fond⁺,
 ʌmyral he spake and round⁺,
 wolde hem saue to þe lyf⁺, 1000
 told⁺ how for þe ryng⁺ þey gon^ʅ stryf⁺.
 ʌmyral lete hem ageyn^ʅ clepe,
 he wolde here hem speke,
 asked Florys what he heete: [110 b]
 he tolde him ful skeete: 1004

e duc þat þe ring funde,
 om to þe Admiral *and* rune, 716
 nd al to gadere he gan him schewe;
 f þat þe children were biknewe.
 e Admiral let hem aȝen clepe,
 or he wolde wiþ floriz speke. 720

· *‘Admiral’ is touched with pity.*

cs clemency for the maiden, and the maiden prays for him.

," he seide, "yf⁺ it were þy wyllle,
ne getest not þat maide to spyllle;
good sir, quel þou me, 1008
lete þat maide on lyue be."

gap in MS.]

incheflour seide byne,
gilt of⁺ oure dedes is moyne."

⁊ "ire," quap floriz, "forsop ihc telle,
⁊ þu no3test no3t þat maide quelle.

Of al þis gilt ihc am to wite;
ic o3te deie *and* he go quite." 724

uap blauncheflur, "aquel þu me,
nd let floriz aliue be.
ef hit nere for mi luue,
e nere no3t fram his londe icome." 728

Admyral seide þoo 1012
rys 3e shul dye boo."

swerd he breide out of his sheeth,
hildren to haue done to deeth.
inchefloure put forþ hur swire, 1016

Florys dide her agayn^l to tyre,
seide, "I am man; I shal byfore,
h wrong hast þou þy lyf loore."
ys forth his swerd putte, 1020

Blauncheflour agayn^l him tytte.

uap þe Admiral, "so ihc mote go,
e schulle deie togadere bo.
liself ihc wulle me awreke;
e schulle 3e neure go ne speke." 732

loriz forþ his nekke bed,
nd blauncheflur wiþdra3e him 3et.
launcheflur bid forþ hire suere,
nd floriz a3en hire gan tire. 736

eiper ne mi3te þere þole
at oþer deide bifore.

iral is at length touched with pity.

ing⁺ seide, “dredry mot 3e be,
rouþ by þis Children to see.”
ing⁺ þat þe ryng⁺ hadde, 1024
routh of⁺ hem sone he radde,
at þe Amyral wyl he spede,
hildren fro þe deþ to lede.

o þe Admiral, þe3 he wroþ were,
er he chaungede his chere. 740
or he se3 þat eyþer wolde for oþer deie,
nd for he se3 mani wepinde eie,
nd for he luuede so muche þat mai,
l wepinge he turnde away. 744
is swerd fel of his hond to grunde;
e mi3te he hit holde þulke stunde.

with the ring speaks for the children.

,” he seide, “it is lytel prys,
Children for to slee y-wys;
it is wel more worship,
ys counsel þat 3e weete,
o him tau3t þat ilke gynne, 1032
oure for to come ynne,
who him brou3t þare,
other, þat 3e may be ware.”

e duc þat here ring hadde,
or hem to speke wille he hadde. 748

Sire Admiral,” he sede, “iwis
Hit is þe wel litel pris
Dis feire children for to quelle.
c betere hit is þat hi þe telle 752
u he com in to þi tur,
o ligge þer bi blauncheflur.
is engin whan þu hit wite,
e betere wiþ oþere þu mi3t þe wite.” 756

seide þe Amyral, “as god me saue, 1036
ys shal his lyf⁺ haue,
he me telle who him tauȝt þerto,
ʔlorys, þat shal y neuer doo.”

lle þat herde wordes his,
isecheþ þat he *granti* þis.
e het him telle his engin,
u he to blauncheflur *com* in, 760
nd to him radde *and* help þarto.

ris tells his story.

uses to tell how he gained entry to the tower until pardon has been promised the porter.

ʔ þey bydden al y-wys 1040
þe Admyral *graunted* þis,
orȝeue þat trespas
Florys told how it was.

þat,” *quaþ* he, “nelle iħc neure do,
or þing þat me mai me do,
ute hit hem beo forȝiue also.” 764
lle þopere bisecheþ þis,
nd of þe Admiral *igranted* is.

ells his story.

⁊ euery word⁺ he haþ him tolde, [111 a]
 ⁊ þat maide was for him solde, 1044
 . how he was of⁺ spayn^Þ a kynges sone,
 grete loue þeder y-come,
 to fonde, with sum gynne, 1048
 feire maide for to wyne,
 . how þe porter was his man by-come,
 his gold and for his warysoun^Þ,
 . how he was in þe Florys borne. 1052
 þe lordinges low3 þerforne:

 u ord *and* ende he haþ hem itold,
 u bla[un]cheflur was fram him isold, 768
 nd hu he was of spaygne a kinges sone,
 or hire luue þuder icume,
 3 fonden wiþ sume gīnne,
 u he mi3te hure awinne, 772
 nd hu þure3 þe cupe *and* þure3 þe gersume,
 e porter was his man bicume,
 nd hu he was in a cupe ibore;
 lle þes opere lowe þeruore. 776

ne of reconciliation.

iral lifts them up, dubs Floris knight, and causes them to be married in church with a ring.

⁊ þe Admyral wol him tyde;
ys setteþ next his syde,
efte he made him stonde vpryzt, 1056
dubbed him þere knyzt,
bade he shulde *with* him be,
urthermost of his meyne.

⁊ e Admiral þo, wel him bitide,
⁊ þat Child he sette bi his side,
And haþ forziue his wrappe bo,
loriz *and* blauncheflur also. 780
nd sede wiþ him hi scholde be,
e beste of al his maine.

ys falleþ doun[⁊] to his feet, 1060
prayeþ geue him his sweet.
myral gaf⁺ him his lemman[⁊]:
at þere were, þankyð him þanne.
Chirche he let hem brynge, 1064
dede let wed hem *with* a rynge.
þese twoo swete þinges y-wys
his feet for to kysse;

nd floriz he makeþ stonde vprizt,
nd þer he dubbede him to knizt. 784
u boþe togadere þes childre for blisse
alleþ to his fet hem to kisse.
e let hem to one Chirche bringe,
nd spusen hem wiþ one gold ringe. 788

iral takes Claris to be his queen.

þrouȝ conseil of Blaunche flour, 1068

ys was fet doun^l of þe Toure,

Amyral wedded hur to queene.

e was fest swythe breeme;

n not telle al þe sonde, 1072

rycher fest was neuer in londe.

ureȝ þe red of blaunche flour,

le fette Clariz adun of þe Tur.

e Admiral hire nam to quene.

ilke feste was wel breme, 792

or þer was alle kunnes gleo,

at miȝte at eni briddale beo.

ers come to Floris announcing his father's death.

it nouȝt longe after þan^l,

to Florys tydyng⁺ cam^l,

þe king⁺ his Fader was deed⁺. 1076

it nas þer after noþing longe

at þer com floriz writ *and* sonde, 796

at þe king his fader was ded,

iral tries in vain to induce him to remain.

Baronage gaf⁺ him reed

he shuld wende hoom^l,

fonge his feire kyngdoom^l.

e Amyral þey toke leue, 1080

he byddeþ þem byleue.

nd þat he scholde nimen his red.

anne seide þe Admiral,

f þu dost bi mi consail, 800

ilef wiþ me; ne wend naȝt hom,

ic wulle ȝeue þe a kinedom

lso long *and* also brod,

lso eue ȝet þi fader ibod." 804

likes rich presents in parting,

and he went *with* royal array,
and was crownyd *with-in* a short day.

follows. The bate~~ll~~ of Troye,

the þat god þis world⁺ wrouȝt⁺
euene and erthe made of⁺ nouȝt⁺

*aves 111-134. Then Amys and Amylion,
aves 134-147. MS. ends with one leaf of
ir Eglamour.)*

c floriz nolde for no winne; euere him were wiþ his kinne. e Admiral he bid god day, nd þonkede Clariz þat faire may, nd to hire he haþ iȝolde wenti pond of ride golde. nd to Daris þat him so tazte, wenti pund he arazte. nd alle þat for him duden eidel, e ȝeld here while suþe wel.	808 812
--	------------------------------------

ris and Blauncheflur depart for their native land.

his home, where he and Blauncheflur reign as king and queen.

e bitaȝte hem alle godalmiȝte nd com hom whane he miȝte.	816
e was king wiȝ Muchel honur, nd heo his quene blauncheflur. u ȝe habbeȝ iherd þane ende f floriz <i>and</i> his lemman hende,	820
u after bale comeȝ bote; od leue þat vs so mote, at we him mote louie so, at we mote to heuene go. AMEN.	824
E-X-PLI-C-IT.	

NOTES.

FLORIS AND BLAUNCHEFLUR.

Links generally lead to the next lower multiple of 4, corresponding to visible line numbers.

[2, T.](#) *þe cristen woman*, the captive mother of Blauncheflur.

[28, T.](#) *louyd togeder*, a French idiom, *s'entr'amoient*.

[72, T.](#) *Boþ by day and by nyȝt*. Cf. 'K. Horn,' 275 Note.

[77, T.](#) *þat oþer*, preservation of the OE. definite inflected form, *þæt*, source of modern English dialect 'tother.'

[80, T.](#) *ben ... wo*. Cf. 142 T, and 'K. Horn,' 121 Note.

[100, T.](#) *fel to*, was due. Cf. Bradl.-Stratm. *fallen*.

[110, T.](#) *wore : lore*. Cf. *were : fere*, 82.

[113-14, T.](#) *sykes, lernes, mornes*. These forms seem due to Northern influence on MS. T.

[140, T.](#) *Let do bring forth*. A curious combination. 'Let' is beginning to usurp the place of 'do' in the sense of 'cause to.' Cf. 155 T, 211 T, 434 C, etc.

[168, T](#) ff. In these allusions to other romances are to be found the most certain clues as to the time of composition of 'Fl. and Bl.'

[193, T.](#) *at oone*. Cf. 'K. Horn,' 997 Note.

[194, T.](#) *Amyral*, emir, saracen ruler.

[210, T.](#) *wyrche*. Cf. 'K. Horn,' 1481.

[226, T.](#) *chargeþ*. Error for *targeþ*. Cf. MS. Cott.

[227, T.](#) *noome*, gone. Cf. *vndernome*, 152, 219 T.

[250, T.](#) *ronne on hye*, ran to the chamber above.

[270, T.](#) *wept*. Cott. has the older form *wep*. Cf., however, *Aryst* (: *atwist*), 869 T and 589 C, and Cott.

[272, T.](#) *So swete a þing*. Cf. v. 525, also 'K. Horn,' 473 C, Note.

[338, T.](#) *care vnbynde*. Cf. 'K. Horn,' 572.

[341-2, T.](#) *devyse* : *prys*. These words have a meaning somewhat different from the modern meaning. *Deuyse* means direction, supervision; *prys* means value. Like *charged* 343, and *monay* 345, they are French words with French meanings.

[343, T.](#) *charged*, loaded. Fr. influence.

[345, T.](#) *monay*, small money. Fr. influence.

[376, T.](#) *dou3t*. This use of 3 where it has no right etymologically shows that it was no longer pronounced. Cf. *anoonery3t* : *white* 766 T.

[40, C.](#) *nabit*. Cf. 'K. Horn,' 1211 L., H.

[67, C.](#) *Fort he dide slep him nome*. 'Until the dead sleep seized him.' *Fort he* comes from *for to he* (Hausknecht).

[76, C.](#) *parais*. A French form. The -d- shaded out in French about 1110.

[110, C.](#) *pane of meniuier*. Cf. Hausknecht's Note. Hausknecht reads: *I paned al wiþ meniver*, supplied with panes of meniver. *Menuier* (*menu* + *vair*) means a kind of fur, probably of squirrel.

[145, C.](#) *in alle halue*. Cf. Map, 338, *on alle halve* (Bradl.-Stratm.).

[173, C.](#) *furtennizt*, a journey of a fortnight. (?)

[176, C.](#) *amidde rizt*, right in the middle of. Cf. also 182.

[231, C.](#) *kernel* (*kanel*), canal (Hausknecht).

[275, C.](#) *spray*. Cf. Bradl.-Stratm.

[300, C.](#) *þonur* (*þe* + *honur*).

[304, C.](#) *bulmep*, error for *welmep*. (?)

[308, C.](#) *for do*, old force of *for-*. Cf. Germ. *ver-*.

[448, C.](#) *hire stonde*. Trace of gram. gender. Cf. Hausknecht, 854 Note.

[465, C.](#) *lepe*. Cf. Hausknecht, 875 Note.

[486, C.](#) *Ho*, who so. Early instance of loss of w-.

[497, C.](#) *for3e me* (*for3ete me*).

[513, C.](#) *ileste a mile*, time to go a mile. Cf. 'K. Horn,' 631-2 Note.

[536, C.](#) *pal*. Cf. Hausknecht, 952 Note.

[589, C.](#) *arist* (: *atwist*). Early instance of a strong verb become weak.

[597, C.](#) *piler*, the pillar in the tower, the one in which the water-pipe runs. Cf. 223-232 C.

[937, T.](#) *withdrow3*, restrained. Rare in this sense.

[941, T.](#) *soord*. Hausknecht reads *soon*.

[960, T.](#) *kinde of man*. Fr. *nature*. *Kind* is felt to be no longer an exact equivalent of *nature*; hence in T, *of man* is added.

[692, 697, C.](#) *him*. Further traces of grammatical gender. Cf. 448, C Note.

[988, T.](#) *lygge*. Read *bygge*. French *racatassent*.

[718, C.](#) *biknewe*. Cf. Glossary.

[1007, T.](#) *ne getest not*. Scribal error. Cf. C and A.

[1009, T.](#) *on lyue*. Mod. Engl. alive. Cf. *adown*, *a-fishing*, etc.

[1011-12, T.](#) *byne* : *moyne*. *byne* not clear; *moyne* error for *myne*. (?)

[1017, T.](#) *tyre* (tear), did struggle toward her.

[814, C.](#) *zeld here while*, paid for their pains. Cf. 'worth while.'

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**King Horn,
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INTRODUCTION.

THE ASSUMPTION OF OUR LADY.

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§ 1. INTRODUCTORY.

FROM the valorous atmosphere of King Horn and the sentimental atmosphere of Floris and Blauncheflur, to the devout atmosphere of the "Assumption," is a very appreciable change. At the same time the oriental romance of Floris and Blauncheflur and our legend, also, no doubt, of eastern origin, betray their common descent in a certain similarity of sentimental tone; and further, both romances, Germanic and oriental, share to some extent their romantic colour with the religious legend. It is perhaps the love of this romantic colour, which the three poems have in common, that has brought them together

in the Cambridge MS. (Gg. 4. 27. 2) which forms the nucleus of the present volume, though the fact that the existing manuscript is but a fragment, forbids any certain conclusion as to the tastes and probable purpose of the collector.

§ 2. SETTING.

In turning from the romances of King Horn and Floris and Blauncheflur to the legend of the Assumption we are entering the most productive field of early English literature. The religious element is the predominant element in Anglo-Saxon poetry. Christianity, from the very first, was received in England with an extraordinary warmth. In the year closely following the conversion of England there came into bloom a rich Christian poetry which soon took the place of, almost displaced, the earlier national epos.

The Norman Conquest was the means of introducing a flood of romances of every conceivable origin, and probably explains the slight revival of genuine English romantic traditions such as those of Horn, Havelok and Waldef, and possibly of Wade. But through the period, immediately following the Conquest, of the domination of the French and Latin languages in English literature, there had persisted a thread of the old English tradition in the homilies which continued for a long time to be industriously read and copied. With these in the 12th century were associated new homilies (cf. R. Morris, *Old English Homilies*), the direct lineal descendants of those of Alfric and Wulfstan, and in the beginning of the 13th century, in the northern midlands the metrical *Ormulum*, which betrays some French influence in a somewhat scanty French element in its vocabulary and in its proper names (cf. F. Kluge, *Engl. Stud.* xxii), but which nevertheless is composed quite in the style and manner of the earlier time.

When, after two centuries, the English language had to some extent come back into use as a language of literature, Cynewulf also found successors, and the legend flourished once more. Indeed in this new period it came to flourish to an extent hitherto unparalleled. This revival was due in part, no doubt, to the story-telling spirit so manifest in this period, and in part to the fact that this period marks the highest point in the progress of saint worship.

Probably the earliest of these newer legends were those of St. Juliana, St. Margeret and St. Katherine, which are written in rhythmical alliterative prose clearly manifesting the earlier English tradition, but which give premonition of a new era in the ring of a lyrical tone and in the already richer, more highly

coloured diction. (Cf. C. Horstmann, *Altenglische Legenden*, Neue Folge, p. xv, Heilbronn, 1881.) Quite romantic in tone and colour are the very early, fine poems, in four-line strophes, of Katerine, Gregory, Mergrete, and the Magdalen, all of which unfortunately are preserved only in later, remodeled forms, and are perhaps only scant remains of an originally much richer literature. (Cf. Horstmann, as above, p. xlii, 225, 242.) According to Horstmann, the poems of Margaret and Gregory belong to the most beautiful productions of the early English language. Even more finely constructed, but rather lyric than narrative in form, are the few legends which fall in with the movement, influenced by French and especially strong in the South of England shortly before 1250, toward the development of the religious lyric. (Cf. R. Morris, *Old English Miscellany*.) Of these semi-lyrical legends, Eustas (MS. Digby 86) and the legends of the Psalter (MSS. Digby and Auchinleck) are composed in six-line strophes. (Cf. Horstmann, pp. 211, 228.) Other poems of this period, such as the *xi Pains of Hell*, already have the short riming couplet. Nearly to this same time belongs the Assumption of our Lady, in riming pairs and also in the Southern dialect.

The Assumption thus finds its setting among the very finest of the English legendary poems. According to Horstmann (as above, p. xliii): 'Never again has legendary poetry reached the same height of pathos, the same purity and beauty of form as in these older legends. The period immediately following shows a decided falling off in poetic power and in talent for form. The tone loses in depth and warmth, the style in fullness and swing.' In the last quarter of the 13th century, as we shall see, the legendary poetry entered the service of the church, and was worked over by the monks into great collections for reading in the services. This no doubt explains the remarkable falling off in poetic style and quality.

§ 3. THE RISE OF THE LEGEND.

The story of the rise [L22](#) of the legend from the *Acta Martyrorum*, the earliest records concerning the saints, to the martyrologies, the records of the recognized martyrs in each individual church, which in turn were expanded after the 8th century, from mere lists of names to the Latin *legendaries* upon which rest the OE. collections of legends,—all this forms an interesting chapter in the history of the church and in the history of literature, but has no place here except in so far as it throws light on the origin of the poem with which we are

concerned. The relation too of the legend to the service of the church has a very much involved history. The *Lectiones* or 'readings' in the daily offices of the church were of three kinds: either (1) selections from the Scriptures, or (2) selections from the commentaries or homilies of the church fathers, or (3) the *Acta Sanctorum*. The last kind came generally to be denoted as *Legenda*, or 'legends.' At first treated with distrust, in time the legend came to play an important part in the service of the church. It seems to have first found its full development in the 'nocturns,' into which it was admitted apparently by the Benedictines in the 8th century. There it first appeared in an amplified and extended form.

The height of the legend's development lies in the 12th and 13th centuries, and coincides with the period (Horstmann, as above, p. xv) of full bloom of the cult of the saints. At this time the number of saints' days multiplied. Each church honoured its special saints. One celebrated not alone the death-day of the saint, but that of the burial and the translation. New saints came to be venerated, and long-forgotten ones were again brought to memory. The relics and traditions were collected, and the lives were written. Special church offices were made for them, and hymns and songs were written in their praise. In these new *offices* of the church the legend found its use. These special festivals often fell on week-days, and one had to fill in *lectiones* for which nothing was ready. Under these circumstances the legend offered itself as if expressly fitted, and became the key to the entire religious celebration. In this situation, amid these most favourable circumstances, the legend developed its full power, and must have been an important factor in the religious life of the period.

In addition to this place of the legend in the offices of the church, it came later to be read within, or instead of the sermon, after the *Evangelium* during the mass, and in the popular language. From very early times it was permitted to the clergy, in place of original productions to read the homilies of others, and to this usage, no doubt, we owe such collections as the Blickling Homilies, Bede's *Homiliae de tempore*, Aelfric's collections, the Ormulum, etc. That the early legends were intended to be delivered as sermons, or in sermons, is apparent from the frequent direct appeals to the congregation, and from their association, in the MSS., with homilies.

During the 11th and 12th centuries the homily, the older element, continued to prevail even on saints' days, but in the 13th and 14th centuries the homily came to be in great measure displaced by the legend on the festival days of the saints, and was used only for Sundays and for the *Festae Christi*. To make a

complete *liber festivalis*, either to the book of homilies was joined a legendary for saints' days, or later the legendary, on the other hand, absorbed the book of homilies, as happened for instance in the case of the *Legenda aurea*, which marks the final step in the development of the Latin legendary, and which presents the homilies of the *Festae Christi*, perhaps the remains of the book of homilies, side by side with the legends. In the north of England the collection of *Evangelia dominicalia*, that is to say the gospels for Sundays and *Festae Christi*, which, according to the original plan, embraced only the Sunday gospel readings with their *expositio* and a *narratio* (i.e. a legendary narrative as an illustration) came in later MSS. to be supplemented by a collection of legends, evidently intended to complete the work by providing also for the saints' days something in the place of the *proprium sanctorum* (i.e. gospels for saints' days). In the South of England, on the other hand, the complete *liber festivalis* grows out of the legendary, which comes to include the homilies.

To sum up, the place of the *evangelium* in the mass for saints' days comes to be filled by the legend, while in the mass on Sunday, the *evangelium* is still retained, though probably often supplemented by an *expositio* and a *narratio*, or legendary tale as illustration for the *expositio*. In consequence the *liber festivalis* falls into two parts, the *temporal* (for Sundays and *Festae Christi*) and the *sanctoral*, or legendary for the saints' days.

§ 4. PLACE OF OUR LEGEND OF THE ASSUMPTION.

What then was the original function of our legend of the Assumption? The *evangelium* and the homily, as we have seen, still retained their places, in part at least, in the *temporal*, where the Assumption would belong, but were supplemented by legendary anecdotes, or even by entire legends. Was our poem originally intended for a place in the religious service, or was it rather a lyrico-romantic production with a sacred theme? What was the original purpose of the poem, it is not easy to determine. In actual use, however, it seems to have played a double role. In two of the six MSS. in which the present version of the story is preserved (viz. the Chetham MS. and Cambr. Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2.), the legend is associated with romances, and we must infer that it is the romantic quality of the legend that has appealed to the collectors. (Cf. also the slightly different version in the Auchinleck MS.) In the other four MSS., however, the associations, as will be seen later, are distinctly religious, though Harl. MS. 2382 seems rather a literary collection than one designed for church use. In all

of the MSS. the poem is referred to as a tale (cf. Harl. MS. 2253, near the end, where occurs the line, *This tale y haue tolde wit mouthe*), and as a *lesson*, that is to say a 'reading,' and if we may judge by the general tone of the different versions, the place for this 'reading' was quite likely the church. Even if the reading was not confined to the church, it usually was of a professionally religious character as we must judge from the remarkable conclusion in Brit. Mus. Add. MS. 10036:

We biseche þee for alle þat hereþ þis vie
 Off oure ladi seynt marie,
 That Ihesu schelde hem fram *grame*
 Fro dedly synne *and* fro schame,
 Ne mysaventure schal bi falle þat man
 That þis a vie here can.
 Ne no womman þat ilke dai,
 That of oure ladi hereþ þis lai,
 Dien ne schal of hure childe;
 For oure ladi hure schal be mylde.
 Ne noone mys-aventure schall be-falle,
 In felde, in strete, ne in halle,
 In stede þer þis vie is rad,
 For oure ladi hure sone it bad,
 And þe archibisshop, seynt Edmound,
 Haþ *graunted* xl. daies to *pardoun*
 To alle þat þis vie wol here,
 Or with good wille wol lere. vv. 879-896.

§ 5. ORIGIN.

The legend of the Assumption, according to ten Brink (*Geschichte der engl. Litt.* I, p. 331), had its origin in the second half of the 4th century. Tischendorf (*Act. Apocr.* p. xxxiv, Leipzig, 1866) believes a still earlier origin to be not impossible. The story had a wide circulation in the East. Besides the Greek versions we know (cf. F. Gierth, *Engl. Stud.* vii, pp. pp. 1-33) of three Syriac, one Arabic, and one Sahidic version. Even in Ethiopia there exists a similar tale (*Journ. of Sacr. Lit. and Bibl. Rec.*, Jan. 1865, p. 48). From the orient the legend spread into the literatures of western Christendom. Tischendorf (as above, p. xliii.) gives a list of a dozen Latin manuscripts of the legend, and from these he offers critical editions of two versions, which, with Gierth, we may indicate as: (1) *Transitus Mariae*, **A** (Tischendorf, pp. 113 ff.) in Latin prose; (2) *Transitus Mariae*, **B**, a fuller version differing from **A** in some respects, notably in the absence of the scene in which Thomas appears.

Other Latin versions are those published by Th. Graesse: (1) The section, *De assumptione beatae Mariae virginis in Jacobi a Voragine Legenda Aurea*, [1.23](#) ed. Th. Graesse, *Dresdae et Lipsiae*, 1846, pp. 504 ff., (2) *De modo assumptionis beatae Mariae*, published by Graesse, as above, pp. 517 ff.

In French may be mentioned the version by Wace (*L'Établissement de la fête de la conception Nôtre-Dame dite la fête aux Normands*. Caen, 1842, or, in another edition, *Vie de la vierge Marie*, Tours, 1859). For account of other unpublished French versions cf. E. Stengel, *Mittheilungen aus franz. hss.*, etc., Halle, 1873, pp. 20 ff.

In German we may mention the version by Conrad v. Heimesfurt, about 1200 (HZ. viii, pp. [156 ff.](#)).

Our story in its present form seems to have made its first appearance in England in the French version, above mentioned, by Wace, in the second quarter of the 12th century. (Cf. however, *Assumptio sanctae Mariae virginis*, Blickling Homilies, E.E.T.S. 58, 63, 73.) Of an English version of the present form of the legend, for English hearers, we have no trace before the middle of the following century, from which it seems we are to infer that the legend remained the property of the French clericals about a century before coming into general circulation in the English-speaking world. This earliest English version of the story is the one of the present edition in short riming couplets.

What then was the source of this earliest English version? Was it derived from Wace, or does it rest on one of the Latin versions? Wace's poem consists of three parts (cf. Gierth, Engl. Stud. vii, p. 6): (1) the institution of the feast of the Conception of Mary, (2) her birth, rearing and marriage, (3) her death and burial. For the first part his source seems to have been the *Miraculum de conceptione sanctae Mariae*; for the second part, the *Evangelium de nativitate Sanctae Mariae*. About these two works, which he has followed almost word for word, Wace grouped a number of minor anecdotes and commentary notes from Anselm, Eadmer, and other of the church writers of the 11th and 12th centuries. For part (3) Wace seems certainly to have used the Latin version of the story, designated by Tischendorf as *Transitus Mariae*, **B**.

The English version has in common with Wace's poem some traits that in the other versions are wanting. For instance, only in these two versions is it related that Mary cared for and instructed the maidens in the temple. (Engl. vv. 60 ff.) Another feature in common is contained in the speech of Christ to his mother shortly before her death, in which he promises her, *La porte d'aidier auras A trestous ceus que tu vorras* (Wace, p. 71, vv. 6, 7), which the English

poet seems to have expanded into a number of verses, in which is promised pardon to every sinner who will betake himself to Mary.

On the other hand, in several instances the English agrees more closely with the Latin, where Wace has considerably abridged, and in these instances the French cannot have been the original of the English poem. A Latin original seems much more probable. The first two-thirds of the English poem corresponds almost exactly with the Tischendorf Latin **B** version. On the other hand, the introduction of Thomas in the last one-third of the poem is a feature of the Latin **A** version, but is foreign to **B**. In other respects the English poem corresponds more closely to a third Latin version from which Tischendorf quotes variants, the *Codex Laurentius*. The English has in common with the *Legenda Aurea* the peculiar trait of making no mention of the miraculous transit of John from Ephesus. Again, some traits in Latin **B** do not appear in the English version, and, on the other hand, the English version contains a few traits not to be found in any of the other versions spoken of.

From the above we must conclude either that the English version rests on a very composite version of which we do not know, or that the composer of the English version was very eclectic, and selected his material from very different sources. The latter explanation seems the more probable one. In this connection it is important to note an observation first made by Zarncke and afterwards corroborated by Kölbing (*Engl. Stud.* ii, pp. 281-2) that the different prose versions of legends influence each other reciprocally, producing mixed or composite forms of the legend (*mischredactionen*) whose exact descent it is impossible to trace. It is here that the learned element makes itself felt and differentiates the tradition of a legend from the tradition of a romance or of a song. The influence of this learned element we must probably assume in explaining the tradition of our legend of the Assumption, which seems to be a *mischredaction*.

§ 6. OTHER ENGLISH VERSIONS.

The story of the Assumption seems to have circulated, as we have seen, both as a romantic story and as a devout legend. It must have been in the first of these two *rôles* that it was admitted to the famous collection of romances in the Auchinleck MS. Here the story appears in a new dress, composed in six-line strophes, with *rime couée*, probably under the influence of the ballad singers. The content of this version (cf. M. Schwarz, *Engl. Stud.* viii, pp. 428 ff.) seems

to be substantially that of the earlier version of the present volume. The first stanza of this version is,—

Who so bere3 palm, þe tokne is þis,
Ðat in clene lif he is;
Ðat is to vnderstonde:
Hit is tokning of loue,
Ðat god him haue3 wraththe for3oue,
Ðat bere3 palm on honde.

The Assumption also forms a member of the Southern cycle of legends, which go to form a legendary. In this *rôle* it appears in Harl. MS. 2277, “a parchment book in a long 4to, imperfect at the beginning and elsewhere; which formerly contained the legends of the Saints, etc., according to the course of the year, written in very old English verse.... The handwriting of this MS. seems to be older than that year” (1320). The MS. contains 69 legends, of which number 38 is *Assumpcio S. Marie*, in 246 long riming lines, the first two of which are,

Seinte marie godes moder : fram þaposteles nas no3t
Ðo þe holi gost a wit sonedai : among hem was ibro3t.

This version seems to rest on the *Legenda Aurea* [1.24](#) as an original, although the incident of the tardy arrival of Thomas, which is contained in the Latin, is wanting in this version.

This same version appears in a later MS., Bodl. 779, [1.25](#) of the 16th century. In this MS. the legend cycle is greatly extended by the addition of a whole new series of legends. The number of legends in this MS. reaches the number of 135, of which the version of the Assumption is number 57.

Another version of our legend is that belonging to the Northern legend cycle, and preserved in two MSS.: Harl. 4196 and Cott. Tiber. E. VII, [1.26](#) of which the latter is the older, but the former the more complete. These two texts correspond word for word, and apart from possible scribal blunder, letter for letter, abbreviation for abbreviation. Harl. MS. 4196 is a large folio on parchment, evidently of about the middle of the 14th century, and written in a beautiful large hand of the Northern type. It has 258 double-columned leaves, and contains (1) several parts of the gospel in verse, which end at fol. 132 *a*, then after a blank page, (2) collection of legends in verse, with special title and an introduction of eight verses (folios 133-205), then as a sort of appendix, (3) a metrical gospel of Nicodemus (folios 206-215 *a*), and (4) the Prick of Conscience in verse. This version, which appears as number 8 in the second

division, the legend collection of the Harl. MS., and whose text is identical in the two MSS. above mentioned, opens as follows,—

Of mari milde now will I mene
þat of all heuyns es corond quene
And lady of all erth to tell
And also Emperise of hell.

Another version belonging to the Southern cycle is that contained in the younger MS. of this cycle, Lambeth MS. 223, a 4to parchment from the beginning of the 15th century. (Cf. Horstmann, *Neue Folge*, p. xlvii. and Notes.) In this MS. the Assumption appears, not in the legendary itself, but as the fifth and last division in the *temporal*, which is prefixed to the Southern cycle of legends. This version has frequent rimes within the verse, and the last half verse has four stresses. The version agrees in many respects with the Northern one just described and also with the earlier Southern version, the one of our present volume. The opening lines are as follows,—

Herkkenes alle gode men, 3if 3e ben wise and slye
And I wole to 3ow rede þe assumpcioun of Marie
How she was from erþe taken into heuen on hegh
And þere she shal euer wone and sitte Ihesu negh.

Another English version of our legend is that incorporated into the Cursor Mundi (vv. 19993-20064). This version is translated into a Northern dialect from a Southern English poem. (Cf. *Cursor Mundi*, ed. by R. Morris, Introduction by Dr. Haenisch, pp. 42 ff.)

And sant edmund o ponteni
Dais o pardun þam gis tuenti
In a writt þis ilk i fand,
He-self it wroght, ic understand.
In sotherin englis was it draun
And turnd it haue i till our aun
Langage o northrin lede,
þat can nan oþer englis rede.

vv. 20057-64.

The poet of Cursor Mundi follows the Southern author nearly line for line, so that there cannot be the slightest doubt that he refers to the Southern English version of the present volume. But now and then he has made additions, for some of which Haenisch finds no source. (Horstmann believes this version to have been translated from Wace.)

The fact that the poet of Cursor Mundi “attributes his original to Edmund of Pontenay was caused by a misunderstanding of the lines 893-96 of the SE. Assumption” (Haenisch).

Cursor Mundi, vv. 20057-60.
And sant edmund o ponteni
Dais o pardun þam gis tuenti;
In a writt þis ilk i fand
He self it wroght, ic understand.

Assumption, vv. 893-6.
And þe archibisshop seynt Edmound
Hap graunted xl. daies to pardoun
To alle þat þis vie wol here
Or with good wille wol lere.

Still another version, which formed part of a work by Barbour, the author of the Scotch collection of legends, is mentioned in his prologue, but, along with the rest of this work referred to, is unfortunately lost.

Still further deserving of mention are (1) the prose version contained in the 'Festial' of Johannes Mirkus (Horstmann, *Neue Folge*, pp. cix. ff.), a collection of sermons, derived for the most part from the *Legenda Aurea* and written about 1400 for the festivals of the church, Festae Christi and Saints' days; [1.27](#) and (2) that contained in the English translation of the *Legenda Aurea* (cf. Horstmann, *Neue Folge*, pp. cxxx ff.). "The Assumption of oure ladi" stands 111 in Harl. MS. 4775.

The above enumeration of versions of our legend will demonstrate effectively its popularity in England, also its use in the service of the church. Further investigation is needed to determine more exactly the interrelations of the various versions, though it is doubtful if such an investigation would produce any very conclusive results, since, as suggested above, many versions of the legends were probably mixed versions (*mischredactionen*).

[§ 7.](#) MANUSCRIPTS.

The earliest English version, the one of the present volume, is known to exist in six manuscripts.

1. Cambr. Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2. (For description cf. introduction to King Horn, p. xxviii.) This fragmentary text (240 lines) is printed in the present volume.

2. Chetham MS. 8009, Manchester, a collection of romances and legends. (For description cf. Engl. Stud. vii, 195 ff., viii, pp. 1 ff.)

3. Cambr. Univ. MS. Dd. 1. 1., a long narrow MS. from about the middle of the 14th century and written in a large, informal, very legible hand. The content of the MS. is the Northern collection of *Evangelia dominicalia*, with which is included, in addition to the sermons with legends attached for the festivals of John and Peter and Paul, also our Southern legend poem of the Assumption, which is perhaps to be attributed to the scribe (named Staundon), who is

Southern. (For a full account of this MS. cf. Horstmann, *Neue Folge*, p. xxvi. and pp. lxvii. ff.) This text of 544 verses has not been printed.

4. Cambr. Univ. MS. Ff. 2. 38, a paper MS. in an informal but legible hand by a Southern scribe. It contains miscellaneous religious writings, the list of which I neglected to copy. Our poem is followed by “þe lyfe of seynt Kateryn.” This text of 770 verses has not been printed.

5. Harl. MS. 2382, a paper book in 4to, in an informal hand, and containing nine miscellaneous theological poems by Lydgate, Chaucer, etc. Poem number 1 is Lydgate’s *Life of the Virgin Mary*, four books at the end of which stands this note, *Explicit quartus liber de sancta Maria*. The second poem is our present version of the Assumption, evidently the end of a sequel to Lydgate’s poem, for at the end stands the note, *Explicit Sextus liber Sancte Marie*, which shows that two other books were added to the original four of Lydgate, written in stanzas, to King Henry V. The other contents of this MS. seem also to be literary, and are as follows: 3. *Oracio ad Sanctam Mariam*, 4. *The Testament of Dan Johan Lydgate*, 5. *Fabula Mornalis de Sancta Maria*, Chaucer’s *Prioress’s Tale*, 6. *Vita Sancte Cecilie*, Chaucer’s *Second Nonne’s Tale*, 7. *De Sancto Erasmo Martire*, 8. *Testamentum Cristi*, 9. *The Childe of Bristow*. This text of 710 verses is in part reprinted in the present volume.

6. Brit. Mus. Add. MS. 10036, a small parchment volume (about 8 × 4) of 100 folios, written in black letter, perhaps in the second half of the 14th century, and containing a miscellaneous religious collection: (1) History of the siege and destruction of Jerusalem by Vespasian (ff. 1-61), (2) The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin (ff. 62-80), (3) A question of the peynes of helle (prose, ff. 81-84), (4) Here bigynneth the thre arowis that God schal schete at domys-dais upon hem that schullen be dampned (prose, ff. 85-91), (5) The seven petitions in the Pater Noster (prose, ff. 91-94), (6) Ave Maria, Pardons and Indulgences for repeating (prose, f. 94), (7) Ten Commandments trans. and expl. (prose, ff. 94-96), (8) The 51st Psalm, *Miserere mei*, trans. into English verse (96-100). This text, in 904 verses, is printed in the present volume.

If for the sake of conformity with the German investigations, we designate Cambr. MS. Gg. 9. 27. 2. as **A**, Brit. Mus. Add. MS. 10036 as **B**, Harl. MS. 2382 as **C**, Cambr. MS. Dd. 1. 1. as **D**, Cambr. MS. Ff. 2. 38. as **E**, and Chetham MS. as **Ch.**, then the interrelations of the different texts of this version are about as follows (F. Gierth, *Engl. Stud.* vii, pp. 1 ff.). **A** and **B** form a special group as opposed to **C**, **D**, **E**, on the one hand, and to **Ch.** alone, on the

other. No one of these versions is the direct source of any other. The different texts may be characterized somewhat as follows:

A offers the best text as far as it goes.

B introduces many important changes, and seems to be somewhat confused in the order of events, but in the passages preserved intact, preserves the text and the rime better than do **C**, **D**, or **E**.

C gives best the true course of the story, but often alters the rime, in particular, individual rime words.

D has many gaps, and is particularly defective after the entrance on the scene of Thomas.

E stands in closer relation to **D** than to **C**, and often takes an intermediate position between **C** and **D**. **Ch.** (cf. M. Schwarz, Engl. Stud. viii, p. 460) we must regard as a compilation of different MSS., and owes its origin perhaps to oral tradition. In the case of **Ch.**, as in the case of the other texts of this version, it will be safer not to set up any diagram representing the interrelations of MSS., since these MSS. are no doubt all of them influenced by written as well as by oral tradition, and, as has been pointed out above, there is at least a possibility, as in the case of **Ch.**, of mixed versions. In dealing with legend, even less than in dealing with romance, does one have to do with a purely epic growth.

§ 8. TIME AND PLACE OF COMPOSITION.

We have already seen that the author of *Cursor Mundi* attributes the authorship of this version of the Assumption to Edmund of Pontenay (pp. liii, liv, above). But we have also seen the probable source of his error. In one thing the Northern writer is no doubt right, when he says (v. 20061), “In sotherin englis was it draun.” The poem is undoubtedly Southern in origin. To gain more definite knowledge is not easy. The rimes, our usual guide in such cases, in this poem are very uncertain. The writer’s ear seems to have been not a delicate one. He does not distinguish carefully open $\bar{e}$ and close $\bar{e}$, e.g. *here* : *lere* 4 Add., *wel* : *del* 212 C, 206 D, 218 Add., 256 C, 262 Add., *were* : *here* 716 Add., etc.

In a similar way he does not distinguish carefully open $\bar{o}$ and close $\bar{o}$, e.g. *gone* : *done* 86 Add., 594 H, *done* : *one* 416 Add., 562 H, 588 H, 750 Add., *anon* : *done* 530 Add., *sloo* : *doo* 508 H, *po* : *do* 262 D, etc. In consequence we are not able to apply the - $w\bar{o}$ -, - $w\bar{o}$ - test with any degree of certainty. OE. - $w\bar{a}$ rimes, now with $\bar{o}$, now with $\bar{o}$, e.g. *fro* : *so* 342 Add., 324 D, *so* : *fo* 374 Add.,

tho : *so* 278 H, *also* : *mo* 17 C, etc.; but *so* : *to* 179 C, 184 Add., 214 C, 296 C, 300 Add., 314 H, 344 Add., 718 Add., 904 Add., *atwo* : *do* 280 H, *whom* : *come* 306 F (*wham* : *cam* 336 Add.), etc.

In the same way OE. *æ*, and shortened OE. *ǣ*, rimes now with *a*, now with *e*, e.g. *was* : *gracias* 310 Add., 774 Add., *Thomas* : *was* 656 C, *Iosephas* : *was* 582 H; but *fless* : *was* 34 C, *best* : *lest* 392 H, *fed* : *bed* 124 C, 132 A, *les* : *wes* 566 D.

In the same way OE. *y* rimes now with *e*, now with *i*, e.g. *stede* : *dude* 57 C, 62 Add., 88 Add., 800 Add., 82 C, 624 Add., *kyng* : *geng* 220 C, *him* (= 'them') : *kyn* 642 Add.; but *mankyne* : *pyne* 426 A, *Inne* : *kynne* 430 A, 478 A, 360 H, 338 D, 346 D, *it* : *pytt* 506 H, *þerynne* : *synne* 604 H, *blisse* : *gladnesse* 384 H, etc.

In the same way in the 3rd plur. pres. indic., the ending is sometimes *-eþ*, sometimes *-n*, e.g. *listneþ* 8 C, *serueþ* 418 H, *goth* 476 H, 593 A, *bup* 22 C, 26 C, etc.; but *ben* 25 A, *beon* 141 C, 149 A, etc., and the rime *kenesmen* : *ben* 122 C, 130 A.

Details may be multiplied indefinitely to show the general Southern character of the language, e.g. the verbal endings in *-i* or *-y*, as *blessi* : *herkni* 7, 8 C, *loky* 47 C, *gladie* 75 C, etc.; the infinitive preserving its final *-n*, as *quene* : *bene* 6 Add., *bene* : *ysene* 40 A, *gon* : *on* 140 C, *quen* : *ben* 98 C, 104 A, 114 C, 120 A, etc.; but *beo* : *gleo* 10 C, etc.; the present participle in *-and*, as *leþand* : *hande* 614 A, etc.; the use of the palatalized consonants, as in *yyeue* 566 H, *ayene* 597 H, etc.

The dialect then certainly is of the Southern part of England; but the rimes do not enable one to locate the dialect more exactly. The composition is undoubtedly that of a scholar in whom one might expect a wider range in pronunciation. Doubtless both Southern and Midland dialects were familiar to him. The pronunciation, however, of OE. *y* as *e* and of OE. *æ* as *e* belongs to the East Southern, and we shall probably be safe in calling the dialect a compromise between East Southern and East Midland.

The time of composition was probably not later than 1250. The OE. *ā* had regularly changed to *ō* (if we neglect an isolated instance like *thomas* : *ras* 822 A); but I find no certain instance of lengthening in open syllables, and further, the oldest MS. (C) is not much later than 1250, as we have seen. It preserves the unmonophthonged *eo*, e.g. *weop* 29, *treo* 35, *heo* 36, *beo* 37, *iseo* 38, etc.

§ 9. VERSIFICATION.

The legend, like the romance of Floris and Blancheflur, is composed in short riming pairs. Each verse nominally has four metrical stresses. The rime may be either masculine or feminine. Frequently assonance takes the place of perfect rime; e.g. *weop : fet* 30 C, *gode : fote* 70 Add., *polen : y-boren* 220 Add., etc.

Footnotes to Introduction

[L.22](#) Cf. Horstmann, as above, pp. xxviii ff.

[L.23](#) A legend cycle composed in Latin prose by the Italian Jacobus a Voragine, Bishop of Genoa.

[L.24](#) Cf. M. Schwarz, *Engl. Studien*, viii, pp. 461 ff. But cf. ten Brink, I, p. 336; Horstmann, *Neue Folge*, p. xxxix.

[L.25](#) Cf. C. Horstmann, *Altengl. Legenden*, p. xxxiv, Paderborn, 1875.

[L.26](#) Cf. Horstmann, *Neue Folge*, pp. lxxviii ff., *Text*, pp. 112 ff.

[L.27](#) The sermons are arranged according to the calendar, so that here the book of homilies and the legendary are at length completely formed into one. In the oldest and best MS., Cott. Claud. A. II, the Assumption is number 52.

ASSUMPCIOUN DE NOTRE
DAME

HIC INCIPIT ASSUMPCIO
BEATE MARIE

ambr. Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2.

Brit. Mus. Add. MS. 10,036, lf. 62.

[Erie tale telle ihc þis day
Of seinte Marye þat swete may.

Al is þe tale *and* þis lescoun
oure swete assompcioun, 4
þeo was fram erþe ynome
þo blisse wiþ hire sone.
yng of heuene hem blessi
þis listneþ *and* wel herkni. 8
moten hi iblessed beo,
vnderstonde wel þis gleo.

On honorance of ihesu cryst
Sitteþ stille *and* haueþ lyst;
And 3if 3e wille to me here,
ff oure ladi 3e mai lere, 4
loue of heuene, ladi *and* quene,
s sche au3t wel to bene,
þo wham aungeles doun here my3t
þo serue hure boþe day *and* ny3t. 8
for auenture 3e haue no3t iherde
how oure ladi went out of þis werde:
sitteþ stille *and* herkenenþ to me;
how ihesu cryst oure helpe be! 12

Whan ihesu crist was don on rode,
þolede deþ for vre gode, 12
þelepede to hym seint Iohan
was his o3e qenes man,
his o3ene moder also;
þelepede he hym feren no mo. 16

Whan ihesu crist was doun on þe rode
and þolede deþ for oure goode,
he callide to hym seynt Iohan,
that was his fleschli kynnes man. 16
his moder swete he dide also;
he callid no men mo him to.

sedde, “wif, lo her þi child,
on þe rode is ispild.
gap in MS.]

hc am honged on þis tre,
sore ihc wot hit reweþ þe. 20
e fet *and* honden of blod [buþ red];
ite gult ih[c] þolie þis ded.

nd seide, “womman, lo here þi sone,
nd, man, take hure to moder *in* good wone. 20
nd þenkeþ on my sorwe nowe
ow I hange here abowe,
ow I hange apone a tre,
ul sore, I wote, hit reweþ þee. 24
lyn feet, myn hondes, of blode ben rede; [leaf 62, back]
/ith owte gilt I þole dede.

e men þat aȝte me to loue,
whan ihc com fram heuene abuue, 24
haueþ idon þis ilke schame,
naue no gult; hi buþ to blame.
ni fader ihc bidde mi bone
he forȝiue hit hem welsone.” 28

ut þei haue wille to louen me
or wham I hange on þis tree. 28
he Iewis me deden mychel schame;
her of hadde I neuer blame.”

is entrusts Mary to John.

arie stod *and* sore weop;
 erres feolle to hire fet.
 wonder nas þeȝ heo wepe sore;
 oreȝe ne miȝte heo wite nomore, 32
 enne he þat of hire nam blod *and* fless,
 his suete wille was,
 g Inayled on þe treo.

M Arie his moder sore dide wepe;
 The teeres fellen at hure fete. 32

Nas no wondre þouȝ sche wepe sore;
 f sorwe wist sche neuer more.
 hen he þat of hure flesche nam,
 or his holi swete nam, 36
 onge þer nailed to a tre,

is, my sone,” seide heo, 36
 may ihc liue? hu may þis beo?
 nai ihc al þis soreȝe iseo?
 rupe ihc neure of soreȝe noȝt;
 eue sone, wat hastu þoȝt? 40
 schal ihc lyue biþute þe?
 e sone, what seistu me?”

Alas, my sone,” þo saide sche,
 How mai I lyue? how mai I bene?
 ow mai I þis sorwe ysene? 40
 euer ere wist I of sorwe nouȝt;
 eue sone, what hauest þou þouȝt?
 ow schal I leue *with* oute þee?
 eue sone, what saist þou to me?” 44

þæt ihsu wordes gode,
he heng vpon þe rode, 44
sede to his moder dere,
schal þe teche a trewe ifere,
trewliche schal loky þe,
while þat þu in erþe be.” 48

iesu spak þo wordes goode,
s he henge on þe rode,
and seide to his moder dere,
schal þee take a trewe fere, 48
hat trewly schal kepen þee, [leaf 63]
while in erþe þou schalt be.”

þæt seide vre lord to seint Iohan,
for my loue qep me þis wymman.
hire wel wiþ al þi miȝte
noman do hure non vnriȝte.” 52

þan seide Ihesu to seynt Iohan,
for my loue kepe wel þis womman. 52
epe hure wel *with* al þi myȝt,
hat no man do hure vnryȝt.”
þan nam þe apostel, seynt Iohan,
in his kepynge þis womman. 56
he kept hure wel *with* al his myȝt,
hat no man do hure none vnryȝt. [A.1](#)

[A.1](#) MS. viryȝt

þe temple mid hire he nam,
also sone so he þar cam,
ong þe lefdis in þe stede,
to serui he hire dude. 56

þe temple he hure nam,
nd also sone as he þer cam, 60
od to serue he hure dede,
monge þe nunnes in þat stede.

bilefte heo al hure lif;
ouede he noþer fiȝt ne strif,
þat in þe temple were,
niȝte noȝt hire forbere. 60
al hure miȝte þe while heo was þore,
seruede boþe lasse *and* more;
re *and* sike he dude god,
seruede hem to hond *and* fot. 64

her sche bileft al hure lyfe,
e loued sche noþer fiȝt ne stryf. 64
The ladies þat þer Inne weren,
ul wel þei ne myȝt hure forberen,
or euer þe while sche was þore,
che wolde serue las *and* more. 68
eke *and* hole sche dide gode
nd seruede hem to hande *and* fote.

re *and* hungrie wel faire he fedde,
sike heo broȝte in here bedde.
þer non so hol ne fer,
to hire nadde mester. 68
ouede hure alle wiþ here miȝte,
heo seruede hem wel riȝte.

aked *and* hungry sche cloþed *and* fedde;
olde *and* seke sche brouȝt to bedde. 72
e was þer noþer seke ne fere, [leaf 63, back]
hat þei nadde to hure mystere.
hei louede hure wel *with* al here myȝt;
che it serued *and* þat was ryȝt. 76

wakede more þane slep;
sone to *serui* was al hire kep. 72
him heo clupede wiþ Murie steuene,
hire he sente an aungel fram heuene,
ladie hire him self he cam,
t þat fless of hire nam. 76

che woke more þan sche slepe;
ure sone to serue was al hure kepe,
o hym sche callid *with* rewful steuene,
nd he hure sent an angel fro heuene, 80
o glade hure, hym self he cam,
hat of hure bodi flesche nam.

ist sends to Mary an angel messenger.

int Ion hire kepte *and* was hire dere;
was hire eure a trewe fere.
le he neure fram hire gon;
at heo wolde he dude anon. 80
whiles hi were in þat stede,
at heo wolde he hit dede.
me heo hadde beo þer longe,
wyntere hem amonge, 84
sone wolde heo come hym to,
me he hit wolde, hit was ido.

eynt Iohan hure keper was hure dere,
nd to hure was a trewe fere. 84
e wolde he neuer fro hure gone;
l þat sche wolde he wolde done.
hile sche was in þat stede,
l þat sche wolde he hure dede. 88
hen sche hadde þer longe ben,
hat faire ladi, heuene quen,
han wolde hure sone sche com him to.
hen he wolde, hit was do. 92

e sente hire on Aungel of heuene,
grette hire wiþ murie steuene. 88
e temple he bad hire bede;
lizte þe aungel in þat stede,
sede, “lefdi ful of grace,

e sent to hure an angel of heuene,
hat gret hure *with* myry steuene,
her sche was *and* bad hure bede,
y3th an angel in þat stede, 96
nd seide, “ladi, ful of grace, [leaf 64]

angel announces that Mary will be summoned to heaven.

I þe beo in eche place. þeo noȝt of drad þeȝ ihc beo her; am þi sones Messenger. n hym to þe ihc am icome rette wel þi dere sone. of erþe, of heuene quen, ssed mote þu eure ben.	92 96
Blessed be þou in eche place. e nouȝt adrad þouȝ I be here; am þi sones messagere. ro hym I am to þee come; e gret þee wel, þi dere sone. loure of erþe, heuene quene, lessed mote þou euer bene.	100 104
beo þe time þat þu were ibore, al þis wordle were forlore; u nere <i>and</i> þat frut of þe, ie lefdi, wel þe be. li, best of alle þinge, bliþe bode ihc þe bringe, 1 þis palm wiþ þi riȝt honde; is þi dere sones sonde.	100 104
Iel be þat tyme þat þou was born, or al þis worlde hit was forlorn, if þou ne were <i>and</i> þe fruyt of þee; larie, ladi, wel þee be. adi, best of al þinge, liþe tiþynges I þee brynge, hou take þis palme þat I brynge þee; hi dere sone haþ sent it þee.	108 112

þinkeþ long hym to se;
schaltu her no lenger beo. 108

wile senden after þe,
n heuene adun of his meigne,
fecche þe in to his blisse,
eure schal leste wiþute misse. 112
he is kyng þu schalt beo quen;
euene for þe schal bliþe beon.”

he þynkeþ longe him to see;
her fore most I no lengere be,
e schal sende after þee
f heuene ferde moche plente, 116
nd brynge þee in to his blisse,
hat euer was *and* now is.

er he is kyng, þou schalt be quene;
l heuen ryche bliþe schal bene. 120
nd alle him þenkeþ swiþe longe
il þou comest hem amonge.”

[leaf 64, back]

me ansuaredi vre lefdi,
e aungel þat stod hire by, 116
u Mi sonas Messenger,
bringest me þis greting her?

he set me any day
nes þat iħc me greþi may, 120
nyme lyue of mine kenemen,
myne frend þat wiþ me beon,
of him þat haþ me cloþed *and* fed,
don also my sone hym bed?" 124

han answerede oure ladi,
nd seide to þe angel, "belamy, 124
rt þou my sonas massagere,
hat bryngest me þis bodes here?
aueþ he me sette any day,
gens when I me greithe may, 128
/ith my frendes *and* my kynnes men,
nd with hem þat I in erþe haue ben,
nd hem þat I haue fedde *and* clad,
nd don al þat my sone hem bad?" 132

seide þe aungel, "iħc telle þe;
e schalt beo her bute dazes þre.
ridde day we schulle come,
gles *fram* heuene aboue, 128
d fette þe wiþ *mur*ye song;
after þe us þinket long."

ho seide þe angel, "I sei þee;
hou schalt be here but daies þre.
he þridde dai we schal come,
lle ix. ordres fram heuen a boue, 136
And fecche þee with myry songe;
or after þee vs þinketh longe."

nne ansuarede vre lefdy,
wat is þi name, belamy?" 132

sede, "my name ne telle ihc þe noȝt;
þe nym þis palm þat ihc habbe þe broȝt
kep hit wel ihc bidde þe;
et hit neure fram þe be. 136

o þat aungel seide oure ladi,
What is þi name, þat standeþ me bi?" 140
My name seie I þee nouȝt;
ut take þis palme þat I haue brouȝt.
epe it wel, I bidde þee,
e lete it neuer be fro þee. 144

dar no leng dwelle her,
ihc was sent as Messenger.
þe apostles ihc schal gon,
bidde hem alle, eurech on, 140
hi beon her þe þridde day;
eng abiden I ne may."

þe mai I no lengere abide here, [leaf 65]
or I am sent a massagere.
schal to þe apostles sone anone,
nd seie to hem sundry, on *and* one, 148
hat þei ben here þe þridde dai;
o lengere abide I ne mai."

ry attires herself, then prays to her Son.

he hadde ydon, to heuene he steȝ;
ie abod *and* was wel sleȝ, 144

nam þat palm þat hire was broȝt,
of þat bode heo hadde gret þoȝt,
hire Chaumbre stille he nam;
so sone so heo þar cam, 148
lude of al hire hatere,

wessch hire body wyþ clene watere,
heo hauede so idon,
newe schrud heo dude hire on. 152

Then he had iseide, to heuene he steie;
nd marie þer bi-left he. 152
No gap in MS.]

n-til hure chambre sone sche nam;
nd also sone as sche þider cam,
che dide of hure clopes alle,
nd wasche hure *with* water of wille. 156
o sone as sche hadde doun,
ewe clopes sche dide hure apoun.

heo was schurd *and* faire iclad,
hesu crist abone heo bad,
sede, “sone, ihc þonky þe
þu hauest iþoʒt of me. 156

e, þu ert of heuene kyng,
biðde þe þi blessing;
e, for þin holy name,
lde me fram pine *and* fram schame, 160
þe deuel ne habbe no myʒt;

Then sche was faire schred *and* clad,
o ihesu cryst aboue sche bad, 160
nd seide, “sone, I þanke þee,
hat þou hast ypouʒt on me,
ly sone, þat is heuene kynge,
praie þee of þi blessing. 164
one, for þyn hye name,
chelde my bodi fro payne *and* schame,
hat þe deuel haue no myʒt;

lerie me hit were vnriʒt.
e, help me nu ihc haue ned,
ine haue of þe feond no dred, 164
wiþ þe giles þat he can,
biþtraieþ many man.

o reyue þee hit were no ryʒt. 168
epe me, sone; now is nede [leaf 65, back]
hat I ne haue of þe deuel no drede.
or with þe wiles þat he can,
e bigileþ many a man. 172

announces her departure to her friends.

le sone, ne 3ef him no3t,
þu hauest so dere ibo3t. 168

e, þu art ful of pite;
senful manne bið ihc þe,
þu for þin holy grace,
nem boþe wille *and* space, 172

Leue sone, 3eue hym nou3t
lan kynde þat þou hast bou3t.
li sone, þat art ful of pite,
or man kynne I *praie* þee, 176
hat þou, for þi holi *grace*,
eue hem boþe my3t *and* space,

1 to amendy er hy beo ded,
þe deuel hem do no qued.
3, sone, þat þu hast hem wro3t,
þat þu hauest hem dere ibo3t. 176
hem þu þoledest pine *and* wo;
e hem wel *fram* here fo.”

em to amende or þei ben dede,
hat þei haue of þe deuel no drede. 180
hynke, leue sone, þou hast hem wrou3t,
nd dere þat þou hast hem bou3t.”

þe heo hadde bisoƷt so,
þæt frend he clupede hire to,
e sibbe *and* fremde Men,
reuful speche heo spak wiþ hem,

180

sede, “leue frend, my sone
e no leng þat iħc her wone;
wile iħc wende *and* mid him be.

184

Then sche hadde praied so,
ure frendes sche callid hure to,
[*No gap in MS.*]

184

ure sibbe *and* hure kynnes men.
With reuful steuene sche spak to hem,
n seide, “leue frendes, my sone
I wol no lenger þat I here wone.
e wol þat I with him be;

188

I bidde iħc Ʒou *par* charite,
iħc habbe eny þing mis wroƷt,
eƷ hit me, ne heleþ hit noƷt.
wulle amende, *and* þat is riƷt
my saule ne beo idriƷt.

188

There fore I praie Ʒow *par* charite,
if I any þinge haue mys wrouƷt,
eieþ me now; for-hele Ʒe nouƷt.
it wole amende with my myƷt,
hat my soule haue no vnplyƷt,

192

[leaf 66]

god 3e habbeþ me ydon,
 sone þat was in rode ydon, 192
 i to bigge fram þe ded,
 le hit 3ou at ower ned,
 bringe 3ou in to þat blis
 eue ilet þar my sone is.” 196

he good þat 3e haue doun me,
 ly sone þat was doun on þe tree, 196
 lan to bigge fro þe quede,
 e 3elde it 3ow at 3oure nede,
 nd brynge 3ow in to his blis,
 her I schal be *and* my sone is.” 200

le þat stoden hire by,
 at tīþinge were sory,
 sede, “lefdi, hu mai hit be?
 schulle we liue wiþ outen þe? 200
gap in MS.]

li dere, what hastu þoʒt?
 of vs; ne wend þou noʒt.
 soreʒe *and* in Muche wo
 ille we lyue beo þu vs fro.” 204

Alle þat weren hure bi,
 Off suche tīþinges weren sori,
 And saide, “lady, how mai þis be?
 ow schulle we lyuen *with* oute þee? 204
 adi, þou hast vs serued so;
 las, how schulle we parte a two?
 wete ladi, what is þi þoʒt?
 ewe on vs; departe vs nouʒt. 208
 in moche sorwe *and* in myche wo
 chulle we lyue, be þou a go.”

n comes and inquires the cause of her grief.

nne spak vre lefdy
iem þat were hire by,
e3 beon; ower wepinge ne helpeþ no3t;
beþ ioeye in ower þo3t. 208
while ihc am her, wakeþ wiþ me;
doþ me god þat ihc 3ou se.

an answerede oure ladi
o þat folke þat stode hure bi, 212
Lateþ be 3our grening⁺ hit helpeþ no3t;
nd haueþ blis in 3oure þou3t.
While I am here, wakeþ with me;
it doþ me good þat I 3ow se. 216

beþ no drede ac witeþ hit wel;
ine ne schal ihc þole no del. 212
schal no sore3 come me to,
my sone hit wule so,
ody ne schal no pine þole,
he was þer of ibore, 216
olede pine him self for me,
ie deide vpon þe tre.

auēþ no drede in wel; [leaf 66, back]
f peyne schal I þole no del.
No gap in MS.]

li bodi mai no peyne þolen,
or he was þer of y-boren. 220
e þoled deþ him self for me;
e honged nailed on þe tree.

þat is almiȝtful kyng,
al me sende of his geng. 220
in *and* þe apostles, whei hy be,
hi schulle come to me.”

li sone þat is kyng⁺ of heuene,
chal me sende worde wel euene; 224
þan *and* þe apostles, where so þei bene,
chulle alle come for to sene.”

while he spac þus to þis men,
l þat þing nuste noȝt Ion. 224
þom to speke wiþ vre lefdi,
hym þuste heo was sori,

s sche so spak to þe mon,
ff al þat wist nouȝt seynt Ion. 228
e come to speke *with* oure ladi;
erli him þouȝt þat sche was sory,

sede, “lefdy, what is þe?
my *seruise* tel hit me. 228
li, what is þe ised?
were leffre to beo ded,
e iseo þe make such chere.
it is þe, my lefdi dere? 232
gap in MS.]

shal ihc neure habbe blis,
þat ihc wite what þe is.”
nd seide, “ladi, what is þee?
hat is þis folk þat I here se? 232
eie me, ladi, what is þee?” he sede;
For me were leuer þat I were dede,
han I þee se suche semblaunt make,
For schal I neuer suche a ladi take. 236
astou ouȝt herde þat I ne can,
ff me or of any oþer man?
chal I neuer haue blis
il I wite, ladi, what þee is.” 240

ry consoles John.

lefdi wep *and* Iohan also;
ve loue was bituex hem tuo. 236
fdi,” he sede, “what is þe?
my loue, tel hit me.”
ie ansuerde wiþ Milde steu[ene],
onde Me cam while er fram h[euene], 240

he MS. ends here. Continued from Harl. MS. 2382.

ure ladi wept and Iohan also, [leaf 67]
or trewe loue was bitwene hem two.
ohan seide, “ladi, what is þee?
or þi sones loue, seie þou me.” 244
larie answerde *with* rewful steuene,
nd seide, “me cam bode fram heuene,

arl. MS. 2382, lf. 78, bk.

ny sone a messynger;
wol no lenger that y be here.
y wote that rueth me,
y shall departe fro the; 244
hi loue and thi seruice
thu me dost in al wise.
hast made me ofte glad;
has done as my sone bad. 248
sone shal it yelde to the;
ol hym pray when y hym se.”

ro my sone a massagere;
e wol no lengere þat I be here, 248
/ite þou wel hit rewip me
hat I schal, Iohan, parte fram þee.
or þi loue *and* þi seruyce
hat þou hast down on eche wise, 252
hou hast me boþe fed *and* clad,
nd down also my sone þee bad.
ly sone schal it wel 3elde þee;
schal him telle when I him se.” 256

answerd to here seynt Iohan,
was a full sory man,
lady Marie, what shal y be
n y shall the no lenger se?
ioye thu art euery del;
enger in erthe worth y well,
we shul departe a two.”

Iohannes

252

han answerde seynt Iohan,
hat was a ful sori man,
nd seide, “ladi, how mai þis be
hat I schal þee no more se?
li ioie, my blis, is down eche del;
e schal me neuer worpen wel,
ithen we ben parted atwo.”

260

n seid Marie, “whi seist þou so?
sothe, thogh y go be-fore,
shal thu not be for-lore.
all pray my lef sone,
thu may vnto vs come.
o thyng, Iohan, y bidde the,
he loue thu hast to me,

Maria

260

[leaf 79]

264

o seide our ladi, “why saistou so?
/ite þou wel, I go be-forn;
hi seruyse schal noȝt be forlorn;
schal to my sone seie of þee
hat þou with hym *and* me schal be.
ut herestou now, my frende Iohan,
/hen þou sest þat I am gon,

264

[leaf 67, back]

268

anone when y am nome,
the fals Iewys ne come
body for to done shame,
hei haten moche my name. 268

wole feyn shame me,
honged my sone on þe rode tre.
ote welþ thei loue me noght;
-for thei bene mysthought. 272

epe my bodi þat I ne be binomen,
hen þe fellon Iewes comen, 272
li bodi forto doun no schame,
or þei hate no þing⁺ more þan my name.

li sone þei hongen on a tre;
el I wote so wolde þei me. 276
wote wel þei louen me nouȝt;
ut þer of be þi most þouȝt.

n y am be-nome fro the,
y body they do no foly.
u Crist oure allere dright,
ham neuer that ilke myght.” 276

hen I am parted, Iohan, fram þee,
hat þei do my bodi none euelte. 280
ly sone, þat woneþ in heuene liȝt,
ete hem neuer þer to haue myȝt.”

apostles arrive from distant regions.

it Iohan answerd tho,
me, lady, if it is so,
we shall departe atwo.
ete lady, how shall y do?
me þe tyme when it shal be,
thu shalt to heuene te.”

Iohannes

280

Ladi, sithen hit is so,
hat we schal departe a two,

284

ie me how long hit is to þan.”

seid, “Iohan, that þou shall se;
ide y here but dayes thre.”
n was Iohan ful hertely sory.

Maria

284

For soþe,” marie seide to Iohan,
3i þis *and* þe þridde day,
o lenger abide I ne may.”
hen he it herde, he was sory;

288

[leaf 68]

and he seyde, “dame, mercy!
 shal y leue? how shal y fare?
 cometh al my sorow *and* care.
 lord was hard y-brought to deth,
 gh fals Iewis that couthe no meth.
 shal oure lady me fro;
 cometh to me al my woo.
 I god that y were ded,
 ight now can y no red.”

Iohannes

288

292

e wept, *and* seide, “ladi, mercy.
 ow schal I lyue? how schal I fare?
 ow schal I blis or ioie haue?
 urst my lord was brougt to dede,
 horw þe felun iewes rede,
 nd now my ladi wil me fro,
 wete lord, now me is wo.
 olde my lord I wolde be dede,
 or I ne can no better rede.”

292

296

y,” she seid, “whi seist thu so?
 elis the shall come to,
 loke to the where thu be,
 h and late to comfort the.”

Maria

[leaf 79, back]

296

iohan,” sche seide, “whi seistou so?
 h[e] aungeles schal þee come to,
 o kepe þee where so þou be,
 rliche *and* late to gladen þee.”

300

n she spake to seynt Iohan,
 ostellis cam yn euerychon),
 none of hem wiste be-forn),
 thei were theder y com,

**nota de apostolis
 omnibus miraculose.**

300

hiles he spak so to seynt Ion,
 ome þe apostles euerychon,
 o gidre; but þei wist nougt
 ow þei weren to gidre brougt;

304

seid, “lady, ne drede þou noght,
one hath vs hider broght, 304
nowe the for oure lady,
le that we bene the by.”

ff oþeres come ne wist none;
ut of hure come bliþe was Ion. 308
e cust hem alle, so fayn he was,
nd seide, “deo gracias;

lessed, ihesu, be þi myȝt,
or it is faire and hit is ryȝt 312
hat þi moder come to þee,
[leaf 68, back]
hat sche faire welcom be

f þine apostles þat most þee louen,
ne wote how þei ben hidre ycomen.” 316
han seide Petyr to seynt Ion,
Whi art þou so sory A mon?

n bids them go and greet Mary.

Not in Harl. 2382)

Whi wepistou, *and* what is þee?
 or felaschip telle þou me. 320
 schal þee seie, seynt Ion,
 /hi I am so sory a mon,
 ut seie me furst, for godes loue,
 /hi 3e arn hider icome, 324
 nd weryn so wide isprad:
 eieþ what haþ 3ou hidre ilad.”
 ho seide Petyr a ferli þinge:
 I was fer hens atte my *preching*e. 328
 was so henne in anoper londe
 nd helde my boke in my honde,
 nd tau3t men of my sermoun,
 ne wote how I cam to þis toun.” 332
 o seide alle þat weren þere,
 uche wondre sawe I neuer ere.
 one of hem ne wist þorw wham,
 e what wai þei þidre cam, [leaf 69]
 han seide seynt Iohan, “for soþe, I wys, 336
 schal 3ow telle what it is.
 omeþ wiþ me in to þis hous;
 ure ladi þer abideþ vs. 340
 che ordeyneþ hure to fare vs fro,
 or hure sone hit wolle so.
 ure sone haþ sent his messagere;
 e wol no lengere þat sche be here. 344
 nd hider he haþ 3ow alle ysent
 o kepe hure bodi when sche is went.
 i fore hure knele 3e alle bi-dene
 nd seieþ, ‘ladi, heuene quene, 348
 ff alle wymmen, best þee be;
 hi sone vs haueþ sent to þee,
 o kepe þee *and* do þi wille:
 s þenkeþ wel þat it is skille, 352
 hat heuene *and* erþe bowe þee to,
 or þi sone hit wol so,
 hi sone, þat is heuene kynge,
 nd alle bing hab in his kepinge.” 356

han comen þe apostles alle,
 nd bi hure bigan to falle.
 p ros oure swete ladi
 nd kist þe apostles bi *and* bi. 360
 ff here come sche was glad;
 [leaf 69, back]
 lle þei dide þat sche bad.
 che asked hem how þei come þere,
 hat sprad so sundry were. 364
 he seide in ful good þouȝt,
 Thi sone vs haþ hidre ybrouȝt
 o kepe þee, *and* by þee by;
 her fore we comen to þe, lady.” 368

ry bids them keep her body from the Jews.

ssid,” she seid, “be my sone.” **Maria**
 was she was of here come. 308
 m his moder,” so seid he,
 d ther for may y be.

ul bliþe sche was of here come;
 Blessed,” sche seide, “be my sone!

when it is my sonnes wille
 ym y come, *and* that is skyle, 312
 y body ye loke al so,
 my foos ne come ther to.

hen it is my sonnes wille
 hat I come him to, hit is skille. 372
 li bodi ȝe schal kepe so
 hat þer-to come nouȝt my fo.
 epeþ faire my body,
 hat none do me no vilany. 376
 he Iewis ben ful of felony;
 ly sone þei slow þorw enuye.

he hateth they my name;
for wold thei do me shame. 316

u bidde *pur* charite,
he loue ye haue to me,
n y fare to heuene blisse,
eth ther my body ys. 320

he haten no þing more þan my name,
od late hem neuer do me schame. 380
her fore I *praie* 3ow, *pur* charyte,
nd for þe loue þat 3e haþ to me,
hen I am faren to heuen blis,
akeþ alle þer my body is. 384

th bothe nyght *and* day,
þe Iewis bere it not away.
wold it brenne or do shame.
u, for thi holy name, 324
ham neuer strengthe to haue
odi in erthe for to laue.”

epiþ it boþe ny3t and dai, [leaf 70]
hat no Iewe stele it awai.
hei wolde it brenne or do it schame;
ut ihesu, for þi holi name, 388
ate hem neuer þer-to haue my3t,
or sikirli hit were vnry3t.”

i answerd, “for sothe, y-wys, [leaf 80]
al be as thi wille ys.” 328
whiles Marie badde here bone
ie apostellis euerychone,

hei seiden, alle soþe, I wys,
Hit schal be, ladi, as þi wille is.” 392
hiles oure ladi spak⁺ so
o þe apostles þat come hure to,

angel a-light on that stede,	Angelus
seid, "Marie, god herd þi bede,	332
all they that bene <i>with</i> the;	
e that thu arayed be.	
shalt to heuene <i>and</i> be quene;	
þlithe may thi hert bene.	336
shalt in hast be in heuene."	
ome an aungel <i>and</i> stode hure bi,	
nd seide, "wel þee be, ladi,	396
nd so be alle þat ben þee bi;	
Loke þou be ful redi.	
ou schalt to heuene <i>and</i> be made quene;	
ul bliþe mai þine hert bene.	400
lle schal þee <i>serue</i> , þe company of heuene."	
n <i>our</i> lady herd this steuene	
angel seid here then to,	
of blisse was she tho.	340
ere bed she went to aray,	
ute þe tyme of hy mydday.	
in the apostell sate here by,	
epe here body sikerly.	344
s soone oure ladi herd þat steuene	
hat þe aungel seide hure to,	
el ful of Ioie was sche þo;	404
che ȝede to hure bedde <i>and</i> lai,	
bowte þe tyme of myddai;	
han <i>and</i> þe apostles weren hure bi,	
o kepen hure as oure ladi.	408
che badde Iohan <i>and</i> þe apostles alle,	[leaf 70, back]
o kepen hure what so bi falle.	

us tells the angels about His life on earth.

Sitteþ now stille, boþe more *and* lesse,
 And herkenep of þe moche blesse 412
 Off Ihesu, þer he come so lyzt:
 e dide his moder ful moche riȝt,
 s a sone auȝt his moder to done,
 e callid þe aungeles euerychone, 416
 nd alle þe mayne þat was in heuene,
 nd seide to hem with mury steuene:
 Commeþ with me to my lemman!
 che is my moder; hure sone I am; 420
 ff hure I toke flesche *and* blode.
 nd sithen I hange on þe rode,
 þat euer was *and* ay schal ben,
 al þis blisse þat ȝe here sen, 424
 hadde reuþe on al mankyne,
 hat alle went to helle pyne.
 made man to serue me,
 nd þorw þe appel of a tre, 428
 hat adam toke *and* ete it Inne,
 o helle he went, *and* al his kynne.
 Hit rewid me, and for-þouȝt sore,
 nd I it wolde þole no more. 432
 lyzt down, *and* man bi-cam,
 nd of þat maide flesche nam. [leaf 71]

nge them alle sone ywys,
ete smeȝ cam fro paradys,
te it was, and ferly,
alle þat were tho here by,
e yong *and* olde *and* euerychone,
feȝ a-slepe, *and* þat anone.
the slepte, saue oure lady.

odor suauiissimus de
paradiso venit

348

3i fore alle oþer I hure ches,
nd I was born of hure flesches.
hritti wynter *and* somme del more,
len to wissen, I was þore.
len dide me moche euelte;
lyn owyn þat ouȝt for to be,
hei token me *and* bette me sore,

436

440

announces that He will bring Mary to heaven.

eneth now, y tell yow why.	nota de transitu sancte
als sone thei were a-slepe,	Marie
n to thondre al vnmete,	352
the erthe so swithe gan quake,	
l the world shuld to-shake.	356
ie awaked then seynt Iohan	
the apostels euerychon,	
maydens þat were the[re]-ynne,	
no man els of hire kynne.	360
keth now, and slepe ye nought!	
e y worth to heuene be broght;	
is tyme y were a fare,	
þ y neuer more suffre care.”	364

nd atte þe last þei dide wel more,
 7ith oute gult þei me swongen,
 nd to a piler þei me bounden. 444
 ailes þei smyten in my fette;
 ff blode myne handes weren rede.
 lyn hert þei stongen *with* a spere;
 hat sawe alle þat weren þere. 448
 her I hange nailed on þe tree,
 ly modre was wel wo for me,
 nd also was hure cosin Ion.
 callid hure to me soone anon, 452
 nd seide, ‘Iohan, for my loue,
 epe wel þis wyf; I am hure sone.’
 oþe þei wenten þo fro me;
 l one I hanged on þe tree, 456
 li soule fram my bodi I nam, [leaf 71, back]
 i to þe pyne of helle sone I came.
 lle my frendes þat I þer fonde,
 toke hem oute *with* my ryȝt honde, 460
 dam *and* Eue *and* many mo,
 dide hem oute of helle go.
 7hen I hadde harwed helle,
 nd don as I ȝow telle, 464
 nd fet adam fro þe quede,
 he þridde dai I ros fro dede.
 ram erþe to heuene I cam;
 od *and* man, bothe I am, 468
 i heuene *and* in erþe is my myȝt;
 Now I wol forþe in ryȝt,
 hat my modre be me bi;
 his tyme I wol for þi, 472
 omeþ with me with mury songe,
 nd do we hure come vs amonge.”

Conversation between Jesus and Mary.

cam Iesus from heuene,
angelis *and* archangelis seuene,
o hire boure *with* mery song;
he merthe was them among.
vonder thogh ther be blisse
the place ther Ihesus ys.

Ihesus

368

han cam ihesu *with* his mayne,
ungeles, archaungeles, moche plente,
to þe chambre þer sche was Inne,
ith ful many of hure kynne.
hat chambere was ful of moche blis,
s euer is þer ihesu is.

476

480

e of them that were there
che blisse saw they nere.
nge al blisses of the trone
y knew here leue sone.

372

ho seide alle þat were þere,
uche a blis sawe þei neuer ere.
monge þat Ioie *and* þat glewe,
ure ladi, hure sone knewe.

[leaf 72]

484

n she hym saw, she was ful glad,
erd the bone that she bad.

Maria

376

hen sche him sawe, sche was glad;
isteneþ þe bede þat sche bad:

blessed mote that tyme be
 thu were borne of me.
 s sene, y am thi moder
 n thu comest þi self hider. 380
 t þou sendest thyn apostelis to me;
 thu comest *with* thi meyne,
 tte me vnto that blisse
 euer lasteth *with* all gladnesse. 384
 e thou art hider y-come
 t thyn angelis from a-bone.
 ou now what thi wille ys;
 ath longed to the, y-wys." 388

Sone, blessid mote þou be,
 hat þou bicomē man of me; 488
 it is wel sene, I am þee dere,
 ow þi self art comen here.
 hine apostles þou sendist furst to me,
 nd now þou art come *with* þi meyne, 492
 o fecchyn me in to þi myȝt:
 as neuer modre sone so bryȝt.
 li leue sone, now art þou come
 ith þi meyne, here a bone. 496
 o, my sone, þat þi wille is;
 o þee me þinkeþ longe I wis."

n Iesus to Marie sede,
der, *with* ioye y wolþ the lede.
l wymmen the worth best,
eue ne blisse that shal lest.
y am kyng; thu shalt be quene;
rete ioye thu shaþ bene.”

Ihesus

[leaf 81]

392

No gap in MS.]

Modre,” he seide, “come with me;
f alle wymmen best þee be.

500

No gap in MS.]

hou schalt to heuen *and* be made quene;
wel bliþe may þine hert bene.”

e sone, y be-seche the
yng that thu telle me.

Maria

396

l y any deuyþ se,
ny *with* the shaþ be?
y loue them neuer one,
bene noght, so mote y gone.”

400

þone,” sche seide, “I be-seke þee
þing þat þou graunt me,

504

hat I noȝt þe deuel se,

[leaf 72, back]

e none þat euer *with* him be.

loue hem nouȝt; þei arn my fone;
e wolde I neuer sene hem none.”

508

us promises mercy to man for Mary's sake.

der, y sey, drede thu noght;	Iesus
tode it neuer on my thoght,	
hu shalt no deuyll se,	
all go be-fore the;	404
ou shalt no deuyll herene,	
only me <i>and</i> my ferene.	
den <i>and</i> moder, euer thu be well;	
shalt of sorwe wete no dell.	408
the spirettes that meten <i>with</i> the,	
om to the shall they be.	
ler, one thyng y gef to the;	
shalt be in heuene <i>with</i> me.	412
Moder," he seide, "ne drede þee nouȝt;	
e come it neuer in my þouȝt;	
e wille I neuer more þole	
hat any of hem come þee bi fore;	512
e schal þou neuer se-ne here	
ut me <i>and</i> aungeles, þine fere.	
Ioder, a ȝift I schal þee ȝyue,	
hou schalt with me in heuene lyue,	516
nd more schal I ȝeue þee;	
I heuene companye schal <i>serue</i> þee.	
der, for the loue of the,	
all haue mercy and pite	
l man kynde thurgh þi prayere,	
ou ne were, they were for-lore.	416
Modre, for þe loue of þee	
schal haue mercy <i>and</i> pite	520
ff al man kynne for þi <i>praiere</i> ,	
hat were forlorn ȝif þou ne were.	

l of them namelich
the serueth trulich,
that to the done mercy crye
sey, 'help vs, dere ladye,'
'hat synne that thei be,
ler, for the loue of the,

**nota bene de
seruientibus sancte
Marie deuote**

420

[leaf 81, back]

Alle þat doun þee worschipe,
nd seruen þee wel, *and* treuliche
i seke to þee, *and* mercy will crie,
nd seyn, 'help, seynt marie,'
i what peyne so he be,
loder, for þe loue of þee,
schal hem reles sone anon;
or þi loue I schal þus done.

524

528

[leaf 73]

gh a man had lad his lyf
nde, in synne, *and* in strif,
e on his last dawne
e *and* crye, *and* to the be-knawe,
telle it oute vnto the preste,

424

3if any haue ben al his lyue
i hede synne, maide or wyue,
nd he wille, on his last þrowe,
chryue him *and* ben y-knowe,
nd telle it, 3if he haue þe prest,

532

in case, vnto his nexte,
that he may do no more,

nota bene de confessione

428

that he aruwe it sore,
that synne that he be,
ler, for the loue of the,
H of hym haue mercy.
sitthe he shall come me by,

432

Or a noþer man þat is him nest,

536

nd 3if he ne mai do no more,
ut þat him forþinkeþ sore,
i what synne so he be,
loder, for þe loue of þee,
schal on him haue mercy,
nd sithen þei schulle wone þee bi.

540

ry is borne to Heaven.

gh a man had fully wrought
he synne that he had thought,

436

he on his laste day
one other wise may,
e wepe and telle to the,
hat synne that he be,

440

3if a man hadde al one wrouzt
lle þe synnes þat myzt be þouzt,

544

nd he on his last dai,
if he none ere ne mai,
epent him, *and* calle to þee,
i what synne so he be,

548

welȝ y shaȝȝ his bone here,
hi loue, my moder dere.

schal here his *praiere*,
or þi loue, modre dere,
I þat þou wolt bi seke fore,
e it lasse, be it more,
it schal ben aftur þi wille,
or I it wille, *and* þat is skille,
at no þing with seie þee,
ff þat þou wolt biseke me.”

552
[leaf 73, back]

556

tho that thu wolt bidde fore
blesse the tyme þat thu were bore.
lle thyng y-blessid thu be,
hat y bidde, thu *grauntes* me.”

444

Oure ladi knelid him bi forn,
And seide, “þe tyme þat þou were born,
Ouer alle oþer blessed þou be,
or alle þat I wol, þou *grauntest* me.”

560

n Ihesus his hand vp heue,
to his moder his blessing yeue,
called to hym seynt Migheȝȝ,
seid, “kep thu my moder welȝȝ,
she fele no maner fere;
is no thyng to me so dere.”

448

452

“So I auȝt, moder, *and* so I wille;”
e left vp his hond *and* blessed hure stille;
is blessing sche þouȝt good,
nd he hure soule vndrestode.
e callid to him seynt myȝhel,
þhou kepe me þis soule wel,
hou and alle þine fere;
no þinge me so dere.”

564

568

when he had the soule hent,
 she was fro the body went,
 n all the verdoune of heuene
 that soule full aboue; [leaf 82]
 the verdoune to heuene thei come, 456
 gret ioie she was yn nome.
 was made quene of heuene
 blessid hire sone *with* mylde steuene. 460

lle þat mayne þat cam fro heuene,
 hei syngen *with* a myry steuene;
 len myȝt wite bi here songe
 hat moche ioie was hem amonge. 572
 7ith alle þat mayne to heuen he hure nam;
 nd as soone as he þer cam,
 e made hure quene of heuen liȝt;
 lessid be hure sones myȝt! amen! 576

apostles in procession bear the body through Jerusalem.

ow shaȝl ye here how she was
 nome, **nota modum**
 wher she was, *and* wheder be- **assumpcionis anime**
 e. **Marie per ihesum**
 n þe soule fro þe body was nome,
 bede seynt Petre to hym come: 464
 the loue y owe to the
 moder-is body thu kep to me.

¶ Ow schal we here of þe bodi, [leaf 74]
 ¶ Where it bi cam, *and* where it li.
 When þe soule was þere fro hure nomen,
 han bad god Peter to him comen, 580
 nd seide, “Peter, I comaunde þee,
 li moder bodi kepe þou me.
 han *and* alle þine fere,
 is no þinge me so dere; 584

n y first to erthe came,
his body flesh y name. 468

as of this body bore,
-for, Petre, go thu be-fore,
thi bretheren forth *with* the
o Iosaphath that vale, 472
leueth it there sone anone;

When I furst in þis worlde cam,
ff hure bodi flesche I nam;
ff hure bodi, I was born,
etyr, go forþe þou be forn, 588
hou *and* alle þine feres *with* þee,
o Iosephat, to þat vale,
nd leiþ þe bodi in a stone;

drede ye nothyng of *your* foone,
erusalem thurgh that toun
e feire *with* youre procession. 476

aeþ no drede of 3oure fone; 592
oth with faire processoun
o ierusalem þorwe þe toun.
oþ þe belles alle to ryngen,
nd loke þat 3e mury syngen. 596
oke þat 3e haue candeale,
orches boþe faire *and* fele.

e of them shul bere þe bere,
one shal kepe my moder dere.
for no thyng dredeth ye,
for my self wol with yow be.” 480

And Ihesus had thus y-seyd,
the body in bere was leyd,
he gaue them alle his blessing,
styed to heuene, þer he was kyng. 484
And he blessyng he geue til vs,
O blessid lord, swete Iesus.

oure of þe apostles schal bere þe beere;
her-on schal ligge me modre deere. 600
And he no drede of no Iew,
[leaf 74, back]
for I my self schal be with yow.”
Then ihesu hadde him so seide,
and þe bodi was on bere leide, 604
he gaf hem alle his blessinge
and stye to heuen, þer he is kynge.

to them seyde seynt Iohan,
we theder right anone, 488
gray we this processioune,
[leaf 82, back]
go we syngand thurgh þe toun.”

To hym þo seide seynt Ion,
Felawes, go we soone anon, 608
and turne we þis processoun,
and synge we faire þorw þis toun.”

e of the apostelis that ther were,
 holy body fourth dud bere. 492
 nery thei song, *and* that was right;
 y tapers ther-*with* thei light.
 Iewis that were Cristes foone,
 thei herd sone anone. 496

[See the [parallel lines](#) to these, below, on page 130,
 col. 2.]

Jews attack the procession, but are rendered motionless.

asked what was the crye.
 seid it was seynt Marie,
 seynt Petre and his fere
 Marye apone a bere. 500
 as,” *quod* the Iewis, “for shame, **nota contra iudeos**
 rei scape, we bene to blame.
 e we vs swithe anone
 let vs take them euerychone. 504
 body also, take we it,
 cast it in-to a foule pytt.
 we it in a foule sloo,
 moche shame we it do.” 508
 cam thei lepe thedeward;
 be-felȝ them swithe hard.
 of the Iewis that there were,
 ȝ honged ouer the bere. 512
 us Crist wold se no shame, **nota miraculum**
 is moder swetely came.
 one had thei goddes grame;
 rem made bothe holt *and* lame. 516

ȝw repents and receives his strength again.

lle þe Iewes ther was none
euer myghte further gone.
of them that there were,
knowed Petre be-fore. 520

her was a Iew hem amonge,
ff þe apostles harde þe songe. 612
o þe beere he cam lepard,
nd as he wolde lai on his hande;

Iewe gon clepe to Petre sone, **Iudeus**
seid to hym *with* wepand bone:
seid then, “knowest þou noght,
n Crist was to deth broght, [leaf 83]
thou hym folwest, and y þe knew, 524
; y the *pray*, on me thou ruwe,
pray to Crist, if it may be,
he now haue mercy on me.” 528

o þe bere he cleued fast,
nd to Petir he criede atte þe last, 616
nd seide, “Petir, þenkest þou nouȝt,
hen þi lord was to vs brouȝt,
hou him forsoke, *and* I þe knewe?
raie for me,” seide þe Iewe, 620
raie þi lord, ȝif I mai so be,
hat he haue mercy on me.

gap in MS.]

henke,” *quod* þe Iewe, “what I þee dede.
hen þou was *with* vs in þat stede, 624
hen þi lord was ytakyn, [leaf 75]
nd þou haddest him forsakyn,
ure mayne þee knewe þat ilke nyȝt
othe bi speche *and* by syȝt, 628
nd seiden alle, for I stode þee bi,

gap in MS.]

hat þou was of Ihesus companye.
hou seidest *with* wordes *and with* þouȝt,
ʒor soþe þat þou knewe him nouȝt.’ 632
raie þi lord of moche myȝt,
nd his moder þat art so bryȝt,
hat he me help at þis stounde,
or I was neuer so harde ybounde. 636
s I þee helped atte þi nede,
elde me, Petir, now my mede.”

at Petre answerid tho **Petrus**
ie Iewe that was so woo,
thu wolt on hym be-leve,
m thy kynne broght to dethe, 532
that he is goddis sone,
sithens man for vs be come,
that Marie hym bare hire be best,
ne Maide *and* right honest, 536
clene vnwemmed *with* outen man,

eynt Petir answerde þo
o þe Iewe þat was so wo, 640
ȝif þou woldest leue on him,
hat on þe rode dide þi kyn,
hat he is soþefast godes sone,
od *and* man for him bi come, 644
hat marie bare in hure lyf,
lene maide *and* clene wyf,
lene widewe *with* oute wem,

shal alle bidde for þe than,
iesu Crist that is a-boue,
his owne moder loue, 540
ef the myght for to go,
brynge the oute of this woo.”

or þee I wol praie þen, 648
iesu cryst vs lizteþ aboue, [leaf 75, back]
hat he, for his moder loue,
o ȝeue þee myȝt for to go,
nd bringe þee oute of þi wo.” 652

Iewe that honged apone the bere, **nota conuersionem Iudei**
verd then as ye may here, 544
seid, “y be-leue, vnder that fourme,
hesu Crist, Maries sone,
Iewis peyned on the rode,
-outen gilt, for oure gode, 548
for vs he lost his lyf,
Marie bare, maide *and* wif.
-seche that he me brynge
his peyne, thurgh *your* biddynge.” 552

he Iewe þat henge apoun þe bere,
nswerde anone as ȝe mai here,
leue wel, *and* better I schal done,
n ihesu crist, godes sone, 656
hat Iewes diden on þe rode,
nd for vs he schedde his swete blode,
hat marie bare in hure lyf,
lene maiden *and* clene wyf; 660
e brynge me, I praie it him,
ute of þe wo þat I am Inne.”

er christens the Jew and ordains him priest.

t vnderstode the Iewis bone.	
was holpe, and that anone;	
et <i>and</i> hand he yeaue hym myght,	
alle his lymes for to right.	[leaf 83, back]
an to stonde vp anone	556
re the Iewis euerychone.	
at was bothe halt <i>and</i> lame	
an to preche in Cristes name,	560
seid, “worship we euerychone	
soche a miracle hath done.”	
s soone as he hadde seide þis bede,	
e was al hole in þat stede:	664
ff fote, of honde, he hadde myȝt;	
lle his lymes bi come ful ryȝt.	
e stode vp swiþe anone	
i-fore þe Iewes euerechone,	668
hat suche a myracle haþ done,	
iesu crist, godes <u>sons</u> ,	
f a wilde hounde haþ made a lomb,	
o preche his worde in eche a lond.	672

seynt Petre, that holi mane,
Iewe Crystened after anone; 564
taught hym his by-leue;
new he was to god y-yeue;
ordeyned hym to prest anone,
bade hym that he shuld gone, 568
preche ouerall, of goddis sone,
every lond where he be-come.

seynt Petir, þat holi man, [leaf 76]
he Iew he crystened anone,
he tauȝt him al his bi leue;
he wist he was to godes biheue; 676
he ordeyned him to prest anone,
and bad him soone for to gone
and prechen al of godes sone,
preche a lond where he come. 680

palme þat Petre had in hond,
toke it hym, thurgh goddes sond, 572
bade hym goddes word to telle
of Iewis that were so felle.

that palm þat Petir helde in his honde,
he toke it him þorw godes sonde,
and bad him godes wordes telle
among þe Iewes þat were so felle. 684

he spake the fourthe day,
turned into goddes fay
housant, *and* somdel mo,
gh the word þat he spake tho.
he apostolis that þer were,
holy body fourth thei bere

580

o he spak þe furst day,
hat he turned to godes lay
wenty þousand *and* sommedel mo,
horw wordes þat he spak þo.

688

[See the [parallel lines](#) to these, on p. 127, col. 1, at
foot, and p. 128, col. 1, at top.]

oure of þe apostles þat were þere,
hat swete bodi forþe þei bere,
he Iewes þat were godes fone,
hei herde þe cri sone anone,
nd þei asked what was þat crie,
nd men seiden it was mari,
hat seynt Petir *and* his fere
are þare apoun a beere.

692

696

[leaf 76, back]

Alas," seide þei, "for schame,
scape þei vs, we schulle haue blame.
rme we vs alle sone anone,
nd take we hem alle þer þei gone.
hat bodi þat þei bere, nyme we it,
nd cast we it in a foule pit,
r brenne we it, *and* do it somme where,
r cast we it in a foule sere."

700

704

[*in it*]

hei comen leþand þiderwarde,
 nd þat hem fel swiþe harde.
 iesu wolde nouȝt þat schame;
 e made hem boþe blynde *and* lame. 708
 ff hem alle, was þer none
 hat myȝt a fote on erþe gone.
 ere mouþes were to here nek went;
 hei þouȝt alle þat þei were schent. 712
 oþe here feet *and* here handes
 /here bounde *with* stronge bandes:
 ul sore bounden þei were,
 or þei ne myȝt go ne here. 716
 han comen here frendes hem to,
 nd seide, “alas, whi leie ȝe so,
 i ȝoure armour so fast yclizt,
 hat beþ so faire *and* so bryȝt? 720
 oure speres, ȝour schildes, helpeþ ȝow nouȝt;
 [leaf 77]
 alleþ vs what ȝe haue þouȝt.”
 hei answerd nouȝt þat leyen þere,
 or þei ne myȝt hem noȝt here, 724
 ut somme of hem þat myȝt speke
 eide, “alas! who schal vs wreke?”
 nd euer þei cryede many a stounde,
 Alas, how harde we lie here ybounde!” 728
 ff fyue þousand was þer none
 hat myȝt of þat stede gone.
 han seide some þat stode hem bi,
 hat hadde ysene þat ferli, 732
 hat ‘seynt Petir *and* his fere
 are oure ladi on a beere,
 Thise men wolde hure haue nomen,”
 nd þus þei ben ouer comen. 736
 he ladi þei wolde haue doun schame;
 her fore þei hauen godes grame.’
 he folke hem bad mercy to crie
 o ihesu cryst of here folie, 740
 nd leue þat he is godes sone,
 nd siben crvsten men bi come.

Virgin Mary's body is laid in the tomb.

We hope þat ihesu schal sone tyme
elyuere 3ow of 3oure pyne.” 744
hei criede “mercy” with good wille, [leaf 77, back]
omme lowde *and* somme stille,
nd ihesu, þorw his mochil my3t,
ere feet *and* handes gan to ry3t. 748
horw myracle þat þer was down,
i-come cristene many on,
nd leuede on cryst and criede mercy,
hat none oþer god was so my3ty. 752

ie vale of Iosephas
y here, there here wille was,
gap in MS. 582

leid the body in a stone,
he apostles went forþe on here way,
o Iosephat, to þat Valay.
hen þe apostles comen were,
el softe þei setten doun þe beere. 756
ith gret deuocioun, euerychone,
hei leide þe bodi in a stone,

-in was body neuer none.
des and sibbe that þer were,
ere wepte many a tere.
n she was in the ston done,
e thei turned euerychone.
he apostelis then were sory
he deth of oure lady;
ther a voice cam them among,
ne lasted not full long,
bade them alle for to gone
re thei had for to done.
apostelis went hem ayene
o the Burgh of Ierusalem;
as thei sate atte mete,
many thynges thei gon speke.
hei were out of that place,

Sepultura sancte Marie

[leaf 84]

588

592

596

s, <i>with</i> his holy grace,	resussitacio corporis
on to take vp anone	Marie
noder body of the stone.	
ym self dud þerynne,	
neuer had y-done synne.	604
solde not in no manere	
the body lafte there.	
at body he dud a leme,	
hter then the sonne beme,	608
made here quene of heuene blisse;	
at place she was and ys.	
nd bileft alle in þat stede,	
s oure ladi hadde hem bede,	760
nd woke þer al þat nyȝt	
with many torches <i>and</i> candle lyȝt.	
n þe morwe when it was dai,	
hei loked where þat bodi lai.	764
hei ouerturned þat ilke stone;	
odi þei founde þer none;	
ut þei sawe in þat stede þana	
iand as it were a mana.	768
hat manna bitokned hure clene lyf,	[leaf 78]
hat sche was modre, maide, <i>and</i> wyf.	
ho wist þe apostles, I wis,	
he bodi was in to paradis,	772
lso godes wille was.	
hei seide, “Deo gracias.”	

ry lets fall her girdle to Thomas.

at Thomas of ynde thederward com,
swithe as he myght gone,
wold haue bene at here berying,
e myght haue come be tyme.
e loked hym be syde,
aw then a bright thyng glide
iat stede as he come,
oure lady to heuene was nome.

Thomas yndie

612

[leaf 84, back]

616

eynt Thomas of ynde þiderward cam
lso blyue as he myȝt gan,
nd wolde haue ben at hure fyne,
if he myȝt haue come bi tyme.
s he loked him bi side,
e sawe a briztnesse bi him glide;
i þat stede þer he come,
ure ladi to heuene was nome.

776

780

neled adoune *and* seid, “lady,
on me thu haue mercy. 620

; quene of heuene bright,
hi mochel holy myght,
l me a token this ilke day,
ie thyng þat y bryng may 624
y felawes, ther y ham fynde,
y was toward þi berynge:
wol not leue þat y was there;
graunte me, lady, my prayere.” 628

e knelede down *and* seide, “ladi,
ff me, I praie 3ow, haue mercy. 784
adi, quene of heuene lyzt,
or þine swete mychel myzt,
ende me token þis ilke day,
/hat þing þat I say may 788
o myn felawis, þer I hem fynde,
hat I was toward þi buriyng.
hei wil nouzt leue þat I were;
ow graunt me, ladi, my praier.” 792

ute here gurdel a mydelȝ sought, **nota de zona sancte**
she hire self had y-wroght, **Marie**
luer *and* gold wonde in palle;
une to hym she lete it falle. 632
oke that gurdeȝ in his hond,
thanked here of here sond.

-bowte hure myddel a seynt sche souzt, [leaf 78, back]
hat sche hure self hadde wrouzt,
ff silk *and* gold wunden in pal;
oun to thomas sche lete it fal. 796
e toke þer þe gurdel in his honde,
nd þanked hure of hure sonde.

th he went of that stede;	
ard the toune he hym yede.	636
elaus then he dud seche	
e myght hem ouer mete.	
temple of dominus	
hem founde alle in ane hous.	640
ful feire he them grette;	
ayenward thei hym chidde.	
orþe he went of þat stede;	
oward þe toune he him dede,	800
is felawis for to seke on his fete,	
if he hem ouȝt myȝt mete.	
tte þe temple dominus	
e fonde hem alle in an hous.	804
hen he hem sawe, he gret hem,	
nd þei answerde alle hym,	
nd seiden, “thomas of ynde,	
uer art þou bi-hynde.	808

<i>apostles find the tomb empty.</i>

ere has thu so long y-bene?
haue beried *our* heuene quene.

644

lakkest euer at euery nede;
helpest neuer at gode dede.”
e me thenketh þat y nas here;
y ne myght come no nere.
ssid be the quene of blys,
ie place there she ys,
welȝ y wote in my thought,
e ye here layde is she nought.”

[leaf 85]

648

652

Whare hast þou so longe bene?
/e haue buried heuene quene.
hou helpest noȝt at no good dede;
hou failest euer at most nede.”
Sore me forþinkeþ þat I ne was here,
ut I ne myȝt come no nere.
lessed be sche, quene of blis,
i þat stede þer now sche is!
or wel I wote bi my þouȝt,
her ȝe hure left, is sche nouȝt.”

812

816

[leaf 79]

i seid to hym swithe anone,
ie Petre and seynt Iohan,
w woldest not be-leue, Thomas,
oure lord y-nayled was. 656

· thu leuys amysse in mynde,
tales y-now thu dos fynde.
· i-leuest in god right noght;
ie tales ne kepe we noght.” 660

han seide to him sone anone,
othe Petir *and* seynt Ione, 820
· thou ne woldest, leue thomas,
hat oure lord fram deth ras.
· ome, þou art mys bileuyd,
nd tales ynow þou canst fynde, 824
hou leuest nouȝt on godes craft;
wylk felawis wille we nauȝt.”

stille,” he seid, “brother Iohan,
· chide ye me so, one *and* one?
henketh ye can litel good,

**nota de verbis sancti
Thome apostoli.**

· 3e stille,” he saide, “broþer Iohan.
· /hi chyde ȝe me euerychone? 828
am ful wery man for-gone;
· Ie ne list answeri neuer one.
ut I thanke oure lord god,

· / here saw bothe flesh *and* blood, 664
· oure lady to heuene wend;
· is the token that she me send.”

· sawe hure *with* flesche *and* blood, 832
her oure ladi to heuene went:
ere is þe token þat sche me sent.”

n seid seynt Petre, “that is soth;
ilke webbe here self woof. 668

here y dud it on the bere;
der me the thenketh þat it is here.
we swithe in-to the vale,
nowe the sothe of this tale 672
he hath vs now y-sayde,
t was in the tombe y-laide.”

uath seynt Petir, “þat is sothe.
his seynt sche hure self wof. 836

we dide it on hure in þe beere;
wonder me þinkeþ þat it is here.
o we swiþe in to þe vale,
o wite þe sothe of þis tale 840
hat he haþ vs here yseide,
[leaf 79, back]
or it was in þe tumbe ylaide.”

us appears to the apostles and blesses them.

e of þat that place then they yede, **nota de sepulcro Marie**
the tumba they vndede. **vacuo.**

ying ther-on there thei founde 676
a floure atte grounde. [leaf 85, back]

ute of þe place swiþe þei zede,
nd þe tumbe þei vndede; 844
o þing þer Inne þei ne founde,
ut a manere floure at þe grounde.

t flour manna was cleped in the tumba was steked.	Manna 680
· went all a-boute þe tumbre kneled on the bare grounde, seid, “Ihesu, goddis sone, hat thu sendes, it is wel-come. hteftull is the heuene kyng; that we know bi thi sayng. nan may know his priuyte, er his swete dignite.”	684 688
hat floure was ‘manna’ yclepid; it was in þe tumbre ystekyd. hei zeden alle abowte þe tumbre nd knelede on þe bare grounde, nd seiden, “ihesu, godes sone, l þi sonde be welcome. lyztful art þou, heuene kynge; hat mai we wite bi þis tokenynge; or no man mai wite ne se /hat is þi derne priuete.”	848 852 856
onge þe apostolis alle a light, kyng that is in heuene bright, blessid ham alle in fere nge the angelis þat there were, seid, “my pees be <i>with</i> yow nowthe, sid ye be of goddis mowthe.”	692
ryst of heuene, þat is so bryzt, monge þe apostles sone he lyzt, nd gret hem alle yfere, /ith aungeles fele þat <i>with</i> him were, nd seide, “now pees be <i>with</i> vs! lessed be 3e,” seide Ihesus.	860

ysty cloude cam after thane,
ouersprad them euerychone,
bare them alle þer they were,
o the stede that they were ere.

**nota miraculum
apostolorum.**

696

lyzt cloude come after þan,
nd ouer sprad hem euery man,
nd bar hem alle þat ben þere,
to here stedes þer þei preched ere;
nd fonden alle þat folke ȝete,
ittand stille atte here fete.
nd þei bigonne for to preche,
nd þe folke for to teche.

864

[leaf 80]

868

he wonder then hem thought
thei were theder y-brought,
hei ne wiste whi ne whane;
thei seid euerychone
rightfull is heuene kyng,
us lord ouer aȝ thyng.

700

704

loche wondre hem þo þouȝt
ow þei weren þidre brouȝt.
liztful art þou, heuene kyng,
iesu Crist, in alle þinge!
he apostles kneled in þat stede;
o ihesu þei bede a bede.
iesu herde here *praiere*,
or þei were him leue *and* dere.

872

876

clusion and invocation.

his tale y haue tolde *with* mouthe,
 wordes that bene ful couthe.
 cleped the Assumpcioun;
 s gef vs his benesoun. 708
 crist, for his myght,
 pray to hym *with* herte light, [leaf 86]
with his holy grace,
 vs bothe myght *and* space, 712
 ie workes for to worche,
 gh the lore of holy church,
 we may to heue[ne] wende,
 is *with* oute begynnyng *and* ende. 716
 Amen!

Explicit Sextus liber *sancte* Marie.

NE biseche þee for alle þat hereþ þis vie
 Off oure ladi seynt marie, 880
 That Ihesu schelde hem fram *grame*,
 fro dedly synne *and* fro schame.

e mys auenture schal bi falle þat man	
hat þis a vie here can.	884
e no womman þat ilke dai	
hat of oure ladi hereþ þis lai,	
ien ne schal of hure childe,	
or oure ladi hure schal be mylde.	888
e none mys auenture schal be-falle	[leaf 80, back]
i felde, in strete, ne in halle,	
i stede þer þis vie is rad,	
or oure ladi hure sone it bad.	892
nd þe archibisshop seynt Edmound	
aþ graunted xl. daies to pardoun	
o alle þat þis vie wol here	
r with good wille wol lere.	896
iesu, for þi modre loue,	
hat woneþ in heuene vs aboue,	
raunt vs, 3if þi wille is,	
he mochil Ioye of paradis!	900
. praier þer-to seie alle we,	
. Pater noster pur charite,	
nd an Aue marie þer-to,	
hat Ihesus vs graunt so. Amen!	904
Celi regina sit scriptori medicina.	

NOTES.

ASSUMPTION.

Links generally lead to the next lower multiple of 4, corresponding to visible line numbers. In this section, missing commas in note references have been silently supplied.

[4, C.](#) *lescoun*, reading. Lat. *lectiones*.

[7, 8, C.](#) *blessi* : *herkni*. Cf. *blessyth* : *herkenythe* F, *blis* : *herkenis* D.

[15, 16, C.](#) *also* : *mo*. H and F have *also* : *two*.

[19-22, Add.](#) Not in H or D, or F.

[21-2, C.](#) *red* : *ded*. The scribe has neglected to cross his *d* to make *ð*. D 21-2 has *beth* : *deth*.

[17-44, C.](#) Omitted in F.

[29-30, C.](#) *weop* : *fet*. *let* : *fet* in H and D.

[33-4, C.](#) *fless* : *was*. H and D have *blode* : *mode*.

[41-2, C.](#) Not in H, or F, or D.

[51-56, C.](#) In D (49-54) all is told in a command to John. F (25-32) follows D rather than C in rimes.

[59-60, C.](#) *were* : *forbere*. F (35-5) has *saumpull* : *tempull*. D (57-8) has *exemple* : *temple*.

[61-2, C.](#) *þore* : *more*. Cf. F (37-8) *more* : *ore*, D (59-60) *more* : *lore*.

[63-4, C.](#) Not in F or D.

[69-70.](#) *fedde* : *bedde*. Cf. F (43-4), D (65-6): *Therefore þey loued hur well all* (D is substantially, not exactly, the same as F): *And sche hyt seruyd wele with all* F.

The rimes are at 65-66, C, and 71-72, A.

[70-1, C.](#) *slep* : *kep*. Cf. F (45-6) and D (67-8):

*Besy sche hur made þat swete may
hur sone to serue nyght and day. F.*

and H 67-8:

*besy shee was day and nyght
for to serue god almyght.*

[75-88, C.](#) Not in F.

[80-86, C.](#) Cf. D (76-80):

*al þat sche wolde he dide sone
Crist hem sette boþe lliche
In to þe blisse of heuene riche
But whan mane þat mayden hende
Schulde out of þis world wende.*

Cf. also H (75-78):

*Crist ham blessid bothe y liche
that sone hem brought to heuen riche.
Tho Marie that mayden hende
shuld out of this world wende,
Crist here sent an Angel fro heuen.*

[97-8, C.](#) *quen* : *ben*. Cf. F (57-8):

*That hye flowre þat groweþ on a tree
Mary modyr he sent to the.*

also D (91-2):

*þe lilye flour þat grew on the
Mayden & moder wel the be.*

also H (89-90):

*lady þe flour that come of the
mayde and moder y-heried þu be.*

[103-4, C.](#) *þinge* : *bringe*. Cf. *brynge* : *tithynge*. F (61-2), D (97-8), H (95-6).

[107-8, C.](#) *beo* : *þe*. Cf. *come* : *wone*. F (65-6), D (101-2), H (99-100).

[110, C.](#) *meigne*. Cf. F 68, D 104, H 102, *plente*.

[121-2, Add.](#) F, D, and H have these verses and an additional couplet: *lady swete y say to the That here schall þow no lengur be*. F (75-6.) D and H have substantially the same.

[116, C.](#) *hire by*. F, D, and H have *belamy* in agreement with [Add.](#)

[121-2, C.](#) *kenesmen* : *beon*. Cf. H 118: *and of my frendes that y kene*.

[127-8, C.](#) *come* : *aboue*. Cf. H (123-4), *come* : *doune*.

[131-2, C.](#) *lefdy* : *belamy*. Cf. H (127-8):

*Then seid Marie to þat angel fre.
What is thi name tel thu me.*

[139-146, C.](#) Cf. F (101-4):

*The aungell to heuene wande
Whan he had seyde hys errande*

*Mary toke that palme in honde
and thoght moche of þat sonde.*

D (135-8) has substantially the same. H (135-8) has, *yede : seide, hond : sond.*

[151-2, C.](#) *idon : on.* Cf. F (109-10) *ydo : to*, D (143-4) *ido : to*.

[162, C.](#) *vnriȝt.* Cf. F (154): *boþe be dayes & be nyght; do.* D (154), H (154).

[164, C.](#) *dred.* H, F, and D have *qued : for I dowte me of þe quede*, F 156.

[177-180, C.](#) *wo : fo, so : to.* F (137-40) has *bone : sone, also : to.* D (171-4) has the same rimes. H (171-4) has *bone : sone, also : tho.*

[190, C.](#) *idriȝt.* F (148), D (172), and H (182) have *plight.*

[193-4, C.](#) *ded : ned.* F (151-2), D (185-6) have *pyne : tyme.* H does not have these verses.

[199-200, C.](#) Cf. F (157-60):

*And sayde lady how may thys be
yf thow wynde sory we bee.
lady thou haste seruyd vs so
allas how schall we the for goo.*

D (191-4) has *be : we, so : go.* H (189-92) has:

*and seid lady how may this be
Yf þu wendist how shal we do
lady whi dos thu serue vs so
how shal we then lady do.*

[213-14, C.](#) *to : so.* Cf. F (173-4):

*ye schall see a wondur dreche
whan my sone wole me fecche.*

D (207-8):

*schal no sorwe me drecche
for my sone wile me fecche.*

H (203-6):

*ther shal me no sorow dery
for my sone wol me wery.
my body shal haue no woo
for Ihesus sake to whom y go.*

[219-20, C.](#) *kyng : geng.* Cf. F (179-80):

*he þat y bare my leue sone
schall sende me aungellys soon*

D (213-14):

*he þat I bar my leue sone
wile þat good folk to me come.*

H (209-10):

*he þat y bare my lef sone
he wol sende other come.*

[226, C.](#) Two lines are omitted here. Cf. F (187-8).

*Seynt John wyste ther of noght.
what tydyng þat the angell broȝt.*

With F agree D (221-2) and H (217-18).

[231-4, C.](#) *chere : dere, blis : is.* Cf. F (193-96):

*Than thou haddyst ony schame
where þorow Ihc myȝt me blame.
and y schall neuyr blythe bee
Tyll y wott what eyleyth the.*

D (227-30) agrees with F. H (223-26) has the rimes, *shame : blame, the : be.*

[247, H.](#) *glad.* F (210) has:

Thou haste me bothe fedd and ladd.

C (244) has:

boþe þou feddist me & clad.

[251-262, H.](#) Not in D.

[261-2, H.](#) *sone : come.* F 223-4 has *abouen : comen.*

[274, H.](#) *foly.* F (236) and D (258) have *velane.*

[275, H.](#) *oure allere dright.* F (237) has: *that ys so bryght.* D (199) has: *king ful of Right.*

[277-80, H.](#) D has only two lines (261-2):

*Seynt John answerid tho
Swete ladi what schal I do.*

[289-92, H.](#) *deth : meth, fro : woo.* Not in D. F (251-4) has *dyght : ryght, froo : twoo.*

[298, H.](#) At this point there follow in D (277-80):

*For soþe þouh I go before
Schalt þou no þing ben for lore.
I schal bidde my leue sone,
þat þou may to vs come.*

[301-2, H.](#) *beforn : com.* D (283-4) has *manere : there.*

[303 ff., H.](#) From this point F and D follow Add. (309-340).

[320, Add.](#) Here D (299-300) has two lines not in Add. or F:

*Telle þou me my leue fere
Whi þou makist so drere chere*

Lines printed before note to 320.

[322, Add.](#) *mon.* F (240): *Why I wepe anone.*

[332, Add.](#) F (301-2) and D (313-14) have two extra lines here:

*So helpe me Ihesus
y not how y come to thys howse.*

[355-6, Add.](#) *wham : cam.* F (305-6) *whom : come.* D 317-18 *nouht : brouht.*

[347 ff., Add.](#) At this point there is a transposition in Add. D and F agree in the main. After 346 A there follow in F (317-337):

*Come now forthe now with me
all before hur knele wee
And seyde lady well thou be
Thy sone vs hath sent to the
To serue the & be the by
For now we be come to the lady
anodur thyng seynt John
To the apostolys oon be oon
loke whan ye come ther yn
ye schall see many of hur kynne
That sory semblant they make
and sore wepe for hur sake
But make we alle feyre chere
For hur frendys that ben there
Than went þe apostelys oon lasse þen xii
Euyn before oure lady hur selfe
Into the chaumbur þat sche was ynne
and many moo of hur kynne
On kneys they sett them ylke oon
As them badd seynt John
They seyde lady heuene queue etc.*

320
325
330
335

[357-8, Add.](#) *alle : falle.* Cf. 331-2 above; also D 343-4.

[360, Add.](#) *bi and bi.* Cf. F 348: *And welcomyd þe apostelys tendurly.* D 358: *& welcomid hem hendeli.*

[363-6, Add.](#) *þere : were, þouȝt : ybroȝt.* F (351-4) has *forme : come, noght : broght.* 363-4, Add. are wanting in D. For 365 Add., D has: *þei seyde : ladi doute þow nouht.*

[369, Add.](#) *come.* D 365 has: *Than seyde oure ladi as was hire wone.*

[309-10, H.](#) *he : be.* F (359-60) has:

*I am hys modur þat he me cutt
Full fayne I am þat he me fett.*

D (367-8) has:

*I am his modur þat is full of myght
ful fayne he haþ ȝow to me dight.*

[375-8, Add.](#) Not in F or D.

[315-16, H.](#) *name : shame.* Not in D.

[326, H.](#) *laue.* F (376) has *scathe*. D (382) *gabbe*.

[329, H.](#) *badde here bone.* F (383) has *speke theron*.

[327-30, H.](#) Not in D.

[331-2, H.](#) *stede : bede.* F (381-2) and D (383-4) have *hur by : mary*.

[339-40, H.](#) Not in D.

[341, H.](#) *went to aray.* F (391) *dud hur ley*. D (391) *3ede and ley*.

[344, H.](#) *here body sikerly.* F (344) *hur os hys lady*. D (394) *wip al hire myght oure ladi*.

[409 ff., Add.](#) F and D agree with H here. The address of Jesus to the angels is peculiar to Add.

[365-6, H.](#) *heuene : seuene.* F (415-16) *meyne : plente*.

[348, H.](#) Some leaves in D at this point are lost. D resumes at 477 H.

[373-4, H.](#) *trone : sone.* F (423-4) *blys : with owt mys*.

[379-80, H.](#) *dere : here.* F (429-30) *moder : hider*.

[382, H.](#) *now thu comest with thi meyne.* F (432) *and thy aungels with mery glee*.

[384, H.](#) *with all gladnesse.* F (434) *with owt mys*.

[394, H.](#) *thu shall bene.* F (444) *schalt pere seene*.

[398, H.](#) *or any with the shall be.* F (448) *The syght of hym pou do fro mee*.

[399-400, H.](#) *one : gone.* F (499-50) agrees in thought with Add. *foone : oone*.

[403-4, H.](#) *se : the.* F (453-4) agrees with Add. *thole : before*.

[405-6, H.](#) Not in F.

[409-10, H.](#) *the : be.* F (457-8):

*all the goostys that wrathedd mee
Blynde schall they all bee.*

[411-12, H.](#) *the : me.* F (459-60) *yeue : leue*.

[416, H.](#) *forlore.* F (464): *That were forlorne nere thow were*. Cf. Add. (467-70).

[419-22, H.](#) F. transposes order, *mary : ynnne, crye : thee*.

[529-30, Add.](#) *anon : done.* F (471-2):

*I schall them helpe sone
Swythe modur for py louen.*

[424, H.](#) *and in strif.* F (474) has: *In deedly synne man or wyfe*.

[425-6, H.](#) *dawe : be-knawe.* F (475-6), *throwe : a knowe*.

[433-4, H.](#) *mercy : me by.* F (483-4):

*y schall haue of them pete
and sone they schall sauyd bee.*

[444-6, H.](#) *bore, be : me.* F (494-98):

*Schall they neuer be for lore
All hyt schall be at thy wyllle*

Cf. Add. 552-6:

*So hyt schall be & þat ys skylle,
Modur y wyll no thyng geyn sey the
What thyng ryghtfull þow aske of me.*

[451-2, H.](#) *fere* : *dere*. F (507-8):

*Thou and all thy felaschypp
That no wyght do hyt no dyspyte.*

[452, H.](#) *hent*. F (509): *to heuene sente*.

[455-60, H.](#) Cf. F (511-18):

*all the aungels of heuen
songyn wyth a mery stevyn
hyt was well seene in ther songe
That moche yoye was þem among
With all þe aungels of heuen sche wan
and as sone as sche thedur came
Sche was made heuene quene
Soche a sone blessyd muste bene.*

[461-2, H.](#) *nome* : *be-come*. F (519-20):

*Now ye schall here a ferly case
how the body kepte was.*

[583-4, Add.](#) Not in F.

[473, H.](#) *and leueth it*. F 531: *Do delue a pytt sone anoone*.

[485-6, H.](#) *vs* : *Iesus*. Not in F or D.

[488, H.](#) *theder right anone*. F 544, *frendys ylkesson*.

[491-2, H.](#) Not in D.

[504, H.](#) *euerychone*. D (420), *as þei gon*.

[505-6, H.](#) Not in D.

[507-8, H.](#) *it* : *pytt*. D (421-2):

*& caste we hem in a slouh
& do we hem schame I nouh.*

[509-10, H.](#) Not in D.

[511-12, H.](#) Not in D.

[514-15, H.](#) Not in F or D.

[516, H.](#) *holt and lame*. D (426), *blynd & lame*.

[519, H.](#) *there were*. F (573), *hyng on þe bere*.

[520, H.](#) *before*. D (430), *ere*.

[623-638, Add.](#) Peculiar to Add. Not in H, or F, or D.

[535-6, H.](#) *be best : honest.* F (589-90), D (443-4), *that here lythe : and clene wyfe.*

[537-8, H.](#) Not in D.

[539-40, H.](#) *aboue : loue.*

F (593): *ys owre be houe.*

D (445-6):

*Ihesu þat was of hire born
& ellis we had alle ben lorn.*

[544, H.](#) *as ye may here.* D (450), *as anoþer it were.*

[545-6, H.](#) *fourme : sone.* D (451-2):

*I beleue at þe forme come
þat ihesu crist is goddis sone*

[551-2, H.](#) Not in D.

[552, H.](#) *thurgh your biddyng.* F (606), *þat y am yn.*

[554, H.](#) *anone.* D (458), *swipe sone.*

[561-2, H.](#) Not in D.

[562, H.](#) Here follows in F (617-18):

*Of an hounde he hath made hys knyzt
To preche of hym day and nyght.*

[565-6, H.](#) *by-leue, y-yeue.* F (621-2):

*he wyste he was to goddys be hove
he taght hym all goddys beleue.*

[569-72, H.](#) D (471-4):

*In eueri lond wher he becam
ouer al to preche in goddis name
a good palme of þe lond
he betauht him in his hond.*

[571-2, H.](#) Not in F.

[574, H.](#) *that were so felle.* D (476), *for to spelle.*

[576, H.](#) *fay.* F (630), D (478), *lay.*

[577-8, H.](#) Not in D.

[691 ff., Add.](#) The order here is peculiar to Add. F and D agree with H.

[581-2, H.](#) *Iosephas : was.* F (635-6):

*In to the vale of Joseph
Os ihesu cryste them badd hath.*

D (481-2):

*to þe vale of Josaphath þei lad
as ihesu crist him self bad.*

[587-94, H.](#) Not in D.

[587-8, H.](#) *done* : *euerychone*. F (641-2):

*Whan þey had beryd þat body
home þey goon sekurlye.*

[592, H.](#) *long*. F (646), *and a full mery songe*.

[598, H.](#) Here follow in F (653-4):

*as soone as they were at þe borde
They began goddys worde.*

[603-4, H.](#) Not in F or D.

[607-8, H.](#) *leme* : *beme*. F (661-2):

*he broght the sowle in to þe body a3en
That was bryghter þen þe sunne beme.*

D (499-500) has the same as F transposed, *beme* : *a3en*...

[609-10, H.](#) *blisse* : *ys*. F (663-4) *has ywys* : *ys*. D (501-2), *quen Iwis* : *heuene blis*.

[611-16, H.](#) F (665-72):

*Thedurward come seynt Thomas
as soone as he myght passe
he was not at hur forthfare
Therefore he was in moche care
he wolde fayne haue be there,
yf that goddys wyll hyt were.
as he thedur toke the way
a bryghtnes hym thoght he say.*

D (503-10) agrees in thought and rime with F, save in verses 509-10, which are:

*& as he thedirward went
a bryghtnes he saw in þe firmamente.*

[625-632, H.](#) Cf. F 681-90:

*To my felows some tokenyng
That y was toward thyn endyng
lady graunte me my boone
Ellys y not what y schall done
They will not leue for nothyng
That y was at thy beryng
abowte hur myddyll was a gyrdyll
That hur selffe louydd mekyll
Of sylke ymade wele wythall
adowne to Thomas sche let hyt falle.*

D (519-24) has:

*to my felawis sum tokenyng
of thi bodili vpsteyeng.
and certis þer aboute hire myddil
sche had vpon a wel good girdil
al of silk well wrouht wiþ alle
& doun to Thomas sche lete it falle.*

[636, H.](#) yede. D (528) has dede.

[639-642, H.](#) F (697-702) has:

*In the tempull of Jerusalem
at mete he fonde them
Whan he þem sye he grett þem anoon
and they hym chydd euerychon
and sayde all to Thomas of ynde
Euyr more thow art be hynde.*

D (531-6) agrees in thought with F, and has, *ierusalem : hem, Inouh : wouh, Inde : behynde.*

[645-6, H.](#) Not in D.

[647-50, H.](#) F (707-712):

*Sore me for thynkyth quod Thomas
That y was not there sche beryed was
as y myght not there come
That wyste wele goddys sone
I blessyd be that quene so mylde
That ys in heuyn wyth hur chylde.*

D (539-544) agrees in matter with F, and has, *Thomas : was, come : sone, quen : schen.*

[657-60, H.](#) F (719-24) has:

*Or thou sye hys bloody syde
and hys wounde depe and wyde
Of false be leue thou haste ybee
Thou art so we may well see
Thou art of an euyll beleue
we kepe no soche maner fere.*

D (551-6) agrees with F, save in v. 555: *þou art of a lither manere.*

[662, H.](#) F (726), *wole ye all vpon me goone.* D (558), *I wile answer the a non.*

Here follow in F (727-8):

*Be iħc þat was in bedlem borne
me lyste to answeere of yon neuer oon.*

[664, H.](#) F (730) has, *os me thynkyth in my mode.*

Then follow in F (731-2):

*I sey hyt yow be my hode
In the place there y stode.*

D (559-62) has, *gode : mode, hode : blode*.

[667-8, H](#). Cf. D (565-8):

*Quod petir this is no les
In þis seynt sche beryed wes
Me þinkiþ wunder þat it is here
for it was beried with bere.*

F (735-38) agrees with H in thought, but inverts the last two lines, the last of which reads:
For hyt was beryed with hur in fere.

[675, H](#). yede. Cf. D (573): *Ferth þei went of þat stede*.

[679-82, H](#). Not in D. D ends thus (576 ff.):

*But a flour in þe grounde
þei seyde ihesu goddis sone
þi sonde to vs is welcome
Jhesu crist ful of myght
among þe apostlis þer a light
& þe aungelis þat wiþ him were
Grette þe apostelis alle in fere.
& þan oure lord ihesu crist
hem ouersprad wiþ a myst
& brouhte hem alle in a stounde
In selcouth place fro þe tounge
þei com alle to hire contray
but non wiste be what way.
Beseke we now þat swete may
þat sche prey for vs nyght & day
& bere oure arnde to hire sone
þat we may to him come.
In to heuene þer he is king
& zeue vs alle good ending. amen.*

[686, H](#), sayng. F (754) reads: *and þat þou wolde sende vs good tydyng*.

[687-8, H](#). Not in F.

[689-90, H](#). F (755-6):

*cryste of heuyn full ryght
among þe apostelys he sente a lyght.*

[695 ff., H](#). F ends thus (761-790):

*Soone aftur to heuyn wente cryste
Vpon the apostelys spreed a myste
and brozt them all fro þat grounde
In to sondry placys in a stounde
Come they all in to ther cuntrey
wyste noon how thedur come they.
moche wondur þan þem thoght
how they were thedur broght.*

*cryste we thanke in euery place
That hath sent vs thys grace.
here endyth thys lesson
That ys clepydd the assumpcion
Of seynt mary meke and mylde
That ys in heuyn wyth hur chylde.
Beseche we all that swete may
To pray for vs nyght and day
and pray for vs to hur sone
That we may to heuyn come
To haue þat blys þere he ys kyng
and gyf vs all goode endynge. amen.*

[General Introduction and Table of Contents](#) (*separate file*)

[King Horn](#) (*separate file*)

[Floris and Blancheflur](#) (*separate file*)

[Introduction to The Assumption of Our Lady](#)

[The Assumption of Our Lady](#)

[Notes to The Assumption of Our Lady](#)

[Glossary](#) (*separate file*)

This text includes characters that require UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding:

ȝ ȝ (yogh)
h̅ (h with stroke)
ll̅ (l with slash, see below)
ā ē ī ō ū ŷ æ (vowels with macron or “long” mark)
ē ē and ō ō, each representing open/closed pairs
ēō (eo with shared macron) used as a stand-in for eō

If any of these characters do not display properly—in particular, if the diacritic does not appear directly above the letter—or if the apostrophes and quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that the browser’s “character set” or “file encoding” is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser’s default font.

Combinations such as ŷ (y with breve and macron) or ō (o with under-dot and macron) may not display as intended in all browsers. These forms are rare.

Except for yogh, h-stroke and paired ll̅, unusual letters appear only in the editorial material (introduction, notes and glossary). For this e-text, the printed book’s circumflex accents have been shown as macrons—that is, æ instead of â and similar—except for “true” circumflexes in modern French citations and the word “rôle”. The character shown here as ēō was printed as “eo” joined by a single circumflex. In the Trentham MS. of Floriz and Blauncheflur, and a few times in the Assumption, some letters were printed with “end flourishes” (see Introduction under “Manuscripts”). They are printed as g⁺, k⁺, n⁺ and similar. In the same passages, the double letter “ll” printed with a joining wavy line is shown as ll̅.

Footnotes have been numbered continuously through the Introduction, and separately for each of the three original texts. For mechanical reasons, some footnotes in the primary text will seem to be out of order. Line numbering is by multiples of 4.

Typographical errors are shown in the text with mouse-hover popups. Errors are listed again at the end of each file. Within correction popups, italics representing editorial expansions are shown with {braces}.

See the [end of the e-text](#) for details about differences between the e-text and the printed book.

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BY J. RAWSON LUMBY,
AND NOW RE-EDITED FROM THE MANUSCRIPTS,
WITH INTRODUCTION, NOTES, AND GLOSSARY,
BY
GEORGE H. McKNIGHT.

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PREFACE.

THE triple labour involved in editing three independent works in one volume will, it is hoped, serve as an excuse for some of the shortcomings of the present publication. Under the circumstances it has been impossible to make the work as definitive as might have been the case with a single text. For example, while I have been able to print the three existing manuscript texts of King Horn, of the other two poems, the textual material is not nearly so complete.

The texts, it is hoped, are accurately printed. The credit for this is due, in large measure, to Dr. Furnivall,—who has read with the MSS. the proofs of all the British Museum texts,—and to the proof-readers at Oxford and Cambridge. The notes to King Horn represent a good deal of labour, and may, I trust, prove useful. The glossary, though not so complete as that in Wissmann's excellent critical edition of King Horn, is intended to fit the volume, and to supply explanation of words and uses of words not intelligible to ordinary readers of Early English Texts.

It is my pleasant duty to acknowledge assistance from various quarters. I am indebted to the libraries of the British Museum and Cambridge University, and the Bodleian library at Oxford for the use of manuscripts; also to the Duke of Sutherland for permission to copy the text of Floris and Blancheflur from the manuscript in his private library; also to the Cornell University library for conveniences placed at my disposal in the preparation of this volume. I must also acknowledge timely words of advice from Prof. J. M. Hart, notes on Layamon from Dr. B. S. Monroe, and assistance in proof-reading by Prof. W. Strunk, jr. But above all I must acknowledge the less apparent work of Dr. Furnivall in preparing the texts for press, a work the amount of which one who has not edited for the E.E.T.S. is not likely to realize.

G. H. M. K.

Ithaca, N.Y., July 8, 1901.

GLOSSARY.

ABBREVIATIONS.

Add. Brit. Mus. Add. MS. of Ass.

Ass. Assumption of our Lady.

C. Cambridge Univ. MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2. of King Horn and Assumption.

Cott. Cottonian MS. of Floriz and Bl.

F. & B. Floriz and Blancheflur.

H. Harleian MSS. of King Horn and of Assumption.

KH. King Horn.

L. Laud Misc. MS. 108 of King Horn.

OE. Old English.

OF. Old French.

T. Trentham MS. of Floriz and Bl.

V. Cottonian MS. of Floriz and Bl.

Yogh ȝ and thorn þ are alphabetized as “g” and “t”. I and J are alphabetized together. U/V as a vowel is alphabetized before V as a consonant.

a b c d e f g h i l m
n o p q r s t u v w y

[abegge](#), abeie, *see* beien.

abide, *see* bide.

acupement, *sb.* accusation, F. & B. 664, 670, etc., C. OF. *acouplement*.

Adam, Ass. 429, 461, 465 Add.

Admiral, *sb.* emir, F. & B. 164, 170 C.; amirel, amirayl, F. & B. 175, 179 Cott.; Admirad, amyraud, Admyrold, KH. 95.

adrenche, *see* drenche.

adriže, *see* dreže.

adrinke, *see* drinke.

adun, *adv.* down, KH. 458 C, 485 C; adune, adowne, adoune, KH. 1608 C L H; adun, adoun, KH. 1610.

age, *sb.* be of —, KH. 1420, F. & B. 37 T, of age. Cf. KH. 1420 Note.

agenes, *see* žen.

agesse, *see* gesse.

agrise, *see* grise.

Ailbrus, Aylbrus, *see* Aþelbrus.

Ailmar, Aylmar, Almair, Eylmer, King of Westernesse, KH. 169, 233, 359, 526, 538, 549, 729, 733, 747, 753, 1331, 1514, 1614, etc. OE. *Aepelmær*.

al, *adv.* all, quite, KH. 38 L H.

alle veile, everywhere, KH. 262 L.

Allof, father of Horn, KH. 4, 33, 73 H.

also, *conj.* as, KH. 32, 1102 etc. OE. *eal swā*.

angussus, *adj.* full of anguish, F. & B. 366 C. OF. *angoissous*.

anhitte, *see* hitten.

apližt, *adv.* on one's faith; aplyžt, F. & B. 88 T; aplyst, F. & B. 200 Cott.; apližt, F. & B. 649 C. OE. *on + pliht*.

aquelde, *see* quelle.

aquite, *see* quite.

aražte, *see* areche.

areche, *v.* explain, recount; *infin.*, KH. 1308 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* aražte, F. & B. 812 C. OE. *arecccean*.

arecche, *see* recche.

areche ?, *see* reche.

aredde, *infin.* rid, deliver, F. & B. 689 C. OE. *ahreddan*.

Arnoldin, Arnoldyn, KH. 1561, 1613, 1618.

aroum, *adv.* apart; aroom), F. & B. 824 T; aroum, Cott. Cf. Gen. & Ex. 4000, 4021. OE. *on rum*, apart.

arre, *see* er.

arson, *sb.* saddle bow; *n. s.*, F. & B. 369 T. OF. *arçon*.

aslawe, *see* slon.

asoke, *see* sake.

assoine, *infin.* prevent, F. & B. 423 T.

at, *prep.* from. KH. 619 etc. OE. *æt*.

atel, *adj.* dreadful, cruel, F. & B. 113 Cott. OE. *atol*, *eatol*.

Aþelbrus, Aylbrous, Ailbrus, etc., KH. 239, 257, 282, 309, 351, 385, 481, 495, 501, 1621, 1627.

Aþulf, Haþulf, ayol, KH. 27, 29, 300, 309, 311, 316, 537, etc. OE. *Æthelwulf*, *Aþulf*, or *Eadwulf*.
aton, *adj.* (at + one) agreed, KH. 997 C H.
at wite, v. find fault with, twit; *infin.* F. & B. 490 C.; 3 s. *pret.* atwist, F. & B. 490 C. OE. *ætwiþan*.
awreke, v. avenge; *infin.*, F. & B. 731 C.; 3 s. *pret.* awrek, KH. 952 H. OE. *wrecan*.
axede, askede, 3 s. *pret.* asked, KH. 43; askede H, axede C, acsede L. OE. *āscian*, *āxian*.
aye, *see* eie.

Babylon, *dat.* F. & B. 147 T; Babyloyn, 190 T, 191 T; -loigne, 119 C.; babyloyne, 147 T, 191 T;
Babyloyne, 153 T; Babilloine, 172 C.; Babiloyne, 181 Cott.; Babilloigne, 120, 129 C.; Babilloine,
129 C, etc. French version has *Babiloine*, 406, 505, etc.

bale, *sb.* bale, calamity, F. & B. 821 C. OE. *bealu*.

barbecan, *sb.* outer work of a fortress, F. & B. 207 C. OF. *barbecane*.

barm, *sb.* lap, bosom; in bearme, KH. 752. OE. *bearm*.

barnage, *sb.* baronage, F. & B. 639 C. OF. *baronage*.

bede, *sb.* prayer, Ass. 89 C, 95 Add., 332 H, 486 Add. etc. OE. *bēd*.

bede, v. present, offer; *infin.*, KH. 492; 2 *pl. pres.*, KH. 977 C L. OE. *bēodan*.

beien, v. buy; 3 s. *pret.* boʒte, KH. 1442 C. abeie, v. atone for, expiate; *infin.* abeie C; abeye L, KH.
116; abugge C H; abygge L 1155; 3 s. *pret.* aboute L; abohte H, KH. 1493. OE. *bycgan*.

belamy, *sb.* good friend, F. & B. 633 C. OF. *bel ami*.

belde, *see* bolde.

belete, *see* leten.

bemeneþ, *see* bimene.

bene, *sb.* petition, KH. 590 C L. OE. *bēn*.

beode, v. offer; *infin.*, F. & B. 369 C.; 3 s. *pret.* bed, F. & B. 733 C. OE. *bēodan*.

Berild, byrild, beryld, Byryld, KH. 816, 817, 825, 837, 845, 877, 878.

berwe, v. protect; *infin.*, KH. 980 L. OE. *beorgan*.

beyne, *num.* both, KH. 949 H. OE. *bēgen*.

bi, by, *prep.* by, along, in, KH. 5, 20, etc. OE. *be*.

bicolwede, *see* colwen.

bidde, v. pray, beg; *infin.* bidde, bydde, KH. 1263; 1 s. *pres.* bidde, Ass. 135 C, 143 Add.; bid, 170 C;
3 s. *pres.* biddeþ, F. & B. 588 C.; byddeþ, F. & B. 1081 T; 3 s. *pret.* bad, bed, KH. 85, 1272; bad,
badde, Ass. 90 C, 95 Add., 329, C; *pp.* ibede, F. & B. 579 C.; ybede, 859 T. OE. *biddan*.

bide, abide, v. (1) wait, (2) expect, (3) wait for, KH. 910, 1099, 1564. OE. *ābīdan*.

bidene, by dene, *adv.* at once, F. & B. 60 T, Ass. 347 Add.

bihelde, biholde, v. look on, behold, F. & B. 102 Cott., KH 639. OE. *bihealdan*.

biheue, *adj.* profitable, Ass. 676 Add. OE. *behēfe*.

bihoten, v. promise; 3 s. *pret.* bihet, KH. 500. OE. *hātan*.

biknewe, *pp.*, *see* knowe.

bileue, *see* leue.

biliue, bliue, *adv.* quickly, KH. 350 L, 502 C, 771 C, 1042 C; blyue, Ass. 776 Add. OE. *bī lifē*.

bimene, v. bemoan, lament; *infin.*, F. & B. 72 Cott.; 3 s. *pres.* bemeneþ, F. & B. 957 T. OE. *bimēnan*.

binom, 3 s. *pret.* took away from, F. & B. 112 Cott.; *pp.* binomen, benome, Ass. 271 A, 273 C. OE. *biniman*.

birine, *see* reyne.

bisemen, v. befit, beseem; 3 s. *pres.* bisemeþ C, byseme L, bysemeþ H, KH. 518. Icel. *sæma*.

bispac, *see* speke.

biswike, *see* swike.

bite, *infin.* bite, partake of as food, KH. 1211 L, H. OE. *bītan*.

biteche, 1 s. *pres.* entrust, KH. 613 L, H. OE. *tācan*.

bitide, *see* tide.

biþinne, *prep.* within, KH. 1122 C, 1387 C.

bitwexe, *prep.* between, KH. 454 C. OE. *betweox*, *betwux*.

biwente, *see* wende.

biwreien, *see* wreien.

Blancheflour, Blauncheflur, etc., *nom.* 18 T, 46 T, 22 V, 34 V; *dat.* 20 T, 22 T, 36 T, 58 T, 114 T, 122 T, 34, 46, 48, 64, 96, 102, 112 etc., C. Fr. *Blanceflors*, *Blanceflor*.

blenche, *infin.* overturn, KH. 1525 C L; ouerblenche, 1525 H. OE. *blencan*.

blesse, *infin.* bless, KH. 17 L H. OE. *bletsian*.

blessing, *sb.* blessing, KH. 170 C. OE. *bletsung*.

blethelyche, *adv.* blithely. OE. *blīðelīce*.

ble[y]ne, *sb.* whale, KH. 727 L. OF. *baleine*.

bliþe, blyþe, *adj.* blithe, KH. 1, 141, etc.

blynne, *see* linnen.

bode, *dat. sing.* message, Ass. 146 C; *accus.* bodes, Ass. 126 Add. OE. *bod*.

bold, bald, baud, *adj.* bold; *sing.* KH. 96; *pl.* belde, bolde, KH. 640. OE. *beald*.

bone, *sb.* prayer, boon, Ass. 522 H, 27 C, 329 C, 441 C. ON. *bōn*.

boneyres, *adj.* devoted, good looking, debonair, KH. 968 L. OF. *bonaire*.

bord, *sb.* (ship) board; *dat. sing.* borde, KH. 119, 123.

bord, *sb.* table, F. & B. 103 C, KH. 269, 1605.

bote, *sb.* remedy, redress, F. & B. 821 C. OE. *bōt*.

bote, KH. 1364 L; v. baddest, or scribal error.

bote, *see* bute.

braide, breide, 3 s. *pret.* draw, brandish, F. & B. 289 T, 1014 T. OE. *brægd*.

breche, *dat. sing.* breeches, F. & B. 258 C. OE. *brēc*.

breme, *adj.* valiant, spirited, famous, F. & B. 792 C, 1071 T. OE. *brēme*.

brenie, brunie, *sb.* coat of mail, KH. 627, 765, 897, 1310. OE. *byrne*.

bruken, v. use, enjoy; *imper.* 3 *sing.* bruc C, brouke L, brouc H, KH. 220. OE. *brūcan*.

brun, *sb.* beer (?); of a brun C, of þe broune L, H, KH. 1202.

brymme, *sb.* edge, shore, KH. 204 C.

buzge, v. bow, writhe, twist, let fall (Mätzner); *infin.* buze C, unbowe H, KH. 458. OE. *būgan*.

bulmeþ, 3 *sing. pres.* boils, F. & B. 305 C. Probable error for welmeþ. Cf. *zelle*.

bur, *sb.* bower, women's quarters, KH. 285. OE. *būr*.
 burdon, *sb.* staff, KH. 1141. OF. *burdoun*.
 burgeis, *sb.* burgess, citizen, F. & B. 115 C, 155 T, etc. Bugays, F. & B. 207 T. OF. *burgeis*.
 burȝ, bureȝ, boruh, *sb.* castle, F. & B. 176, 181, 182 C.; boruh, F. & B. 190 Cott. OE. *burg*, *burh*.
 burles, *sb.* tomb, sepulchre, F. & B. 63 Cott. OE. *byrgels*.
 bute, bote, but, *conj.* but, unless, KH. 26 L, 69, 207 C, 37 L, H, etc. OE. *būtan*, except, unless.
 buxom, *adj.* flexible, obedient, Ass. 410 H. OE. *būhsum*.
 byȝete, *sb.* acquisition, F. & B. 202 T, and Cott. OE. *begietan*.
 bygone, *pp.* surrounded, F. & B. 371 T. OE. *bigān*.
 byne, (?), F. & B. 1010 T.

cacche, v. catch; *infin.* KH. 1307, 1465 H; 3 *pl. pret.* kaute, KH. 944 L.; *infin.* bikeche, KH. 328 L. OF. *cachier*.

can, v. can, know; 3 *s. subj. pres.* cunne; conne, KH. 602 C, H; *infin.* konne, KH. 598 L; 3 *pl. pret.* couȝ, couth, F. & B. 33 T, 157 T. OE. *cann*.

care, *sb.* care, sorrow, KH. 279. OE. *cearu*.

catel, *sb.* property, capital, F. & B. 150 T, 988 T. OF. *catel*.

kele, *infin.* cool, F. & B. 995 T. OE. *cēlan*.

kelwe, *see* colmie.

ken, kenne, kunne, *sb.* race, people, KH. 156, 190, 1358. OE. *cynn*.

kende, cunde, *sb.* birth, kind, Nature, KH. 451, 1479 C, L; F. & B. 677 C, 960 T. OE. *cynd*.

kene, *adj.* keen, brave, KH. 42, 97, 178, 539, 1208, etc. OE. *cēn*.

kepe, v. (1) keep, (2) guard, protect, KH. 800, 1288 C H, Ass. 49 Add., 52 Add., 271 Add. OE. *cēpan*.

kep, *sb.* heed, care, Ass. 72 C, 78 Add.

kerue, v. carve, KH. 249. OE. *ceorfan*.

Cesar, F. & B. 181 T. French version has *Cesar*, v. 494.

chaere, *sb.* throne (?), KH. 1353. OF. *chaere*.

ycharged, *pp.* loaded, F. & B. 343 T. OF. *charger*.

chelde, kolde, kelde, *infin.* become cold, KH. 1230. OE. *cealdian*.

chepinge, *sb.* market, fair, F. & B. 186, 188 Cott. OE. *cēapung*.

chere, *sb.* mien, facial expression, KH. 1143, 1165 L. OF. *chere*.

child, *sb.* (1) child, (2) youth, KH. 10, 13, 27, 99, etc. OE. *cild*.

Clariss, Clarice, Clariz, Clarys, F. & B. 895 T, 901 T, 905 T, 915 T, 931 T, etc.; C. 479, 485, 529, etc.

French has Claris, 2125, 2131, 2115, 2339, etc.

cleche, *infin.* reach (with nails), KH. 1027 H; *pp.* yclizt, Ass. 719 Add.

clef, scribal blunder (?), *c* + *lef*, KH. 161 L.

clenchen, *infin.* make to clink, KH. 1596.

clene, *adj.* pure, F. & B. 297 C. OE. *clāne*.

clepe, clepen, clepede, clupede, cleped, icluped, etc., v. call, KH. 239, 840 L; F. & B. 137 T, 287 T, 137 T, 837 T; 607 C, 140 C, etc.; Ass. 707 H, 847 Add., 73 C, 180 C, etc. OE. *cleopian*.

clergie, *sb.* learned knowledge, F. & B. Cf. Hausknecht's note.

cleppe, clippe, cluppe, klippt, klepte, iclupt, etc., *v.* embrace, KH. 1297 H, 1450; F. & B. 549 C, 594 C, 614 C, 806 T, 512 C, etc. OE. *clyppan*.

yclizt, *see* cleche.

knaue, *sb.* boy, servant, KH. 1012 C, 1095 C; F. & B. 166 T. OE. *cnafa*.

knowe, *v.* (1) know, (2) recognize, KH. 1294; (3) beon biknowe of = acknowledge (cf. Mätzner, KH. 983 Note; Lay. II. 355, III. 51; Alisaunder 724, etc.); *pp.* was iknowe C, was by cnowe L, was biknowe H, KH. 1059 = confessed. OE. *cnāwan*, *becnāwan*.

knyhty, *v.* knight, KH. 488 H, 547, 682.

colmie, kelwe, *adj.* sooty, KH. 1162, *see* colwen.

colwen, bicolwede, *v.* smear, blacken, KH. 1144, 1162.

con, *v.* *auxil.* = did, KH. 817 H, 825 H, 938 H, 1470 H, 1549 H, 1632 H; 3 *s.* *pluperf.* coupe, 1634 H, *see* gan.

icore, *pp.* chosen, F. & B. 268 C. OE. *gecoren*.

creyde, 3 *s.* *pret.* cried, KH. 1362 L. OF. *crier*.

crois, *sb.* cross, KH. 1405 C H; croy3, KH. 1398 H. OF. *crois*.

crowch, *sb.* cross, KH. 1398 L, 1405 L. Lat. *crucem*.

crude, *infin.* press, crowd, KH 1385. OE. *crūdan*.

crune, *sb.* skull, head, KH. 1607. ON. *kruna*.

culuart, *adj.* false, faithless, F. & B. 210, 329 C. OF. *culvert*.

cupe, *sb.* basket, F. & B. 435, 438, 452, 471 C, etc. OE. *cȳpe*, Lat. *cūpa*.

cuppe, cupe, coupe, *sb.* cup, KH. 250, 479; coupe, F. & B. 163 T, 181 T, 208 T, etc. OE. *cuppa*.

Cutberd, Cuberd, Cubert, KH. 876, 833, 851 C, 882, 895, 912, 938, 948, 965 L, 981. OE. *Cūþbeorht*.

cupe, 1 *s.* *pret.* knew, Ass. 39 C; 3 *pl.* *pret.* couthe, Ass. 290 C.

cupe, cowpe, coupe, 3 *s.* *pret. subj.* could, KH. 371.

[dales](#), *pl.* valleys, dales, KH. 168. OE. *dæl*.

dar, *v.* dare, 3 *s.* *pres.* durþ, KH. 408 H; 3 *s.* *pret.* dorte, dorste, F. & B. 167 C, 204 T; 3 *s.* *pret. subj.* þorte, F. & B. 216 C, KH. 408 C. OE. *dearr*, *dorste*.

Daris, Dares, Dayre, daye, Darys, doyres, Darie, F. & B. 561, 570, 599, 737, 816. French has *Daires*, *nom.* 1470, 1531, 1853, etc. *Dairon*, *accus.* 1931.

dawes, *pl.* days, KH. 999 L; *nom. sing.* day. OE. *pl. dagas*.

ded, deed, *sb.* death, KH. 345 L.; *dat. sing.* deede, F. & B. 46 T.

deie, deye, de3e, *infin.*, KH. 115. ON. *deyja*.

del, *sb.* part, portion, deal, Ass. 212 C, 218 A, 261 A; dell, 225 C. OE. *dæl*.

ideld, *p. pl.* separated, F. & B. 598 C. OE. *dælan*.

demure, demere, *sb.* delay, F. & B. 591 C. and Cott. OF. *demeurer*.

denie, *v.* din, rattle, KH. 628. OE. *dynian*.

dent, dunt, *sb.* stroke, blow, KH. 164 C, 607, 647, 913, 920, 933, 946. OE. *dynt*.

deol, dole, *sb.* grief, KH. 1128, 1129. OF. *doel*, *duel*.

dere, *adj.* dear, beloved, KH. 161 L, etc. OE. *dēore*.

derie, dere, *infin.* injure, harm, KH. 840, F. & B. 378 T, Ass. 162 C. OE. *derian*.
 derne, *adj.* secret, hidden, Ass. 856 Add. OE. *dierne*.
 deuisse, 2 s. *pres. subj.* devise, KH. 253 L, H. OF. *deviser*.
 direwurpe, *adj.* precious, F. & B. 289 C. OE. *deōrwyrðe*.
 don, dede, dude, v. (1) cause to, KH. 148, 284, 1069, Ass. 462 Add., 474 Add., etc. (2) put, KH. 360, 745, 1332 C; F. & B. 46 T, 200 T, 69 C.; Ass. 61 Add., etc. (3) *intens.* do, did, KH. 1003 (?), F. & B. 16 C, Ass. 17 Add., 80 C, etc. (cf. dede let wed, F. & B. 1065 T). OE. *dōn*, *dyde*.
 dreden, 3 *pl. pret.* fear, dread, KH. 130; dradde C, adred L; *pp.* adred H; 1 *sing. pres.* of drede. C L; adrede H, KH. 307. OE. *drædan*.
 dreze, adrize, *infin.* suffer, endure, KH. 1115. OE. *drēogan*.
 dreme, *sb.* sound, F. & B. 37 C, 397 T. OE. *drēam*.
 drenche, v. drown; *infin.* adrenche, KH. 111 C H, 1526; to drenche, KH. 1045 L; *pp.* adrent, KH. 1053 C; drenched, KH. 1054 L. OE. *drencan*.
 dright, drihte, *sb.* lord, Ass. 275 C, KH. 1406 C. OE. *drihten*.
 idriht, *pp.* troubled, Ass. 190 C. OE. *gedreccan*.
 drinke, v. drink; *infin.* adrinke, adrynke, drown, KH. 111 L, 1045 C H. OE. *drincan*.
 druerie, drury, *sb.* love, F. & B. 382 C, 820 T. OF. *druerie*.
 dun, doun, down, *sb.* dune, hill, KH. 168. OE. *dūn*.
 dunt, *see* dent.
 dureþ, 3 *sing. pres.* extendeth, F. & B. 173 C. OF. *durer*.
 durþ, *see* dar.
 dute, v. fear, be afraid; *infin.* duti, F. & B. 4 C, 192 Cott.; 1 *sing. pres.* dute, doute, KH. 362; 2 *pl. imper.* douzt, dute, F. & B. 817 T, 531 C. OF. *douter*.
 dy3cte, *infin.* arrange, KH. 904 L; *pp.* idiht, F. & B. 23, 260 C. OE. *dihtan*.

[ede](#), *see* zede.

Edmound, seynt, Ass. 893 Add.

eidel, *sb.* anything, F. & B. 813 C. OE. *ænig dæl*.

eie, aye, *sb.* fear, F. & B. 791 T. OE. *ege*.

eke, *adv.* also, KH. 17, 99, 1474, etc. OE. *ēac*.

enchesone, *sb.* occasion, F. & B. 78 T. OF. *enchaisoun*.

engynne, *sb.* device, scheme, artifice, F. & B. 313 T; engin, Ass. 755, 759 C. OF. *engin*.

Enneas, F. & B. 177 T. French version *Eneas*, 489.

entermeten, *infin.* meddle with, F. & B. 167 C. OF. *entremetre*.

er, arre, her, or, *conj.* before, ere, KH. 136 H, 567 C; arre, 567 L.

Ermenild, *see* Reynild, KH. 979 H. Cf. Eormenhild, daughter of Eorcenbriht, king of Kent, Leechdoms iii, index.

erndinge, *sb.* result of undertaking. OE. *ærendung*.

erne, v. run; *infin.* vrne, erne, KH. 936; 3 s. *pret.* arnde C, rende L, ernde H, KH. 1314; *pp.* iorne C, hy 3ouren L, yorne H, KH. 1228. OE. *yrnan*.

escheker, *sb.* chess board, F. & B. 344 C, etc. OF. *eschekier*.

Estnesse, KH. 1018 L H, 1295 L.

eþe, yþe, *adv.* easily, KH. 61, 891. OE. *ēaðe*.

epelikeste, *superl.* most precious, F. & B. 274 C. OE. *æðel*.

Eue, Ass. 461 Add.

euene, eueneliche, *adv.* equally, symmetrically, KH. 100.

euerich, *adj.* every, KH. 230. OE. *ǣfrǣlc*.

eure ȝut, ever yet, KH. 842.

[fable](#), *sb.* story, KH. 762 L.

fader, *sb.* father; *gen. sing.* fader, C H; faderes L, KH. 116; fader, 1622 H.

fairhede, fayrhede, feyrhade, *sb.* fairness, KH. 89.

falle, *v.* fall; bifalle, bualle, happen, occur, become; *infin.*, KH. 105, 186; *pp.* 450 C, L.

fawe, fain, F. & B. 986 T. OE. *fægn*.

fay, *sb.* faith, Ass. 576 C. OF. *fei*.

fayne, *adj.* glad, F. & B. 97 T. OE. *fægn*.

fayne, *adv.* gladly, F. & B. 286 T.

fecche, fette, *infin.* fetch, Ass. 129 C, 137 Add.; 3 *pl. pret.* fett, Ass. 456 C. OE. *fetian*.

feere, *see* fere.

feire, *sb.* market, fair, F. & B. 179 C. OF. *feire*.

felaurende, *sb.* company, KH. 180 H. ON. *fēlagi*.

yfelde, 3 *pl. pret.* feel, KH. 58. OE. *gefēlan*.

fele, vele, *adj.* many, KH. 60, 1425 C, 1464 H. OE. *fela*.

felle, *v.* fell, slay; *infin.*, KH. 66; 3 *pl. pret.* felde, KH. 58.

felle, *sb.* skin, KH. 1015 L. OE. *fell*.

felle, *adj. pl.* fierce, cruel, fell, KH. 1581 L, Ass. 574 C, 684 Add. OE. *fel*.

felun, *adj.* savage, cruel, F. & B. 210, 329 C. OF. *felon*, *felun*.

fende, feond, *sb.* fiend, devil; *dat. sing.* KH. 1480 L, Ass. 164 C. OE. *fēond*.

feo, *dat. sing.* money, expense, F. & B. 25 C. OE. *feo(h)*.

fer, *adj.* unharmed, sound, KH. 161 C, H; Ass. 67 C, 72 A. OE. *fēre*, Icel. *færr*.

veracle, *sb.* company, KH. 180 C. OE. *ferræden*.

ferde, *sb.* host, army; *dat. sing.*, Ass. 116 Add. OE. *ferd*, *fyrð*.

ferde, 3 *s. pret.* went, KH. 663, 805, 1010. uerden, 3 *pl. pret.* behaved, F. & B. 24 C. OE. *fēran*.

fere, ifere, *sb.* companion, comrade; *sing. accus.* fere, Ass. 78 C, 84 Add., 78 Add.; ifere 46 C; *dat. sing.* ifere C, fere L, yfere H, KH. 1209; *plur.* feren, KH. 21, 53 H, 88, 108, 235 L, etc.; ifere C, yfere L, KH. 235; ferene, Ass. 406 C. OE. *fēra*, *gefēra*.

fere, feere, *sb.* companionship, F. & B. 5, 81, 280 T, etc. OE. *gefēr*.

ferli, ferlich, *sb.* miracle, wonder, F. & B. 456 C, Ass. 732 Add. OE. *fǣrlīc*.

ferli, ferly, *adj.* (1) fearful, (2) unexpected, sudden, (3) rare, wonderful, Ass. 327, Add. 347 C.

fett, *see* fecche.

Fikenhild, fykenyld, fykenild, fokenild, Fykenhild, Fekenyld, etc., KH. 28, 30, 731, 1336, 1493, 1509, 1513, 1516, 1543, 1554, 1567, 1589, 1613; *gen.* 1554, 1607.
 fine, *infin.* end, KH. 274. OF. *finer*.
 fipeleres, fypelers, *sb.* fiddler; *nom. pl.* KH. 1592. OE. *fiðelere*.
 fle, *infin.* flay, KH. 1468 C. OE. *flēan*.
 fleme, *sb.* fugitive, exile, KH. 1363 C, L. OE. *flēma*.
 fleoten, flete, *v.* flow, float, swim; *infin.* flete, L; fleoten H, KH. 165; flette 811 L; 3 s. *pret.* flet, KH. 203 H; 3 *pl. pret.* fletten, 811 H; *pp.* bi flette, KH. 1504 C. OE. *flēotan*.
 flitte, flecte, flette, 2 s. *subj. pres.* leave, depart, KH. 757. ON. *flytta*.
 Floris, Florys, Floreys, Florens, Floyres, Floriȝ, Florice, Floures, Florisse, etc., F. & B. 40 T, 44 T, 49 T, 56 T, 65 T, etc. French version has *Floires*, *Floire*.
 flotterede, 3 *sing. pret.* was tossed in the waves, KH. 135 H.
 flur, flour, *sb.* flower, KH. 15, F. & B. 780 T, 482 C, etc.
 flyten, *infin.* combat, KH. 903 H. OE. *flītan*.
 fode, foode, *sb.* food, child, KH. 1436, F. & B. 149 T.
 foȝel, foul, *sb.* bird, KH. 139, 1506; F. & B. 277 Cambr., etc. OE. *fugol*.
 fole, *sb.* foal, horse, KH. 623. OE. *fōla*.
 follyche, KH. 98 L. (?). OE. *fūllīce*.
 fond, *pret. sing.* found, KH. 39. OE. *findan*.
 fonde, *v.* try, experience, prove; *infin.*, KH. 163 C H, 782, 1634 H; F. & B. 2 T, 55 T, 158, 399 C, etc.; 3 *sing. pret.* fonde, fondede, KH. 1634 C. OE. *fandian*.
 fonge, underfonge, *v.* receive, take; *infin.* fonge, KH. 345 C L, 163 L, 769; F. & B. 300, 395 C. etc.; vnderfonge, KH. 607 H, 255, 976 C, etc. OE. *fōn*.
 forbere, *infin.* do without, dispense with, Ass. 60 C, 66 Add. OE. *forberan*.
 forbod, forbode, *acc. sing.* forbiddal, prohibition, KH. 82.
 fordo, *pp.* destroyed, F. & B. 308 C. OE. *fordōn*.
 foreward, forewart, *sb.* agreement, pledge, KH. 482, 586 H; F. & B. 426 C. OE. *foreweard*.
 forȝolde, *pp.* paid for, F. & B. 388 T. OE. *forgieldan*.
 forgone, *pp.* distressed, Ass. 829 Add.
 forhele, 2 *sing. imper.* conceal, Ass. 192 Add. OE. *forhelan*.
 forleie, forlauȝt, *pp.* commit adultery, F. & B. 301 Cambr., 618 T. OE. *forlicgan*.
 forlesen, *see* lesen.
 forliued, *pp.* mislived, F. & B. 99 Cott.
 forloren, *see* lesen.
 fort (for + to), until, F. & B. 66, 122 C.; fort he = for to þe.
 forþinkeȝ, 3 *sing. pres., reflex.*, repent, Ass. 538 Add., 813 Add. ON. *fyrirþykkja*.
 forto, forte, *conj.* in order to, KH. 25.
 forto, *prep.* to, for to, KH. 166 L.
 fremde, fremede, *sb.* foreigner, stranger, KH. 68. OE. *fremede*.
 fremde, *adj.* strange, foreign, Ass. 181 C. OE. *fremede*, *fremde*.

frume, atte, first, F. & B. 135, 179, 345 C. OE. *fruma*.
 ful, foul, foule, *adj.* foul, dirty, KH. 1143. OE. *fūl*.
 fulde, 3 *sing. pret.* filled, KH. 1202. OE. *fyllan*.
 funde, fonde, founde, *v.* go, KH. 109, 143, 780, 888, 942, 1372. OE. *fundian*.
 fundlyng, fundyng, etc., *sb.* foundling, KH. 234 C H, 242 C, 450.
 furst, *sb.* space of time, respite, F. & B. 638 C. OE. *fyrst*.
 furthestmost, foremost, F. & B. 1059 T.
 fus, *adj.* ready, F. & B. 368 C. OE. *fūs*.
 fyȝen, fissen, *infin.* fish, KH. 1216. OE. *fiscian*.

[gabbe](#), joking, F. & B. 785 T.

gabbest, 2 *sing. pres.* (1) ridicule, (2) deceive, (3) chatter, F. & B. 235 T. ON. *gabba*.
 gabbing, *nom. sing.*, (1) deceit, (2) babble, F. & B. 236, T and Cott.
 galeie, *sb.* galley, KH. 199, 1084 C, 1086 H. OF. *galee*.
 game, *sb.* joy, pleasure, KH. 211. OE. *gamen, gomen*.
 gan, *v. auxil.* did; gan, gon, KH. 257, 268, 312 C, 318 C, etc.; *plur.* gunne, gonne, gunnen, gonnen, KH. 55, 65, 193, 675, 1090, etc.; *imper.* gyn, KH. 329 H, 396 H; bigyn, KH. 329 L; bigan, began, did, KH. 127, 146 L, 203 C, 1271 H; con, did, KH. 372 H, 817 H, 825 H, 938 H, 1049 H, 1470 H, 1632 H, etc.; *pluperf.* couȝe, KH. 1634 H.
 ȝare, *adv.* quickly, KH. 497 C, 960 C, 1453 L. OE. *gearu*.
 garysone, garisone, *sb.* treasure, F. & B. 206, T and Cott. OE. *gersum, gersuma*. OF. *garison*. Cf. *gersume*.
 ȝede, yede, eode, *v. pret.* went; 3 *sing.* ȝede C, eode H, KH. 621, 622; yede Ass. 636 H; 3 *pl.* yede L, ede H, KH. 117; ȝede C, yede L, eoden H, KH. 167, 621; yede Ass. 634 H, ȝede Ass. 843 Add., ȝeden Ass. 849 Add., F. & B. 444 C.
 gegges, *sb.* frivolous women (?), F. & B. 439 C.
 ȝelde, yelde, *v.* (1) yield, (2) pay for; *infin.*, KH. 514 C H, Ass. 249 C, 255 Add.; *pp.* iȝolde C, yolde L, ȝolde H, KH. 681; iȝolde C, hyȝolde L, yȝolde H, KH. 490; F. & B. 161 T, 809 C; 2 *sing. subj.* or *imper.* ȝeld, pay for, KH. 1066. OE. *gieldan*.
 ȝelle = welle (?), F. & B. 621 T.
 ȝem, 2 *sing. imper.* protect, care for. OE. *gīeman*.
 ȝeme, *sb.* care, F. & B. 38 C.
 ȝen, against; aȝeyn KH. 60, aȝenes C, ayenes L, aȝeyn H, KH. 82. OE. *gegn, gēn*.
 ȝend, gonde, *prep.* throughout, KH. 1078; *adv.* yonder, far away; ȝent, KH. 1261 H; gonde, beyond, F. & B. 210 C. OE. *geond*.
 geng, *dat. sing.* company, Ass. 220 C. OE. *genge*.
 gent, *adj.* noble, F. & B. 47 Cott. OF. *gent*.
 ȝere, yere, *sb.* year; *pl.* ȝere C, yere L, KH. 102. OE. *gēār*.
 ȝerne, *v.* desire, ask for; 1 *sing. pres.* ȝerne C H, herne L, KH. 985; *infin.* KH. 1495 L, 1517 C. OE. *geornian*.
 ȝerne, *adj.* willing, desirous, eager, KH. 1165 C, 1472 H, etc. OE. *georn*.

3erne, *adv.* eagerly, F. & B. 127, 375, 588 C. OE. *georne*.
 (pure3) gersume, reward, F. & B. 405, 419, 773 C. Cf. *garisone*.
 gesninge, gestinge, iustinge, *sb.* entertainment, F. & B. 82, 125, 164 C., 175 Cott.
 gesse, *infin.* guess (?), agesse C, agesce L, gesse H, KH. 1267.
 3euen, v. give, KH. 170, 172, etc. OE. *giefan*, *gifan*.
 gigours, *nom. plur.* violin players, KH. 1592 C. OF. *gigueour*.
 ginne, gynne, *sb.*? (1) contrivance, scheme. (2) tool, penis, KH. 1574 C H; F. & B. 131, 195, 206, 258 C., etc.; F. & B. 1032, 1048 T. ON. *ginna*, Lat. *ingenium*.
 ginnur, *sb.* engineer, workman, F. & B. 324 C.
 gle, glewe, *sb.* song, joy, KH. 1352 C H; Ass. 483 Add. OE. *glēow*, *glīw*.
 glede, *sb.* coal, KH. 532 L H. OE. *glēd*.
 gleowinge, glewinge, gleynge, *sb.* play, KH. 1588.
 glide, *infin.* (1) glide, (2) slip away, KH. 146 L, 1127. OE. *glīdan*.
 gloue, glouen, *acc. plur.* gloves, KH. 848. OE. *glōfa*.
 Godhild, Godild, Godyld, Godylt, KH. 7, 72, 75, 158, 159, 1458.
 Godmod, Horn's assumed name, KH. 821, 833, 879, 883, 895, 911, 925, 949, 952, 965, 987.
 3onge, 3ynge, *adj.* young, KH. 137, etc. OE. *geong*.
 3ore, *adv.* long ago, F. & B. 174 C. OE. *gēara*.
 grace, *sb.* virtue, power, KH. 605. OF. *grace*.
 grame, *sb.* anger, wrath, F. & B. 712 C.; Ass. 515 H, Ass. 738 Add. OE. *grama*.
 igraue, hygraue, ygraued, *pp.* scratched, engraved, KH. 599. OF. *grafan*.
 grede, v. cry out; *infin.* F. & B. 454 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* gredde, KH. 1282 H. OE. *grædan*.
 greding, *sb.* clamour, lamentation, Ass. 213 Add.
 greithe, greþi, *infin.* prepare, make ready, Ass. 120 C, 128 Add. ON. *greiða*.
 grete, *infin.* weep, KH. 957 C L. OE. *grētan*.
 gripe, *infin.* grip, seize, KH. 55. OE. *grīpan*.
 grisen, v. feel horror; *infin.* agrise C L; agryse H, KH. 925; 3 *sing. pret.* gros C, agros L, H, KH. 1410. OE. *āgrīsan*.
 grom, *sb.* boy; *nom. sing.* grom, KH. 1035 L H; *nom. pl.* grome, KH. 175, F. & B. 111 T. ON. *gromr*.
 grunde, grounde, *sb.*; *dat. sing.* ground, bottom, KH. 110, 144, 352, 1242.
 gume, *sb.* man; *nom. sing.* gume, F. & B. 261 C.; *nom. plur.* gomes, KH. 24, gumes C, gomen H; grome L, KH. 175. OE. *guma*.

[halke](#), *dat. sing.* corner, KH. 1167 C L. OE. *healoc*.

Harild, Alrid, Ayld, Aþyld, KH. 815, 877, 878.

harwed, 1 *sing. pret.* harrowed, Ass. 463 Add. OE. *hergian*.

hatere, *sb.* garments, Ass. 149 C. OE. *hæteru*.

hatte, 3 *sing. pret.* became hot, KH. 646 C. OE. *hætan*.

heelee, 1 *sing. pres.* conceal, F. & B. 820 T, 533 C. OE. *helan*.

heete, 3 *sing. pret.* was named, F. & B. 1004 T. Cf. *hoten*.

helde, v., *see* holde.

helde, *sb.* faith, allegiance, F. & B. 397 C. OE. *hyldo*.

heleþ, 3 *sing. imper.* conceal, Ass. 188 C, *see* heele.

hende, *adj.* (1) prompt, gracious, alert, KH. 391, 1197, 1345, etc., F. & B. 156 T, etc.; (2) near, ready, KH. 1217 H. OE. (3e)hende.

henne, hanne, hennes, *adv.* hence, KH. 50, 337, 341 C.

hente, v. grasp, receive, get; *infin.* KH. 1032 H; 1 *pl. pret.* KH. 919 L; *pp.* hent, Ass. 453 C.

hepe, *dat. sing.* throng, crowd, F. & B. 466 C. OE. *hēap*.

her, *see* er.

here, *poss. pron.* their; *nom. sing.*, KH. 9, etc.

heren, v. hire; 3 *sing. pret.* hurede C, herde L, herde L H, KH. 806. OE. *hȳrian*.

heste, *dat. sing.* command, hest, F. & B. 610 C. Cf. Skeat.

het, 3 *sing. pret.* bade, F. & B. 608, 619 C. OE. *hātan*.

heynde, *sb.* hind (?), KH. 686 L. OE. *hind*.

hiȝe, v. hasten, hie; 3 *sing. pret.* KH. 1042 C. OE. *higian*.

hiȝhede, *sb.* height, F. & B. 327 C.

hitten, v. hit, strike; 1 *sing. pres.* anhitte C; *infin.* hette L, KH. 758. ON. *hitta*.

hol, *adj.* safe, KH. 161 C H etc. OE. *hāl*.

holde, helde, v. hold, KH. 323, 482. OE. *healdan*.

holde, *adj.*, *accus. pl.* faithful, KH. 1339 L H. OE. *hold*.

holt, *adj.* lame, halt, Ass. 516 H. OE. *healt, halt*.

hondhabbing, having in the hand, in the act, *en flagrant delit*, F. & B. 668 C. OE. *hondhæbbende*.

Horn, 9, 74, 121, 128, 135, 184, etc.; horn child 121 L, 128 C, 173, etc.; Horns 123 L; horn þe ȝynge 137 H; Hor 185 L, 397 L, 459 L, 558 L.

hoten, v. be called; 1 *sing. pres.* hote, KH. 821; 3 *sing. pret.* het C, hihte H, KH. 9, 27 C; *pp.* ihote C, hote L, yhote H, KH. 215, 1125 C. OE. *hātan*.

houe, 2 *sing. pret.* raised, KH. 1359 C H; ȝoue L. OE. *hebban*.

hurne, *dat. sing.* corner, KH. 1471 H. OE. *hyrne*.

hynde, *adj.* kind (?), F. & B. 355 T.

l—, I lome, etc., *see* lome, etc.

Ierusalem, Ass. 475 C, 594 Add.

Iewes, Iewis, Iewys, *nom. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 620 Add., 564 H, Iew 674 Add.; *dat. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 530 H, Iew, Ass. 620 Add.; *gen. sing.* Iewis, Ass. 553 H, etc.

Almost everything in this entry is wrong. As printed:

lewes, lewis, lewys, *nom. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 620 Add., 674 H [564 H corresponds to 674 Add.], Iew 674 Add.; *dat. sing.* Iewe, Ass. 530 C, Iew, Ass. 620 Add. [this is wrong, but the correct form has not been identified]; *gen. sing.* Iewis, Ass. 553 C, etc.

Ihesu, Ass. 51 Add., 324 C, 388 Add., Ihesus 481 C, Iesus 486 C; *gen.* Ihesus 624 Add., Crist 76 C, Ihesu crist 248 T, etc.

ilk, ylk, *adj.* same; *dat. sing.* ilke, KH. 948 C, ylke F. & B. 78 T, vlke C, hulke L, KH. 1285, etc. OE. *ilca*.

ynde, India, Ass. 611 C, 775 Add., 807 Add.

Iogelours L, iogelers H; *nom. pl.* jugglers, KH. 1592. OF. *jongleur*.

Iohan, Ion, Ass. 14 C, 15 Add., 49 C, 52 Add., 55 Add., 77 C, 224 C, 228 Add., etc.; *nom. sing.* seynt Ione, 820 Add.

Iosaphath, Iosephas, Iosephat, Ass. 472 C, 581 C, 754 Add.

Irisse, yrisse, yrisshe, Hyrische, KH. 1080, 1302 L, 1382, 1464.

Irlond, hirelonde, yrlonde, KH. 810 L, 1078 C, 1633 C H.

[lacchen](#), v. catch, take; *infin.* lacchen, KH. 686 L, lache KH. 702 L; 3 *sing. pret.* lazte C, laucte L, lahte H, KH. 259; 3 *pl. pret.* laucte, KH. 943 L, by laucte 705 L; 3 *pl. pret.* of laucte, 943 L. OE. *(3e)læccan*.

laze, lawe, *sb.* (1) law, (2) religion, (3) custom, KH. 69 C H, 1190. OE. *lagu*.

largeliche, *adv.* liberally, F. & B. 71 C. OF. *large*.

laste, leste, v. last, endure, KH. 6, 433 L, etc. OE. *læstan*.

lay, ley, *sb.* law, religion, KH. 69 L, 1642 H, Ass. 686 Add. OF. *lei*.

lef, leue, leof, luef, *adj.* dear, KH. 126 L, 342, 695, 754, 1013, 1457, etc.; F. & B. 151 C., 321 C., etc.; Ass. 40 C, 167 C, 42 Add., 173 Add., etc. OE. *lēof*.

lef, leue, leof, lyfe, *sb.* dear one, darling, F. & B. 108 T, 89, 103 Cott., 312 T, 831 T, 542 C. OE. *lēof*.
leue, v. believe, F. & B. 325 T. OE. *lēfan*, *lȳfan*.

bileue, v. remain; *infin.* KH. 381, F. & B. 103 Cott., 51 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* bilefte, Ass. 57 T, bileft 63 Add., 151 Add.; 3 *pl. pret.* bileft, Ass. 759 Add., etc. OE. *belāfan*.

leiȝe, leyhe, v. laugh; *infin.* leyhe L (lyȝe H?), KH. 372; 3 *sing. pret.* lowe L, loh KH. 373, louȝe C, lowe L H, KH. 1600; 3 *plur. pret.* lowȝ, F. & B. 1053 T, 776 C. OE. *hlehhan*.

leme, *sb.* light, brightness, F. & B. 198 C, Ass. 607 H. OE. *lēoma*.

lemman, leman, *sb.* dear one, leman, KH. 463, 589, 721. OE. *lēōfmon*.

lene, v. lend, KH. 491. OE. *lānan*.

leng, *compar.* longer, KH. 1183 etc. OE. *leng*.

lep, lepe, *sb.* basket, F. & B. 465 C., 738, 740, 741 T, 753 T, 758 T. OE. *lēap*.

lere, *sb.* cheek, F. & B. 501 C. OE. *hlēor*.

lere, v. teach, KH. 257, F. & B. 148 C, Ass. 896 Add. OE. *lāran*.

lese, leose, forlese, v. lose; *infin.* leose C. forlese L, forleose H, KH. 707; *pp.* forloren, KH. 511 C. OE. *forlēōsan*.

leste, luste, v. listen, KH. 355, 505, 1355 C. OE. *hlystan*.

leste, luste, v. desire, [hanker](#), lust, KH. 426, 433, 918, 1298. OE. *lystan*.

lesing, lesyng, *sb.* falsehood, F. & B. 84 T, 233 T, 585 C. OE. *lēāsung*.

lete, late, v. let, permit, leave, lose, KH. 1124 C, 1330 L; belete, leave behind, F. & B. 201 T, 1593; forlete, desert, KH. 232, F. & B. 201 Cott. OE. *lātan*.

let, lette, v. hinder, retard, impede, KH. 100, F. & B. 333 T, 25 C. OE. *lettan*.
 yliche, iliche, *sb.* like, equal, KH. 20, 305, 331, etc. OE. *gelīca*.
 licte, lyhte, v. alight, KH. 51 etc; 3 *sing. pret.* alizte, KH. 51 C. OE. *lihtan*.
 linne, lynne, blynne, v. cease, KH. 329, 372, 1068. OE. *linnan*.
 list, *sb.* art, KH. 251, 1577. OE. *list*.
 lite, lyte, *adj., adv.* little, KH. 1004, 678 L, 1211 C. ON. *litt*.
 liþe, lyþe, v. listen, KH. 2, 354, 372 H, 436 L. ON. *hlýða*.
 lodlike, *adj.* loathsome, hateful, KH. 1415 L.
 lofte, *sb.* loft, upstairs, women's apartments, KH. 974 C. OE. *loft*. ON. *lopt*. The peculiar turn of meaning is Scandinavian.
 loke, loky, v. watch, guard, KH. 800, 1180, 1181 L H, 1419 L H, Ass. 47 C. OE. *lōcian*.
 looking, lokyng, *sb.* care, watch, KH. 360.
 ilome, *adv.* frequently, F. & B. 96 Cott. OE. *gelōme*.
 londiss, *adj.* native, KH. 671. Cf. *vnlondisse*, KH. 672 H. OE. *lendisc*.
 longest, 3 *sing. pres.* belongest, KH. 1406 C. OE. *longian*.
 lore, *sb.* teaching, bidding, KH. 472. OE. *lār*.
 loþe, *adj.* hateful, KH. 1140, 1283. OE. *lāð*.
 Lombardy, F. & B. 179 T. French version has (En)Lombardie 49.
 lure, v. (1) lour, look sullen (?), (2) lie in wait, set trap (?), KH. 286, 1312.
 luste, *impers.* be pleasing, F. & B. 378 C.
 lut, *sb.* little, KH. 658 H. OE. *lȳt*.
 luþere, *adj.* evil, bad; *nom. plur.*, KH. 530 C. OE. *lȳðer*. Cf. *of þan luþer folke* (= accursed), Lay. 29576 B.
 lyst, *sb.* desire, pleasure, Ass. 2 Add. OE. *lyst*.

maine, meyne, meigne, *sb.* household, Ass. 110 C, 417, 475, 569, 573 Add.; F. & B. 782 C, 1059 T. OF. *maisnee*.
 maister, *sb.* leader, KH. 659; maister-king, KH. 659 L, 680. OF. *maistre*.
 make, *sb.* wife, spouse, KH. 1523, F. & B. 78 Cott., 303 T. OE. *gemaca*.
 make, v. pretend to be, F. & B. 76 T.
 male, *sb.* bag, pouch, F. & B. 689 T. OF. *male*.
 manrede, *sb.* homage, F. & B. 395 C. OE. *manræden*.
 Marie, Marye, *gen.* Maries, Ass. 29 C, 31 Add., 239 C, 241 Add., 253 C, 498 H, 500 H, 546 C, etc.; *seynt Marye*, F. & B. 248 T; *seynte-marie*, F. & B. 49 V.
 may, *sb.* may, maid, KH. 329, 979 H, 1019 H, 1516 H; F. & B. 201 T, 393 T, 46, 102 C., etc.; Ass. 4 C, etc. OE. *māg*.
 me, *indef. pron.* one, KH. 1008 C H, 1126 C; F. & B. 671, 672, 699 C., etc. OE. *man(n)*.
 mede, *sb.* mead, meadow, F. & B. 434 C. OE. *mæd*.
 mede, *sb.* reward, KH. 288 L, 500, 1498 L, Ass. 638 Add. OE. *mēd*.
 meene, v. mourn, lament, 1 *sing. pres.* F. & B. 273 T. OE. *(bi)māenan*.
 meigne, meyne, *see maine*.

meniuer, *sb.* a kind of fur, F. & B. 110 C. Cf. Hausknecht's Note. Lat. *minutus varius*.
 menske, *sb.* honour, F. & B. 56 T. OE. *menniscu*, humanity; Icel. *menska*, honour.
 mesauenture, *sb.* ill luck, KH. 344 C L. OF. *aventure*.
 mest, *superl. adj.* most, KH. 26.
 mester, mystere, *sb.* (1) office, trade, (2) need, necessity, KH. 243, 581. OF. *mestier*.
 mete, *v.* meet, encounter, 3 *plur. pret.* metten. KH. 169. OE. *mētan*.
 ymete, *adj.* fit, reasonable, KH. 1401 L. OE. *gemāte*.
 mete, *v.* dream, KH. 1522. OE. *mātan*.
 meting, metyng, *sb.* dream, KH. 699. OE. *mātan*.
 mid, *prep.* with, KH. 22 L, 25 L, etc. OE. *mid*.
 middelerd, *sb.* earth, world, F. & B. 272 C. OE. *middangeard*.
 misliken, *v.* misplease, KH. 455. OE. *mislician*.
 mod, *sb.* mood, mind, KH. 297, 1579 C H. OE. *mōd*.
 modi, mody, *adj.* full of passion, angry, KH. 748. OE. *mōdiȝ*.
 Modi, Mody, KH. 1023, 1094, 1121 L, 1331 L, 1626.
 molde, *sb.* earth, KH. 335, F. & B. 343 T. OE. *molde*.
 mone, ymone, *sb.* companion, KH. 560, 840 C L. OE. *gemāna*.
 mone, *sb.* companionship, communion, participation, KH. 890 L, 1149 C.
 mote, moste, *v.* may, might, was to; mote, KH. 197, 218 C, 829; moste, KH. 67 C, 186; munthe (?), KH. 1508 L.
 Mountargis, F. & B. 66 T. French version, Montoire, 174, 316, etc.
 murne, *adj.* troubled, KH. 748. OE. *(un)murne*.
 Murry, Murri, morye, moye, moy, Mory, mury, KH. 4, 33, 73, 921, 1431. Cf. Maurius (Maurus), son of Aruiragus, Lay. 9895 ff. He defeats the invading Picts, and sets up a stone with runes to commemorate the victory.

[nabod](#) (ne + abod).

neb, nebbe, *sb.* face, F. & B. 615 C, 890 T. OE. *nebb*.
 nime, *v.* take; *infin.* nyme, Ass. 121 C; 2 *sing. subjunct.* or *imper.* nym, KH. 1205 L; 1 *sing. pres.* nime, KH. 713 L; 3 *sing. pret.* nam, nom, KH. 619, 1269, Ass. 33 C, 35, 59 Add., etc.; 3 *pl. pret.* neme C, nomen L H, KH. 64; *pp.* ynome, Ass. 6 C; vndernome, F. & B. 128 T, 189 T, 219 T, 227 T, 920 T, etc.; nam = went, Ass. 53 C. Cf. vndernom. OE. *niman*.
 nīping, *sb.* wretch, villain, evil man, KH. 210. OE. *nīðing*.
 noȝ, enough, KH. 196; inoȝe C, hy nowe L, ynowe H. OE. *genōh*.
 nonskyns, *adj.* of no kind, F. & B. 226 T. OE. *nānes cynnes*.
 noȝing, *adv.* not at all, KH. 290 C.
 Nubil, F. & B. 665 C. French, (de) Nubie, 2492.

[O](#), *prep.* until, KH. 134 H. OE. *oð*.

of drede, *see* dreden.

of reche, *see* reche.

on, *prep.* on, in; on mi lokyng, KH. 360 C; on kneuling, KH. 503 L.
 onde, *sb.* envy, Ass. 424 C. OE. *anda, onda*.
 one, *sb.* alone, solitary; hou one KH. 364 L, is one 559 L, go one 559 C, al one C, alon L, ys one H 650. Cf. Bradley-Stratmann.
 oppe, *prep.* upon, KH. 466, 480 L.
 or, *see* er, or oþer.
 ord, *sb.* point, beginning; *dat. sing.* orde C H, horde L, KH. 662; *dat. sing.* ord H, hord L, KH. 1475; *accus. sing.*, F. & B. 48 C. OE. *ord*.
 ore, *sb.* favour, grace, KH. 695, 1629 C, F. & B. 173 C. OE. *ār*.
 orfreys, *sb.* orfrey, gold fringe, F. & B. 371 T. OE. *orfreis*.
 Orgas, F. & B. 101 T. French, *Li dus Joras*, 357.
 oþer, *num.* second, KH. 201. OE. *ōðer*.
 oþer, *conj.* or, KH. 44. OE. *oððe*.
 oþer, *pr.* other, KH. 28. OE. *ōðer*.
 otter (buterfliȝe C), *sb.* butterfly (?), F. & B. 772 T.
 oueral, *adv.* everywhere, KH. 262 H. Cf. Germ. *überall*.
 out londisse, *adj.* foreign, KH. 635 L.
 ower, *gen. plur.* your, F. & B. 534 C. OE. *ēower*.

[paene](#), *adj.* pagan, KH. 159 C.
 payn, peynim, payen, pain, paynim, paen, etc., *sb.* paien, pagan, heathen, KH. 45, 63, 82, 87, 193, 935, 948, 950, 1412, etc.
 paynime, *sb.* heathen land, KH. 859.
 page, *sb.* boy, servant, KH. 1012 L H, 1379 H. OF. *page*.
 pal, palle, *sb.* costly sort of cloth, F. & B. 822 T, and Cott.; Ass. 631 H, 795 Add. OE. *pæll*, OF. *pal*.
 parage, *sb.* high birth, F. & B. 256, 269 C., etc. OF. *parage*.
 paramur, *adv.* passionately, F. & B. 486 C., etc.
 Paryse, *nom. sing.*, F. & B. 168 T. Fr. *Paris*, 449, etc.
 pel, pelle, *sb.* skin, KH. 421, 1582 L. OF. *pel*.
 pelte, pulte, pylte, 3 *sing. pret.* pushed, KH. 1529.
 pilegrim C, pylegrim L, pelryne H, KH. 1236 pilgrim. OF. *pelegrin*.
 Petir, Petyr, Peter, Petre, Ass. 317, 327, 580, 581, 638, 639, 673 Add., 464, 470, 529 C, 499, 563 H, etc.
 ipight, *pp.* placed, F. & B. 117, 183 C.
 pine, pyne, v. pain; *infin.* KH. 726 C; 1 *sing. pres.*, KH. 1280 L; *pp.* pined C, pyned H, KH. 1280. OE. *pīnian*.
 pyne, *sb.* pain, torture, KH. 277 C H, Ass. 426, 458 Add. OE. *pīn*.
 plawe, *sb.* sport, fight, KH. 1170 H. Cf. Bradley-Stratmann, *plaze*.
 pleie, pleye, v. play, KH. 25, 200, 363. OE. *plegian*.
 pleing C, pleyhunge L, pleyzyng H, KH. 34, playing.
 plener, plenere, *adj.* full, F. & B. 179 C., 188 Cott. OF. *plenier*.

plizte, v. plight; *infin.* plizte, plyzte, plyhte, KH. 321; 2 *sing. imper.* plist, plyct, plyht, KH. 440; 1 *sing. pres. indic.* plizte C, plicte L, plyhte H, KH. 716; *pp.* iplizt, F. & B. 141 C. OE. *plihtan*.
 pomel, *sb.* pommel, F. & B. 209, 213 Cott. OF. *pomel*.
 porter, *sb.* doorkeeper, F. & B. 329 C. OF. *portier*.
 posse, v. push; *infin.* KH. 1087 C; 3 *sing. pret.* puste, KH. 1153 H; pugde 1156 L. OF. *pousser*.
 poure, pure, *infin.* pore, look, KH. 1172 C L.
 prede, *sb.* pride, KH. 1497 L. OE. *prȳta*.
 prime, *sb.* first quarter of the day, name of one of the offices of the Church, after 'lauds,' KH. 1040; *at prime tide*, KH. 905.
 pris, prys, *sb.* value, worth, KH. 968 C, F. & B. 310, 350, 750 C., 1028 T. OF. *pris*.
 pruesse, *sb.* brave deed, prowess, KH. 588. OF. *proesse*.
 pugde, *see* posse.

[quantityse](#), *sb.* cleverness, F. & B. 543 T.

qued, *sb.* bad, Ass. 174 C, 197, 465 Add. etc. OE. *cwēd*.
 quelle, v. kill; *infin.* KH. 65, 656 C; 2 *sing. imper.* quel, F. & B. 1008 T, aquel 725 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* quelde, F. & B. 904 T, aquelde KH. 929 L H, aquelde H, quelde C, KH. 1064. OE. *cwellan*.
 queme, v. please, KH. 517. OE. *cwēman*.
 queme, *adj.* pleasing, KH. 501 L. OE. *(ge)cwēme*.
 queþe, v. say; 3 *sing. pret.* quaþe, quoþ H, KH. 137, etc. OE. *cweðan*.
 quic, quike, *adj.* alive, KH. 92 C, 1468 C, 1478 H. OE. *cwic*.
 quite, aquite, *pp.* through with, quit of, F. & B. 171, 724 C., 180 Cott. OF. *aquiter*.
 qware, where, KH. 735 L.

[rake](#), *infin.* hasten, KH. 1126 L, 1158 L. OE. *rācian*.

rape, *sb.* haste, KH. 586 C, 1532 C.

rathe, *adv.* soon, quickly, KH. 1407 L, F. & B. 24 T, 193 T, etc. OE. *hræð*.

recche, rekke, v. reckon, care for; 3 *sing. pres.* recche C, reche L, yrecche H, KH. 370; 3 *sing. subj.* arecche, KH. 710 H; 1 *sing. pres.* rekke, F. & B. 96 T. OE. *reccan*.

reche, areche, ofreche, þorhreche, v. reach; *infin.* areche, KH. 1308 C; of reche, gain, KH. 1375 C L; þorhreche, traverse, KH. 1375 H; *pp.* araȝt, F. & B. 687 C, rauȝt F. & B. 974 T. OE. *rācan*.

rede, reed, reede, *sb.* counsel, opinion, F. & B. 45 T, 50 T, 53 T, 314 T, Ass. 294, 298 Add., etc. OE. *rād*.

rede, v. (1) read, (2) counsel, advise; *infin.* KH. 308, 511 L, 881, 966 L, F. & B. 21 T, 148, 151 C.; 1 *sing. pres.* KH. 966 C, F. & B. 75 T; *pp.* rad, Ass. 891 Add., irad F. & B. 578 C., yredde 858 T. OE. *rādan*.

rein, *sb.* rain, KH. 11.

reme, *sb.* coast (?), OE. *rima*; or realm (?), OF. *reaume*, KH. 1625 H (reaume 1623 L).

rende, *see* erne.

rende, v. rend, tear; 3 *sing. pret.* rente C H, to rente L, KH. 775.

rente, *sb.* pay, wages, KH. 984 C L. OF. *rente*.

reue, *sb.* reeve, guard, KH. 1418. OE. *(ge)rēfa*.
 reue, reyue, *infin.* rob, plunder, F. & B. 209 C., Ass. 168 Add. OE. *rēāfian*.
 rewe, *infin.* rue, repent, KH. 398. OE. *hrēowan*.
 rewlich, *adj.* sad, KH. 1129. OE. *hrēowlīc*.
 reyne, ryne, birine, *infin.* rain, KH. 11.
 Reynes C, reny L, Raynis H, KH. 1023.
 Reynild, Hermenyl, hermenylde, ermenyld, KH. 973, 1636. ON. *Ragnhilda*, OE. Eormenhild, daughter of Eorcenbriht, king of Kent.
 riche, *sb.* kingdom, KH. 20. OE. *rīce*.
 rigge, *sb.* back, KH. 1138. OE. *hrycg*.
 rime, ryme, *sb.* rime, speech, KH. 860, 1461.
 rive, *adj.* abundant, F. & B. 73 Cott. OE. *rīf*.
 riuen, ariuen, *v.* arrive, land; *infin.* ariue C, aryue H, KH. 193; *pp.* riued, KH. 162 L, 193 L, ariued, aryued, KH. 40, 162.
 rizte, *adv.* direct, at once, KH. 1428 C.
 roche, *sb.* rock, KH. 79.
 rode, *sb.* cross, rood, KH. 346, Ass. 12, 19 C, 44 C, 46 Add., 270 C, etc. OE. *rōd*.
 roþer, *sb.* rudder, KH. 202. OE. *rōðer*.
 roun, rowne, *sb.* counsel, KH. 1378. OE. *rūn*.
 runde, rounde, 3 *sing. pret.* whispered, F. & B. 716 C., 999 T. OE. *rūnian*.
 Rymenhild, rimenild, rymenyld, reymnyld, rymenild, reymild, reymyld, Rymyld, rimenyld, etc., KH. 264, 293, 393, 472, 600, 652, 691, 738, 741, 1510, etc. Rimhild, OE. *nomen mulieris*.
 ryue, *sb.* shore, KH. 142.

[sake](#), *v.* contend, fight; 3 *pl. pret.* asoke C, forsoken L H, KH. 69, gave up. OE. *sacan*.
 sale, *sb.* hall, KH. 1187 C H. OE. *sal*.
 salyley, scribal error (?), KH. 199 L.
 Sarazin, sarazyn, KH. 42, 636, 645, 671, 1415, 1477 H, 1479.
 scene, schene, *adj.* beautiful, KH. 97 L, 178 L, F. & B. 263 C. OE. *scēne*.
 schautillun, *sb.* model, F. & B. 325 C.
 schenche, *v.* give, serve, dispense; *infin.* schenche, shenche, KH. 1186; 2 *sing. subjunct. or imper.* shenh, KH. 1199 H. OE. *scencan*.
 schende, *v.* (1) scold, (2) injure; *infin.* KH. 747 L, 724; 3 *sing. pret.* schente, schende, shende, KH. 340. OE. *scendan*.
 schete, *v.* shoot, KH. 1011. OE. *scēotan*.
 schillen, *v.* sound; 3 *sing. pres.* shilleþ, KH. 224 L. OE. *scillan*.
 schonde, *sb.* harm, disgrace, KH. 746, 760 C, F. & B. 942 T. OE. *scand*, *sceand*.
 schrede, *v.* clothe; 3 *sing. pret.* schredde L, sredde H, KH. 625, schredde C L, shredde H, KH. 896; 3 *pl. pret.* schrudde C, schurde L, KH. 1582. OE. *scrȳdan*.
 schrewe, *sb.* shrew, evil person, KH. 60. OE. *scrēāwa*, barn mouse.
 schulle, *adv.* shrill, sonorous, KH. 221 C. OE. *scylle*, *scelle*.

sclauyne, *sb.* pilgrim's cloak, KH. 1134, 1137, 1310. OF. *esclavine*.
 scrippe, *sb.* scrip, sack, KH. 1141. ON. *skreppa*.
 scur, *sb.* shower, F. & B. 73 Cott. OE. *scūr*.
 sekerly, *see* sikirli.
 senpere, *sb.* bridge keeper (?), F. & B. 500 T, 513 T.
 sere, *sb.* apparel (?), contrivance (?), Ass. 704 Add. OE. *searo*.
 seriauns, *sb.* sergeant, man at arms, F. & B. 218 C. OF. *sergant*, *serjant*.
 serie, *infin.* dispense, KH. 1489 C. OE. *scerwen*, 'a scattering.'
 seyne, *sb.* snare, fishing net, KH. 726 L. OE. *segne*, OF. *seine*.
 shrelle, *infin.* cry, F. & B. 756 T.
 sib, sibbe, *sb.* kinsman, kindred, KH. 68, Ass. 181 C, 185 Add., 585 H. OE. *sibb*.
 side, syde, *sb.* (1) side, (2) shore, KH. 35, 145. OE. *sīde*.
 sike, syke, syken, *v.* sigh, KH. 456; 3 *sing. pres.* sykes, F. & B. 113 T; 3 *sing. pret.* syȝt, syȝte, F. & B. 256, 270 T, 417, 431 C. OE. *sīcan*.
 sikirli, sekerly, *adv.* certainly, Ass. 390 Add., F. & B. 92 T. OE. *sicor*.
 siȝe, syȝe, *sb.* time, KH. 374 C, 1446, F. & B. 196 T. OE. *sīð*.
 sithen, *conj.* since, Ass. 283, 422 Add. OE. *siððan*.
 siȝpe, sitthe, sithen, *adv.* afterwards, KH. 1185 C, 1238, Ass. 542 Add., 434 C. OE. *siððan*.
 skeete, soon, quickly, F. & B. 1005 T. OE. *scēot*, ON. *skiōtr*.
 skille, skyle, *sb.* right, reason, Ass. 312 H, 352 Add. Icel. *skil*.
 slitte, *sb.* opening in garment, pocket, F. & B. 348 C.
 slon, *v.* slay; *infin.* slen C, slon L, slo H, KH. 91, 47; 3 *pl. pret.* sloȝen C, slowe L, slowen H, KH. 195; *pp.* aslaȝe C, yslawe L H, KH. 94. OE. *slēan*.
 sloo, *sb.* slough, Ass. 507 H. OE. *slōh*.
 smerte, *v.* pain, KH. 1602. OE. *smeortan*.
 snelle, *adj.* quick, KH. 1581 C. OE. *snell*.
 so, *conj.* as, KH. 14, 15, etc.
 soler, *sb.* upper room, summer room, F. & B. 173. OF. *solier*, Lat. *solarium*.
 sond, sonde, *sb.* (1) message, (2) dish at table, Ass. 634 H, 798 Add., F. & B. 1072 T.
 sonde, *sb.* messenger, KH. 281, 287, (ysonde 287 L), 992 H, 1005 C H, etc., F. & B. 796 C., Ass. 106 C, 682 Add. OE. *sand*, *sond*.
 sore, *sb.* pain, KH. 75 L H. OE. *sār*.
 sore, *adv.* much, very, KH. 73, 362. OE. *sāre*.
 soth, soȝ, soȝe, *adj.* true, F. & B. 321 T, etc. OE. *sōð*.
 soune, *sb.* sound, KH. 224 H. Fr. *son*.
 soune, *adv.* clearly, KH. 224 L.
 Spaine, Spayne, Spaygne, Speine, F. & B. 413, 769 C., 1046 T.
 spede, *sb.* speed, good luck, KH. 491. OE. *spēd*.
 spede, *infin.* speed, have good fortune, KH. 852 C H, F. & B. 1026 T. OE. *speke*, *bispac*, *spēdan*.
 spell, selle, *sb.* tale, KH. 1015 H, 1106. OE. *spell*.

spille, spylle, v. perish, kill, KH. 208, 720 L, F. & B. 1007 T; *pp.* ispild, killed, Ass. 19 C. OE. *spillan*.
 squire, *sb.* square, F. & B. 325 C. OF. *esqvarre*.
 stage, *sb.* upper floor of a house, F. & B. 218, 270 C. OF. *estage*.
 stede, *sb.* horse, steed, KH. 51. OE. *stēda*.
 stede, *sb.* place, KH. 273, Ass. 730, 866 Add. OE. *stede*.
 steke, v. pierce; 2 *sing. pres.* stikkeſt, F. & B. 98 Cott.
 stere, *sb.* rudder, ship, KH. 107 C, 1471 C. OE. *stēor*.
 stere, v. lead, command, KH. 464 C, L. OE. *stēōran*.
 sterne, *adj.* stern, insolent, KH. 935 C, 784 H. OE. *sterne*, *styrne*.
 sterte, v. start, leap, F. & B. 457 C. ON. *sterta*.
 sterue, v. die, KH. 829, 980 C, 984 H, 1253 C. OE. *steorfan*.
 steuene, *sb.* voice, KH. 1453 L, F. & B. 54 C., Ass. 73, 239 C, 79, 245 Add., etc. OE. *stefn*.
 stey3, 3 *sing. pret.* climbed, F. & B. 892 C. OE. *stīgan*.
 stonde, *infin.* spring up, rise, KH. 809 L, H. Cf. Lay. 20509.
 stonge, 3 *pl. pret.* pierced, KH. 1475 L H, Ass. 447 Add. OE. *stingan*.
 store, *adj., nom. plur.* great, strong, F. & B. 19 C. OE. *stor*.
 stounde, stunde, *sb.* point of time, period of time, F. & B. 327 T, Ass. 635, 727 Add., KH. 181 C, 351, 791, 1030, 1371. OE. *stund*.
 striken, 3 *pl. pret.* struck, stripped (Stratmann)?, striken L H, strike C, KH. 1089. OE. *strīcan*.
 sture, *infin.* stir, move, KH. 1541 H. OE. *styrīan*.
 Sture, name of a river, KH. 729, 1551.
 Suddene, Sodenne, Sudenne, Suddenne, KH. 155, 189, 542, 929, 1062, 1351, 1370, 1389, 1463, 1637.
 sundry, *adj.* separate, apart, Ass. 148, 364 Add. OE. *syndrig*.
 sune, 2 *sing. subj. pres.* sound, KH. 223 C. OF. *soner*.
 swage, *infin.* assuage, abate, F. & B. 38 T. OF. *asuager*.
 swere, swire, suire, *sb.* neck, KH. 796, 1144, 1291, F. & B. 1016 T. OE. *swira*, *sweora*.
 sweting, *sb.* favourite, KH. 234 L.
 sweuen, *sb.* dream, KH. 710, 723. OE. *swēfen*.
 sweuening, *sb.* dream, KH. 774.
 swike, swyke, *infin.* deceive; biswike C L, bysuyke H, KH. 306; biswike C, swike L, byswyke H, KH. 711. OE. *swīcan*.
 swilc, swihc, such, etc., such. OE. *swylce*.
 swīpe, swype, supe, *adv.* (1) very, KH. 96, 98 L H, 172, 192, etc., Ass. 355 C, F. & B. 87, 280 C.; (2) soon, quickly, rapid, KH. 129 L H, 374 L, 435 L, 289, 845, 1042, etc., F. & B. 148, 308 C., Ass. 612, 671 H, 839 Add., etc. OE. *swīðe*.
 iswo3e, yswowe, *pp.* in a faint, KH. 458, 914.
 swo3ning C, swohinge L, swowenyng H, *sb.* fainting spell, swoon, KH. 474.
 swongen, 3 *pl. pret.* suspended, (?) Ass. 443 Add. OE. *swingan*.
 swymme, swemme, *infin.* move on water, KH. 203. OE. *swimman*.

take, v. take, give, KH. 568, 834, 1134, 1204, F. & B. 207 T, 159 C., Ass. 48, 682 Add., 572 H, etc.; bitak, KH. 839 C, bytoke L, bitoke H, KH. 1179. Cf. teche, biteche. ON. *taka*.

targeþ, v. delay, F. & B. 226 Cott. OF. *targier*.

te, ten, v. draw; *infin.* te, Ass. 282 C, ten KH. 767 T, teon 767 H; 3 *sing. pret.* te3, F. & B. 617 C.; 2 *sing. imper.* te, KH. 327 L. OE. *tēon*.

teche, v. usually 'teach,' sometimes 'give' (cf. take); *infin.* teche, give, Ass. 46 C; 1 *sing. pres.* biteche, KH. 619 L H.

tendeþ, v. set on fire, burn, F. & B. 672 C. OE. (*on*)*tendan*.

tene, teone, *sb.* injustice, harm, KH. 367, 727; anger, F. & B. 902 T. OE. *tēōna*.

terme, *sb.* term, period, F. & B. 432 Cambr. OF. *terme*.

teyse, *sb.* measure of three yards, F. & B. 201, 203 Cott. OF. *toise*.

þar, v. need, KH. 408 L. OE. *þearf*.

þat, (1) *demonstr.* the, that, KH. 27, 28; (2) *rel.* that, KH. 2, 22; (3) *conj.* that, KH. 33 L; (4) *comp. rel.* him, who, KH. 1064 C.

the, *infin.* prosper, thrive, F. & B. 566 T. OE. *ðēon*.

þinke, v. seem; *infin.* KH. 1233; 3 *sing. pres.* þinkþ, KH. 1405 C, etc.; þincheþ, F. & B. 169 C.; of þinke, misplease, repent, *infin.*, KH. 112, 1046 C H, 1136. OE. *þyncean*.

þo, *adv.* then, KH. 52, etc. OE. *ða*.

þole, þolie, v. endure, suffer; *infin.*, F. & B. 422, 677, 678, 737 C., Ass. 22, 215 C, 26, 217, 219 Add.; 3 *sing. pret.*, F. & B. 580 C., etc. OE. *þolian*.

Thomas, F. & B. 611 C, 659, 775, 796, 807, 821 Add.

þorhreche, *see* reche.

þral, þralle, *sb.* slave, thrall, KH. 449. OE. *þræl*.

þroze, *sb.* period of time, KH. 354, 1036. OE. *þrāge*.

þrottene, þrettene, *num.* thirteen. OE. *þrēotȳne*.

þulke (þe + ulke), the same, F. & B. 746 C., etc.

þurston, KH. 875, 1057. Seems to be Norse. A frequent name of Hus Carls. Thurstan (Turstayn) is one of two tax collectors sent by Hardicanute to Worcester.

tide, *sb.* time, KH. 1563. OE. *tīd*.

tide, bitide, v. happen, betide; *infin.*, KH. 212 L H, 218 C; 3 *sing. pres.*, tit, tyt, KH. 1442 L H; bitide, *infin.* KH. 218 L H, 575. OE. *tīdian*.

Printed on two lines with superfluous "OE.":

tide, bitide, v. happen, betide; *infin.*, KH. 212 L H, 218 C; 3 *sing. pres.*, OE.
tit, tyt, KH. 1442 L H; bitide, *infin.* KH. 218 L H, 575. OE. *tīdian*.

timing, tymyng, *sb.* success, KH. 1701 C H. OE. *tīmian*.

tire, tyre, *infin.* tear, F. & B. 736 C., 1017 T. OE. *teran*.

tiþing, tidinge, etc., *sb.* tiding, KH. 138, 1058, 1318.

to, (1) *prep.* to, KH. 2; (2) *adv.* too, KH. 37 L H; (3) *prefix* apart, asunder.

to-brake, 3 *sing. pret.* broke apart, F. & B. 133 T.

to-draze, to drawe, *infin.* draw to pieces (cf. draw and quarter), KH. 1612; 3 *pl. pret.* KH. 195. Cf. *alle þa chirchen he to droh*, Lay. 29135 A.

toʒenes, *see* ʒen.

to-shake, *v.* shake to pieces. Ass. 356 C.

trende, 3 *sing. pret.* roll, KH. 460 H. OE. *trendan*.

trewage, truage, *sb.* tribute, homage, KH. 1618. OF. *truage*.

trewþe, *sb.* truth, troth, KH. 321. OE. *trēowð*.

Troye, *dat. sing.*, F. & B. 178 T.

Tune, *sb.* town, city, KH. 168. OE. *tūn*.

twie, tueye, tweyne, *num.* two, twain, KH. 943 H, 955. OE. *twēgen*.

twie, twye, *adv.* twice, KH. 1570 C L. OE. *tuwa*, *twiwa*.

tytte, 3 *sing. pret.* pull tightly (Bradley-Stratmann).

[vʒten](#), *sb.* morning, dawn, KH. 1474. OE. *ūhte*.

uncuþe, vncouþe, *adj.* unknown, KH. 781. OE. *cūð*.

vnderfonge, *see* fonge.

vnderʒete, *v.* perceive, learn; *infin.* F. & B. 49 T; 3 *sing. pret.* vnderʒat, F. & B. 35 C., etc.; *pp.*, F. & B. 292 T, and Cott. 556 C. OE. *undergietan*.

vndern, *sb.* noon, F. & B. 511 T; *ondarne*, Cott. OE. *undern*.

vndernome, *pp.* journeyed, F. & B. 189, 219 T; vndernome, set out, gone, 920 T. Cf. *noome*, gone, F. & B. 227 T.

vndrestode, 3 *sing. pret.* received, Ass. 564 Add.

vnmete, *adv.* violently, Ass. 354 C. OE. *unmete*.

vnmeþ, *sb.* immoderation, F. & B. 675 C. OE. *unmet*.

vnneþes, *adv.* with difficulty, F. & B. 63 T. OE. *unēāðe*.

unorne, *adj.* old, ugly, KH. 348, 1646 C. OE. *unorne*.

vnpliʒt, *sb.* peril, Ass. 194 Add.

unspurne, *infin.* kick open, KH. 1159. OE. *spurnan*.

vnwemmed, *adj.* spotless, Ass. 537 C. OE. *wamm*.

vrne, *see* erne.

utrage, *sb.* error for truage (?), KH. 1618 L.

[verde](#), *see* ferde.

verdoune, *sb.* troop, company (?), Ass. 455, 457 H.

vertu, *sb.* power, strength, F. & B. 370 T. OF. *vertu*.

vie, *sb.* life, Ass. 879, 889, 891 Add. OF. *vie*.

[warysoun](#), *sb.* reward, F. & B. 1051 T, *see* gersume, garisone.

wat, water, KH. 634 L.

waxe, wexe, *v.* grow, wax; *infin.*, KH. 101, 268 C, 312 C; 3 *sing. pret.* wex, KH. 268 L. OE. *weaxan*.

wed-broþer, *sb.* pledged brother, KH. 300 L. Cf. Lay. 14469 and Note 32209. Sax. Chron. 30, brother by baptism. Wace has for Layamon's wed-broðer, in one instance 'cousin,' in another 'nephew.' Cf. also Plummer, Two Saxon Chronicles, p. 25, bottom. ON. *veð brōðar*.

wedde, *v.* wed, marry; *infin.*, KH. 1021; 3 *sing. pret.* wedde (wax mad?); *pp.* wedde, KH. 316 C, L. OE. *weddian*.

wede, *sb.* clothes, KH. 1132. OE. *wæd*.

wel, *adv.*, (1) well, KH. 374 etc., (2) very, KH. 74 L, 97 L, 98 C, 131, F. & B. 147 C. OE. *wēl*.

welde, wolde, *infin.* wield, rule, KH. 324, 452 L, 972 L, F. & B. 207 T. OE. *wealdan*.

wem, *sb.* spot, stain, Ass. 647 Add. OE. *wamm*.

wende, *v.* turn, wend, go; *infin.*, KH. 971 C L, F. & B. 60 C.; 2 *sing. imper.* went C H, wend L; go, KH. 343, 755 C, 759 C H; *pp.* wend H, I wend C, turned, KH. 1170; went, turned, Ass. 346 Add.; biwente C, bywende L, bywente H; 3 *sing. pret.* turned around, KH. 339. OE. *wendan*.

wendling, *sb.* vagrant (?), KH. 754 L.

wene, *v.* think, KH. 131, 313, 1204, 1207, 1213, 1365. OE. *wēnan*.

wene, weene, *sb.* (1) thought, F. & B. 651 C.; (2) doubt, F. & B. 197 T, 181 Cott. OE. *wēn*.

were, 2 *sing. pres. subj.* wear. OE. *werian*.

werie, werye, *infin.* protect, KH. 839. OE. *werian*.

werne, wurne, *v.* prevent, KH.; *infin.*, KH. 938 L H, 1166 C, 1496 L, 1518 C. OE. *wyrnan*.

werþe, *v.* become, shall be; 2 *sing. pres.* wurstu C, worstu L, worþest þou H, KH. 342; 3 *sing. pres.* wurþ C, worþ L H, KH. 490, 728. worþe, KH. 509. OE. *weorðan*.

westernesse, westnesse, westene londe, westnesse londe, westnisse, KH. 172, 182, 228, 808, 993, 1017, 1088 C H, 1268, 1295 C H, 1615 C H.

whannes, wenne, whenne, *inter. adv.* whence, KH. 175. OE. *hwanne*, *hwenne*.

weturly, wytterli, *adv.* surely, F. & B. 819 T, Cott. ON. *vitrliga*.

wif, *sb.* woman, Ass. 18 C. OE. *wīf*.

wiȝt, *sb.* (1) bit, KH. 535; (2) being, person, KH. 715. OE. *wiht*.

wis, ywis, *adv.* certainly, indeed; KH. 131 C, 54 L H, 131 L H, 210 C, etc.

wise, *sb.* guise, KH. 378. OF. *guise*.

wise, wisse, *v.* conduct, direct, KH. 253 C, 443, 807 L, 1575. OE. *wīsian*.

wit, witte, wytte, *sb.* intelligence, understanding, wit, KH. 188, 692 C, 1164. OE. *witt*.

wite, *v.* 1 know; *infin.* KH. 309, 471 L, F. & B. 170, 609, 620 C.; 1 *sing. pres.* wole, Ass. 332 Add.; 2 *pl. pres.* woot, F. & B. 940 T; 2 *pl. subj.* weete, F. & B. 1031 T; 2 *sing. subj.* wite, 755 C.; 3 *sing. pret.* wiste, C L, nust H, KH. 84. Cf. also Ass. 32 C, 240 Add., etc. OE. *witan*.

wite, iwite, *v.* 2 guard, keep; 2 *sing. subj.* white, KH. 1569 H; *infin.* wite, F. & B. 555, 756 C. OE. *wītan*, *gewītan*.

wiþerling C, wiþering L, wytherlyng H, *sb.* enemy, foe, KH. 160.

wiþsegge, *v.* deny, KH. 1368. OE. *secgan*.

wode, *adj.* mad, KH. 950 L. OE. *wōd*.

wowe, wowe, awowen, wowen, *infin.* woo, KH. 578, 847, 1517 C. OE. *wōgian*.

wowe, wowe, *sb.* wall, KH. 1048. OE. *wāg*.

wolde, *see* welde.

won, *sb.* store, quantity, pomp (?); wip̃ ryche won, KH. 962 H, F. & B. 386 C.
wonde, *v.* hesitate, delay, KH. 355, 788. OE. *wandian*.
wone, wonie, wune, *v.* dwell, be accustomed to; *infin.* KH. 783, 1456, F. & B. 218 Cott., Ass. 184 C;
pp. wonede, KH. 80 L H, iwuned, F. & B. 567 C., etc. OE. *wunian*.
wone, wune, *sb.* custom, practice, F. & B. 557 C., 90 Cott., Ass. 20 Add. OE. *(ge)wuna*.
wood, *adj.* mad, F. & B. 936, 994 T. OE. *wōd*.
worship, *sb.* dignity, honour, F. & B. 1030 T. OE. *weorðscipe*.
worstu, thou shalt be, *see* werpe.
wreche, *sb.* vengeance, KH. 1376. OE. *wrēc*.
wreie, wreye, *v.* (1) bewray, (2) accuse, KH. 1338, 1341 L, F. & B. 816 T. biwreie, bewray, accuse,
KH. 380 C. OE. *wrēgan*.
wreke, *infin.* avenge, Ass. 726 Add., F. & B. 919 T; awreke, 640 C. OE. *wrecan*.
wringe, *v.* wring, twist; *infin.* wringe, wrynge, KH. 1142 H; 3 *sing. pret.* wrong, 1142 C; *pr. part.*
wringinde C, wringende L, wryngynde H, KH. 118. OE. *wringan*.
wrope, *adj.* fearful, afraid, KH. 366, 1304. OE. *wrāð*.
wunder, wonder, *sb.* wonder, harm, KH. 1335, 1536. OE. *wundor*. Cf. Mätzner, King Horn, 1247
Note, 1422 Note.
wyzte, *adj.* brave, dexterous, KH. 1080 L, 1302 L.
wynne, *sb.* joy, pleasure, F. & B. 333 T. OE. *wynn*.

[y-](#), *see* i-.

Differences between this e-text and the printed book

Sidenotes giving leaf-and-column information were often abbreviated for space. The forms “lf.” and “bk.” have been silently regularized to “leaf” and “back”. The full word “leaf” has been supplied where missing, except in references to the Trentham MS., where it was consistently omitted in the original.

Notes were variously printed in the side margin or at the bottom of the page, depending on space constraints. They have been treated as footnotes or sidenotes according to their function: information about the text or MS. (footnote), leaf- or column numbering (sidenote), narrative summary (sidenote). Where more than one MS was used, narrative sidenotes are shown at the beginning of each group of lines.

The recurring words “No gap in MS.” are in the original; they are generally followed by one or more blank lines inserted to keep the texts parallel. The words

are retained in *King Horn* to preserve the editor's line numbering; in the other texts they were retained only when needed to prevent ambiguity.

Each page of *King Horn* was divided into three: the Cambridge and Laud versions in adjoining columns, and the Harleian across the bottom, with lines printed in pairs separated by a | divider. For this e-text, the Harleian text has been separated into single lines to match the other two. General sidenotes were originally printed in the Harleian section.

Other Texts

At time of preparation, the three diagrams shown in the Introduction were available online at The Internet Archive:

Wissmann on King Horn:

<http://www.archive.org/details/dasliedvonkingh00wissgoog> (page n16)

Herzog on Floris and Blancheflur in Scandinavia:

<http://www.archive.org/details/diebeidensagenk00herzgoog> (page n100)

Hausknecht on Floris and Blancheflur:

<http://www.archive.org/details/florisandblaunc00hausgoog> (page n131)

In the Introduction to Floris and Blancheflur, the English passages printed alongside the French version are from Hausknecht's edition.

Inconsistencies

Preface:

The forms "H Z", "HZ." and "H. Z." (for "Haupt's Zeitschrift für deutsches Alterthum") each appear once.

The term "X type" (of OE. rime) appears both with and without period, and in both bold and ordinary type.

Some references to Hempl's test have "-wō-, -wō-" instead of the expected "-wō-, -wō-". These are shown as printed.

In a few paragraphs, the abbreviation "O.E." has been silently regularized to "OE."

General:

The abbreviations "V." and "Cott." (see beginning of Glossary) refer to the same MS., Cott. Vitell. D. III.

"MS. Gg. 4. 27. 2." is written both with and without final period (full stop).

When the editor is writing in his own voice, the Introduction uses "æ" while the notes use "ae". Middle English is always "æ" (one letter); Latin is always "ae" (two letters).

The Laud MS. always has "crist..." instead of the more common "crist..."

In the Notes, anomalous quotation marks such as 'R. H.' for R. H. (without quotes) are unchanged.